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ETHICS

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Paper - IV

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Chapter 1

Ethics And Human Interface

PYQs

[2026] Owing to paucity of time, a university professor generates a Ph.D. evaluation report using Artificial Intelligence and submits it with some modifications. Discuss this from the perspective of accountability and integrity. (10)

[2026] Dr. B. R. Ambedkar had cautioned that employing civil disobedience within a constitutional democracy equates to endorsing 'anarchy'. How should modern democracies navigate the ethical dilemmas posed by civil disobedience movements that aim to promote social justice against policies that may raise genuine concerns? (10)

[2026] Some moral philosophers argue that spending some of your resources, without significantly affecting your financial stability, to help other people who badly suffer is our moral duty and not merely a matter of charity. Justify this claim by explaining the distinction between duty and charity. (10)

[2025] "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment but a product of civil education and adherence to the rule of law." Examine the significance of constitutional morality for public servants highlighting the role in promoting good governance and ensuring accountability in public administration. (10)

[2024] "Ethics encompasses several key dimensions that are crucial in guiding individuals and organizations towards morally responsible behaviour." Explain the key dimensions of ethics that influence human actions. Discuss how these dimensions shape ethical decision-making in the professional context. (10)

[2024] "The concept of Just and Unjust is contextual. What was just a year back, may turn out to be unjust in today's context. Changing context should be constantly under scrutiny to prevent miscarriage of justice." Examine the above statement with suitable examples. (10)

[2023] Differentiate 'moral intuition from 'moral reasoning' with suitable examples. (10)

[2022] It is believed that adherence to ethics in human actions would ensure the smooth functioning of an organization/system. If so, what does ethics seek to promote in human life? How do ethical values assist in the resolution of conflicts faced by him in his day-to-day functioning? (10)

[2021] "Integrity is a value that empowers the human being." Justify with suitable illustration. (10)

[2020] Distinguish between laws and rules. Discuss the role of ethics in formulating them (10)

[2019] What is meant by the term 'constitutional morality'? How does one uphold constitutional morality? (10)

[2018] With regard to the morality of actions, one view is that means is of paramount importance and the other view is that the ends justify the means. Which view do you think is more appropriate? Justify your answer. (10)

[2018] "In looking for people to hire, you look for three qualities: integrity, intelligence and energy. And if they do not have the first, the other two will kill you." – Warren Buffett (10)

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Ethics and Human Interface

Introduction to Ethics

1. Ethics is derived from the **Greek** word ethos and the **Latin** word mores, which mean "custom," "ways of behaviour," or "human character.
2. According to philosopher **Mackenzie**, ethics is the study of moral values, focusing on what is good and bad, right and wrong.
3. Ethics is based on well-founded standards of right and wrong that prescribe what humans ought to do, usually in terms of rights, obligations, benefits to society, fairness, or specific virtues.

Determinants of Ethics

Foundational psychological forces (internal) and socio-cultural frameworks (external) that dictate moral standards and behavioral choices.

Internal Determinants of Ethics - They represent the "subjective" side of morality.

1. **Conscience:** The "inner voice" or moral compass that provides an immediate sense of right and wrong. **Eg. Gandhiji ended the Non-cooperation movement after Chauri Chaura**
2. **Knowledge & Awareness** about the consequences and nature of their action.
3. **Intent:** Even a "good" act can be unethical if the intent is malicious. Eg. helping a victim to later rob them.
4. **Values & Personal Beliefs**. **Ratan Tata's** decision to keep paying 26/11 victims' families for life reflects his core value of Empathy and Corporate Social Responsibility..
5. **Stage of Moral Development:** An individual's intellectual growth level that determines whether they do good out of fear of punishment or from universal principles.
6. **Voluntariness:** The degree of freedom or "free will" one has. Actions taken under extreme coercion are viewed with less ethical scrutiny.
7. **Attitude:** A settled way of thinking or feeling about someone or something that dictates one's response to an ethical dilemma.
8. **Moral Reasoning:** The logical process an individual uses to justify a decision. Eg. Utilitarianism vs. Deontology.
9. **Past Experience** that guides current moral judgments.
10. **Moral Courage: Satyendra Dubey** blew the whistle on the Golden Quadrilateral project corruption despite knowing the risk.

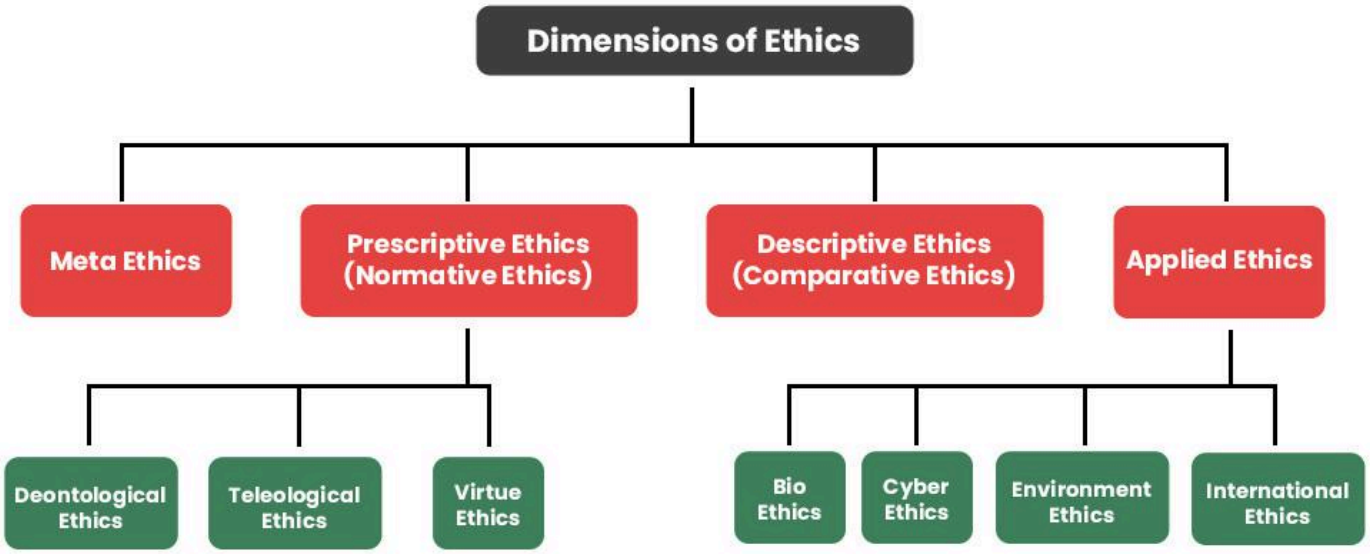
External Determinants of Ethics - They represent the "objective" side of morality.

1. **Constitution & Law:** provide a baseline for social conduct. Eg. Law against untouchability
2. **Religion-** offer a "Divine Command" code of conduct.
3. **Family & Upbringing:** The first institution of socialization where a child learns foundational virtues like truth and respect.
4. **Culture & Traditions:** Shared societal norms that define acceptable behavior. **Eg.** The practice of saying **Namaste**
5. **The judiciary** set ethical standards through judgments and guidelines. **Eg. Sabarimala case** upheld gender equality
6. **Media and Digital Ecosystem:** The films, and social media platforms constantly construct or shift public perceptions of right and wrong.
7. **Education:** provides intellectual development and exposes individuals to different moral philosophies

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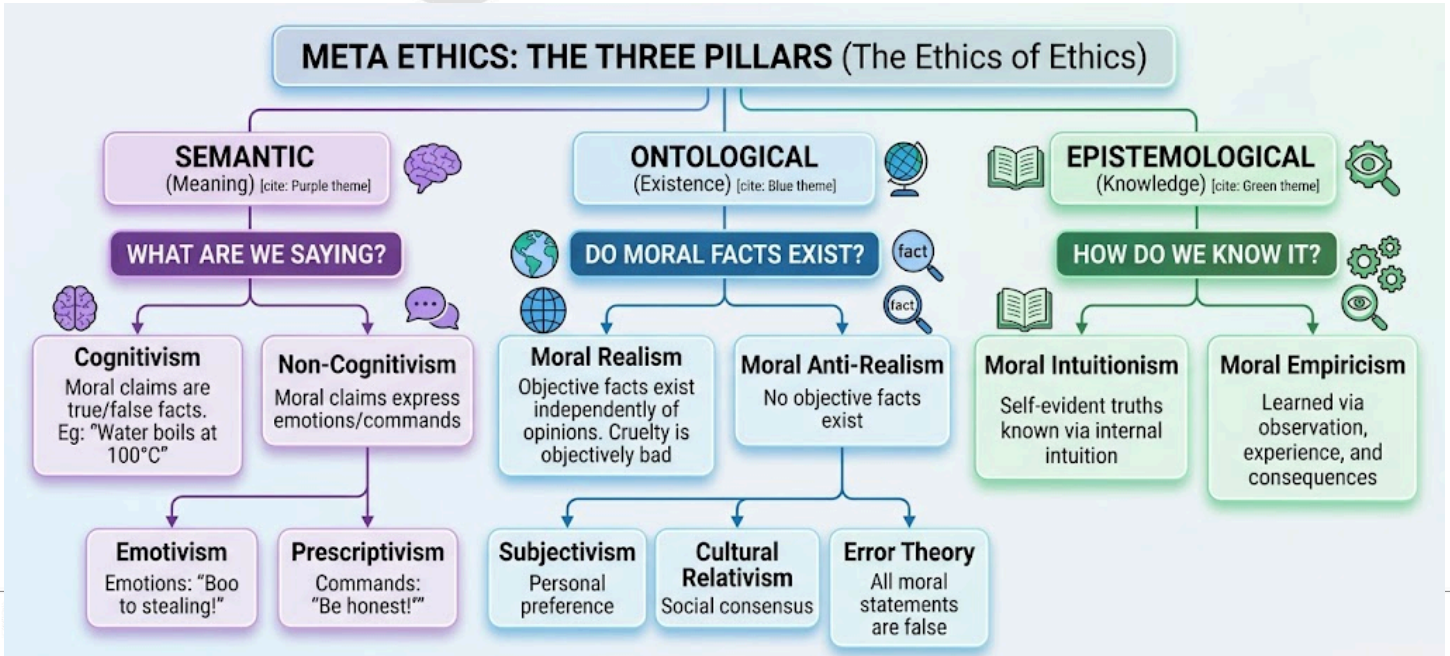
8. **Professional Codes of Conduct:** Rules governing specific fields, like the Hippocratic Oath for doctors or civil service rules for bureaucrats.
9. **Peer Influence:** The social pressure from friends and colleagues that can encourage either ethical behavior or moral compromise.
10. **Societal Expectations:** The "Social Contract" of what a community deems "good." **Eg. Nazi Germany - morally corrupt society** and **Sati - unethical practice** in traditional India.
11. **Leadership:** The influence of role models whose actions set a standard for followers.
12. **Situational Factors:** Eg. a "lie" told to save a life is viewed differently than a lie told for profit

Dimensions of Ethics



Meta Ethics

Meta-ethics is a major branch of ethics that studies the **nature, origin, language, and meaning of moral concepts**, rather than deciding what specific actions are right or wrong.



While **Normative Ethics** asks, "Is stealing wrong?" and **Applied Ethics** asks, "Is euthanasia ethical?", **Meta-ethics** steps back to ask:

1. "What does the word 'wrong' even mean?" * "Are moral values objective facts or just human opinions?" "How can we ever prove a moral statement?"

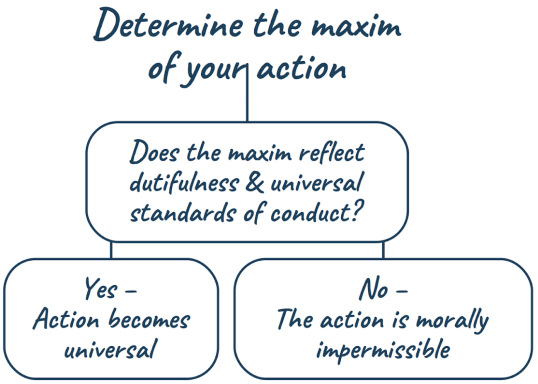
In short, it is the study of the foundation of ethics itself- the **"ethics of ethics."**

Normative Ethics

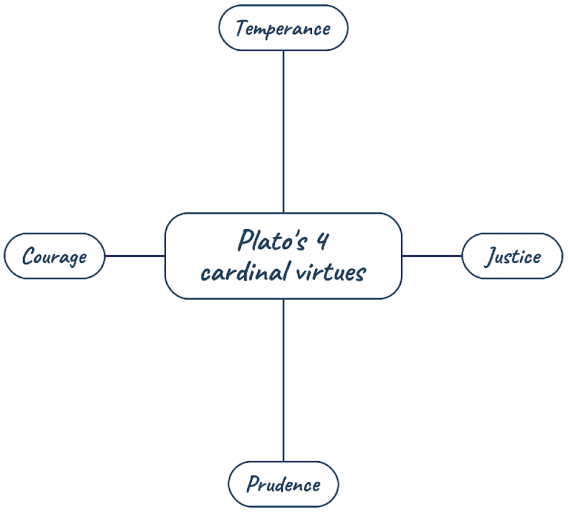
Normative Ethics is the branch of ethics that aims to establish a set of rules, principles, or "norms" to determine what we **ought** to do in our daily lives.

It is generally classified into three major schools of thought based on where they place the moral "weight."

1. **Deontology (Duty-Based Ethics)** - This school argues that the morality of an action is based on whether it follows a set of rules or duties. The consequences do not matter; only the "rightness" of the act itself counts.
   a. **Key Proponent:** Immanuel Kant.
   b. **Core Principle:** The "Categorical Imperative"-act only according to rules that you would want to become universal laws.
   c. **Eg.** A whistleblower exposing administrative fraud purely because "lying and deception are fundamentally wrong," even if doing so temporarily destabilizes an organization or harms their own career.



2. **Teleology / Consequentialism (Result-Based Ethics)** - This school argues that the "end justifies the means." The morality of an action is judged solely by its consequences.
   a. **Key Proponents:** Jeremy Bentham, John Stuart Mill.
   b. **Core Principle: Utilitarianism**-"The greatest good for the greatest number."
   c. **Eg.** In a medical crisis with limited medicine, a Consequentialist would give the dose to a person who can be saved and go on to help many others, rather than someone with a 1% chance of survival.
3. **Virtue Ethics (Character-Based Ethics)** - Instead of focusing on rules (Deontology) or outcomes (Teleology), this school focuses on the inherent character of the person. It asks, "What would a virtuous person do?"
   a. **Key Proponents:** Aristotle, Plato, Buddha.
   b. **Core Principle:** The **"Golden Mean"**-finding the perfect balance between two extremes (Eg. Courage is the mean between Cowardice and Recklessness).
   c. **Eg.** An honest person tells the truth not because of a rule or a result, but because **honesty is part of their identity**.



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The principal virtues and vices, according to Aristotle			
Sphere of feeling or action	**Excess (vice)**	**Mean (virtue)**	**Deficiency (vice)**
Fear and confidence	Rashness	Courage	Cowardice
Pleasures and pains	Self-indulgence	Temperance	Insensibility (rare)
Getting and spending (minor)	Prodigality	Liberality	Meanness
Getting and spending (major)	Tastelessness	Magnificence	Niggardliness
Honour and dishonour (minor)	Ambition	Proper ambition	Lack of ambition
Honour and dishonour (major)	Vanity	Proper pride [megalopsuchia]	Pusillanimity
Anger	Irascibility	Good temper	Lack of spirit
Self-expression	Boastfulness	Truthfulness	Mock modesty
Conversation	Buffoonery	Wittiness	Boorishness
Disposition to others	Obsequiousness	Friendliness	Cantankerousness
Shame	Bashfulness	Modesty	Shamelessness
Indignation	Envy	Proper indignation	Spite

Means vs End

The **Means vs. Ends** debate in ethics questions whether achieving a good outcome justifies using unethical methods.

Justification of "Means"

1. **Preservation of Human Dignity by** treating people as "ends in themselves". Eg. right to a dignified execution (no public hanging) for death row convict
2. **Moral Integrity:** As Gandhi said, "The means are the seed, the end is the tree."
3. **Predictability and Trust:** When the process is fair (Procedural Justice), it builds public trust in institutions.
4. **Prevention of Authoritarianism:** Strict adherence to ethical means (like the Rule of Law) prevents leaders from using "national interest" as a mask for tyranny.
5. **Long-term Sustainability:** Eg. Gandhian non-violent freedom struggle of India
6. **Avoidance of Moral Slip:** If we justify "small" bad means for "big" ends, it creates a slippery slope where eventually any atrocity can be justified.
7. **Certainty vs. Uncertainty:** We have total control over our **actions** (means), but we can never fully guarantee the **outcome** (ends). Therefore, we should focus on what we can control.
8. **Spiritual/Karmic Value:** Many traditions, like **Nishkama Karma in the Gita**, argue that performing one's duty (right means) is the only true moral obligation.
9. **Consistency:** Using right means ensures that our actions align with our stated values, preventing hypocrisy.

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Justification of "Ends" (The Result Matters)

Focus: Utilitarianism, Teleology, and Prerogative of State.

1. **Maximization of Welfare:** Eg. **Compulsory Vaccination** during the COVID-19
2. **Practicality and Realism:** Eg. **Krishna** advising **Yudhisthira** to tell half-truth about "Ashwatthama is dead" to defeat Drona
3. **Efficiency in Governance:** Sometimes, bureaucratic "means" can cause delays. Focusing on the "end" ensures that services reach the poor in time.
4. **Lesser of Two Evils:** If using a "questionable" mean (like a white lie) prevents a massive disaster, the end clearly outweighs the method used. Eg. **The Trolley Problem**
5. **Altruistic Sacrifice:** It justifies asking a small group to bear a burden for the survival or prosperity of the whole nation. Eg. progressive taxation
6. **Resource Optimization:** When resources are scarce, "ends-based" thinking ensures they are directed where they will have the most significant impact. Eg. Hospital Triage
7. **Many great historical shifts involved "messy" means** but resulted in the "end" of freedom for millions. Eg. American Revolution
8. **Outcome-Based Accountability:** In the private and public sectors, people are often judged by their results (KPIs).
9. **Prevention of Gridlock:** A pure "means" approach can lead to "**paralysis by analysis.**" An "ends" focus drives decisive action.
10. **Strategic Necessity:** In international relations (Realpolitik), the survival of the state is the ultimate "end" that justifies strategic maneuvers.

Descriptive Ethics

While **Normative Ethics** asks "What should we do?" and **Meta-Ethics** asks "What does 'good' mean?", **Descriptive Ethics** is the most grounded branch. It is an empirical field that simply asks, **"What do people actually believe is right or wrong?"**

It does not judge or prescribe rules; it functions like a social science (sociology or psychology) to map out the moral landscape of a society.

Key Characteristics of Descriptive Ethics

1. **Scientific Approach:** uses surveys, interviews, and historical analysis to gather data on moral beliefs.
2. **Value-Neutral:** A descriptive ethicist doesn't say "Stealing is bad." Instead, they say, "In this specific community, 90% of people believe stealing is bad."
3. **Comparative Nature:** It often compares the moral codes of different cultures, generations, or religions.

Aspect	Meta-Ethics	Normative Ethics	Descriptive Ethics
Focus	Nature, meaning, and origin of moral concepts	What is morally right or wrong, good or bad	What people actually believe and how they behave morally
Key Question	"What does 'good' mean?" "Are moral values objective?"	"What should one do?" "What is the right thing to do?"	"What do people actually do? What they actually consider right and wrong"
Approach	Philosophical/analytical	Philosophical/prescriptive	Empirical/social-scientific

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Aspect	Meta-Ethics	Normative Ethics	Descriptive Ethics
Judgmental?	No - analyzes concepts and language	Yes - prescribes moral standards and principles	No - records and explains beliefs without judgment
Examples of Theories	Moral realism, emotivism, intuitionism	Utilitarianism, deontology, virtue ethics	Cultural moral codes, ethical surveys, cross-cultural studies
Disciplines Involved	Philosophy, logic	Philosophy, political theory	Sociology, psychology, anthropology
Outcome	Understanding meaning and truth of moral language	Developing ethical principles and moral duties	Observing and reporting moral behavior and beliefs

Ethics and Morals

While often used interchangeably, ethics refers to external codes or rules, whereas **morals pertain to personal beliefs about right and wrong.**

Aspect	Ethics	Morals
Origin	Greek word "ethos" meaning "character"	The Latin word "Mos" means "custom".
Nature	Broader and systematic- designed to maintain social order and fairness	More individual and subjective
Source	External sources such as societal norms, laws, or professional codes of conduct.	Internal sources like individual conscience, family, religion, or personal experiences.
Basis	based on logic and reason	often based on religion or culture
Application	Applied in formal settings, such as the workplace, law, or professional conduct.	Applies more to personal life decisions and individual behavior in daily life.
Flexibility	Ethics largely stays universal. Eg. truth, compassion, non-violence, etc.	Usually consistent, although can change if an individual's beliefs change. Eg. views on homosexuality.
Enforcement	Enforced by external entities like laws, organizations, or professional bodies.	Self-enforced; relies on personal conviction and conscience.
Examples	Medical ethics, business ethics, legal ethics.	Honesty, kindness, respect for others.

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Ethics and Values

While all ethics are values, not all values are considered ethical. Ethics refers to moral principles that govern behavior, while values are personal or societal beliefs that guide actions.

All Ethics are Values

1. **Honesty**
2. **Justice**
3. **Integrity**
4. **Compassion**
5. **Non-Violence**

But Not All Values are Ethics

1. **Aesthetic Values:** You may highly **value** "Minimalist Architecture." While this is a preference you hold dear, it is not an **ethical** issue.
2. **Economic Values:** A company may **value** "Efficiency" or "Profit Maximization." Sometimes the value of profit can conflict with the ethics of environmental protection.
3. **Personal Preferences:** You might **value** "Punctuality." While it is a good trait, being five minutes late to a lunch with a friend is a "lapse in value," but it is rarely considered an "unethical" act
4. **Athletic Values:** A sportsperson might **value** "Physical Strength." But, being weak is not "immoral" or "unethical."
5. **Cultural/Social Values:** In some families, "Eating together at the table" is a strictly held **value**. However, a family member eating in their room is not committing an **unethical** act

Aspect	Ethics	Values
Definition	Rules or principles that govern appropriate conduct	Core beliefs or standards that guide individual behavior
Nature	External, social, and often codified (Eg. professional ethics)	Internal, personal, and subjective
Source	Society, profession, culture, or institution	Family, religion, upbringing, personal experiences
Scope	Concerned with what is morally right or wrong in actions	Concerned with what is personally important or desirable
Examples	Honesty in journalism, medical confidentiality, integrity in civil services	Honesty, loyalty, freedom, respect, success
Stability	More uniform within a group or profession	Varies significantly among individuals and cultures
Purpose	Maintain social and professional order	Drive personal goals and preferences

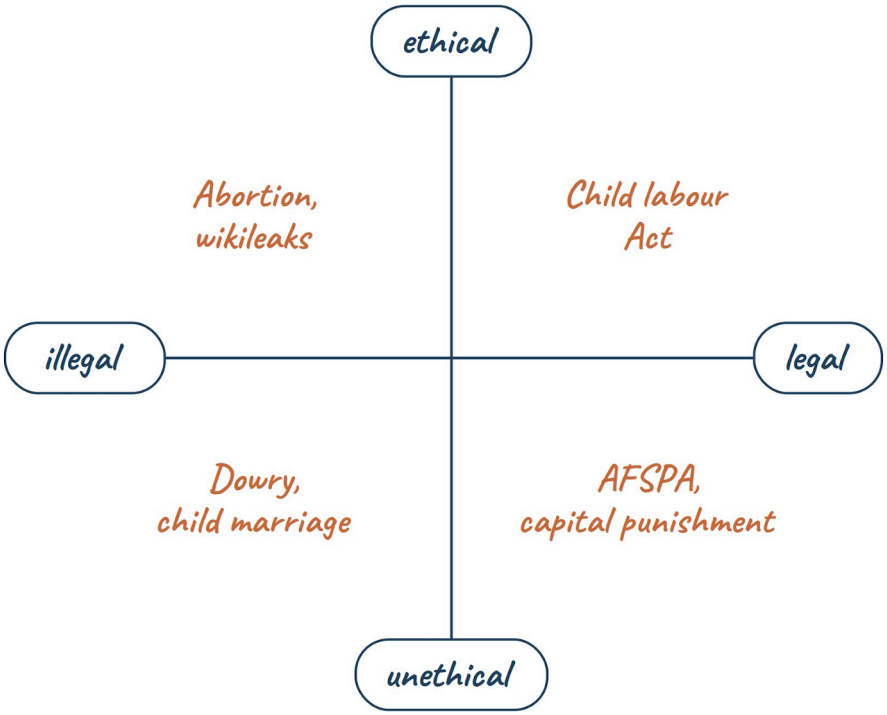
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Aspect	Ethics	Values
Conflict Possibility	Ethical duties may clash with personal values (Eg. whistleblowing)	One's values may contradict ethical expectations

Ethics and Laws

Law is a system of **enforceable rules established by authorities to regulate behavior, maintain order, protect rights, and promote justice** within society.

Law provides enforceable rules to regulate behavior, while ethics offers moral principles to guide personal and professional actions.



1. **"Law sets the minimum standard of human behaviour while ethics sets the maximum standard of human behaviour."**
2. **"Good people do not need laws, but bad people will always find ways to circumvent them" - Plato. Eg. tax evasion**
3. **"Law should be seen as a means to achieve good conduct, not an end in itself."**
4. "A strong society is built not by strict laws alone, but by individuals with good character" - **Swami Vivekananda**

Commonalities Between Laws and Ethics

1. **Regulate Human Behavior** - Both aim to guide and regulate individual and collective conduct in society. They promote order, harmony, and stability. Eg. Both laws and ethics discourage theft, fraud, and violence.
2. **Promote Social Good and Justice** - Both serve as tools to ensure fairness, protect rights, and promote social welfare. **They aim to minimize harm and maximize societal benefit.**
3. **Rooted in Shared Values** - Both reflect societal norms, customs, and collective conscience.
4. **Mutually Reinforcing** - Legal frameworks often codify ethical norms. **Eg. anti-corruption laws based on integrity.**
5. **Shape Public Expectations** - Both define what society expects in terms of acceptable behavior. Violations of either can result in social disapproval or institutional action.
6. **Dynamic and Evolving** - Both are not static-they evolve with changing values, knowledge, and societal needs. Eg. Legalization of same-sex marriage followed a shift in ethical attitudes.
7. **Examples**

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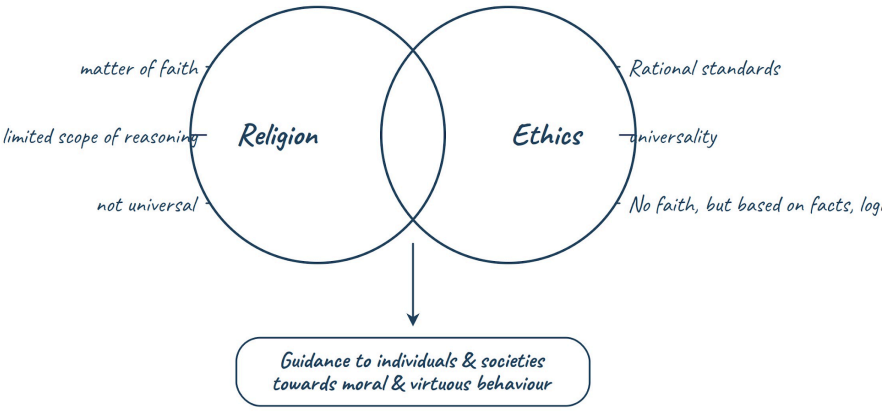
a. **Right to Information (RTI):** A legal right grounded in the **ethical principle of transparency**.
b. **Sexual Harassment at Workplace Law:** Reflects the ethical value of **gender equality and dignity**.

Aspect	Laws	Ethics
Definition	Formal rules enacted by a governing authority	Moral principles guiding what is right or wrong
Nature	**External** and enforceable by institutions (Eg. courts)	**Internal** and self-regulated by conscience or values
Source	Constitution, legislation, judiciary, government	Society, culture, religion, philosophy, professional codes
Purpose	Maintain order, ensure justice, and protect rights	Promote moral behavior and integrity
Enforcement	Enforced through legal systems and punishment	No formal punishment; guided by social or personal disapproval
Universality	Applies uniformly to all citizens	Can vary across individuals, cultures, and contexts
Examples	BNS, RTI Act, Contract Law	Honesty, loyalty, compassion, confidentiality
Punishment for Violation	Legal penalties (fine, imprisonment)	Moral guilt, social stigma, loss of reputation
Relationship	Laws can be based on ethical principles but not always ethical	Ethics often go beyond what laws require

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Ethics and Religion

Religions are sets of moral principles which guide society. Therefore, religion has a profound influence on ethics but ethics is not religion.



Religion can be questioned, as demonstrated by socio-religious reforms in India during the mid-19th century by reformers like **Raja Rammohan Roy**, **Swami Vivekananda**, and **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**.

1. Sometimes, practices considered religiously moral by individuals may not align with ethical standards. **Eg.**
   a. **Sati** (abolished by law in **1829**).
   b. **No entry of women** of certain age groups in **Sabarimala Temple**.
   c. **Casteism/Untouchability**.
   d. **Triple Talaq**.
   e. **Pardah System** (violates right to dignity).
2. Conversely, some acts deemed immoral by certain religions may be considered ethical. **Eg.**
   a. **Abortion**, seen as immoral in some religions, is ethical when done for valid reasons, respecting a woman's right to self-determination of motherhood.
   b. **Homosexuality**, deemed immoral by many religions, is accepted as ethical .
   c. **LGBTQ+ rights**, considered immoral by some, are recognized as ethical

Commonalities Between Ethics and Religion

1. **Both provide guidelines** for distinguishing right from wrong, good from bad. **Eg. Both commands truthfulness.**
2. **Values and Virtues** - Both uphold universal human values such as kindness, humility, patience, and justice.
3. **They provide a moral compass for individuals and communities to ensure social harmony and moral responsibility.**
4. **Influence on Law and Culture** - Many legal systems and ethical norms have evolved from religious traditions. Eg. Dharma influenced Indian philosophy and law.
5. **Emphasis on Accountability - Both encourage accountability for one's actions:**
   a. Ethics: accountability to society, conscience, or rational principles.
   b. Religion: accountability to God, divine law, or spiritual beliefs.
6. **Prescriptive in Nature** - Religion does this through commandments, scriptures, and teachings; ethics through moral reasoning or philosophical frameworks.
7. **Focus on Altruistic Benevolence:** Both systems demand that individuals look beyond personal greed to serve vulnerable populations.
8. **Cultivation of Internal Virtues:** Eg. Aristotle's virtue ethics mirrors the moral character building found in the Buddhist **Noble Eightfold Path**.

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Ethical Value	Religious Teaching
Non-violence	Ahimsa in Jainism, Buddhism, and Hinduism
Compassion	Karuna in Buddhism, Charity (Zakat) in Islam, Love in Christianity

Difference between Ethics and Religion

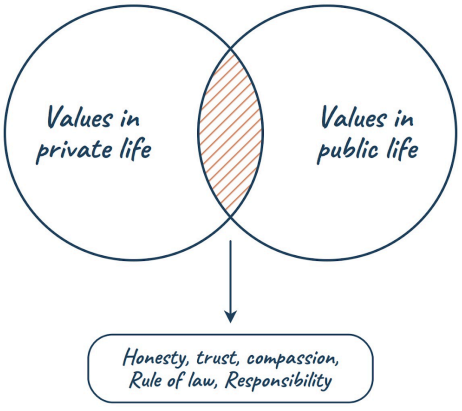
Aspect	Ethics	Religion
Definition	A system of **moral principles** that governs human behavior	A system of **faith or worship** involving belief in a higher power, spiritual truths, and sacred practices
Source	**Reason, human experience, logic, and philosophy**	**Sacred texts, divine revelation, prophets, and spiritual traditions**
Authority	**Individual conscience or rational justification**	**Divine command or religious doctrine**
Universality	Can be **universal** and secular across cultures	Often **specific to religious communities**
Objective	To promote **human well-being, fairness, and social harmony**	To achieve **spiritual salvation, devotion, and moral discipline**
Flexibility	**Adaptable** to changing societal needs and reasoning	Often **fixed or slow to change** due to traditional beliefs
Judgment Basis	Actions judged based on **outcomes, duties, or virtues**	Actions judged based on **alignment with divine will or scripture**
Examples	Utilitarianism, Kantian ethics, virtue ethics	Hinduism, Christianity, Islam, Buddhism, Sikhism, etc.

Ethics in Public and Private Relationships

" A Person Cannot Do Right In One Department, While Attempting To Do Wrong In Another. Life Is One Indivisible Whole".- **Gandhiji.**

Private or personal relationships refer to close connections between individuals, formed through emotional bonds and interactions, such as between a husband and wife, parent and child, or friends.

Public relationships involve interactions in the public sphere, such as between colleagues or employer and employee.



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Commonalities

Aspect	Explanation
Guided by Moral Values	Both are grounded in core ethical values like honesty, trust, respect, loyalty.
Aim to Build Trust	Ethical behavior in both spheres fosters **mutual trust and cooperation**.
Require Accountability	In both relationships, individuals are expected to be accountable for their actions.
Involve Duties and Responsibilities	Ethical conduct involves fulfilling one's roles dutifully, whether as a public servant or family member.
Promote Social Harmony	Moral behavior in both domains contributes to stability in society.

Differences

Aspect	Public Relationships	Private Relationships
Nature of Duty	**Impersonal, rule-based, institutional**	**Personal, emotion-driven, informal**
Accountability	To **law, constitution, public interest, and organizational ethics**	To **family expectations, cultural values, and personal conscience**
Transparency Requirement	High - subject to **public scrutiny** and RTI	Low - protected by **privacy** and social boundaries
Impartiality	Must maintain **neutrality and fairness** in decision-making	May involve **favoritism or emotional bonding**
Professional Boundaries	Governed by **code of conduct, service rules**	Governed by **personal emotions, cultural norms**
Scope of Influence	Affects **large groups and society at large**	Affects **individuals and close groups**
Conflict of Interest	More frequent; requires **strict avoidance**	Less formal; sometimes **managed personally**

Impact of Disharmony Between Public and Private Values

Disharmony arises when an individual's **private moral beliefs conflict with the ethical standards required in public life** (especially in roles like civil services, leadership, or public trust).

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1. **Crisis of Conscience:** Internal psychological friction occurs when official duties directly violate an individual's private moral convictions. Eg. Whistleblowers like Edward Snowden.
2. **Institutional Corruption:** Eg. Former ICICI Bank CEO Chanda Kochhar faced criminal charges for prioritizing private family business over public banking duties.
3. **Erosion of Public Trust:** Eg. UK Prime Minister Boris Johnson resigned following public fury over hosting private parties during public COVID-19 lockdowns.
4. **Cognitive Dissonance:** Eg. Bureaucrat Shah Faesal resigned from the IAS due to deep friction between his personal political views and state actions.
5. **Culture of Nepotism:** Substituting universal institutional rules with private sectarian, caste, or religious biases.
6. **Paralysis in Decision-Making:** Personal prejudices cause administrative delays when managing urgent, diverse public welfare mandates.
7. **Subversion of Constitutional Morality:** Personal biases override public values of secularism, equality, and equal protection.
8. **Loss of Leadership Authority:** Managers lose the professional moral right to command when they violate their own rules.
9. **Misappropriation of Public Resources:** Treating state properties as private entitlement rather than as a sacred public trust.

Way Forward

1. **Ethical Training and Moral Education** - Moral education from early schooling to build foundational values that align with social responsibility.
2. **Development of Emotional Intelligence (EI)** - Cultivating EI helps individuals navigate emotional conflicts, manage biases, and make balanced decisions.
3. **Clear Codes of Conduct**
   a. Enforcing **strict ethical codes and service rules** ensures that private interests do not influence public duties.
   b. Regular **declarations of conflict of interest** should be mandated for transparency.
4. **Leadership by Example** - Role models (Eg. E. Sreedharan, T.N. Seshan) serve as living examples of balancing personal integrity with public ethics.
5. **Institutional Mechanisms**
   a. Strengthen internal oversight mechanisms such as **vigilance cells, ethics committees, and ombudsmen**.
   b. Encourage **whistleblower protection** to report unethical blending of private interest and public function.
6. Promote the idea of "servant leadership", where duty to public good is central.

Consequences of Ethical Behaviour

At the Individual Level:

1. **Satisfies Human Growth Needs:** According to **Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs**, self-actualization is only possible when one remains ethical and true to oneself. **Eg. Buddha**
2. **Sense of Being:** Ethics elevate individuals to higher order values, beyond material desires. **Eg. Nishkam Karmayoga Principle**
3. **Self-respect and Inner Peace:** Ethical individuals experience inner harmony and a clear conscience.
4. **Reputation and Trustworthiness:** Consistently ethical behaviour builds **personal credibility** and **respect from others**.

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5. **Emotional and Mental Well-being:** Reduces guilt, anxiety, and internal conflicts; promotes psychological resilience.
6. **Professional Growth:** Enhances career prospects, especially in roles of leadership and public trust.
7. **Moral Integrity:** Strengthens one's moral compass, leading to consistency between thought and action.

At the Organisational Level:

1. **Credibility and Public Confidence:** Institutions rooted in ethics (Eg. judiciary, civil services, media) gain long-term legitimacy and public support.
2. **Efficiency and Accountability:** Ethical behaviour leads to transparent procedures, better governance, and reduced corruption.
3. **Sustainability:** Ethical institutions adopt **long-term, inclusive, and environmentally responsible policies**.
4. **Culture of Integrity:** Encourages ethical behaviour among members and improves morale.

At the Social Level:

1. **Social Capital:** Ethics strengthen networks of relationships within society, ensuring effective functioning. **Eg. Bhutan's environmental** sustainability.
2. **Social Trust and Cohesion:** Ethical conduct in public life (Eg. in governance, policing, or education) fosters public trust and unity.
3. **Reduction in Social Evils:** Promotes values like **non-violence, tolerance, gender equality**, and **justice**, curbing issues like corruption, discrimination, and violence.
4. **Civic Responsibility:** Inspires others to act responsibly, enhancing collective moral standards and citizenship.
5. Eg. The collective ethical response of society during natural disasters (Eg. COVID-19 frontline workers) strengthens communal solidarity.

Consequences in the Absence of Ethics

At the Individual Level:

1. **Loss of Integrity and Self-Respect:** Leads to **moral guilt**, inner conflict, and a fractured sense of self.
2. **Damaged Reputation:** Dishonest or selfish conduct erodes **trust**, making one unfit for leadership or collaboration.
3. **Legal and Professional Consequences:** In professions like civil services, medicine, or law, unethical behavior may lead to **suspension, dismissal, or prosecution**.
4. **Psychological Stress:** Fear of exposure, guilt, and social rejection can affect **mental health**.

At the Society Level:

1. **Rise in Crime Rates:** When people do not respect the lives of others, crime rates increase. **Eg. Nazis** committed gross human rights violations during WWII.
2. **Communal Conflict:** Without ethics, intolerance rises, leading to communal strife. **Eg. 1984 Sikh riots** following Indira Gandhi's assassination.
3. **Stereotypes:** Oversimplified views about certain groups lead to prejudice. **Eg.** South Asians have historically been stereotyped as potential terrorists.
4. **Instability:** A lack of ethics destabilizes society, leading to riots and conflicts. **Eg.** The **Rwandan Genocide** saw the massacre of the Tutsi minority and moderate Hutus.

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5. **No Rule of Law:** Without ethics, society disregards the rule of law, leading to rampant crime and conflict. **Eg.** During the **Delhi riots in 2020**, there was mass looting of shops.
6. **Moral Corruption:** When individuals lack moral values, they engage in unethical acts. **Eg.** During the 2013 **Uttarakhand floods**, people were seen looting from the deceased.

At the Organizational Level:

1. **Corruption:** Lack of ethics leads organizations to engage in corrupt practices, betraying public trust. **Eg. Saradha Chit fund scam** defrauded millions of people.
2. **Criminalization:** Organizations or individuals become involved in criminal acts due to an absence of ethical guidance. **Eg. criminalization of politics**
3. **Nepotism:** Ethics are neglected when favoritism and personal interests override merit. **Eg. Mahinda Rajapaksa**, former President of Sri Lanka, appointed his brothers to key ministries, prioritizing family over merit.
4. **Violation of Public Trust:** Without ethics, organizations betray public trust, engaging in fraud and deception. **Eg. Lalu Prasad Yadav** was involved in the ₹900 crore **Fodder Scam**.
5. **Spoils brand image**. **Eg. volkswagen emission scandal**
6. **Reduce profits**. Eg. The absence of corporate ethics at **BYJUs** reduced their profits.

Values

Values are fundamental beliefs that guide or motivate attitudes and actions. They help us determine what is important and influence judgments about what is right or wrong for individuals or groups.

G.W. Allport, P.E. Vernon, and G. Lindzey categorized values into six major types based on their **Study of Values** theory. These value types are:

1. **Theoretical**: Emphasis on the discovery of truth through reasoning, logic, and systematic thought.
2. **Economic**: Focus on practicality, usefulness, and material wealth.
3. **Aesthetic**: Appreciation of beauty, form, and harmony.
4. **Social**: Concern for human relationships, love, and helping others.
5. **Political**: Interest in power, influence, and leadership.
6. **Religious**: Focus on unity, purpose, and understanding of the universe through spiritual beliefs.

Relative And Absolute Values

Aspect	Relative Values	Absolute Values
Definition	Moral principles that **vary** depending on culture, context, or situation	Moral principles that are **universally fixed** and unchanging
Nature	**Contextual, flexible, and subjective**	**Universal, constant, and objective**
Source	**Culture, society, personal beliefs, situational needs**	**Reason, religion, moral philosophy, or natural law**
Changeability	Can **change over time or across societies**	Do **not change** across time or place

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Aspect	Relative Values	Absolute Values
Examples	- Dress codes- Polygamy vs monogamy- Eating habits	- Truth- Justice- Respect for life
Application	Often **adjusted** to suit local customs, beliefs, or emergencies	Expected to be followed **regardless of situation**
Ethical Theories	Linked to **moral relativism**, cultural relativism	Linked to **deontology**, divine command theory, natural rights
Criticism	May lead to **moral subjectivism or inconsistency**	May lead to **rigidity or insensitivity to cultural diversity**

Functions of Values

1. **Guiding Behaviour** - Values serve as internal standards that guide individuals in making ethical choices. Eg. A person with the value of honesty is likely to avoid cheating, even if they could escape detection.
2. **Shaping Attitudes and Beliefs** - Values influence how individuals perceive situations, react to challenges, and form opinions. Eg. A person valuing equality will support inclusive policies and oppose discrimination.
3. **Motivating Action** - Values provide reasons for action and determine life choices such as career, relationships, and civic engagement. Eg. A person who values service may choose a career in civil services or NGOs.
4. **Building Character and Integrity** - Consistent adherence to values like honesty, responsibility, and empathy helps build trustworthy and principled personalities.
5. **Promoting Social Cohesion** - Shared values help build common understanding within communities and nations. Eg. Democratic societies often share values of freedom, justice, and equality.
6. **Influencing Decision-Making** - In ethical dilemmas, values help prioritize competing interests and arrive at justifiable choices.
7. **Supporting Role Performance** - Values define how individuals fulfill their roles and responsibilities in families, professions, and society.
8. **Driving Change and Reform** - Values such as justice, human rights, and compassion drive social reforms and activism. **Eg.** The abolition of untouchability or women's rights movements are rooted in changing value systems.

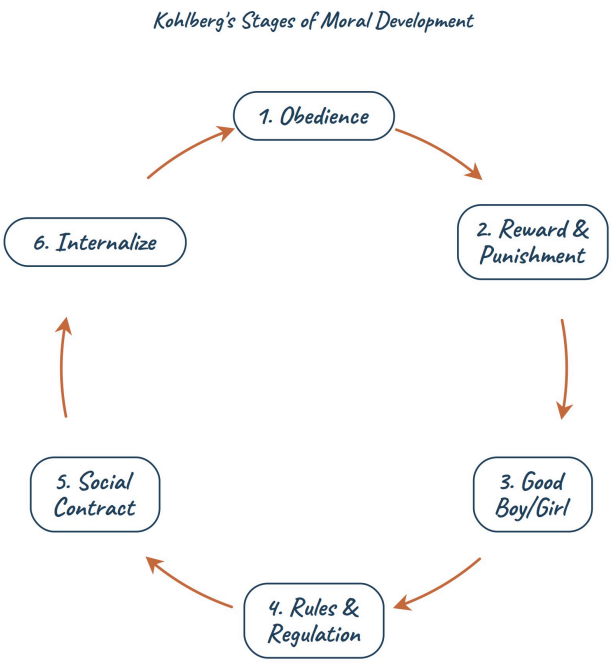
Socialization

Socialisation is the process by which we **learn and develop through interaction with our environment,** shaping our identity in relation to others**. It involves the transfer of culture across generations, helping individuals become productive members of society.**

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Importance of Socialization

1. **Identity Formation** by allowing them to interact with others and understand their roles in different social contexts.
2. **Cultural Transmission**: It ensures the continuity of cultural norms, values, beliefs, and traditions by passing them from one generation to the next.
3. **Language Acquisition**: **Eg. A toddler learns to speak by mimicking family members.**
4. **Behavioral Norms**: It instills societal norms, rules, and expectations, guiding individuals on how to behave and interact with others.
5. **Emotional Development**: Through social interactions, individuals develop emotional intelligence, empathy, and social well-being by expressing and understanding emotions.
6. **Adaptation to Social Roles**: Socialization prepares individuals to take on roles and responsibilities in families, communities, and society, promoting functional integration.
7. Equips individuals with **negotiation, conflict resolution, and problem-solving skills**, essential for navigating relationships and societal challenges.



8. **Social Cohesion**: It fosters a sense of belonging, solidarity, and cooperation within communities, enhancing mutual respect and collective action.
9. **Moral and Ethical Development**: Socialization imparts moral values and ethical principles, helping individuals develop a sense of right and wrong and guiding responsible citizenship.

Role of Family in Value Inculcation

A family is a social institution that binds individuals through shared beliefs, religion, customs, culture, language, and lifestyle. It serves as a medium for passing on traditions and heritage from one generation to the next.

Types Of Parenting:

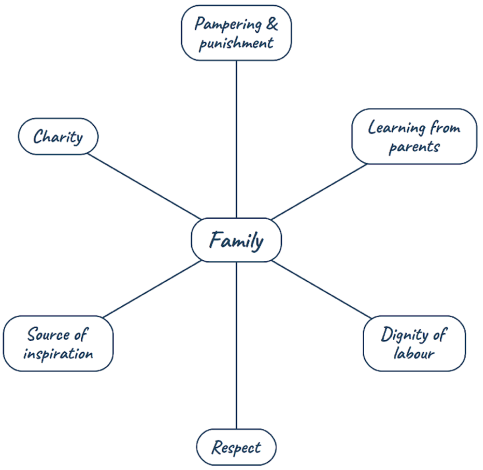
1. **Authoritative Parenting**: **High expectations** with **supportive** and **responsive** guidance. Encourages independence while maintaining control.
2. **Democratic Parenting**: Emphasizes **equality**, involving children in **decision-making** and promoting **open communication**. **Eg**: Parents and children agree on household rules through discussion and mutual consent.
3. **Permissive Parenting**: **Lenient** and **non-controlling**, with few demands and limits on behavior.

Quotes:

- "There is nothing called a self-made man. We are made up of thousands of others." - George Mathew Adams
- "A man is usually closest to five people around him."

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1. **First School of Value Learning for Children: Eg.** In Indian households, **grandparents share stories from Mahabharata and Ramayana, instilling values of honesty and truth.**
2. Families offer **emotional support, care, and guidance** to help individuals overcome negative thoughts and challenges.
3. **Family shapes identity** by teaching language, religion, food, and cultural norms. What feels "normal" varies globally, as individuals grow up with unique experiences, ideas, and values influenced by their environment.
4. **Informal Learning: Eg.** Children are taught to share lunch boxes with friends and toys with siblings, fostering a spirit of charity and brotherhood.
5. **Family members act as role models. Eg. If parents show respect, children adopt similar values.** However, disregarding societal rules, like traffic laws, may lead children to imitate such behaviors.



Role of Mother

1. **Primary Caregiver**: Provides physical care, emotional support, and nurtures children, fostering a sense of security and trust essential for social development.
2. **Modeling Behavior**: Serves as a role model, teaching social norms, communication, and emotional regulation through actions and interactions.
3. **Teaching Social Skills**: Guides children in developing empathy, cooperation, and conflict resolution skills.
4. **Emotional Support**: Creates a secure attachment, promoting emotional well-being and positive relationships.
5. **Gender Socialization**: Influences children's understanding of gender roles and expectations through early socialization experiences.

Role of Father

1. **Provider and Protector**: Demonstrates responsibility and commitment, providing financial support and ensuring family security.
2. **Role Model**: Instills values like integrity, responsibility, and emotional management through example.
3. **Discipline and Authority**: Teaches the importance of rules and consequences, fostering self-discipline and respect for authority.
4. **Emotional Support**: Builds strong emotional bonds, contributing to children's self-esteem and emotional development.
5. **Encouraging Independence**: Promotes exploration, risk-taking, and independence, fostering resilience and confidence.
6. **Gender Socialization**: Shapes understanding of masculinity and influences gender role attitudes.

Role of Grandparents

1. **Cultural Transmission**: Pass down traditions, values, and customs, contributing to intergenerational bonding.
2. **Role Modeling**: Offer emotional support and exemplify positive behaviors.
3. **Childcare Support**: Provide practical help with childcare and household tasks.
4. **Respect for Elders**: Instill values of reverence and appreciation for older generations.

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Impact of changing family structure on socialization of children

Positive Impacts on Socialization

1. **Enhanced Gender Equality:** Growing up with dual-income parents normalizes democratic sharing of household chores.
2. **Cultivation of Self-Reliance:** Less direct parental supervision fosters independent decision-making and early problem-solving skills.
3. **Promotion of Democratic Dialogue:** Nuclear setups substitute rigid patriarchal dominance with open, expressive family discussions.
4. **Higher Material and Educational Investment:** Smaller family sizes allow focused financial spending on high-quality skill development.
5. **Inculcation of Inclusivity:** Exposure to diverse cosmopolitan neighborhoods weakens rigid, traditional caste and sectarian biases.
6. **Respect for Individual Autonomy:** Reduced communal surveillance teaches children to value personal boundaries and privacy rights.

Negative Impacts on Socialization

1. **Emotional Loneliness and Isolation:** Minimal interaction with extended kin networks leaves children vulnerable to severe alienation.
2. **Degradation of Intergenerational Wisdom** due to separation from grandparents. Eg. Children missing out on moral Panchatantra bedtime stories that build foundational character.
3. **Escalation of Peer Dependency:** Lack of familial interaction forces kids to seek validation from online peer groups.
4. **Rise of Hyper-Individualism:** Nuclear insulation often diminishes the vital civic values of sharing, tolerance, and sacrifice.
5. **Vulnerability to Psychological Fragility:** Absence of an extended familial safety net leaves kids unable to handle failures.
6. **Commercialization of Upbringing:** Parents substituting genuine emotional presence with materialistic rewards breeds deep-seated consumerism.

Addressing these issues requires promoting healthy relationships, positive communication, and breaking cycles of negative family dynamics.

Peer Group and Socialization

Peer groups influence adolescents by fostering shared norms, values, and behaviors, offering support, independence, and social networks. They shape identity but can create conflict with parental expectations and societal norms.

Role of Peer Groups in Socialization:

Aspect	Positive Role of Peer Groups	Negative Role of Peer Groups
Moral Development	Encourages fairness, cooperation, and moral reasoning	May promote unethical behaviors (Eg. cheating, bullying)
Social Skills	Improves communication, teamwork,	Can foster exclusion, mockery, or peer rivalry

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Aspect	Positive Role of Peer Groups	Negative Role of Peer Groups
	and empathy	
Identity Formation	Helps build self-confidence and independent thinking	May pressure individuals to conform and suppress individuality
Behavioral Influence	Motivates healthy habits (Eg. studying, fitness, discipline)	Can encourage risky behavior (Eg. smoking, substance abuse)
Support System	Provides emotional support during stress or crisis	Can become a source of stress or emotional harm (Eg. peer rejection)
Exposure to New Ideas	Broadens perspectives and promotes tolerance	Can spread misinformation or normalize negative stereotypes
Academic Motivation	Promotes competition and goal-oriented behavior	Distraction from studies or fear of falling behind peers
Ethical Decision-Making	Offers real-life moral dilemmas to reflect on (Eg. fairness in group tasks)	Peer pressure may override ethical judgment and personal conscience

Role of Educational Institutions in Value Inculcation

According to the **National Education Policy**, **education** is the key tool for instilling values. **Schools** shape children's **character** and **behavior**, introducing societal norms and teaching them how to regulate actions in the community.

Quotes:

- "Intelligence plus character is the true goal of education." - **Martin Luther King**
- "Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man a more clever devil."

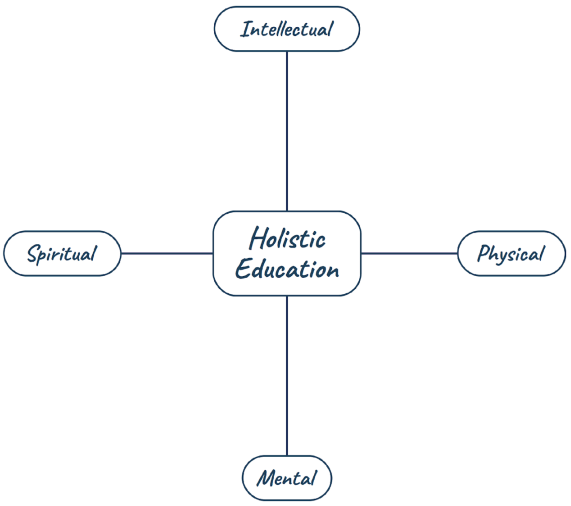
- C. S. Lewis

- "The purpose of education is to teach the mind to think, the heart to feel, and the body to act."

- John Dewey

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1. **Curriculum as Value Carrier-** Textbooks embed constitutional values in minds. Eg. NCERT civics teaches fundamental duties.
2. **Teachers as Moral Models-** Teachers demonstrate integrity through daily conduct.
3. **Sports Building Fairness-** Games develop teamwork and fair play practically. Eg. NCC training instills discipline and patriotism.
4. **Inclusive Classrooms Dismantling Prejudice-** Diverse campuses build mutual respect among students. Eg. Ambedkar's college experience shaped his anti-caste commitment.
5. **Student Governance Developing Accountability-** Elected bodies teach democratic responsibility practically.
6. **Community Service Nurturing Empathy-** Outreach connects privileged students with ground realities. Eg. NSS volunteers develop civic responsibility in villages.
7. **Institutional Culture Shaping Ethos-** Campus traditions silently shape students' long-term values. Eg. Shantiniketan created culture of creativity and freedom.



8. **Universities Promoting Critical Thinking-** Higher education challenges students to question injustice courageously. Eg. JNU's open debate tradition cultivated democratic accountability values.
9. **NEP 2020 Institutionalising Value Education-** Policy integrates Indian ethos across all educational levels. Eg. NEP mandates holistic development replacing examination-oriented schooling.
10. **Basic Etiquettes and Values:** Educational systems in various countries **emphasize value-based learning from an early age**. **Eg.** In Japan, children learn basic etiquettes like cleaning toilets.

Role of Society in Value Inculcation

1. **Society Imparts Values Through Social Traditions: Eg. Touching the feet of elders** reflects respect for elders.
2. **Transmission of Culture Through Society** to future generations, facilitating mental and intellectual growth. **Eg.** Practices **worshipping the peepal tree**, **Ganges river**.
3. Society **enforces discipline** through mechanisms like **rewards and punishments.**
4. **Family as First School-** Family instils foundational values of honesty, respect, and empathy in children. Eg. Gandhi learned truth and non-violence from mother Putlibai's daily practices.
5. **Peer Groups Shaping Moral Behaviour-** Eg. Self-Help Groups in Andhra Pradesh built financial discipline and collective responsibility among rural women.
6. **Educational Institutions Building Character-** Eg. Tagore's Shantiniketan integrated nature, art, and ethics into education beyond textbooks.
7. **Religious Institutions Promoting Ethical Living-** Eg. Gurudwaras through langar tradition teach equality, humility, and selfless service daily.
8. **Media Influencing Public Conscience-** Eg. Raja Ram Mohan Roy used his newspaper Sambad Kaumudi to campaign against Sati practice.
9. **Civil Society Organisations Challenging Social Evils-** Eg. Medha Patkar's Narmada Bachao Andolan built values of environmental justice and tribal dignity.

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10. **Cultural Traditions Transmitting Collective Memory-** Eg. Kerala's Onam festival promotes social equality by celebrating a just ruler Mahabali irrespective of caste.
11. **Political Leadership Modelling Public Values-** Eg. Lal Bahadur Shastri voluntarily skipped one meal every Monday during 1965 food crisis inspiring national sacrifice.
12. **Social Reform Movements Transforming Regressive Norms-** Eg. Jyotirao Phule's Satyashodhak Samaj dismantled caste hierarchy by promoting rationalism and human dignity.
13. **Digital Communities Creating New Value Ecosystems-** Eg. Twitter campaigns like MeToo India collectively built societal values of gender dignity and workplace accountability.

Religion on Socialization

"Religion is not merely a set of beliefs-it is a school of moral training."

Religion is a collection of **belief systems, cultural systems and the world view** that relate humanity to spirituality and sometimes to **moral values.** Religions have traditions, symbols, practices, customs that are intended **to give meaning to life.**

Religion Facilitates The Development Of Moral Values By

1. **Informing the children** in their formative years about what is sacred and what is profane, and **encouraging them to follow sacred ones** and avoid profane ones.
2. **Religion acts as a social watchdog by promoting ethical standards and accountability.** Eg. Karma encourages positive behavior, as actions are believed to have consequences.
3. **Meaning and Purpose**: Eg. the concept of **Karma** encourages positive actions to attract favorable outcomes.
4. **Providing a Moral Code of Conduct** - Eg. The Ten Commandments in Christianity, the concept of **Dharma** in Hinduism, or the **Five Precepts** in Buddhism guide adherents toward ethical living.
5. **Encouraging Virtues and Character Building** - Religion promotes **universal virtues** such as:
   a. **Honesty** (Eg. Islam: Ameen)
   b. **Compassion** (Eg. Christianity: Love thy neighbour)
   c. **Forgiveness**, **Charity**, **Self-discipline**, and **Truthfulness**
6. **Creating Accountability through Divine Oversight** - Belief in God, karma, heaven, or hell creates a sense of moral responsibility and fear of consequences.
7. **Offering Role Models and Moral Narratives** - Eg. Lord Rama's commitment to truth and duty, and Jesus' teachings on humility and forgiveness.
8. **Strengthening Community-Based Moral Reinforcement - Eg.** Regular prayer gatherings, fasting, or charity events help build moral discipline.
9. **Promoting Altruism and Service** - Many religions place emphasis on selfless service (seva) and charity (zakat, daan).
10. **Offering Moral Stability in Uncertain Times** - It provides meaning and purpose, helping people adhere to values even in adversity.

Reasons for Erosion of Values

1. **Materialism and Consumerism** - Growing emphasis on **wealth, possessions, and external success** leads to **greed, competition, and unethical shortcuts** to achieve personal goals.
2. **Weak Value-Based Education** - Formal education often focuses on **marks, employability, and skills**, with little emphasis on **ethical and moral development**.

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3. **Decline of Role Models** - Youth lose trust in integrity-based success and **normalize unethical behavior**. Eg. glorification of gangsters
4. **Erosion of Family and Community Bonds** - Nuclear families, urban migration, and digital lifestyles reduce **intergenerational interaction** and **value transmission**.
5. **Overexposure to Unfiltered Media and Internet** encourages **instant gratification, insensitivity**, and unrealistic life goals. Eg. Blue Whale Suicides
6. **Peer Pressure and Herd Mentality** - Leads to moral compromise and decline in **individual moral courage**. Eg. **Cyberbullying or substance abuse** among teenagers to appear "cool" in peer groups.
7. **Political and Institutional Corruption** - When institutions tolerate **nepotism, bribery, and impunity**, citizens lose **faith in justice and fairness**, normalizing unethical shortcuts. Eg. Coal Scam or Vyapam Scam
8. **Decline in Religious or Spiritual Anchoring** - When religious practices become ritualistic, the ethical core is lost. **Eg.** Religious events being used for **political mobilization or hate speeches**
9. **Globalization and Cultural Dilution** - Exposure to diverse cultures without critical filtering lead to **identity confusion or value conflicts**, replacing traditional ethical systems with **relativism or moral ambiguity**.
10. **Stressful, Competitive Lifestyles** - High-pressure environments prioritize success over ethical reflection, leading to **moral fatigue** and ethical compromise. Eg. Corporate employees fudging performance reports
11. **Moral Degradation**: **Cynicism**, **moral decay**, and **violence** contribute to ethical decline. **Eg**: The rise in **rape cases** like **Nirbhaya case (2012)** illustrates the moral breakdown and violence in society.

Character

Character refers to the stable constellation of moral qualities, values, and behavioural dispositions that define how an individual thinks, feels, and acts consistently across situations.

As Aristotle said, character is not a single act but a sustained pattern of virtuous living - it is who you are when no one is watching.

1. "Character is like a tree and reputation is like its shadow. The shadow is what we think of it; the tree is the real thing." - Abraham Lincoln
2. "The strength of a man's character is measured not by how high he climbs but by how he behaves when he falls." - Winston Churchill
3. "Be the change you wish to see in the world." - Mahatma Gandhi

Significance of Character

1. **Foundation of Trust-** Character builds trust between individuals and institutions enabling stable governance. Eg. Sardar Patel's integrity made him a trusted architect of Indian national integration.
2. **Guiding Ethical Decisions-** Strong character helps choose right over convenient in difficult moral dilemmas. Eg. Ashok Khemka refused political pressure despite facing 50+ punitive transfers.
3. **Nation Building-** Collective character of citizens determines the moral health of an entire nation. Eg. Gandhi's personal character transformed India's freedom movement into a nonviolent moral force.
4. **Corruption Prevention-** Persons of strong character resist temptation even without fear of detection. Eg. T.N. Seshan reformed the Election Commission through personal integrity and moral courage.
5. **Leadership Effectiveness-** Eg. Mandela's forgiveness and dignity united deeply divided post-apartheid South Africa peacefully.
6. **Professional Excellence-** Character sustains long-term commitment beyond incentives and external rewards alone. Eg. Dr. Sanjiv Chaturvedi exposed AIIMS corruption winning Ramon Magsaysay Award
7. **Democratic Functioning-** Democracy needs citizens of character who prioritise public good consistently.

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8. **Intergenerational Value Transfer-** A person of character becomes a living model for future generations. Eg. Savitribai Phule continues inspiring gender reformers across generations today.
9. **Crisis Resilience-** Character enables maintaining ethical conduct under extreme pressure and adversity.

Methods of Character Development

1. **Self-Reflection and Introspection-** Eg. Gandhi maintained a daily diary reviewing his moral failures and ethical commitments.
2. **Reading and Moral Education-** Studying lives of great personalities shapes moral imagination and ethical reasoning.
3. **Hardship and Adversity-** Facing difficulties builds patience, resilience, and empathy that comfort cannot develop.
4. **Mentorship and Role Models-** Eg. Vivekananda's character transformed completely under Ramakrishna Paramhansa's spiritual mentorship.
5. **Practice of Virtues Daily-** Aristotle argued virtue is a habit built through repeated conscious ethical choices. Eg. Gandhi practised truth and non-violence daily as deliberate disciplines
6. **Religious and philosophical traditions** provide frameworks for sustained ethical living. Eg. Bhagavad Gita's concept of Nishkama Karma builds character of selfless duty-oriented action.
7. **Accountability Mechanisms-** Being answerable to others strengthens internal discipline and consistent ethical behaviour.
8. **Exposure to Suffering and Service-** Eg. Mother Teresa's character deepened through decades of direct service to Kolkata's dying poor.
9. **Critical Thinking and Ethical Reasoning-** Learning to examine moral dilemmas analytically strengthens decision-making under pressure.
10. **Social Environment and Peer Influence-** Surrounding oneself with persons of integrity reinforces and sustains good character.

Way Forward

1. **Mandate Value-Based Curriculum in Schools -** compulsory "Ethics & Values" subject with weekly activity based assessments. Use storytelling, real-life case studies, and moral dilemma simulations to engage students.
2. **Reward Ethical Behavior in Governance and Institutions**
   a. Create a **"Public Integrity Index"** to rank departments based on transparency and ethical practices.
   b. Establish annual **"Ethical Civil Servant" and "Honest Bureaucrat" awards** at district and state levels.
3. **Make Ethics Training Mandatory for Public Officials**
   a. Introduce **quarterly ethics refreshers** for civil servants, police, and judiciary.
   b. LBSNAA and state ATIs should roll out online ethics certification programs. Include modules on **constitutional morality, emotional intelligence, and ethical leadership**.
4. **Civic Campaigns Promoting Everyday Ethics -** Launch national campaigns like #IndiaWithIntegrity, promoting small acts of honesty (Eg. returning lost items, fair queueing).
5. **Parenting Workshops on Ethical Nurturing -** Ministry of Women & Child Development can integrate value-nurturing modules in ICDS schemes.

Global Best Practices to Preserve and Promote Values

1. **Japan -** Character and Moral Education (Doutoku)
2. **UK -** "Seven Principles of Public Life" (Nolan Principles) : Selflessness, Integrity, Objectivity, Accountability, Openness, Honesty, Leadership.

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Scholar and Thinker Suggestions on Values

1. **Mahatma Gandhi** - Advocated for Nai Talim (Basic Education) to combine learning with character building.
2. **Swami Vivekananda** - Advocated education for "man-making and character-building." Stressed on service, strength, and moral courage as pillars of national development.
3. **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** - Emphasized constitutional morality - loyalty to justice, equality, and liberty above social customs. "Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment. It has to be cultivated."
4. **Lawrence Kohlberg (Moral Development Theory)** - Ethics evolve through stages: obedience, conformity, law and order, and finally universal ethical principles. Education systems should guide students from rule-following to principled moral reasoning.

CIVILSDAILY IAS

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Chapter 2

Applied Ethics

PYQs

[2025] In the present digital age, social media has revolutionised our way of communication and interaction. However, it has raised several ethical issues and challenges. Describe the key ethical dilemmas in this regard. (10)

[2025] Keeping national security in mind, examine the ethical dilemmas related to controversies over environmental clearance of development projects in ecologically sensitive border areas in the country. (10)

[2025] Carl von Clausewitz once said, "War is diplomacy by other means." Critically analyse the above statement in the present context of contemporary geo-political conflict. (10)

[2024] The soul of the new law, Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) is Justice, Equality and Impartiality based on Indian culture and ethos. Discuss this in the light of a major shift from a doctrine of punishment to justice in the present judicial system. (10)

[2024] Global warming and climate change are the outcomes of human greed in the name of development, indicating the direction in which extinction of organisms including human beings is heading towards loss of life on Earth. How do you put an end to this to protect life and bring equilibrium between the society and the environment? (10)

[2024] "It is not enough to talk about peace, one must believe in it; and it is not enough to believe in it, one must act upon it." In the present context, the major weapon industries of the developed nations are adversely influencing the continuation of a number of wars for their own self-interest, all around the world. What are the ethical considerations of the powerful nations in today's international arena to stop continuation of ongoing conflicts? (10)

[2023] 'International aid' is an accepted form of helping 'resource-challenged' nations. Comment on 'ethics in contemporary international aid'. Support your answer with suitable examples. (10)

[2022] Russia and Ukraine war has been going on for the last seven months. Different countries have taken independent stands and actions keeping in view their own national interests. We are all aware that war has its own impact on the different aspects of society, including human tragedy. What are those ethical issues that are crucial to be considered while launching the war and its continuation so far? Illustrate with justification the ethical issues involved in the given state of affair. (10)

[2021] "Refugees should not be turned back to the country where they would face persecution or human right violation." Examine the statement with reference to the ethical dimension being violated by the nation claiming to be democratic with open society. (10)

[2020] Discuss the role of ethics and values in enhancing the following three major components of Comprehensive National Power (CNP) viz. human capital, soft power (culture and policies) and social harmony. (10)

[2020] "Education is not an injunction, it is an effective and pervasive tool for all round development of an individual and social transformation". Examine the New Education Policy, 2020 (NEP, 2020) in light of the above statement. (10)

[2020] "The current internet expansion has instilled a different set of cultural values which are often in conflict with traditional values.' Discuss. (10)

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[2020] "The will to power exists, but it can be tamed and be guided by rationality and principles of moral duty.' Examine this statement in the context of international relations. (10)

[2018] Suppose the Government of India is thinking of constructing a dam in a mountain valley bond by forests and inhabited by ethnic communities. What rational policy should it resort to in dealing with unforeseen contingencies (10)

[2026] An endangered tribe has developed a severe skeletal deformity. A university research has identified a mineral supplement as a possible remedy, though clinical trials are yet to be conducted. Should the District Magistrate (DM) use this research on the tribe? Discuss from the perspective of medical and administrative ethics. (10)

[2026] Discuss how national security can be balanced with concerns of human rights. (10)

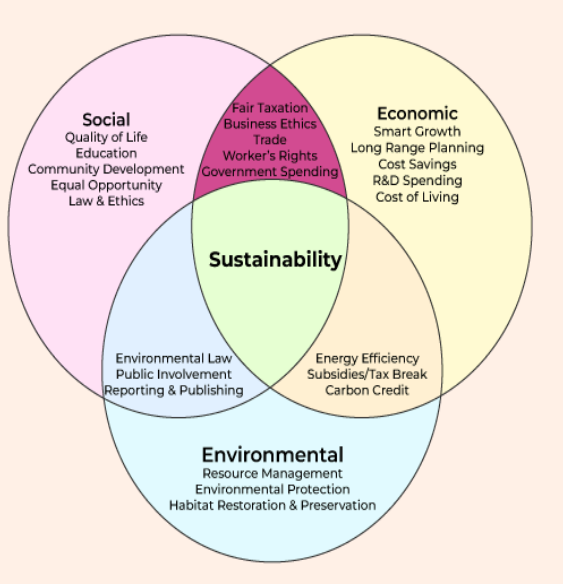
[2026] Citing the serious adverse effects of long-term medication, a doctor convinces the family of a female patient for surgery. This led the patient to reluctantly consent for the surgery, though her original choice was to opt for medication. Explain the concepts of paternalism and beneficence by analysing the doctor's action. (10)

[2026] In international relations, ethical considerations are often subjugated to the strategic interests of nation-states. Discuss this from an ethical perspective. (10)

Environmental Ethics

- **"The Earth does not belong to us; we belong to the Earth."** - Chief Seattle
- **"What we are doing to the forests of the world is but a mirror reflection of what we are doing to ourselves and to one another."** - Mahatma Gandhi
- **"The greatest threat to our planet is the belief that someone else will save it."** - Robert Swan
- **"We do not inherit the Earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children."** - Native American Proverb

Environmental ethics is the branch of applied ethics that studies the **moral relationship of human beings to the environment** and its non-human contents.



Philosophical Foundations of Environmental Ethics

1. **Anthropocentrism:** Treating nature as an instrument whose primary value lies in ensuring human survival and prosperity. Eg. **chopping trees for commercial purposes**

Climate change efforts do not belong exclusively to one category. Instead, they can be driven by **both anthropocentric and Ecocentric worldviews**, depending on the underlying motivation for the action.

1. **Anthropocentric efforts** - keeping human survival at centre. Eg. montreal protocol
2. **Ecocentric efforts** - recognising intrinsic value of nature rather than instrumental value. Eg. Sacred groves or Chipko movement

2. **Biocentrism:** Granting intrinsic moral worth to all individual living organisms, regardless of their utility to humanity. Eg. **CITES**

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3. **Ecocentrism (Ecosystem-Centered Ethics):** Shifting moral focus to whole ecological systems, recognizing nature as an interconnected, indivisible web. Eg. **UNESCO Biosphere Reserves**
4. **Intergenerational Equity:** The moral obligation to preserve a resourceful, healthy planet for all future generations. Eg. Norway's **Sovereign Wealth Fund** intentionally saves economic and ecological capital for its future citizens.
5. **Intragenerational Equity:** Fairly distributing environmental benefits and pollution burdens among all human populations living today. Eg. UN's **Loss and Damage Fund** for LDCs.
6. **Precautionary Principle (Safety First):** Pausing industrial activities that carry unverified risks of causing irreversible damage to the biosphere. Eg. Ban on diesel vehicles in Delhi
7. **Eco-Feminism:** Linking the patriarchal oppression of women directly with the capitalist, aggressive exploitation of nature. Eg. **Chipko Movement** saw rural women physically hug trees to block corporate commercial logging.
8. **Deep Ecology (Radical Equality):** Rejecting human supremacy to advocate for a total revolution in how humans live with nature. Eg. **legal personhood rights** for sacred ecosystems like the Whanganui River in New Zealand.
9. **Polluter Pays Principle:** Eg. National green tribunals imposing massive **carbon taxes and clean-up penalties** on corporate oil spill culprits.
10. **Stewardship Ethos (Trusteeship):** Eg. Indigenous communities utilizing ancient **sacred groves** traditions to restrict hunting and preserve pristine forest ecosystems.

Major issues in Environmental Ethics - 6P approach

1. **People** - Human Welfare, Health, and Equity
   a. **Unequal exposure to harm:** Eg. Delhi air pollution disproportionately impacts the poor and elderly.
   b. **Right to clean environment:** Denial of clean air, water, and healthy surroundings violates human dignity.
2. **Planet** - Ecosystem Integrity and Biodiversity
   a. **Biodiversity loss:** Eg. Hasdeo Arand forest mining and the **Great Nicobar Project (2023)** threatens rare species and dense forests.
   b. **Pollution of natural systems:** Eg. **Yamuna floodplain damage** during unregulated events like Art of Living 2016.
   c. **Violation of nature's intrinsic value:** Eg. Forest clearance for expressways without ecological studies.
   d. **Ignoring the precautionary principle**. Eg. **IPCC AR6 Report** warns of exceeding 1.5°C threshold with irreversible ecosystem consequences
3. **Prosperity** - Sustainable Development and Resource Ethics
   a. **Intergenerational Injustice:** Overuse of non-renewables compromises the needs of future generations. Eg. 70% of India's groundwater is contaminated
   b. **Overconsumption and waste:**
   c. India generates **3.5 million tonnes of plastic waste** annually.
   d. India is the 3rd **largest e-waste generator**; over 90% handled informally.
4. **Peace** - Environmental Conflicts and Displacement
   a. **Resource-Based Conflicts and Community Displacement:** Eg. **Vedanta-Niyamgiri mining case** - Gram Sabhas rejected mining on ethical and cultural grounds.
   b. Projects disrupt sacred lands, traditional knowledge, and ecological relationships. Eg. **Char Dham road project** altering fragile Himalayan topography.
5. **Partnerships** - Global Cooperation and Climate Justice
   a. **Climate Injustice and North-South Inequity:** Eg. Small island nations facing sea-level rise while high emitters delay action.

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   b. **Weak enforcement of multilateral commitments:** Eg. **COP28 (2023)**-"phase-down" of fossil fuels diluted under pressure from oil-rich states.
6. **Policy -** Governance, Laws, and Ethical Decision-Making
   a. **Weak enforcement of laws:** Eg. Despite rules, **illegal sand mining** continues in UP, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra.
   b. **Dilution of regulatory frameworks:** Eg. **EIA 2020 Draft Notification** faced criticism for allowing post-facto environmental clearances.

Other Frameworks

- **Lifecycle-Based Framework**
- **Extraction** - Deforestation, mining, displacement
- **Production** - Pollution, resource wastage
- **Consumption** - Overconsumption, packaging waste
- **Disposal** - E-waste, plastics, landfill ethics
- **Restoration** - rehabilitation issues, climate finance issues

Ethical Dilemmas in Environment vs Development

1. **Economic Growth vs Ecological Conservation -** Industries generate employment but damage forests and biodiversity. Eg. Mining in Aravalli Hills.
2. **Infrastructure vs Displacement -** Development projects improve connectivity but displace vulnerable communities. Eg. Sardar Sarovar Dam project.
3. **Energy Security vs Climate Responsibility -** Coal-based energy supports growth but increases carbon emissions. Eg. Expansion of thermal power plants.
4. **Urbanisation vs Environmental Sustainability -** Smart cities require land, reducing wetlands and green cover. Eg. Bengaluru lake encroachments.
5. **Industrialisation vs Public Health -** Factories create jobs but increase pollution-related diseases. Eg. Bhopal Gas Tragedy.
6. **Hydropower vs River Ecosystems -** Dams provide clean energy but disrupt aquatic biodiversity. Eg. Projects in Himalayan rivers.
7. **Tourism vs Ecological Balance -** Tourism boosts local economy but degrades fragile ecosystems. Eg. Over-tourism in Himachal Pradesh.
8. **Agricultural Expansion vs Forest Protection -** Expanding cultivation threatens wildlife habitats and tribal livelihoods. Eg. Deforestation in Central India.
9. **Consumerism vs Sustainable Living -** Rising consumption improves living standards but increases waste generation. Eg. Plastic pollution crisis.
10. **Short-Term Gains vs Intergenerational Equity -** Present development may compromise future environmental security. Eg. Groundwater depletion in Punjab.

Way forward

1. **Institutionalize Ethical Environmental Governance**
   a. Make **Environmental Impact Assessments (EIAs)** more participatory, transparent, and ethics-based. Empower **local bodies and Gram Sabhas** in decision-making.
   b. Incorporate the **Public Trust Doctrine** (SC ruling in M.C. Mehta v. Kamal Nath) in natural resource regulation.
2. **Legal and Institutional Reforms**
   a. Strengthen and adequately staff the **National Green Tribunal (NGT)** and **State Pollution Control Boards**.

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   b. Recognise **"Rights of Nature"** as in **New Zealand's Whanganui River Law** and **Ecuador's Constitution (2008)**, which grants legal rights to ecosystems.
3. **Ethical Corporate and Technological Practice**
   a. Mandate **ESG (Environmental, Social, Governance)** reporting and **green audits** for industries.
   b. Encourage **ethical innovation**: Eg. adoption of **Cradle-to-Cradle** (C2C) design model to eliminate waste.
   c. Discourage **greenwashing** through legal penalties and ethical certification (as used in **EU Green Deal** framework).
4. **Sustainable Development Models**
   a. Develop a **Green GDP** or **Gross Environmental Product (GEP)** to reflect true ecological costs and benefits
   b. Audit policies through an **Environmental Ethics Impact Assessment**
5. **Promote Ethical Technology and Sustainable Innovation**
   a. Incentivize **Green Technology**, circular economy, and **eco-design principles**.
   b. Follow **Sweden's carbon taxation model** and **Costa Rica's forest conservation payments** as best practices.
6. **Educate for Ecological Citizenship**
   a. Integrate **environmental ethics** into school curricula and public administration training (recommended by **NCERT** and **TSR Subramanian Committee, 2016**).
   b. Promote **indigenous ecological wisdom** (Eg. Bishnoi community, Chipko movement) through conservation policy.

Ethical Theories

- Use **Gandhian Trusteeship** model - promote harmony with nature, minimalism, and self-restraint.
- Apply **Utilitarian Ethics** in public policy to maximise long-term ecological well-being.

As the Earth enters the Anthropocene, where human action shapes planetary destiny, ethics rooted in **stewardship, sustainability, and intergenerational justice** are critical.

Medical Ethics

Medical ethics is a branch of applied ethics that deals with the principles and values that should guide medical professionals in their **clinical, research, and administrative roles**.

"Health is not a privilege of the few but a fundamental right of every human being." - WHO

"Primum non nocere: First, do no harm." - Hippocratic Oath

"It is not how much you do, but how much love you put in the doing." - Mother Teresa

Core Principles of Medical Ethics (Beauchamp and Childress Framework)

1. **Autonomy** - Respect the patient's right to make informed decisions. Eg. Consent before surgery or treatment.
2. **Beneficence** - Act in the **best interest of the patient**. Eg. Advising treatments that benefit the patient, even if less profitable.
3. **Non-maleficence** - "First, do no harm." Eg. Avoiding risky or experimental treatments without adequate safeguards.
4. **Justice** - Ensure **fair access to healthcare** and resources. Eg. Treating all patients equally regardless of background.

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Importance of Medical Ethics

1. **Protects Patient Rights and Dignity** - Eg. Seeking informed consent before surgery or disclosing sensitive diagnoses (like HIV).
2. Ensures Trust in the Doctor-doctor-patient relationship by fostering transparency, honesty, and accountability.
3. **Guides Decision-Making in Complex Situations** - Eg. Prioritising ICU beds or ventilators during COVID-19 based on ethical triage criteria.
4. **Balances Science with Humanity** - Eg. Ethical oversight in clinical drug trials to avoid exploitation.
5. **Promotes Equity and Social Justice** - Eg. Ensuring tribal and rural populations receive care under schemes like Ayushman Bharat.
6. **Prevents Malpractice and Corruption** - Eg. Indian Medical Council (Professional Conduct) Regulations discourage fee-splitting and unethical prescriptions.
7. **Supports Public Health Goals** - Eg. Ethical mass vaccination during COVID while respecting choice and misinformation concerns.

Major Issues

1. **Informed Consent and Patient Autonomy** - Patients may be unaware, illiterate, or unconscious, making true informed consent difficult.
2. **Confidentiality vs Public Safety** - Balancing patient privacy with the need to inform others or authorities (Eg. infectious diseases, mental illness).
3. **End-of-Life Decisions and Euthanasia** - Ethical dilemma in withdrawing life support, Do Not Resuscitate (DNR), and passive euthanasia. Eg. Aruna Shanbaug case
4. **Resource Allocation and Triage** - During health crises (Eg. pandemics), limited ICU beds, ventilators, and vaccines must be rationed.
5. **Commercialisation and Conflict of Interest** - Incentives, commissions from pharmaceutical companies, and unnecessary procedures compromise ethical duty.
6. **Medical Negligence and Accountability** - Lack of mechanisms for redressal and justice for malpractice or errors. Defensive medicine (ordering excessive tests to avoid liability).
7. **Ethics in Clinical Trials and Research** - Eg. HPV vaccine trial controversy in India (2010) over consent and safety.
8. **Genetic Engineering and Emerging Technologies** - CRISPR, IVF, AI in diagnostics raise issues of equity, accuracy, consent, and long-term risks.
9. **Organ Transplant Ethics** - Issues of organ trafficking, fairness in donor-recipient allocation, and consent from brain-dead patients' families. Eg. the Black-market kidney trade in India.
10. **Public Health vs Individual Rights** - During epidemics: Vaccination mandates, isolation, and lockdowns conflict with personal freedoms.

Way Forward

1. Make medical ethics a **core part of medical education** and civil services training (as suggested by the National Medical Commission).
2. **Strengthen Legal and Regulatory Frameworks**
   a. Update and enforce **Indian Medical Council (Professional Conduct) Regulations** and link them with **legal accountability** mechanisms.
   b. Establish **independent ethics committees** at institutional and district levels to review complaints and research practices.
3. **Ensure Informed Consent and Autonomy** - Use multilingual, visual consent protocols in rural and low-literacy areas.

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4. **Promote Equity and Justice in Access**
   a. Strengthen **universal health coverage** (Eg. Ayushman Bharat) to reduce ethical inequality in healthcare access.
   b. Implement **transparent triage protocols** during health emergencies, guided by principles of **distributive justice** (Rawlsian ethics).
5. **Regulate Medical Commercialisation** - Monitor and cap fees for life-saving procedures to prevent exploitative pricing.
6. **Ethical Use of Technology and Research**
   a. Institutionalise **Ethics Committees** for all AI, biotech, and drug trials to ensure **safety, consent, and post-trial care**.
   b. Adopt **global best practices** from **Declaration of Helsinki** and **Belmont Report**.
7. **Patient-Centric Care and Communication**
   a. Encourage the practice of **compassion, empathy, and active listening** in clinical settings (virtue ethics).
   b. Use tools like **Advance Medical Directives** for end-of-life care (as allowed post **Aruna Shanbaug case**).

Abortion in India

Abortion is the termination of a pregnancy before the foetus reaches viability.

Important Quotes

- "No woman can call herself free who does not own and control her own body." - Margaret Sanger
- "Reproductive rights are human rights." - United Nations Population Fund
- "The strength of a nation lies in the health and freedom of its women." - Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Legal Provisions in India

1. **Medical Termination of Pregnancy Act 1971-** allows abortion up to 20 weeks under specific medical, humanitarian, and social grounds with registered medical practitioner's opinion.
2. **MTP Amendment Act 2021-** Extended upper limit from 20 to 24 weeks for special categories including survivors of rape, minors, disabled women, and those whose marital status changed during pregnancy.

Supreme Court Judgments

1. **Suchita Srivastava v. Chandigarh Administration (2009)-** Supreme Court held reproductive autonomy is a dimension of personal liberty under Article 21
2. **Murugan Nayakkar v. Union of India (2017)-** Court permitted termination at 24 weeks in case of minor rape survivor
3. **X v. Principal Secretary Health (2022)-** Supreme Court held unmarried women have equal right to safe abortion as married women
4. **Nikhil Soni v. Union of India (2015)-** Court held foetus does not have independent legal personhood separate from mother

Arguments in Favour	Arguments Against
Woman's right to bodily autonomy is absolute	Foetus has right to life from conception
Unsafe abortions kill 8 women daily in India	Abortion ends a potential human life
Rape and incest victims must not be forced to continue	Adoption is a humane alternative to abortion
Foetal abnormality causes lifelong suffering	Selective abortion worsens female foeticide

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Arguments in Favour	Arguments Against
Poverty makes additional children impossible to support	Encourages irresponsible sexual behaviour
Mental health of woman is a medical necessity	Slippery slope toward sex-selective elimination
Denying abortion violates Article 21 right to dignity	Life begins at conception - religious and moral consensus
Early abortion is safer than full-term delivery risks	Undermines sanctity of human life as constitutional value

Way Forward for India

1. **Remove Gestational Limits for Rape Survivors**
2. **Increase Access in Rural Areas**
3. **Full Implementation of Confidentiality-** Section 5A protections must be strictly enforced preventing family, community, and institutional disclosure.
4. **Address Sex-Selective Abortion-** Strengthen PC-PNDT Act enforcement while simultaneously ensuring abortion access

Ethical arguments in Euthanasia

Euthanasia is the deliberate act of ending a person's life to relieve suffering. It is derived from Greek 'eu' (good) and 'thanatos' (death) - meaning a good death.

Arguments For and Against Euthanasia

Arguments in Favour	Arguments Against
Relieves unbearable terminal suffering compassionately	Violates sanctity of human life absolutely
Upholds patient's right to die with dignity	Risk of misuse against elderly and disabled
Prolonged dying causes psychological trauma to family	Palliative care can manage all pain adequately
Reduces financial burden of futile treatment	Doctors' duty is to heal not to kill
Respects autonomy and informed patient choice	Diagnosis of terminal illness can be wrong
Prevents undignified mechanical existence without quality	Slippery slope toward non-voluntary euthanasia
Consistent with compassionate medical ethics	Vulnerable patients may feel pressured to choose death

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Biotechnology and Ethics

Biotechnology ethics refers to the **moral principles and societal concerns** surrounding the **development and application of biotechnologies**, including genetic engineering, cloning, stem cell research, synthetic biology, and gene editing.

"Science without conscience is the ruin of the soul." - **Rabelais**

Global Ethical Benchmarks & Best Practices

1. **UNESCO Declaration on Bioethics and Human Rights (2005)**
2. **Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety (2000)** - regulating GMOs across borders
3. **Belmont Report (USA)** - ethical conduct in biomedical research
4. **India's GEAC (Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee)** - approves GM crop trials
5. **ICMR Guidelines** - on stem cell research and human genome editing

Ethical Arguments

Ethical Principles	Arguments in Favour	Arguments Against
Utilitarianism	Maximises welfare through disease cures and food security (Eg. Golden Rice)	GMOs may harm biodiversity or farmer livelihoods (Eg. BT Brinjal controversy)
Beneficence	Saves lives via gene therapy (Eg. CRISPR for sickle cell)	Rushed biotech may cause harm (Eg. thalidomide drug tragedy)
Non-maleficence	Reduces pesticide use with GM crops (BT Cotton)	Unintended side effects on health/ecosystem (insect resistance)
Autonomy	Informed genetic testing (Eg. BRCA gene testing for cancer)	Risk of coercive use by insurers/employers (discrimination by genetic profiling)
Justice	Nutritional equity via biofortified crops (Golden Rice)	Access limited by patents and cost (Monsanto seed pricing in India)
Precautionary Principle	Safe if tested and regulated (ICMR guidelines on gene editing)	Irreversible risks if unregulated (CRISPR germline editing concern)
Virtue Ethics	Reflects compassion and innovation (developing insulin through biotech)	Shows hubris in altering life (designer babies debate)
Deontological Duty	Moral duty to fight disease and hunger (stem cell research)	Duty not to manipulate life forms (cloning or human embryo editing)

Way Forward

1. Constitute **independent Bioethics Committees** to review biotech research, as suggested by **ICMR Guidelines on Gene Therapy (2020)**
2. Revise and strengthen the role of Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee (GEAC) for transparent approvals of GMOs and biotech trials.

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3. **Ethical Bioprospecting and Protection Against Biopiracy**
   a. Enforce benefit-sharing and local rights through:
   b. **Biological Diversity Act (2002)**
   c. **Nagoya Protocol (2010)**
4. **Develop Ethical Data Governance** - Take cues from **HIPAA (USA)** and **GDPR (EU)** in managing bioinformatics, patient rights, and data transparency in AI-driven biotech.
5. Include **bioethics modules in school curricula**, medical and life science education (aligned with **NEP 2020** emphasis on interdisciplinary ethics).
6. Encourage **Open-source biotechnology** platforms to democratize innovation (Eg. India's **DBT's Biotech Kisan program**).

MEDIA ETHICS

Media ethics refers to the **moral principles and standards** that govern the conduct of individuals and organizations in the media industry.

> **"Freedom of the press is a precious privilege that no country can forego."** - Mahatma Gandhi
> **"The role of journalism is to shape society with truth, not gossip and sensationalism."** - R.K. Laxman
> **"The power of the press should be used not to exploit but to inform."** - Ramnath Goenka
> **"Journalism is a guardian of truth and the voice of the voiceless."** - Prannoy Roy
> **"Freedom of the press is the mortar that binds together the bricks of democracy."** - Franklin D. Roosevelt

Core Principles

Principle	Description
Truth & Accuracy	Report facts truthfully, verify sources, avoid distortion.
Independence	Stay free from political or corporate influence; resist paid news or propaganda.
Fairness & Objectivity	Avoid bias, give balanced perspectives, present multiple viewpoints.
Accountability	Correct errors, accept responsibility, avoid misleading the public.
Respect for Privacy	Avoid intrusion into personal lives unless justified by public interest.
Public Interest	Prioritize societal good over sensationalism or profit motives.
Decency & Non-Harm	Avoid inciting violence, hate speech, or graphic content.

Significance of media

1. **Acts as the Fourth Pillar of Democracy** - Ensuring accountability of public institutions by acting as a watchdog over the executive, legislature, and judiciary.
2. **Informs and Educates the Public** - Media enables civic education and promotes informed citizenry by spreading accurate, timely, and relevant news critical for deliberative democracy.
3. **Agenda-Setting and Public Opinion** - Drives policy focus, and amplifies grassroots concerns, shaping the public sphere.

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4. **Political Socialisation and Electoral Participation** by covering debates, manifestos, and electoral processes.
5. **Voice to the Voiceless and Pluralism** - By promoting inclusivity, media becomes a platform for marginalised voices and fosters representational justice in a diverse, plural society.
6. **Transparency and Good Governance** - Media exposes corruption, ensures policy scrutiny, and upholds administrative accountability
7. **Media Ethics and Social Responsibility** - Adherence to ethical journalism, including truth, fairness, and decency, ensures that media serves the public interest
8. **Digital Engagement** - Through social media activism, media fosters real-time public engagement, enhances citizen feedback loops, and supports responsive governance.

Key issues-

1. **Paid News** - Eg. Cobrapost's Operation 136 exposed major Indian media houses willing to publish content promoting Hindutva ideology in exchange for money.
2. **Sensationalism** - Breaking news culture, infotainment, clickbait journalism, TRP wars, media circus violates accuracy and public interest, promotes panic or misinformation.
3. **Trial by Media** - Eg. Aarushi Talwar case, Sushant Singh Rajput investigation.
4. **Fake News and Misinformation** - Eg. Fake news during Operation Sindoor
5. **Communalization & Hate Speech** - Communal bias, hate-mongering, polarizing narratives, incitement to violence through reporting. Eg. tablighi jamaat coverage during Covid
6. **Conflict of Interest & Ownership Bias** - Cross-media ownership in media conglomerates leading to editorial interference and corporate-political nexus.
7. **Invasion of Privacy** - Paparazzi culture and unauthorized surveillance violates dignity and decency. Eg. Gudiya Rape Case (2002): Media's intrusive coverage led to the victim's suicide
8. **Lack of Accountability and Regulation** - Absence of binding ethical codes, especially for digital platforms. Weak enforcement by self-regulatory bodies like the Press Council of India.
9. **Clickbait and Infotainment Culture** - Prioritizing speed and virality over credibility. Reduces journalism to entertainment, trivialising serious issues.
10. **Non-adherence to Ethical Norms** in Reporting Sensitive Issues - Graphic visuals, communal content, victim-blaming. Violates ethics of non-harm and sensitivity.
11. **Digital Media Ethics & AI Challenges** - Eg. Meta's Content Moderation Failures during 2024 elections

6C framework

C	Issue Type
Content	Fake news, hate speech, obscenity
Credibility	Paid news, lack of verification, TRP chasing
Conflict of Interest	Political/corporate ownership bias
Confidentiality	Breach of privacy, exposure of victims
Consent	Unauthorized use of personal info or images
Coverage Ethics	Trial by media, communal narratives

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Way Forward

1. **Institutional Strengthening** - Law Commission of India recommended a **Media Council of India** with wider powers than the Press Council to regulate both print and digital media.
2. **Mandatory Ethical Code for All Media** - Enforce a uniform, legally binding Code of Ethics for TV, print, digital, and social media.
3. **Strengthen Self-Regulation with Public Accountability**
   a. Empower bodies like:
   b. **News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA)**
   c. **Broadcasting Content Complaints Council (BCCC)**
   d. Mandate **ombudspersons** and public **disclosure of corrections, retractions**, and **funding sources**.
4. **Implement media literacy programs** in schools, colleges, and civil services training (recommended by NEP 2020).
5. **Ensure Editorial Independence** - Delink **ownership from editorial policy**- following the **UK's Ofcom model**.
6. **Technology Ethics - Create a Digital Media Ethics Charter** to guide social media platforms
7. **Global Best Practices**

Best Practice	What to Learn
BBC Editorial Guidelines (UK)	Independence, accuracy, balance in reporting
SPJ Code of Ethics (USA)	Seek truth, minimize harm, act independently, be accountable
UNESCO Media Development Indicators	Pluralism, safety of journalists, ethical content ecosystem
Trust Project (Global)	Use of transparency indicators to build credibility

"Freedom of the press is not just the right to publish, but the duty to inform with integrity."

Sports Ethics

Sports ethics refers to the application of ethical principles like **fairness, integrity, respect, and accountability** in the domain of sports-on and off the field.

Core Principles

Principle	Explanation
Fair Play	Competing honestly, respecting rules, and not seeking unfair advantage.
Integrity	Rejecting corruption, match-fixing, or performance-enhancing drugs.
Respect	Acknowledging opponents, officials, and fans with dignity.
Accountability	Taking responsibility for one's actions, both success and failure.
Inclusion & Equality	Ensuring sports are accessible regardless of gender, race, caste, or class.

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Key Ethical Issues in Sports:

Challenge	Example
Doping and Cheating	Lance Armstrong's doping scandal; Narsingh Yadav (India)
Match Fixing	IPL spot-fixing (2013); Mohammad Azharuddin ban
Gender Inequality	Disparity in pay and recognition (Eg. women's cricket in India)
Commercialisation	Excessive endorsements compromising performance priorities
Age and Identity Fraud	Common in junior athletics and domestic cricket
Abuse and Harassment	Gymnastics abuse scandal (USA); allegations in Indian wrestling
Fan Violence and Hooliganism	World Cup crowd riots; Indian stadium violence

Global Standards and Regulations:

1. **World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA):** Sets universal standards for preventing doping and ensures a level playing field.
2. **Olympic Charter:** Promotes equality, fairness, and respect across all participants in Olympic sports.
3. **FIFA's Anti-Discrimination Initiatives:** FIFA has implemented various anti-racism campaigns and rules to combat discrimination in football.
4. **UNESCO International Charter of Physical Education and Sport:** Emphasizes that access to sports is a fundamental human right and promotes ethical values in sports globally.

Sports ethics is not just about playing by the rules-it is about **upholding values** that transcend the field. In an age of rising commercialisation and pressure to win at all costs, reinforcing ethical conduct in sports ensures that it remains a **beacon of inspiration, integrity, and national pride**.

AI and Ethics

AI Ethics refers to the **moral principles and values** that govern the development, deployment, and use of **artificial intelligence systems**, ensuring they benefit society while avoiding harm, discrimination, or misuse.

> **"AI is likely to be either the best or worst thing to happen to humanity."** - Stephen Hawking
>
> **"Technology and ethics must evolve together to build AI that respects human values."** - Sundar Pichai

Ethical Case for AI

1. It reduces **cognitive bias** and offers **Neutrality and Objectivity** in decision making. Eg. use of AI in SSC exam evaluation
2. **Data-driven policymaking** promotes evidence-based governance. Eg. Aarogya Setu App
3. **Ensures consistency and predictability** - Eg. AI based custom approval process by DGFT
4. **Efficiency** in service delivery. Eg. **Samagra Vedika** platform of telangana create a "360-degree profile" of every citizen to verify eligibility for welfare schemes

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5. By removing the **"human interface"**, AI reduces the opportunity for **bribery and rent-seeking.** Eg. AI-driven **MCA21 V3** portal flags suspicious shell companies and fraudulent filings.
6. **Enhances accuracy**. Eg. IMD using AI for weather forcasting
7. **Disaster Management Efficiency-** Eg. **Google's AI Flood Forecasting** model, used by **CWC**, provides real-time flood alerts
8. **Targeted welfare delivery** - AI improves beneficiary identification in DBT.
9. **Utilitarian Optimization- Eg. NITI Aayog** partnered with IBM to develop AI models for **Crop Yield Prediction for farmers**
10. Enhancing **public participation** through **language inclusivity**. Eg. **BHASHINI** platform

Ethical Concerns

1. **The "Black Box" Problem-** AI logic is often opaque.
2. **Institutionalizing Historical Bias-** If data is biased , the AI will "learn" and automate that bias. Eg. **US COMPAS tool biased against African-Americans.**
3. **Difficulty in ensuring accountability** for mistakes.
4. **Loss of "Compassion" and "Conscience"-** Eg. It cannot "bend the rules" for a starving widow whose paperwork is missing.
5. **Digital Dehumanization-** AI reduces complex human lives into "risk scores" or "eligibility percentages".
6. **Threat to Right to Privacy-** Constant AI monitoring can turn a "Welfare State" into a "Surveillance State".
7. **Skill Atrophy-** Administrators may stop using their own judgment, leading to a loss of critical thinking - "Steel Frame" to **"Silicon Frame"**
8. Widening **North-South divide** - Poor countries lack access to tech-mediated services.

Way Forward- "Human-Centric AI."

1. **Explainable AI-** Implementing systems where the AI must provide a "human-readable" reason for every decision.
2. **Human-in-the-Loop (HITL)-** The final "sign-off," especially in cases affecting human rights, must be by a human officer.
3. Mandating **regular 3rd-party audits** of government algorithms to detect and "unlearn" biases.
4. **The EU AI Act Approach- "Risk-Based Framework"** where high-risk AI (policing or judiciary) face the highest level of ethical regulation.
5. **Digital Ethics Commissions** including ethicists, jurists, and technologists to oversee AI deployment in public service.
6. **Right to Appeal against AI-** Statutory rights for citizens to have an AI-driven decision reviewed by a human committee.
7. **Ethical Coding Standards-** Teaching **"Ethics by Design"** to programmers working on public infrastructure.
8. Training civil servants in **AI Literacy** under **Mission Karmayogi**.
9. Strengthening **privacy safeguards under DPDP Act.**

The goal must be not AI-driven governance, but ethically guided AI-assisted governance.

Military Ethics

Military ethics governs the moral conduct of military personnel and operations, emphasizing **justice**, **accountability**, and **human dignity**.

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1. "It is not enough to fight. It is the spirit which we bring to the fight that decides the issue." - George Marshall
2. "In war, truth is the first casualty." - Aeschylus

Key Principles

1. **Just War Theory (Jus Ad Bellum)-** War is morally justified only as a last resort for just cause with the right intention. Eg. India's 1971 Bangladesh liberation war to prevent genocide.
2. **Proportionality-** Military force used must be proportionate to legitimate military objectives sought. Eg. Geneva Conventions prohibit disproportionate attacks causing excessive civilian casualties.
3. **Discrimination/Distinction-** Combatants must always distinguish between military targets and civilian non-combatants always.
4. **Military Necessity-** Only force genuinely necessary to achieve legitimate military objectives is ethically permissible.
5. **Humanity Principle-** Even in war unnecessary suffering must be prevented and human dignity respected. Eg. India's treatment of 93,000 Pakistani POWs after 1971 war
6. **Obedience vs Conscience-** Soldiers must obey lawful orders but have the duty to refuse manifestly illegal or unethical commands. Eg. My Lai Massacre 1968
7. **Chivalry and Honour-** Military tradition demands respect for surrendering enemy, wounded soldiers, and prisoners of war.

Indian Military Ethics

1. **Martial Traditions-** Indian military ethics draws from Mahabharata's dharma-yuddha - righteous war
2. **Regimental Honour-** Indian Army's regimental system builds unit-level ethical culture of loyalty, courage, and sacrifice.
3. **UN Peacekeeping Ethics-** Indian peacekeepers in Congo and South Sudan widely respected for ethical conduct and civilian protection.
4. **Counter-Insurgency Ethics-** Army's Sadbhavana Programme (civic action, schools, medical camps) reflects ethical counter-insurgency beyond kinetic operations.
5. **Civil-Military Relations-** Democratic civilian control of the military is itself an ethical principle ensuring accountability.

Legal Framework

1. **Geneva Conventions 1949-** Four conventions governing treatment of wounded, prisoners, and civilians. India signatory.
2. **Hague Conventions-** Regulates means and methods of warfare. Prohibits certain weapons causing unnecessary suffering.
3. **Army Act 1950-** Governs discipline, conduct, and punishment of Indian Army personnel including military justice system.
4. **Rome Statute-** Established International Criminal Court. Criminalises war crimes, crimes against humanity, and genocide.

Key Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Collateral Damage-** Military operations inevitably risk civilian casualties. Eg. Attack on Schools during Israel-Iran conflict.
2. **Torture -** Coercive interrogation may yield intelligence but violates human dignity and international law absolutely. Eg. USA's post-9/11 enhanced interrogation programme
3. **Drone Warfare and Accountability-** Remote killing through drones disconnects operators from the moral weight of taking human life.
4. **Nuclear Weapons Ethics-** Nuclear deterrence that relies on credible threat of mass civilian destruction is ethically paradoxical.

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5. **Soldier's Moral Injury-** Combat trauma includes not just psychological but moral injury from participation in killing. Eg. Rising PTSD and suicide rates among veterans globally
6. **Cyber Warfare-** Digital attacks on civilian infrastructure blur distinction between military and civilian targets entirely. Eg. Stuxnet attack on Iran's nuclear facility
7. **AI and Autonomous Weapons-** Lethal autonomous weapons systems removing human judgment from killing decisions. Eg. UN debates on Killer Robots (LAWS)
8. **Human Rights-** Special powers granting immunity to armed forces in disturbed areas conflict with accountability principle. Eg. Manipur fake encounter cases

Way Forward:

1. **Ethics in Military Education-** NDA, IMA, and Staff College must integrate applied ethics, international humanitarian law, and moral philosophy into core curriculum.
2. **AFSPA Reform-** Accountability mechanisms must be strengthened to prevent impunity while maintaining operational effectiveness in disturbed areas.
3. **Autonomous Weapons Governance-** India must actively participate in international efforts to establish ethical red lines for autonomous lethal weapons.
4. **Veteran Mental Health-** Ex-Servicemen Contributory Health Scheme must be expanded to include specialised moral injury and trauma counselling.
5. **Cyber Warfare Norms- Tallinn Manual** provides an international cyber warfare ethics framework that India's cyber doctrine must engage with explicitly.

Ethical Issues in International Relations and Funding

International ethics, a set of **universal standards** and values, guides nations in their **global interactions**.

Theories of International Relations

1. **Realism - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Anarchy:** No global government or central authority.
   b. **Power:** States seek to accumulate power to ensure survival.
   c. **Self-Help System:** States rely on their own resources for security.
   d. **Balance of Power:** States form alliances to prevent any one state from becoming too powerful.
   e. **Eg.** The Cold War rivalry between the United States and the Soviet Union.
2. **Liberalism - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Interdependence:** Economic, social, and political ties create opportunities for cooperation.
   b. **International Institutions:** Organizations like the United Nations and World Trade Organization (WTO) facilitate cooperation and conflict resolution.
   c. **Democracy:** Democratic states are less likely to go to war with each other (Democratic Peace Theory).
   d. **Eg.** The European Union (EU) as an example of economic cooperation leading to peace and integration.
3. **Constructivism - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Social Construction of Reality:** The belief that international actors' identities and interests are shaped by social interactions.
   b. **Norms and Ideas:** Norms and ideas, not just material power, drive state behavior.
   c. **Identity:** State behavior is influenced by the identity it constructs for itself.
   d. **Eg.** The end of the Cold War, where shifting ideas about democracy and human rights influenced global politics.
4. **Marxism - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Class Struggle:** The division between the bourgeoisie (capitalist class) and the proletariat (working class).

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b. **Imperialism:** Capitalist powers exploit less-developed countries for resources and labor.
c. **Economic Determinism:** Economic factors shape political and social systems.
d. **Eg.** The exploitation of developing countries by colonial powers or multinational corporations.

5. **Feminist Theory - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Gendered Power Relations:** Political power is often distributed unevenly along gender lines.
   b. **Inclusive Security:** Gender equality is essential for achieving lasting peace and security.
   c. **Critique of Traditional Theories:** Feminist theory critiques traditional theories (like Realism and Liberalism) for ignoring gendered experiences and perspectives.
   d. **Eg.** Women's involvement in peace negotiations, such as the role of women in the peace process in Liberia.
6. **Critical Theory - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Emancipation:** The goal of freeing marginalized groups from oppression.
   b. **Power and Ideology:** The role of dominant ideologies in shaping international order.
   c. **Hegemony:** The dominance of certain political and economic systems over others.
   d. **Eg.** The postcolonial critique of Western dominance and global capitalism.
7. **World Systems Theory - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Core, Semi-Periphery, and Periphery:** The division of the world economy into exploitative and exploited regions.
   b. **Global Capitalism:** The dominance of capitalist economies that perpetuate global inequality.
   c. **Unequal Exchange:** The flow of resources from peripheral to core regions.
   d. **Eg.** The relationship between developed countries (like the US or Germany) and developing countries (like many African nations).
8. **Postcolonial Theory - Key Concepts:**
   a. **Colonial Legacy:** The continuing impact of colonialism on global politics, economics, and culture.
   b. **Eurocentrism:** The tendency to prioritize European or Western perspectives in global affairs.
   c. **Resistance and Identity:** The struggle of colonized nations to assert their identities and independence.
   d. **Eg.** The criticism of the modern international system for perpetuating inequalities inherited from colonialism.

Major Ethical Issues in International Relations

1. **Sovereignty vs. Human Rights - Eg. The 1994 Rwandan Genocide** - The international community's failure to intervene in time
2. **Controversy over Humanitarian Intervention - Eg. NATO's intervention in Kosovo (1999)**
3. **Refugee Crisis** - Mass displacement creates tension between state sovereignty over borders and moral obligation toward persecuted human beings.
4. **Nuclear Deterrence Ethics-** Eg. India's No First Use doctrine attempts ethical constraint but Pakistan's first-use posture creates ethical asymmetry in deterrence.
5. **Climate Justice and Historical Responsibility-** Eg. India's per capita emissions are fraction of USA yet faces equal pressure for emission reductions at COP negotiations.
6. **Economic Sanctions Ethics-** Sanctions punish civilian populations for governments' actions, raising justice and proportionality concerns.
7. **Debt Trap Diplomacy-** Predatory lending by powerful nations to developing countries undermines sovereignty and creates modern economic dependency. Eg. Sri Lanka's Hambantota Port lease to China
8. **Technology and Surveillance** - Powerful nations use digital surveillance globally without accountability to affected populations. Eg. NSA's PRISM programme revealed by Snowden
9. **Arms Trade Ethics-** Global arms exports fuel conflicts, prolong wars, and contribute to civilian casualties in recipient countries.

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10. **Humanitarian Aid Conditionality-** Eg. IMF structural adjustment conditions imposed on Sri Lanka and Pakistan during economic crises restricted sovereign policy choices.
11. **Terrorism and State Sponsored Violence-** Defining terrorism raises ethical questions - one nation's terrorist is another's freedom fighter.
12. **Intellectual Property and Global Health-** Patent protections on medicines create ethical tension between corporate profit and access to life-saving drugs.
13. **Foreign Interference in Domestic Politics** - Eg. accusations of Russian interference in USA presidential elections of 2016
14. **Global Wealth Inequality-** Top 1% own more than bottom 50% globally

India's Ethical Framework in Foreign Policy

1. **Panchsheel Principles 1954-** mutual respect, non-aggression, non-interference, equality, peaceful coexistence
2. **Non-Alignment Movement-** moral assertion that developing nations have right to independent ethical foreign policy.
3. **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam-** Eg. India's G20 Presidency 2023 theme - One Earth One Family One Future
4. **Strategic Autonomy-** maintaining independent ethical judgment on each international issue.
5. **Development Partnership Ethics-** Eg. ITEC programme and India-Africa Forum Summit
6. **Nuclear Ethics-** India's nuclear doctrine - No First Use, credible minimum deterrence, disarmament aspiration
7. **Climate Ethics-** Eg. India's PANCHAMRIT commitments at COP26

Way Forward

1. **Reform UN Security Council**
2. **Universal Human Rights Enforcement** without selective application based on strategic interest.
3. **Global Tax Justice-** Eg. OECD's Global Minimum Corporate Tax 15%
4. **Climate Finance Delivery-** immediate delivery of developed nations' $100 billion annual climate finance pledge
5. **Strengthen Arms Trade Treaties** to prevent weapons exports fuelling civilian-targeting conflicts globally.
6. **Global Health Justice-** Pandemic preparedness and vaccine access must be governed by global public good principles not pharmaceutical profit.
7. **Digital Governance Ethics-** International framework governing state surveillance, cyber warfare, and digital sovereignty
8. **Refugee Protection Framework-** Universal refugee protection system built on human dignity
9. **Decolonisation of Global Institutions-** Eg. vote reform in Bretton Woods institutions
10. **Ethical AI in Global Governance-** AI-powered surveillance, autonomous weapons, and algorithmic diplomacy require international ethical red lines.

Ethical Issues in sanctions

1. **Collective Punishment of Civilians-** Eg. UN sanctions on Iraq from 1990 to 2003 led to an estimated 500,000 children dead from malnutrition and medicine shortages. **(UNICEF)**
2. **Double Standards and Selective Application-** Eg. USA sanctioned Russia for the Ukraine invasion but maintained close ties with Saudi Arabia despite its war crimes in Yemen.
3. **Legitimacy Without UN Mandate-** Eg. USA's unilateral sanctions on Cuba, Iran, and Venezuela lack UNSC authorisation and violate the sovereign equality principle.
4. **Economic Coercion Versus Sovereignty-** Sanctions undermine a target nation's sovereign right to determine its own economic and political path freely.

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5. **Proportionality Concern-** Hyperinflation and supply side disruptions in Cuba and Venezuela leading to civilian suffering. Eg. power grid failure in Cuba
6. Even sanctions with **formal humanitarian exemptions** fail in practice because banking restrictions prevent medicine and food imports.
7. **Secondary Sanctions Coercion-** Eg. CAATSA secondary sanctions threatened India for purchasing Russian S-400 systems
8. **Sanctions Strengthen Authoritarian Regimes** by providing them a nationalist narrative and control over scarce resources. Eg. North Korea

Way Forward

1. **Multilateral Mandate Requirement-** All sanctions must require UNSC authorisation
2. **Mandatory Humanitarian Impact Assessment-** Independent assessment of humanitarian consequences must precede and continuously monitor every sanctions regime imposed.
3. **Sunset Clauses-** All sanctions must carry defined duration and specific measurable conditions for removal preventing indefinite collective punishment.
4. **Genuine Humanitarian Exemptions-** Exemptions for food, medicine, and essential services must be operationally effective
5. **Accountability Mechanism-** An independent international body must assess sanctions effectiveness and proportionality on a regular basis.
6. **Reconciliation Framework-** Every sanctions regime must include a defined diplomatic pathway for normalisation preventing permanent economic isolation of nations.

Ethical Issues in Global Environmental Politics

Global environmental politics refers to the arena of international negotiations, agreements, and power struggles over shared ecological resources and responsibilities.

1. "We are the first generation to feel the impact of climate change and the last generation that can do something about it." - **Barack Obama**
2. "Climate change is not an environmental issue. It is a human rights issue, a justice issue, and a survival issue." - **Mary Robinson**
3. "The Earth does not belong to us. We belong to the Earth."

Key Ethical Principles

1. **Intergenerational Equity-** Present generation has no moral right to exhaust ecological resources that future generations depend upon for survival.
2. **Intragenerational Equity-** Environmental burdens and ecological benefits must be distributed fairly among all people living on Earth today.
3. **Common But Differentiated Responsibilities-** Historical ecological damage creates differentiated moral obligations among developed and developing nations.
4. **Precautionary Principle-** When scientific uncertainty about environmental harm exists, precaution must override economic convenience and delay.
5. **Polluter Pays Principle-** Those causing environmental degradation must bear full costs of restoration and compensation to affected communities. Eg. Coal Tax
6. **Right to Development-** Developing nations have sovereign moral right to pursue economic growth and poverty elimination through their own chosen path.
7. **Environmental Justice-** No community should bear disproportionate environmental burden due to race, class, caste, or political powerlessness.
8. **Trusteeship Principle-** States and citizens are trustees of natural resources holding them in custody for all living beings and future generations.

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Major Ethical Issues

1. **Climate Justice and Historical Responsibility-** Developed nations historically caused climate change while developing nations disproportionately bear its consequences today.
2. **Broken Climate Finance Promises-** Developed nations pledged $100 billion annually for climate action in developing countries but consistently failed to deliver promised funds.
3. **Carbon Colonialism-** Developed nations impose emissions reduction obligations on developing nations that constrain their sovereign right to industrialise and eliminate poverty.
4. **Loss and Damage Injustice-** Small island nations facing existential climate threats receive no compensation for damages caused by others' emissions.
5. **Greenwashing by Corporations and Nations-** Eg. major oil companies publicly committed to net zero while simultaneously expanding exploration and production investments
6. **Technology Transfer Denial-** Eg. Solar panel patents and green hydrogen technology remain concentrated in few developed nations.
7. **Carbon Market Ethics-** Carbon trading allows rich nations and corporations to buy their way out of emissions reductions instead of genuinely decarbonising.
8. **Exporting of waste by developed countries-** Eg. USA, UK, and Japan exporting plastic waste to Malaysia, Vietnam, and Indonesia after China banned imports in 2018.
9. **Environmental Racism-** Polluting industries, toxic waste facilities, and ecological sacrifice zones are systematically located in poor, minority, and marginalised communities.
10. **Deforestation and Sovereignty-** Developed nations demand developing nations protect forests while having already cleared their own for industrial development historically.
11. **Green Conditionality in Aid** constrains sovereign development choices of recipient nations.
12. **Extractivism and Neo-Colonialism** for critical minerals. Eg. USA's attempt to control critical minerals in Ukraine

Way Forward

1. **Binding Climate Finance Commitments** for developed countries under CBDR principle.
2. **Reform Global Environmental Governance-** UNEP must be upgraded to a specialised UN agency with binding authority and adequate funding for implementation.
3. **Indigenous Rights in Conservation-** Conservation frameworks must recognise indigenous communities as partners and rights-holders not obstacles to be displaced.
4. **Just Transition for Developing Nations-** Green transition must be accompanied by financial and technical support ensuring no developing nation is left behind.

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Chapter 3

Attitude

PYQs

[2022] The Rules and Regulations provided to all the civil servants are the same, yet there is a difference in the performance. Positive minded officers are able to interpret the Rules and Regulations in favour of the case and achieve success, whereas negative minded officers are unable to achieve goals by interpreting the same Rules and Regulations against the case. Discuss with illustrations. (10)

[2021] Attitude is an important component that goes as input in the development of humans. How to build a suitable attitude needed for a public servant? (10)

[2020] "Hatred is destructive of a person's wisdom and conscience that can poison a nation's spirit.' Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. (10)

[2020] A positive attitude is considered to be an essential characteristic of a civil servant who is often required to function under extreme stress. What contributes to a positive attitude in a person? (10)

Attitude refers to a **learned, settled, and relatively enduring evaluative disposition** of an individual toward a person, object, idea, situation, or event, which influences their thoughts, feelings, and behaviour consistently.

QUOTES ON ATTITUDE

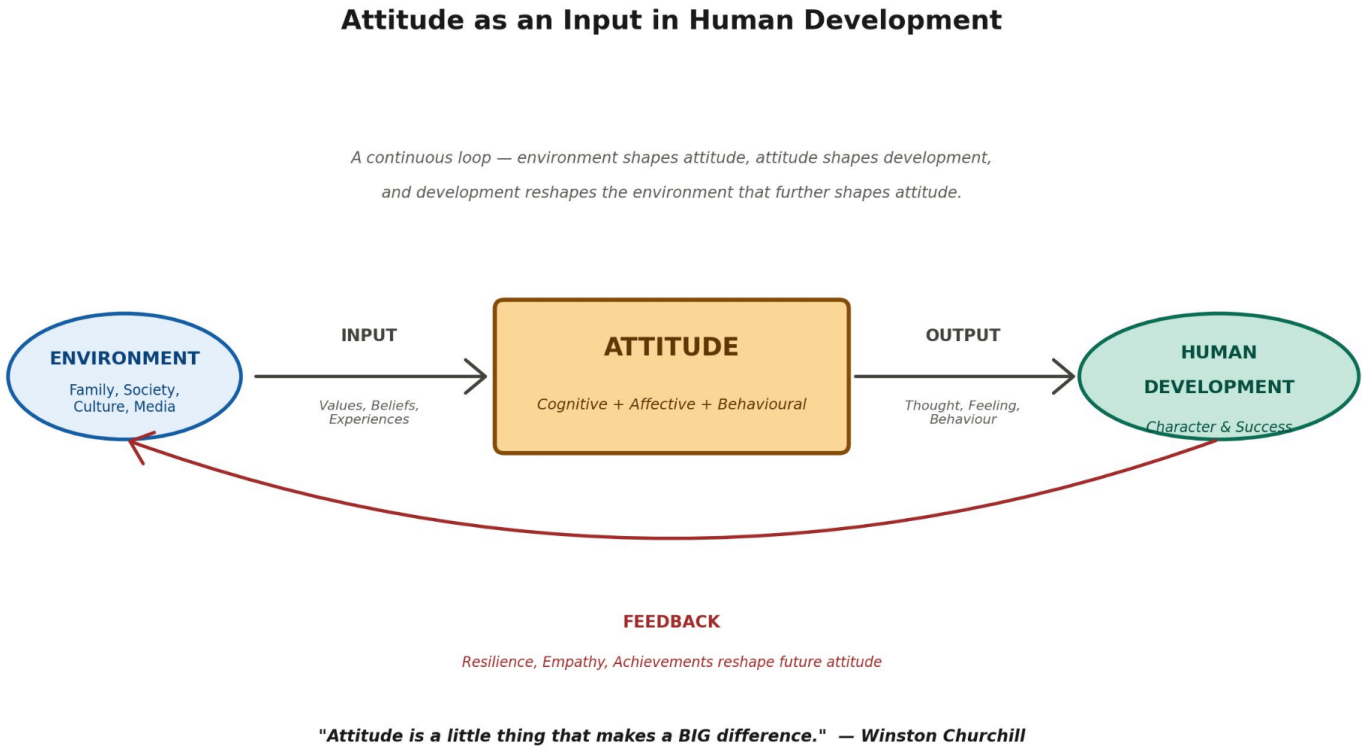
- **Ability** is what you are **capable of doing**. **Motivation determines what you do**. Attitude determines **how well you do** it."
- "**Attitudes are habits of the heart**"- michael sandel
- "Our attitude towards life determines life's attitude towards us."
- "Our attitude, not aptitude will determine our altitude."
- "Our THOUGHTS become our WORDS. Our WORDS become our BEHAVIOR. Our BEHAVIOR becomes our HABITS. Our HABITS become our VALUES. Our **VALUES become our DESTINY**." - **Mahatma Gandhi.**
- "Education is not the name of any degree or certificate that can be shown as proof. It is the name of our attitude, actions, language, and behavior with others in real-time." - **Barack Obama**.
- "You can often change your circumstances by changing your attitude". -**Eleanor Roosevelt**
- "Attitude is a little thing that makes a big difference" -**Winston Churchill**
- Nothing can stop the person with the right mental attitude from achieving his goals. Nothing on earth can help the person with the wrong mental attitude.-**Thomas Jefferson**

Characteristics of Attitude

1. Attitudes are **not innate** but acquired through **socialisation, observation, and experience**. **Eg. Children of social reformers inherit progressive attitudes through household exposure**
2. **Relatively Enduring:** Once formed, attitudes remain stable over time though they can change with effort. **Eg. Sardar Patel's lifelong attitude of national unity**
3. **Directed Toward an Object** like a person, group, idea, or situation. **Eg. Savitribai Phule's positive attitude toward girls' education shaped her work toward female learners.**

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4. **Influences Behaviour: Eg. Verghese Kurien's positive attitude toward farmers' cooperatives created the Amul White Revolution.**
5. **Can Be Changed Through Persuasion: Eg. Public attitudes toward LGBTQ rights shifted significantly after Navtej Singh Johar judgment 2018.**
6. **Carries Evaluative Dimension:** Every attitude includes a like or dislike judgment toward the object.
7. **Multidimensional Nature:** Attitudes involve cognition, emotion, and behavioural tendency operating together.
8. **Social and Cultural Influence:** Attitudes are heavily shaped by family, society, religion, and culture.
9. **Often Unconscious:** Many attitudes operate without the person being fully aware of them.



Structure of Attitude

Gregory R. Maio and Geoffery Haddock suggest that attitudes consist of 3 components: **cognitive (thoughts), affective (feelings), and behavioral (actions or experiences**).

1. **Cognitive component**: It refers to the thoughts and beliefs one holds about the attitude object.
   a. **Analogy**: I believe spiders are dangerous.
2. **Affective component**: This represents the **emotional response**, such as liking or disliking, towards an attitude object. It often **involves an initial reaction,** whether positive or negative, such as fear or excitement.
   a. **Analogy**: I am afraid of spiders.
3. **Behavioral component**: This refers to an individual's verbal or non-verbal behavioral tendencies, manifesting in actions or observable responses toward an attitude object.
   a. **Analogy**: I will avoid spiders and scream and run when I see one.

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Portugal's football player Ronaldo removed Coca-Cola bottles from the camera's view and replaced them with a bottle of water in his press conference. In this example, the A-B-C components of attitude can be observed as follows:

- **Affective component- The feeling of disgust towards Coca-Cola.**
- **Behavioural component- Removal of the Coca-Cola bottles.**
- **Cognitive component- Knowledge of Ronaldo that Coca-Cola Is bad for health.**

Key Functions of Attitude

1. **Adjustment Function-** Attitudes help **adjust to the social environment and gain approval.** Eg. civil servants develop public service attitudes for institutional adjustment.
2. **Ego-Defensive Function:** Attitudes protect self-esteem and shield individuals from inner conflicts and anxieties. Eg. An administrative officer blaming systemic political pressure rather than acknowledging their own executive management failures.
3. **Value-Expressive Function:** Attitudes allow individuals to express their core values and beliefs publicly. **Eg. Medha Patkar's protest attitude expresses her core values of social justice and tribal rights.**
4. **Knowledge Function:** Attitudes help organise and simplify complex information about the world. **Eg. An officer's positive attitude toward evidence-based policy helps her organise data-driven governance decisions.**
5. **Social Identity Function:** Attitudes signal group membership and social belonging. **Eg. IAS officers shared attitudes toward constitutional values create a distinct professional identity**
6. **Instrumental Function:** Attitudes help achieve desired rewards and avoid punishments in social settings. **Eg. Students develop positive attitudes toward academic excellence to gain career rewards.**
7. **Motivational Function:** Attitudes drive sustained action toward chosen goals despite obstacles. **Eg. Kalpana Chawla's positive attitude toward space science sustained her through years of rigorous training.**
8. **Decision-Making Function:** Attitudes provide cognitive shortcuts for routine ethical and practical decisions. **Eg. An officer with an anti-corruption attitude instinctively refuses bribes without lengthy deliberation each time.**

Factors Determining Attitude

1. **Family Influence: Eg. Gandhi's attitudes of truth and non-violence** were rooted in mother Putlibai's daily religious discipline.
2. **Educational Institutions** shape attitudes through curriculum and institutional culture. **Eg. Tagore's Shantiniketan cultivated attitudes of creativity, freedom, and respect for nature.**
3. **Peer Group Influence** shapes attitudes through social pressure and modeling. **Eg. Bhagat Singh's revolutionary attitudes** were shaped through interactions with peers in HSRA.
4. **Religious and Cultural Background** provide foundational attitudes toward life and morality. **Eg. Buddhist philosophy of compassion shaped Ashoka's transformation post Kalinga war.**
5. **Personal Experience** shapes attitudes toward objects and situations. **Eg. Dr. Ambedkar's experience of caste humiliation** in childhood shaped his lifelong attitude against caste.
6. **Mass Media:** Newspapers, and digital media influence attitudes on public issues. **Eg. Nirbhaya case 2012 media coverage transformed public attitudes toward gender violence.**
7. **Role Models** shape attitudes through their example and conduct. **Eg. APJ Abdul Kalam's life inspired positive attitudes toward science and patriotism in millions of Indian youth.**
8. **Economic class and social position** shape attitudes toward authority, work, and opportunity. **Eg. L.B. Shastri's modest background** shaped his lifelong attitude of simplicity and frugality in public office.

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9. **State policies, laws, and institutions** shape collective attitudes over time. **Eg. Swachh Bharat Mission transformed public attitudes toward cleanliness**

Significance of Positive Attitude for Individuals

1. **Mental Health and Wellbeing-** Reduces stress and improves emotional resilience. Eg. **Helen Keller's** positive attitude despite blindness and deafness sustained lifelong literary achievements
2. **Better Physical Health-** Eg. Mayo Clinic studies show optimists have 50% lower cardiovascular disease compared to chronic pessimists.
3. **Stronger Relationships-** Enables **empathy and cooperation** in social bonds. Eg. Nelson Mandela's reconciliation attitude after 27 years in prison healed apartheid wounds.
4. **Higher Academic and Professional Achievement-** Eg. APJ Abdul Kalam's positive attitude took him from selling newspapers in Rameswaram to becoming President of India.
5. **Resilience in Adversity-** Eg. Arunima Sinha lost her leg in a 2011 train accident yet became the first amputee woman to climb Mount Everest in 2013.
6. **Better Decision Making-** Improves **cognitive flexibility and creativity.**
7. **Leadership Capacity-** Inspires others through hope and possibility. Eg. Sundar Lal Bahuguna's positive forest attitude inspired the Chipko Movement of 1973 in Reni village Uttarakhand.
8. **Spiritual Growth-** Enables gratitude and inner peace across traditions.

Significance of Positive Attitude for Civil Servants

1. **Effective Service Delivery-** Eg. **DM Armstrong Pame** built 100 km Manipur road in 2012 without government funds through a positive can-do attitude.
2. **Empathy for Vulnerable Groups-** Eg. **IAS Smita Sabharwal** launched Aasara helpline for women in Karimnagar reflecting empathetic governance attitude.
3. **Resilience in Crisis-** Sustains officers through disasters and administrative pressure.
4. **Constructive Team Building-** Inspires juniors and creates collaborative culture. Eg. Kiran Bedi's positive leadership transformed Tihar Jail through Vipassana meditation programmes.
5. **Integrity Under Pressure-** Eg. T.N. Seshan's positive attitude toward democracy transformed the Election Commission into a feared institution between 1990-96.
6. **Innovation and Problem-Solving-** Eg. **DM O.P. Choudhary** built the Rajiv Gandhi Education Mission in Dantewada providing tribal education during Naxal violence.
7. **Public Trust Building-** Earns citizen trust **through respectful conduct.**
8. **Career Sustainability-** Eg. **E. Sreedharan's** positive attitude over 50 years built Konkan Railway and Delhi Metro into infrastructure landmarks.
9. **Constitutional Morality Embodiment-** Eg. **Ashok Khemka's** positive attitude toward rule of law sustained 57 punitive transfers without ethical compromise.

Impact of Negative Attitude for Individuals

1. **Mental Health Deterioration:** Negative attitude is closely linked to depression, anxiety, and substance abuse disorders. **Eg. WHO** reports India accounts for 36% of global suicides driven significantly by sustained negative emotional patterns.
2. **Physical Health Decline:** Negative attitude is correlated with hypertension, cardiovascular disease, and weakened immune systems.
3. **Damaged Relationships:** Negative attitude **erodes trust, empathy, and emotional intimacy** in family and social bonds.
4. **Career Stagnation:** Negative attitude limits learning, collaboration, and adaptability essential for professional growth.
5. **Reduced Decision Quality:** Negative attitude narrows cognitive flexibility and breeds pessimistic biases distorting judgment.

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6. **Social Isolation:** Negative attitude pushes people away creating loneliness and withdrawal from social engagement.
7. **Loss of Resilience:** Negative attitude makes setbacks feel permanent producing despair instead of learning. **Eg. Student suicide deaths in Kota**
8. **Reduced Creativity and Innovation:** Negative attitude blocks open thinking, experimentation, and creative problem-solving capacity.
9. **Spiritual Emptiness:** Rising materialism combined with negative attitudes produces what **Viktor Frankl called the existential vacuum of meaninglessness.**

Impact of Negative Attitude Among Civil Servants

1. **Public Service Burnout:** Negative attitude produces cynicism, exhaustion, and disengagement among officers themselves over careers.
2. **Erosion of Public Trust:** Negative attitude makes officers appear dismissive, arrogant, and disconnected from citizen concerns.
3. **Bureaucratic Apathy and Indifference: Eg.** Aadhaar exclusions causing starvation deaths reflect institutional apathy producing tragic human consequences.
4. **Resistance to Reform:** Negative attitude breeds **status-quo mentality** blocking innovative and citizen-centric administrative reforms. **Eg. Bureaucratic resistance to e-governance**
5. **Demoralisation of Juniors:** Negative attitude in seniors crushes junior officers' enthusiasm and creates toxic work cultures.
6. **Corruption Tolerance:** Negative attitude toward integrity creates institutional environments where corruption becomes normalised.
7. **Discrimination Against Marginalised:** Negative attitudes manifest as caste, gender, and class bias in welfare delivery and policing.
8. **Risk Aversion and Decision Paralysis:** Negative attitude breeds defensive file-noting without bold decisions in public interest.

Bureaucratic vs Democratic attitude

Aspect	Bureaucratic Attitude	Democratic Attitude
Approach to Power	Command-and-control; authority-driven	Participative; power seen as responsibility and trust
Decision-Making	Hierarchical, rigid, process-focused	Consultative, flexible, people-centric
Communication Style	One-way instructions; formal and distant	Two-way communication; open and responsive
View of Citizens	Subjects to be governed and regulated	Partners in governance; stakeholders in decision-making
Rule Interpretation	Literal and mechanical application of rules	Spirit-based, humane interpretation of rules
Accountability Focus	More toward superiors or institutional procedures	More toward people, constitution, and public interest

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Aspect	Bureaucratic Attitude	Democratic Attitude
Ethical Orientation	Procedural compliance often prioritized over outcomes	Emphasis on justice, empathy, inclusiveness, and equity
Example	Denying widow pension due to lack of one document	Helping the widow complete formalities and get the pension on time

Attitude Change

Attitude change involves transforming the valence (positive/negative) of an attitude, as seen in shifting political preferences or opinions on issues like atomic weapons.

1. **Persuasion Approach (Yale Model)**
   a. **Carl Hovland's model** focuses on:
   b. **Source** (credibility of communicator),
   c. **Message** (clarity, logic, emotional appeal),
   d. **Audience** (receptiveness).
   e. **Eg.** A respected IAS officer delivering talks on integrity influences aspirants positively.
2. **Cognitive Dissonance Theory (Leon Festinger)**
   a. When people face **conflict between beliefs and behavior**, they feel discomfort (dissonance) and change their attitude to resolve it.
   b. **Eg.** A bureaucrat who values honesty but takes bribes may change attitude or behavior to reduce dissonance.
3. **Learning Theories (Classical & Operant Conditioning)**
   a. Attitudes can be shaped by **association (classical)** or **rewards/punishments (operant)**.
   b. **Eg.** Citizens develop a positive attitude towards e-governance after repeatedly experiencing faster service.
4. **Social Learning Theory (Albert Bandura)**
   a. Attitudes change by **observing and imitating role models**, especially when outcomes are rewarding.
   b. **Eg.** Subordinates adopt people-friendly attitudes by observing empathetic senior officers.
5. **Elaboration Likelihood Model (Petty & Cacioppo)**
   a. Attitude change happens via:
   b. **Central route**: deep thinking (long-lasting).
   c. **Peripheral route**: superficial cues like speaker's appearance (short-lived).
   d. **Eg.** Detailed policy debates (central route) vs flashy slogans (peripheral route).

Measures to Build Positive Attitude

1. **Self-Awareness Through Introspection:** Regular self-reflection helps identify and challenge negative thought patterns proactively. **Eg. Gandhi's daily diary practice**
2. **Cognitive Reframing:** Conscious reframing of challenges as opportunities transforms negative attitudes into positive ones.
3. **Surrounding Oneself With Positive Influences: Eg. Vivekananda's** character transformed completely under Ramakrishna Paramhansa's spiritually positive mentorship influence.
4. **Practising Gratitude: Eg. Research by Robert Emmons** shows **daily gratitude journaling** significantly improves mental wellbeing and life satisfaction.
5. **Learning From Failure: Eg. APJ Abdul Kalam's positive attitude** toward the failed SLV-3 launch in 1979 built the foundation for India's later space successes.

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6. **Service to Others:** Engaging with the less fortunate develops compassion, gratitude, and positive purpose simultaneously.
7. **Meditation and Mindfulness:** Regular meditation builds emotional regulation, equanimity, and positive mental states scientifically.
8. **Reading Inspirational Literature:** Studying lives of great personalities builds positive moral imagination and ethical aspiration.
9. **Setting Meaningful Goals:** Clear purposeful goals provide motivation and positive direction sustaining attitude through challenges.
10. **Physical Exercise and Healthy Lifestyle:** Regular exercise releases endorphins and builds biological foundation for positive emotional states.
11. **Ethical Education and Training:** Structured ethics training in institutions builds positive attitudes through deliberate skill development. **Eg.** LBSNAA's foundational training builds positive constitutional attitudes through case studies and field experience.
12. **Role Model Identification:** Choosing positive role models provides concrete templates for emulating positive attitudes and behaviour.

Persuasion

Persuasion is the deliberate process of changing or reinforcing another person's attitudes, beliefs, or behaviour through reasoned communication, emotional appeal, and ethical influence rather than through coercion, manipulation, or force.

Factors Determining Persuasion

1. **Credibility of the Communicator-** Persuasion depends on trustworthiness and expertise of the persuader. Eg. E. Sreedharan's engineering credibility
2. **Quality of the Message-** Clear, evidence-based, and logically structured messages persuade more effectively.
3. **Emotional Appeal-** Eg. Mahatma Gandhi's emotional appeal during Dandi March 1930 persuaded millions to join civil disobedience nationwide.
4. **Audience Characteristics-** Education, age, culture, and prior beliefs shape receptivity. Eg. Polio campaign messages were customised in different languages and cultural idioms.
5. **Channel of Communication-** Choice of medium whether speech, print, digital, or face-to-face affects persuasion impact. Eg. PM Modi's Mann Ki Baat radio programme.
6. **Repetition and Consistency** build attitude change over time. Eg. Swachh Bharat Mission's consistent messaging over five years persuaded behavioural change in toilet usage.
7. **Social Proof-** Eg. Vaccination uptake during COVID-19 surged after public figures and celebrities were seen taking jabs publicly on television.
8. **Authority and Expertise-** Eg. Dr. Soumya Swaminathan's WHO position lent authority persuading Indian states to adopt evidence-based COVID protocols.
9. **Timing and Context-** Same message succeeds or fails depending on political and social moment.
10. **Cultural Resonance-** Eg. Beti Bachao Beti Padhao campaign in Haryana used local cultural icons persuading communities to celebrate daughters.
11. **Personal Relationship-** Eg. ASHA workers' persuasion on institutional deliveries succeeds because of their long-term village-level relationships with women.

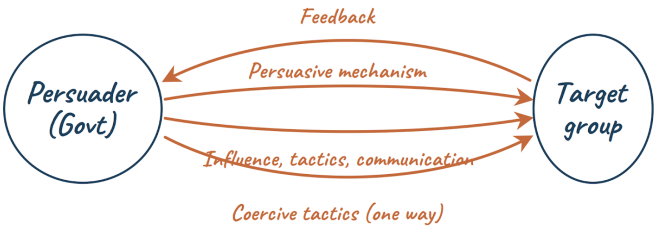
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Methods of Persuasion

1. **Appeal to Reason (Logos)**: This approach uses **logical reasoning**, **evidence**, and **rational arguments** to persuade, relying on **facts**, **statistics**, **expert opinions**, and **logical deductions**
2. **Appeal to Emotion (Pathos)**: Emotional appeals are often effective through storytelling, personal anecdotes, or powerful narratives.
3. **Appeal to Authority (Ethos)**: Citing credible experts or authorities.. Eg. Quoting **M.S. Dhoni**, a respected cricketer, to promote the importance of discipline and teamwork in sports.
4. **Social Proof**: Testimonials, reviews, endorsements, or case studies serve as social proof to sway opinions. **Eg. peaceful protests as a means to support or oppose public policy**
5. **Scarcity**: create **urgency** and **fear of missing out**, prompting immediate action. **Eg.** A limited-time offer for a product or service.
6. **Contrast and Framing**: using comparisons make information seem more **favorable**.

Significance of Persuasion in Public Administration

1. **Voluntary Compliance with Laws-** Eg. Beti Bachao Beti Padhao campaign reducing female foeticide in Haryana and rajasthan
2. **Policy Implementation Success-** Eg. **Polio Pulse campaign's success** in eliminating polio.
3. **Behavioural Change Programmes-** Modern governance challenges behavioural persuasion not just legal enforcement. Eg. responsible digital conduct
4. **Conflict Resolution-** Persuasion resolves disputes between communities, departments, and stakeholders peacefully without litigation.
5. **Crisis Management-** Eg. PM's appeals during COVID-19 lockdown persuaded 130 crore citizens to accept unprecedented restrictions on mobility.



6. **Welfare Scheme Uptake-** Persuasion ensures eligible beneficiaries actually apply for and use welfare entitlements designed for them. Eg. **Renouncing LPG subsidy under the PAHAL**
7. **Centre-State Coordination-** Eg. GST implementation in 2017 required persuading all states to sacrifice fiscal autonomy.
8. **International Diplomacy-** Persuasion is the core skill of foreign policy and international negotiations.
9. **Bureaucratic Reforms-** Persuasion enables internal reforms by winning officer support for change rather than imposing it.
10. **Reducing Coercion Costs-** Persuasion-based governance is far cheaper than enforcement-based governance over time.
11. **Building Democratic Legitimacy-** Persuasion-based governance enhances regime legitimacy by treating citizens as partners not subjects.
12. **Sustaining Long-Term Reforms-** Reforms achieved through persuasion endure longer than those imposed through coercion.

Major Challenges in Persuasion in Public Administration

1. **Misinformation and Fake News-** Eg. COVID-19 vaccine hesitancy in 2021 was fuelled by WhatsApp misinformation spreading faster than government persuasion efforts.
2. **Trust Deficit Toward Government-** corruption and inefficiency erode citizen trust in government communication.
3. **Cultural and Linguistic Diversity** make uniform persuasion campaigns extraordinarily difficult.

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4. **Digital Divide-** Persuasion campaigns relying on digital platforms exclude rural and elderly populations from communication reach.
5. **Echo Chambers and Filter Bubbles-** Algorithm-driven social media confines users to information silos blocking exposure to government messages.
6. **Politicisation of Government Messaging-** Eg. Demonetisation messaging was criticised as politically motivated reducing persuasive impact among opposition supporters.
7. **Bureaucratic Communication Failure-** Government officials often communicate in jargon-filled language that fails to persuade ordinary citizens.
8. **Resource Constraints-** Eg. ASHA workers driving persuasion in villages remain underpaid limiting their motivation and reach.
9. **Resistance to Behavioural Change-** Deeply rooted cultural practices and habits resist short-term persuasion campaigns.
10. **Skepticism of Educated Citizens-** Educated and informed citizens are harder to persuade through emotional appeals or authority claims. Eg. low urban middle-class voter turnout
11. **Opposition and Vested Interests-** Eg. Farm Laws 2020 faced organised opposition that successfully countered government persuasion efforts forcing repeal in 2021.

Ethical Dimensions of Persuasion

1. **Persuasion vs Manipulation-** Ethical persuasion respects audience autonomy while manipulation bypasses rational judgment.
2. **Truth and Transparency-** Ethical persuasion requires honest communication without concealment or distortion of facts. Eg. transparent communication during COVID-19
3. **Respect for Autonomy-** Persuasion must respect citizens' right to make informed decisions freely without coercion.
4. **Avoiding Fear-Based Manipulation-** Excessive fear appeals manipulate emotions overriding rational deliberation.
5. **Cultural Sensitivity-** Ethical persuasion respects diverse cultural contexts rather than imposing dominant norms.
6. **Protecting Vulnerable Groups-** Special ethical care needed when persuading children, elderly, or psychologically vulnerable populations.

Way Forward

1. **Evidence-Based Persuasion Design-** Government persuasion campaigns must be designed using behavioural science research and rigorous evaluation.
2. **Local Language and Cultural Adaptation-** Persuasion campaigns must speak in citizens' own language and cultural idioms.
3. **Strengthening Frontline Persuaders-** ASHA workers, Anganwadi workers, and teachers must be trained and adequately resourced as persuasion agents.
4. **Combating Misinformation-** The government must build rapid response systems to counter misinformation with verified facts and trusted messengers. Eg. PIB Fact Check Unit
5. **Ethical Standards for Government Communication-** Eg. UK Government Communication Service Code of Conduct provides ethical framework
6. **Building Government Communication Capacity-** Civil servants must receive structured training in persuasion skills as part of mandatory capacity building.
7. **Citizen Champions and Influencers-** Eg. Sachin Tendulkar and Amitabh Bachchan as polio campaign ambassadors
8. **Behavioural Nudges Over Coercion-** Use behavioural nudges and choice architecture rather than coercive enforcement wherever possible. Eg. Organ donation registration nudges

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TARES Test

- The TARES test serves as a framework for making and defending ethical decisions in persuasion.
- Developed by **Baker and Martinson** in 2001, it focuses on five key principles of ethical persuasion.
- TARES stands for **Truthfulness** (of the message), **Authenticity** (of the persuader), **Respect** (for the persuader), **Equity** (of the persuasive appeal), and **Social responsibility** (for the common good).

Examples of Persuasion

- **Disclosure of income**: Encouraging honest taxpayers by honoring and rewarding them to prevent tax evasion.
- **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao/Selfie with Daughter**: Aimed at changing societal attitudes towards girls.
- **#GiveItUp Campaign**: Persuading citizens to voluntarily give up government subsidies and benefits.
- **Marking environmental days**: Symbolic observances like Earth Hour, Earth Day, Forest Day, and Wildlife Day to raise public awareness and gather support for environmental causes.

Persuasion vs Manipulation

Aspect	Persuasion	Manipulation
Intent	Ethical, aims to benefit both parties; promotes informed choice.	Self-serving, often deceptive; aims to exploit or control the other party.
Transparency	Open and honest about goals, methods, and consequences.	Conceals true intentions or misleads the audience.
Means Used	Relies on logic, facts, empathy, and emotional appeal in ethical boundaries.	Uses flattery, fear, misinformation, or emotional exploitation.
Respect for Autonomy	Respects the individual's right to choose freely.	Undermines free will; decisions are often coerced or manipulated emotionally.
Ethical Standing	Aligns with values like integrity, empathy, and public good.	Violates ethical values; driven by personal or organizational gain.
Example (Governance)	Encouraging sanitation through emotional appeals and role models (Swachh Bharat).	Spreading exaggerated fear to gain votes or public compliance without evidence.

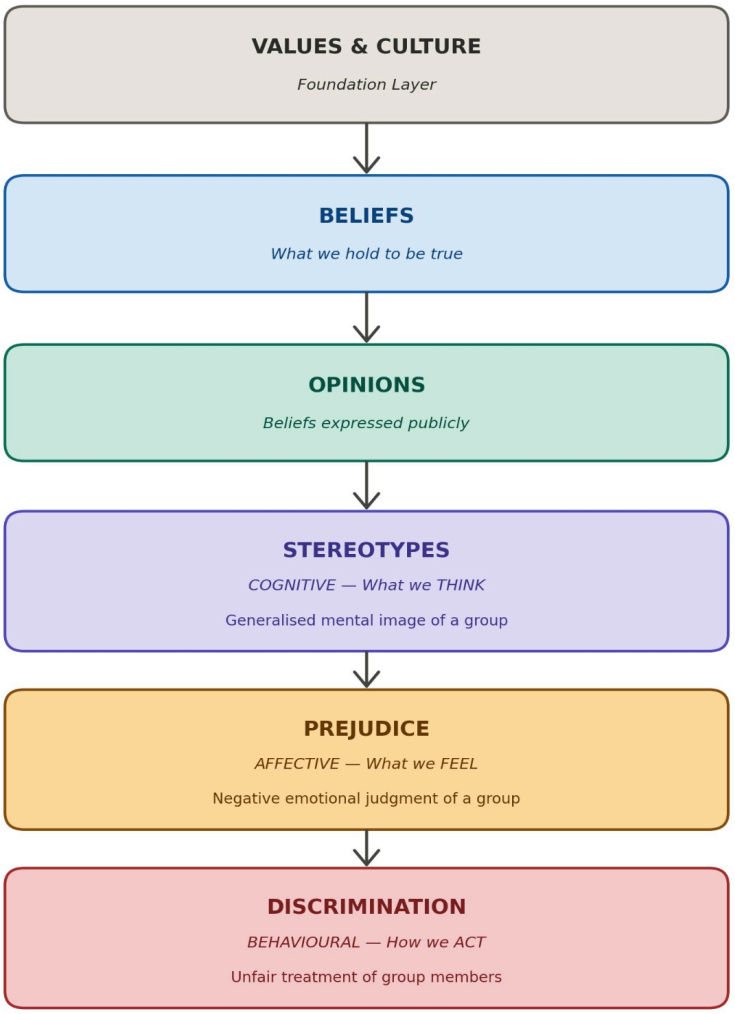
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Prejudice and Stereotype

Prejudice refers to a pre-formed negative judgment or attitude toward a person or group based on their perceived membership in a category rather than on actual knowledge or evidence.

Stereotype refers to an oversimplified, generalised mental image or belief about an entire group of people, attributing certain characteristics uniformly to all members regardless of individual variation.

Linkage Between Values, Beliefs, Opinions, Stereotypes, Prejudice and Discrimination



The Cognitive — Affective — Behavioural Triangle of Intergroup Bias

Factors Leading to Formation of Prejudice and Stereotype

1. **Family Socialisation-** Eg. Children growing up hearing anti-Dalit slurs at home internalise caste prejudice.
2. **Educational Curriculum-** Eg. Northeast Indians stereotyped or invisibilised in mainstream school curricula.
3. **Media Representation-** Eg. Bollywood's persistent portrayal of South Indians with exaggerated accents and Muslims as villains reinforces stereotypes nationally.
4. **Historical Conflicts-** Eg. 1947 Partition trauma continues to fuel Hindu-Muslim prejudice in border regions of Punjab, Bengal, and Rajasthan.
5. **In-Group Bias Psychology-** Humans naturally favour their own group and view outsiders with suspicion.
6. **Scapegoating During Economic Stress-** Anti-immigrant prejudice rises during recessions globally. Eg. attacks on Bihari migrants in Maharashtra
7. **Limited Intergroup Contact** breeds prejudice through ignorance. Eg. rigid caste segregation in rural India
8. **Political Mobilisation-** Politicians exploit identity divisions for electoral gains deepening prejudice. Eg. Communal speeches before elections
9. **Social Media Echo Chambers-** Algorithm-driven platforms amplify prejudiced content creating closed information loops.
10. **Cultural Imperialism-** Eg. Western media's persistent stereotyping of Africa as a poverty-stricken continent.
11. **Confirmation Bias-** People seek information confirming existing prejudices and ignore contradicting evidence.

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Impact of Prejudice and Stereotype

1. **Communal Violence and Conflict** destroys lives and social fabric.
2. **Caste Discrimination and Atrocities - Eg. Hatras rape**
3. **Gender Discrimination-** patriarchy confine women to traditional roles and justify violence. Eg. Sarpan pati Syndrome
4. **Workplace Discrimination-** Prejudice produces unfair hiring, promotion, and pay practices against minorities.
5. **Mental Health Damage-** Constant exposure to prejudice causes anxiety, depression, and trauma among victims. Eg. Rohith Vemula Death
6. **Economic Costs-** Eg. Campaign to boycott of Muslim shops by right wing groups
7. **Political Polarisation-** Prejudice fragments democratic societies into hostile camps unable to deliberate constructively. Eg. Polarisation around CAA-NRC in 2019-20
8. **Justice System Bias-** Police and judiciary affected by prejudice produce unequal justice for marginalised communities.
9. **Internalisation of Inferiority-** Long-term prejudice exposure makes victims internalise negative self-image.
10. **Migration and Displacement-** Severe prejudice produces forced migration breaking community networks. Eg. 1990 exodus of Kashmiri Pandits
11. **Hate Crimes and Lynching-** Eg. 2017 Junaid Khan lynching in Haryana and Mohammad Akhlaq lynching in Dadri 2015
12. **Erosion of Constitutional Values-** Prejudice fundamentally contradicts constitutional values of equality, fraternity, and justice.

Way Forward

1. **Intergroup Contact Theory -** Increased meaningful contact between groups under equal conditions reduces prejudice systematically.
2. **Educational Reform-** School curricula must teach constitutional values, diversity appreciation, and critical thinking from primary level.
3. **Media Responsibility and Regulation-** News and entertainment media must follow editorial guidelines preventing stereotypical representation of communities.
4. **Anti-Discrimination Legislation-** Comprehensive anti-discrimination law covering caste, religion, gender, region, and orientation must be enacted.
5. **Diversity in Workplaces-** Public and private organisations must actively pursue diversity in hiring across caste, gender, and religion.
6. **Police and Judicial Sensitisation-** Mandatory training programmes must address unconscious bias in law enforcement and judiciary.
7. **Digital Platform Accountability-** Social media platforms must invest in content moderation preventing hate speech and prejudice amplification.
8. **Counter-Stereotype Communication** through positive role models. Eg. Beti Bachao Beti Padhao campaign celebrating women achievers in various fields nationally.
9. **Inclusive Public Spaces-** Urban planning must create shared public spaces where diverse communities interact naturally.
10. **Celebration of Diversity Through Festivals and Arts-** Eg. Republic Day parade showcasing different states' cultures, Sufi music festivals

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Chapter 4

Emotional Intelligence

PYQs

[2023] What really matters for success, character, happiness and lifelong achievements is a definite set of emotional skills - your EQ - not just purely cognitive abilities that are measured by conventional IQ tests." Do you agree with this view ? Give reasons in support of your answer. (10)

[2021] In case of a crisis of conscience, does emotional intelligence help to overcome the same without compromising the ethical or moral stand that you are likely to follow? Critically examine. (10)

[2020] What are the main components of emotional intelligence (EI)? Can they be learned? Discuss. (10)

[2019] "Emotional Intelligence is the ability to make your emotions work for you instead of against you". Do you agree with this view? Discuss. (10)

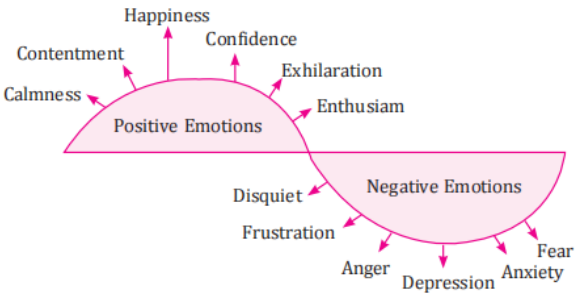
Emotions

Emotions are complex psychological and physiological states that arise in response to a stimulus, involving subjective feelings, bodily changes, cognitive interpretation, and behavioural expression.

Components of Emotions:

1. **Cognitive Component (Thoughts)** - Involves how we **perceive and interpret** a situation. It is our **mental assessment** of an event that leads to an emotional response.
2. **Physiological Component** - Emotions trigger **autonomic nervous system** responses like heart rate, sweating, or blushing. **Eg.** Your heart pounds when you're afraid or excited.
3. **Behavioral Component (Expressions and Actions)** - Includes **facial expressions**, **body language**, and **tone of voice**. Often **unconscious** or instinctive. **Eg.** Smiling when happy

Classification of Emotions



1. **Primary and Secondary Emotions**:
   a. **Primary Emotions**: These are the **initial** and **direct emotional responses** to a situation, such as **fear**, **anger**, or **joy**.
   b. **Secondary Emotions**: These develop in response to **primary emotions** and are often **more complex**, such as feeling **guilt** after experiencing anger.
2. **Positive and Negative Emotions**:
   a. **Positive Emotions**: Emotions that are **pleasant** and **enjoyable**, allowing us to be more **open** to new possibilities. **Eg. Love**, **joy**, **happiness**.
   b. **Negative Emotions**: Emotions that are generally **unpleasant** and can cause **distress** or discomfort. **Eg. Sadness**, **anger**, **distress**.

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3. **6 basic emotions by Paul Ekman:**
    a. **Happiness**: Characterized by smiling, raised cheeks, and crow's feet around the eyes.
    b. **Sadness**: Marked by a frown, downward mouth corners, and drooping eyes.
    c. **Anger**: Displayed through furrowed brows, wide-open eyes, and a tightened mouth.
    d. **Fear**: Identified by widened eyes, raised eyebrows, and an open mouth.
    e. **Surprise**: Signified by raised eyebrows, wide-open eyes, and a dropped jaw.
    f. **Disgust**: Shown by a wrinkled nose, raised upper lip, and narrowed eyes.

Functions of Emotions

Function	Description	Example
Adaptive	Helps with survival responses	Fear leads to escape from danger
Motivational	Drives goal-directed behavior	Joy motivates repetition of an action
Cognitive	Influences thought processes and judgment	Anxiety sharpens focus
Social/Communicative	Facilitates interaction and understanding among individuals	Smiling invites friendliness
Regulatory	Helps maintain emotional balance	Laughter eases stress
Moral/Ethical	Promotes adherence to ethical standards and values	Guilt after cheating encourages honesty

Emotional Intelligence

Emotional Intelligence (EQ) is the ability to identify, understand, manage, and use one's own emotions and the emotions of others effectively in personal, professional, and social interactions.

Coined by Salovey and Mayer in 1990 and popularised by Daniel Goleman in 1995, it complements cognitive intelligence (IQ) in determining real-world success.

Important Quotes

1. "It is very important to understand that emotional intelligence is not the opposite of intelligence. It is not the triumph of heart over head - it is the unique intersection of both." - **David Caruso**
2. "Anyone can become angry - that is easy. But to be angry with the right person, to the right degree, at the right time, for the right purpose, and in the right way - that is not easy." - **Aristotle**
3. "In a high IQ job pool, soft skills like discipline, drive, and empathy mark those who emerge as outstanding." - **Daniel Goleman**

Components of Emotional Intelligence (Goleman's Five-Component Model)

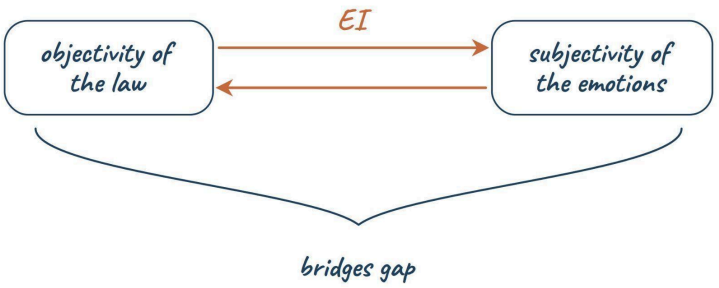
1. **Self-Awareness-** Ability to recognise one's own emotions, strengths, weaknesses, and triggers. Eg. Gandhi's daily diary at Sabarmati Ashram demonstrated deep self-awareness through systematic reflection on his moral failures.
2. **Self-Regulation-** Capacity to control disruptive emotions and adapt to changing circumstances. Eg. Lal Bahadur Shastri's self-regulation during 1965 Indo-Pak war maintained composure despite enormous national pressure.

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3. **Motivation-** Inner drive to pursue goals with energy, persistence, and optimism beyond external rewards. Eg. APJ Abdul Kalam's motivation took him from selling newspapers in Rameswaram to becoming Missile Man and President.
4. **Empathy-** Ability to understand and share emotional experiences of others authentically. Eg. Mother Teresa's empathy enabled her to feel the suffering of Kolkata's dying poor.
5. **Social Skills-** Capacity to manage relationships, build networks, and influence others positively. Eg. Sardar Patel's social skills persuaded 565 princely states to join India

Significance of Emotional Intelligence for Personal and Professional Growth of civil servants

1. **Self-awareness**
   a. **Recognising emotions** before they control behaviour helps manage anger and frustration
   b. **Understanding emotional triggers** helps in better preparation. Eg. Awareness of anxiety before public speaking.
   c. **Realistic self-assessment** helps in knowing one's strengths and weaknesses.



2. **Self-regulation**
   a. **Impulse control** - Prevents emotional outbursts and rash decisions. Eg. Not shouting at subordinates during stress.
   b. **Ensures emotional balance** - Eg. Calm leadership during disasters.
   c. **Builds adaptability** to changing situations. Eg. Accepting e-governance by civil servants
3. **Motivation**
   a. **Positive drive** helps turn frustration into determination. Eg. Officers working overtime during elections to ensure fairness.
   b. **Optimism** despite setbacks. Eg. ISRO successfully launching Chandrayan 3 after failure of Chandrayan 2
   c. **Adaptability to Change-** EQ allows individuals to navigate uncertainty without emotional breakdown.
4. **Empathy**
   a. Understanding others' feelings and viewpoints helps developing **broader outlook and leadership**
   b. **Conflict Resolution-** EQ helps de-escalate conflicts by addressing underlying emotions, not just surface issues.
5. **Social skills**
   a. **Effective communication** by expressing emotions constructively. Eg. PM addressing the nation during a pandemic.
   b. **Relationship building** - Eg. **Operation Sadbhavana** of Army in J&K for trust and cooperation with locals
   c. **Effective Leadership-** EQ enables leaders to inspire teams through vision, empathy, and emotional connection.

> **Google's Project Aristotle 2015** found **psychological safety** driven by EQ as top predictor of team performance.

Challenges/limitations of EQ

1. **Emotional manipulation** - Eg. caste politics by leaders
2. Emotion-reading skills can enable fake empathy and dishonesty.
3. **Rationalising wrongdoing.** Eg. justifying corruption as "systemic necessity."
4. **Emotional burnout** due to constant **emotional regulation**
5. **High empathy may lead** to compromise on objectivity and firmness

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6. **Conflict avoidance** instead of **necessary confrontation.**
7. **Emotional intelligence without moral compass** becomes a tool of self interest

Ways to Inculcate Emotional Intelligence (EI)

1. **Self-Awareness Through Journaling-** builds awareness of triggers, patterns, and growth areas.
2. **Emotional Literacy:** Self-introspection and talking to friends to become aware of emotional impulses.
3. **Mindfulness and Meditation Practice-** strengthens emotional regulation through cultivated present-moment awareness. Eg. Vipassana
4. **Active Listening Skills-** Deliberate practice of full attention listening builds empathy and emotional understanding.
5. **Empathy Through Service-** Direct engagement with marginalised communities develops authentic empathy beyond academic understanding.
6. **Feedback Seeking-** Actively requesting honest feedback from trusted peers builds blind spot awareness. Eg. 360-degree feedback mechanisms in corporates
7. **Reading Literature and Biographies-** Studying lives of emotionally intelligent leaders builds moral imagination and emotional vocabulary.
8. **Cognitive Reframing** of challenges transforms emotional response patterns over time.
9. **Emotional Vocabulary Building-** Learning precise emotional terminology improves emotional perception and expression. Eg. Plutchik's wheel of emotions teaches 32 distinct emotions enabling individuals to articulate feelings with greater precision.
10. **Stress Management Practices-** Yoga, exercise, and breathing techniques build physiological foundation for emotional regulation.
11. **Conflict Management Training-** Structured training in non-violent communication builds emotional skills in interpersonal disputes. Eg. Marshall Rosenberg's NVC methodology

Developing EI in Children

Developing Self-Awareness

- **Emotion naming:** Teach children to **identify and label emotions**-use emotion charts, books, or games (Eg. "I feel happy because...").
- **Daily check-ins:** Encourage kids to describe how they feel at different times of the day.
- **Mirror exercises:** Help them recognize how emotions show on their faces and in others'.

Practicing Self-Regulation

- **Calm-down techniques:** Introduce **breathing exercises**, counting to ten, or using a "calm corner" with sensory toys.
- **Role-play scenarios:** Practice how to respond to anger, disappointment, or excitement.
- **Model self-control:** Adults should demonstrate how to stay calm under stress or when upset.

Building Empathy

- **Storytelling with feelings:** Discuss characters' emotions in books or cartoons-"How do you think she felt?"
- **Empathy games:** Use activities that prompt kids to think about others' perspectives (Eg. "What would you do if your friend lost their toy?").
- **Encourage helping behavior:** Promote kindness through acts like sharing, helping classmates, or community activities.

Improving Social Skills

- **Turn-taking and sharing:** Use group games to teach cooperation and communication.
- **Teach respectful communication:** Reinforce saying "please," "thank you," and making eye contact.

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- **Conflict resolution practice:** Guide children to talk about problems and find win-win solutions.

Encouraging Emotional Expression

- **Creative outlets:** Let children draw, paint, or write about their feelings.
- **Emotion puppets or toys:** Use them to act out different emotional scenarios.
- **Safe expression space:** Validate their feelings and let them know it's okay to feel angry, sad, or scared.

School and Home Support

- **SEL (Social-Emotional Learning) programs:** Encourage schools to include structured EI curriculum.
- **Consistent routines:** Predictability helps children feel secure and emotionally regulated.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Praise children when they express or manage their emotions constructively.

Intelligence Quotient (IQ)

1. **Intelligence Quotient (IQ)** measures an individual's cognitive abilities, focusing on thinking, reasoning, problem-solving, and learning skills.
2. **Purpose:** IQ assessments provide insight into a person's **academic and cognitive performance**, indicating their capacity to comprehend information, make connections, and solve problems efficiently.

Dimension	IQ (Intelligence Quotient)	EQ (Emotional Quotient)
Definition	Cognitive ability to reason, analyse, and solve problems	Ability to identify, manage, and use emotions effectively
Origin	Measured by Alfred Binet in 1905	Coined by Salovey & Mayer 1990, popularised by Goleman 1995
Core Skills	Logic, memory, mathematical and verbal reasoning	Self-awareness, empathy, social skills, motivation, regulation
Genetic Basis	Largely inherited and relatively stable through life	Significantly learnable and can be developed at any age
Measurement	Standardised IQ tests like Wechsler and Stanford-Binet	EQ-i 2.0, MSCEIT, and Goleman's ESCI assessments
Predicts	Academic performance and technical job competence	Leadership effectiveness, relationship quality, life success
Workplace Role	Helps in technical problem-solving and analysis	Helps in teamwork, conflict management, and leadership
Trainability	Limited growth possible after adolescence	Can be developed and improved throughout adulthood
Crisis Performance	May freeze under emotional pressure	Maintains composure and makes calm decisions under stress

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Dimension	IQ (Intelligence Quotient)	EQ (Emotional Quotient)
Example	Stephen Hawking's exceptional logical reasoning capacity	Mahatma Gandhi's exceptional emotional and social leadership

Emotional intelligence vs social intelligence

Social Intelligence is the capacity to understand and navigate complex social environments, including understanding people, group dynamics, and interpersonal behavior.

Key Components:

1. **Social awareness** - Reading social cues and dynamics.
2. **Interaction skills** - Building rapport and navigating conversations.
3. **Empathy** - Understanding others' perspectives and emotions.
4. **Influence & persuasion** - Guiding others' behavior effectively.
5. **Situational appropriateness** - Knowing how to act in various social contexts.

Aspect	Emotional Intelligence (EI)	Social Intelligence (SI)
Focus	Emotions (internal and external)	Social behavior and interactions
Primary Domain	Intrapersonal + Interpersonal	Interpersonal
Core Skill	Understanding and managing emotions	Navigating social contexts and relationships
Application	Emotional regulation, empathy, personal growth	Communication, leadership, conflict management
Empathy	Emotional empathy	Both emotional and cognitive empathy
Measurement	Tools like EQ-i, MSCEIT	Less standardized; observed through social behavior

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Chapter 5

Contributions of Moral Thinkers and Philosophers from India and World

PYQs

[2020] What teachings of Buddha are most relevant today and why? Discuss. (10)

[2020] What are the main factors responsible for gender inequality in India? Discuss the contribution of Savitribai Phule in this regard. (10)

[2023] What were the major teachings of Guru Nanak? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. (10)

[2025] What are the major teachings of Mahavir? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. **(10)**

[2018] "The true rule, in determining to embrace, or reject anything, is not whether it has any evil in it; but whether it has more evil than good. There are few things wholly evil or wholly good. Almost everything, especially governmental policy, is an inseparable compound of the two; so that our best judgement of the preponderance between them is continually demanded. "Abraham Lincoln **(10)**

[2018] "Falsehood takes the place of truth when it results in unblemished common good." - Tirukkural **(10)**

[2019] "An unexamined life is not worth living". - Socrates (10)

[2020] "A system of morality which is based on relative emotional values is a mere illusion, a thoroughly vulgar conception which has nothing sound in it and nothing true." - Socrates **(10)**

[2019] "Where there is righteousness in the heart, there is beauty in the character. When there is beauty in the character, there is harmony in the home. When there is harmony in the home, there is order in the nation. When there is order in the nation, there is peace in the world" - A.P.J. Abdul Kalam **(10)**

[2022] "If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, I strongly feel there are three key societal members who can make a difference. They are the father, the mother and the teacher." - Abdul Kalam. **(10)**

[2021] Life doesn't make any sense without interdependence. We need each other, and the sooner we learn that, it is better for us all." -Erik Erikson (10)

[2022] Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have the right to do and what is right to do.'-Potter Stewart . (10)

[2023] "To awaken the people, it is the women who must be awakened. Once she is on the move, the family moves, the village moves, the nation moves." - Jawaharlal Nehru (10)

[2024] "In law, a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics, he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so." - Immanuel Kant (10)

[2024] "Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength. Faith and strength, both are essential to accomplish any great work." - Sardar Patel (10)

[2025] "Those who in trouble untroubled are, Will trouble trouble itself." - Thiruvalluvar (10)

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[2025] "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James (10)

[2018] "Anger and intolerance are the enemies of correct understanding. " _ Mahatma Gandhi (10)

[2019] "A man is but a product of his thoughts. What he thinks he becomes." - M.K. Gandhi (10)

[2020] "The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." - Mahatma Gandhi **(10)**

[2023] "The simplest acts of kindness are by far more powerful than a thousand heads bowing in prayer." - Mahatma Gandhi **(10)**

[2020] "Condemn none: if you can stretch out a helping hand, do so. If not, fold your hands, bless your brothers, and let them go their own way." - Swami Vivekanand (10)

[2021] "Every work has to pass through hundreds of difficulties before succeeding. Those that persevere will see the light, sooner or later.-Swami Vivekananda (10)

[2023] Do not hate anybody, because that hatred that comes out from you must, in the long run, come back to you. If you love, that love will come back to you, completing the circle." - Swami Vivekanand. (10)

[2024] "Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it, do not become others." - Swami Vivekananda (10)

[2025] "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." - Swami Vivekananda (10)

Western Thinkers

1. The term **Philosophy** originates from **Greek Philosophia, meaning "love of wisdom,"** a concept introduced by the **pre-Socratic thinker Pythagoras in the 6th century BC.**
2. In ancient Greece, philosophers like **Socrates and Plato engaged in deep reflections on life, knowledge, and the right way to live**. They posed fundamental questions such as, "What is the meaning of life?" and "How do we discern truth?"

Philosophy by Socrates

Socrates (469-399 BCE) was a foundational Greek philosopher who fundamentally shifted intellectual inquiry from cosmology to human morality, ethics, and character building.

He believed that virtue is grounded in rational self-examination, famously asserting that the unexamined life is a life not worth living for a rational being.

Key Quotes

1. "An unexamined life is not worth living."
2. "I know that I am intelligent, because I know that I know nothing."

Major Teachings of Socrates and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Socratic Method (Elenchus) - Learning by asking continuous questions.**
   a. Helps people **spot fake news** by teaching them to check facts before believing internet stories. Eg. AltNews fact-checking protocols.
   b. Stops **online fights** and anger by making people question their own biases before arguing. Eg. Inter-faith harmony dialogues.
2. **Virtue is Knowledge - Believing that bad actions happen because of a lack of true understanding.**

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a. Guides computer scientists to teach **good morals to robots** and artificial intelligence programs. Eg. OpenAI safety alignment boards.
b. Shows that schools should teach **good behavior and values** instead of just school grades. Eg. Delhi Schools' Happiness Curriculum.

3. **Care of the Soul (Psyche) - Making your inner goodness more important than money or fame.**
   a. Keeps workers honest and gives them the courage to **stop office corruption**. Eg. Ashok Khemka.
   b. Helps people fight the urge to **wastefully buy things** just to show off to friends. Eg. India's Mission LiFE.
4. **Intellectual Midwifery (Maieutics) - Helping others find answers on their own.**
   a. Inspires **case-study-based pedagogy** and independent decision-making capacities in civil service training programs. Eg. LBSNAA training modules.
   b. Encourages **empathetic mentoring** and participative management styles in institutional spaces. Eg. ISRO's team mentoring systems.
5. **Universal Definition of Virtues - Finding fixed definitions for fairness and bravery.**
   a. Supports **constitutional values** and rule of law against arbitrary populist shifting standards. Eg. Basic Structure Doctrine enforcement.
   b. Relevant for building **objective ethical indicators** across global governance platforms. Eg. Transparency International ranking metrics.
6. **The Political "Gadfly" - Asking tough questions to leaders in power.**
   a. Inspires bold journalists to **expose hidden secrets** and government cheating. Eg. Edward Snowden.
   b. Makes the government **answerable to regular citizens** through official information requests. Eg. RTI Act implementation.
7. **Intellectual Humility - Realizing that you do not know everything.**
   a. Makes internet spaces friendlier by teaching people to **chat respectfully online**. Eg. Wikipedia collaborative editing rules.
   b. Helps combat **epistemic arrogance** and cognitive bias among executive policymakers. Eg. NITI Aayog multi-stakeholder consultations.
8. **Supreme Moral Sacrifice - Choosing death over cheating your own rules.**
   a. Validates the actions of modern **whistleblowers** who expose major financial and ecological violations despite high personal risks. Eg. Satyendra Dubey.
   b. Challenges **opportunistic behavior** and institutional spinelessness during ethical dilemmas. Eg. Bureaucrats resisting illegal orders.
9. **Definition of Objective Truth - Saying that some things are always wrong.**
   a. Promotes **unbiased reporting** and truth-seeking mechanisms over highly sensationalized or post-truth narratives. Eg. BBC Editorial Guidelines.
   b. Supports ideals of **universal human rights** and equity that cross individual state boundaries. Eg. UN Human Rights Council.
10. **Self-Examination - Checking your own daily actions and habits.**
    a. Counters corporate **greenwashing tricks** by demanding genuine structural introspection by business houses. Eg. SEBI's mandatory BRSR audits.
    b. Encourages **sustainable living** habits through deliberate tracking of personal ecological consumption. Eg. Individual carbon footprint calculators.

In an age of deepfakes, extreme polarization, and materialism, Socrates' teachings provide timeless guidance for an ethical, rational, and inclusive world.

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Philosophy of Plato

Plato (427-347 BCE), a student of Socrates, was a monumental idealist philosopher and the founder of the Academy in Athens.

He integrated ethics, metaphysics, and politics, arguing that a truly just society can only be realized when structural governance is guided by absolute rational wisdom, transcendent moral truths, and the perfect harmony of the human soul.

Key Quotes

1. "Good people do not need laws to tell them to act responsibly, while bad people will find a way around the laws."
2. "The price good men pay for indifference to public affairs is to be ruled by evil men."

Major Teachings of Plato and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Theory of Forms - The physical world is a flawed shadow of a higher, perfect reality.**
   a. Encourages a focus on **unchanging moral truths** rather than chasing temporary material success or viral internet metrics.
   b. Serves as a standard for building **ideal ethical institutions**. Eg. Strengthening independent anti-corruption bodies.
2. **Tripartite Soul - Human mind is divided into Reason, Spirit (Honor), and Appetite (Desire).**
   a. Urges individuals to let **Reason rule Appetite**, fight unhealthy consumerism and impulsive online behavior. Eg. Controlling hyper-consumerist shopping habits.
   b. Helps leaders prioritize **duty over ego (Spirit)**, keeping administrative actions humble and focused on service.
3. **The Philosopher King - Rulers must be trained in deep wisdom and moral values.**
   a. Highlights the ongoing global need for **highly educated, ethical statesmen** to solve complex planetary problems.
   b. Argues that **intellectual depth and integrity** must be valued over charismatic speechmaking in leadership roles. Eg. Selecting technocrats for economic policy.
4. **Four Cardinal Virtues - Moral excellence relies on Wisdom, Courage, Temperance, and Justice.**
   a. Guides administrators to exercise **temperance and balanced judgment** when pressured by majoritarian demands.
   b. Inspires professionals to show **moral courage** when encountering systemic fraud inside their organizations. Eg. Corporate whistleblowers reporting scams.
5. **Allegory of the Cave - True knowledge requires breaking free from illusions into reality.**
   a. Empowers modern citizens to **see past political propaganda** and algorithmic media echo chambers.
   b. Promotes the pursuit of **objective scientific facts** over popular, unverified conspiracy theories. Eg. Global health vaccination campaigns.
6. **Justice as Functional Specialization - Doing one's designated duty without interference.**
   a. Enhances **institutional efficiency** by ensuring different parts of governance do their work without overstepping. Eg. prevents judicial overreach
   b. Fosters **deep professional expertise** and disciplined time-management across corporate and public enterprises.
7. **Abolition of Private Interest for Rulers - Guardians must avoid wealth and family bias.**
   a. Direct backing for modern laws that demand **asset disclosures and declarations** from public servants.
   b. Minimizes the risk of **nepotism and corporate capture** within the highest levels of governance. Eg. Chanda Kocher case
8. **State-Sponsored Holistic Education - Integrating physical, mental, and moral growth.**

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   a. Shapes modern education policies to blend **technical training with ethical values** and mental wellness.
   b. Prevents the development of a **morally indifferent elite** who only focus on financial profitability.
9. **Gender Equality in Leadership - Women possess the same basic capacities to rule as men.**
   a. Validates modern global movements pushing for **gender parity in governance** and corporate boardrooms. Eg. Women reservation in Parliaments.
   b. Challenges lingering **patriarchal biases and glass ceilings** across various professional fields. Eg. Female fighters in combat roles.
10. **Myth of Er - Moral choices have permanent, long-lasting consequences.**
   a. Backs the framework of **intergenerational equity**, reminding generations to preserve the planet for the future. Eg. Strict carbon reduction timelines.
   b. Builds a sense of **deep personal accountability**, knowing that today's actions shape tomorrow's societal health. Eg. Sustainable corporate governance models.

Aristotle

Aristotle (384-322 BCE), student of Plato, was a practical philosopher who founded virtue ethics. He argued that morality is not an abstract theory but a lifelong habit aimed at achieving human flourishing (Eudaimonia) through balanced actions.

Key Quotes

1. "We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act, but a habit."
2. "Happiness is the meaning and the purpose of life, the whole aim and end of human existence."

Major Teachings of Aristotle and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **The Golden Mean - Virtue is the middle ground between deficiency and excess.**
   a. Provides a blueprint for **balanced administration**, helping officials avoid inaction or harsh execution. Eg. Police standard operating procedures.
   b. Guides individuals toward **emotional self-regulation**, avoiding cowardice and foolish recklessness. Eg. Satyendra Dubey exposing corruption.
2. **Eudaimonia (Human Flourishing) - Living actively with moral virtue.**
   a. Inspires governance to shift metrics from pure economic wealth toward **holistic well-being indicators**. Eg. Bhutan's Gross National Happiness.
   b. Reminds professionals to seek **purpose and character development** over endless corporate burnout.
3. **Habitual Cultivation (Hexis) - Moral virtues develop through consistent practice.**
   a. Encourages schools to focus on **building civic habits** through hands-on community service. Eg. Compulsory NSS camp volunteering.
   b. Underpins training methods that turn **integrity and ethical standards** into automatic behaviors. Eg. CVC online integrity pledges.
4. **Phronesis (Practical Wisdom) - Applying moral rules flexibly based on context.**
   a. Equips judges and law enforcement to use **fair discretionary power** in complex cases. Eg. SC using Article 142 for issuing Vishaka guidelines
   b. Enables public servants to **resolve ethical dilemmas** when rigid regulations clash with urgent needs.
5. **Distributive Justice - Allocating resources based on merit and contribution.**
   a. Serves as a template for designing **fair performance evaluation systems** in workplaces. Eg. SPARROW appraisal for bureaucracy.
   b. Ensures that **true talent and social contributions** are rewarded over nepotism.
6. **Civic Friendship (Philia) - Goodwill bonds between citizens hold a state together.**
   a. Acts as a social antidote to **communal hatred and digital polarization** by rebuilding trust. Eg. Post-conflict local Mohalla Committees.

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   b. Promotes the growth of **social security networks** to ensure no group feels abandoned. Eg. Kudumbashree community relief networks.
7. **The Citizen as an Active Participant - Taking part in governance and justice.**
   a. Drives the shift toward **participatory democracy**, letting residents voice thoughts on public spending. Eg. MGNREGA social audits.
   b. Encourages a culture of **proactive civic duty**. Eg. ECI's SVEEP literacy campaign.

Stoicism

Stoicism, a Hellenistic philosophy founded in Athens by **Zeno of Citium** (circa 300 BCE), emphasizes rationality, self-discipline, and living in harmony with nature. It teaches individuals to focus on what they can control and accept what they cannot, fostering resilience and tranquility.

Core Tenets of Stoicism

1. **Living in Accordance with Nature**
   a. Stoics believe the universe operates according to a rational and natural order (logos). Living virtuously means aligning one's actions with this order.
   b. **Quote**: "Follow nature." - Epictetus
2. **Dichotomy of Control**
   a. Central to Stoic thought is distinguishing between what we can control (our actions, thoughts, and attitudes) and what we cannot (external events, others' opinions, outcomes).
   b. **Eg.** If criticized unfairly, focus on your response rather than the criticism itself.
   c. **Quote**: "You have power over your mind - not outside events. Realize this, and you will find strength." - Marcus Aurelius
3. **Virtue as the Highest Good**
   a. Virtue (arete) is the only true good and comprises four cardinal virtues:
   b. **Wisdom** (phronesis): Making sound judgments.
   c. **Courage** (andreia): Facing challenges with bravery.
   d. **Justice** (dikaiosyne): Treating others fairly.
   e. **Temperance** (sophrosyne): Exercising self-control.
   f. Material wealth, pleasure, or status are "indifferents"-neither inherently good nor bad.
4. **Amor Fati (Love of Fate)**
   a. Stoics advocate accepting events as they occur, recognizing them as part of the natural order.
   b. **Quote**: "A blazing fire makes flame and brightness out of everything thrown into it." - Marcus Aurelius
5. **Practicing Self-Discipline**
   a. Stoicism emphasizes controlling desires, emotions, and impulses.
   b. **Eg.** Avoiding anger when faced with provocation reflects self-mastery.
6. **Focus on the Present Moment**
   a. Stoics encourage mindfulness, emphasizing that we only have control over the present.
7. **Universal Brotherhood**
   a. Stoics view all people as part of a single community, sharing rationality and interconnectedness.
   b. **Quote**: "I am a citizen of the world." - Diogenes, echoed in Stoic thought.

Practices in Stoicism

1. **Daily Reflection**
   a. Reflect on your thoughts and actions to align with Stoic principles.
   b. **Eg.** Marcus Aurelius kept a journal, later published as Meditations.

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2. **Negative Visualization** (Premeditatio Malorum)
   a. Anticipate potential challenges or losses to prepare for adversity.
   b. **Eg.** Envisioning life without a luxury or relationship fosters gratitude and resilience.
3. **Voluntary Discomfort**
   a. Embrace discomfort to strengthen discipline and appreciate what you have.
   b. **Eg.** Practicing fasting or enduring the cold without complaint.
4. **Practicing Gratitude**
   a. Focus on appreciating what you have rather than lamenting what you lack.
   b. **Eg.** Acknowledge the small joys in daily life.
5. **Detachment from External Outcomes**
   a. Perform duties without attachment to results.
   b. **Eg.** Focus on doing your best in an exam, regardless of the outcome.

Philosophy of Immanuel Kant

Immanuel Kant (1724-1804) was a German philosopher whose works in **ethics, epistemology,** and **metaphysics** are foundational to modern Western philosophy.

His ethical theories are detailed in influential texts like **Groundwork of the Metaphysics of Morals**, **Critique of Practical Reason**, and **Metaphysics of Morals**.

Kant is known for his **deontological ethics**, which emphasize **duty** and the **inherent morality of actions** over their consequences.

Core Tenets of Kant's Philosophy

1. **Epistemology: The Critique of Pure Reason**

1. Kant sought to reconcile empiricism (knowledge through experience) and rationalism (knowledge through reason). He proposed that:
   a. **Knowledge arises from the interaction between sensory experience (a posteriori) and innate concepts (a priori).**
   b. The human mind structures experiences through categories like causality, time, and space.
2. We do not see things as they are but as they appear to us, shaped by the mind's framework.

2. **The Categorical Imperative (Moral Philosophy)**

1. Kant's ethical system is based on the principle of duty, not consequences. He formulated the **Categorical Imperative**, a universal moral law derived from reason.
   a. **First Formulation**: Act only according to the maxim that you can will to become a universal law. **Eg.** Lying is unethical because if everyone lied, trust would collapse.
   b. **Second Formulation**: Treat humanity, whether in yourself or others, as an end in itself, not as a means to an end.
   c. **Third Formulation**: Act as though your actions contribute to a universal kingdom of ends, where rational beings are both law-makers and followers.
2. "Two things fill the mind with ever-increasing admiration and awe: the starry heavens above me and the moral law within me."

3. **Autonomy and Free Will**

1. Kant emphasized the **autonomy of the will**, arguing that moral actions must stem from an individual's rational choices, free from external influences.
2. Autonomy underpins his belief that humans are morally responsible for their actions.

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4. **Deontological Ethics**

1. Kant's ethics are deontological (duty-based), contrasting with consequentialist theories like utilitarianism.
2. Moral worth lies in performing one's duty out of respect for the moral law, not for personal gain or emotional inclinations.
3. **Eg.** Donating to charity is morally praiseworthy only if done from a sense of duty, not for recognition.

5. **Perpetual Peace (Political Philosophy)**

1. Kant proposed principles for global peace in his essay Perpetual Peace: A Philosophical Sketch:
   a. Establishing republican constitutions.
   b. Promoting international cooperation through federations.
   c. Respecting universal human rights.

Relevance of Kant's Philosophy Today

1. **Ethics in Public Administration**
   a. Kant's emphasis on duty aligns with the principles of accountability and integrity in governance.
   b. **Eg.** Decisions made by civil servants should prioritize ethical duty over personal gain.
2. **Human Rights and Dignity**
   a. Kant's principle of treating individuals as ends underpins modern human rights frameworks.
   b. **Eg.** The Universal Declaration of Human Rights reflects Kantian ideals of respect for individual dignity.
3. **Rule-Based Ethical Frameworks**
   a. Deontological ethics guide professions like law, medicine, and military service, ensuring actions are governed by rules rather than outcomes.
4. **Environmental Ethics**
   a. Kant's idea of a universal kingdom of ends inspires ethical considerations for sustainability and respect for future generations.
5. **Moral Responsibility in AI**
   a. Kant's focus on autonomy and rationality informs discussions on the ethical programming of artificial intelligence.

John Rawls' Philosophy and its Modern Relevance

John Rawls (1921-2002) was a preeminent American political philosopher who revitalized modern liberalism and social contract theory. In his seminal work A Theory of Justice, he propounded the framework of "justice as fairness," providing an objective, rational methodology to design an egalitarian, inclusive, and structurally fair social order.

Key Quotes

1. "The principles of justice are chosen behind a veil of ignorance."
2. "Each person possesses an inviolability founded on justice that even the welfare of society as a whole cannot override."

Major Teachings of John Rawls and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Veil of Ignorance - Designing rules unaware of one's own identity, class, or talents.**
   a. Ensures **impartiality in public policies**, blocking lawmakers from favoring their own socio-economic class. Eg. Drafting gender-neutral labor laws.
   b. Promotes **fairness in algorithm designs**, eliminating built-in race or gender biases in technology. Eg. Testing facial recognition AI on diverse data.

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2. **The Equal Liberty Principle - Guaranteeing maximum basic liberties compatible for all.**
    a. Safeguards **fundamental democratic rights** against arbitrary surveillance or state overreach. Eg. Protecting right to privacy under Article 21.
    b. Secures **freedom of expression**, preventing majoritarian groups from silencing minority dissent. Eg. Safeguarding peaceful public demonstrations.
3. **The Difference Principle - Socio-economic inequalities must maximize benefit to the least advantaged.**
    a. Justifies **progressive welfare schemes**. Eg. Free food grains via PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana.
    b. Provides philosophical backing for **affirmative action policies**, correcting historical structural gaps. Eg. Socio-economic reservation policies in public employment.
4. **Fair Equality of Opportunity - Public offices and positions must be open to everyone equally.**
    a. Demands **merit-based level playing fields**, neutralizing structural family or class privileges in job markets.
    b. Guides states to **bridge the digital divide**, ensuring rural students can access competitive career pathways. Eg. Free internet and tablet distribution
5. **Lexical Priority of Justice - Basic liberties can never be traded off for economic gains.**
    a. Restricts states from **sacrificing tribal human rights** under the pretext of corporate industrial development. Eg. Supreme Court halting mining in Niyamgiri hills.
    b. Validates **labor safety standards**, preventing corporations from trading worker health for profit margins.
6. **Reflective Equilibrium - Balancing general moral principles with specific situational judgments.**
    a. Assists judicial bodies to **refine constitutional interpretations** dynamically over time. Eg. Recognizing LGBTQ+ rights via Navtej Johar case judgment.
    b. Helps public administrators **tweak active welfare rules** based on direct field challenges. Eg. Allowing physical verification when biometric systems fail.
7. **Overlapping Consensus - Agreeing on core moral justice principles despite diverse religious views.**
    a. Provides a baseline for **harmonious secular governance** within multicultural and multi-faith populations.
    b. Facilitates **bipartisan political cooperation**, enabling bitter rivals to pass critical welfare legislations. Eg. Consensus passing of the GST Act.
8. **The Inviolability of the Individual - Rejecting utilitarian sacrifice of a person for societal good.**
    a. Solidifies **bioethical healthcare protocols**, blocking clinical drug trials on poor populations without consent. Eg. ICMR clinical trial guidelines.
    b. Condemns **punitive state demolition drives** executed without following proper legal processes.
9. **Just Distribution of Common Assets - Viewing natural talents as collective social assets.**
    a. Encourages wealthy individuals to **divert private resources** back into funding public institutions. Eg. Corporate Social Responsibility mandates
    b. Promotes **global vaccine equity**, forcing developed countries to share medical tech with poor nations. Eg. COVAX global vaccine distribution initiative.

Confucius

Confucius, a prominent Chinese philosopher from the 5th century BCE, deeply influenced Chinese society and beyond with his teachings on **morality, ethics, governance**, and **social relationships**.

Key Concepts and Modern Applications

1. **Ren (Humaneness or Benevolence)**: **Ren** signifies **compassion** and **empathy**. **Eg. Baba Amte** exemplifies **humaneness** and **benevolence** through his **selfless work** with **leprosy patients**.

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2. **Yi (Righteousness or Justice)**: Yi is the **moral drive to do good**, emphasizing **integrity and justice** over personal gain. **Eg. Durga Shakti Nagpal** combating **illegal sand mining**
3. **Li (Ritual Propriety)**: **Li** involves adhering to **traditional rituals** and **social norms** to foster **respect** and **harmony**, with Confucius viewing **etiquette** in daily life as essential for maintaining **order** and **mutual respect**.
4. **Zhi (Wisdom)**: Confucian **wisdom** extends beyond intellectual knowledge, focusing on understanding people and situations to act morally. Eg. **Buddha's insights** on **suffering** embody **Zhi**, highlighting **wisdom** and **compassionate understanding**.
5. **Xin (Trustworthiness)**: Xin represents **honesty and reliability**, where one's actions align with their words and maintain **social trust**. **Eg. iPhone's brand reliability** shows **Xin**, as users trust its **quality and performance**.
6. **Filial Piety (Xiao)**: Xiao embodies **loyalty, respect, and care** for family, which Confucius saw as the root of all **moral values**. It fosters a sense of **duty and respect**.
7. **Harmony in Society**
   a. Confucius emphasized social harmony through hierarchical relationships, where everyone fulfills their role responsibly.
   b. The "Five Relationships" structure social interactions:
   c. Ruler and Subject
   d. Parent and Child
   e. Husband and Wife
   f. Elder and Younger Sibling
   g. Friend and Friend
8. **Empathy and Mutual Respect**: Confucius's version of the **Golden Rule**, "Do not impose on others what you yourself do not desire," underscores **empathy and mutual respect** in relationships.
9. **Humility and Openness to Learning**: Confucius believed in **lifelong learning** and encouraged openness to learning from all, regardless of their status.

Nelson Mandela

Nelson Mandela (1918-2013) was a monumental anti-apartheid revolutionary, statesman, and philanthropist who served as the first democratically elected President of South Afric

He transformed global political ethics by championing reconciliation over revenge, human rights, and racial equality.

Key Quotes

1. "The greatest glory in living lies not in never falling, but in rising every time we fall."
2. "For to be free is not merely to cast off one's chains, but to live in a way that respects and enhances the freedom of others."

Major Teachings of Nelson Mandela and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Reconciliation Over Revenge - Forgiving historic oppressors to construct a unified nation.**
   a. Provides a blueprint for **healing deeply fractured societies** after long periods of civil conflict.
   b. Counters **vengeful majoritarian policies**, ensuring minority groups are actively included in state-building.
2. **Ubuntu Philosophy - The African ethical belief that "I am because we are."**
   a. Discourages **narrow hyper-individualism**, nudging communities to pool collective resources for the common good. Eg. Grassroots community kitchen initiatives during economic lockdowns.
   b. Shapes international relations to focus on **global human solidarity** rather than aggressive border isolationism. Eg. India's vaccine maitri

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3. **Sacrifice and Moral Fortitude - Enduring personal hardship for systemic justice.**
    a. Inspires modern leaders to **stand firm on core constitutional values** despite intense political pressures. Eg. Ashok Khemka
    b. Motivates human rights defenders to **persist through lengthy legal struggles** against autocratic regimes.
4. **Education as an Equalizer - The ultimate weapon used to alter and elevate the world.**
    a. Directs states to invest in **equitable public schooling infrastructures**, neutralizing generational poverty loops. Eg. India's Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan
    b. Promotes **comprehensive skill-building over rote learning**, unlocking socio-economic upward mobility for marginalized youth.
5. **Dignity of the Oppressed - Recognizing the inherent human worth of every individual.**
    a. Mandates **humane legal and prison administration practices**, protecting incarcerated individuals from cruel, arbitrary abuse.
    b. Drives the formulation of **inclusive public space designs**, safeguarding the mobility rights of physically challenged citizens.
6. **Humility in Power - Resigning willingly to secure democratic transitions.**
7. **Moral Leadership in Crises - Addressing taboo social emergencies with total honesty.** He Publicly disclosed his son's HIV/AIDS status to break societal silence.

Martin Luther King Jr.

Martin Luther King Jr. advocated **non-violence, equality, justice, and human dignity** against racial discrimination and social injustice.

Contemporary Relevance of Teachings of Martin Luther King Jr

1. **Non-Violence** - Peaceful resistance against injustice and oppression.
    a. Relevant amid rising **terrorism, hate crimes, and communal violence** globally.
    b. Inspires peaceful democratic protests and civil rights movements. Eg. Black Lives Matter movement
2. **Equality and Civil Rights** - Equal dignity irrespective of race, caste, or religion.
    a. Supports struggles against **racism, caste discrimination, and xenophobia**.
    b. Reinforces constitutional values of justice and equality worldwide.
3. **Social Justice** - Elimination of systemic discrimination and exclusion.
    a. Relevant in addressing inequalities in education, healthcare, and employment.
    b. Encourages inclusive governance and welfare-oriented public policies.
4. **Compassion and Brotherhood** - Humanity should transcend racial and social divisions.
    a. Promotes harmony in multicultural and diverse societies.
    b. Counters growing intolerance and identity-based politics globally.
5. **Moral Courage** - Standing for truth and justice despite threats and hardships.
    a. Encourages ethical leadership and responsible citizenship.
    b. Relevant for whistleblowers, activists, and human rights defenders.

In an era of inequality, intolerance, and social conflict, Martin Luther King Jr.'s teachings remain timeless guides for justice, peace, and human dignity.

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Buddhist Philosophy

Gautama Buddha's ancient teachings offer a highly practical, rational psychological manual to navigate modern global crises, ethical dilemmas, and mental health challenges.

Major teachings of Buddha and their relevance in the contemporary world

1. **Four Noble Truths** - Understanding suffering and its causes.
   a. Encourages self-reflection and emotional resilience in modern life challenges.
   b. Relevant in addressing rising mental health disorders and social dissatisfaction.
2. **Middle Path - Balanced life avoiding extreme luxury and severe austerity.**
   a. Helps reduce **consumerism, stress, and burnout** in modern competitive societies. Eg. Corporate mindfulness programmes
   b. Encourages sustainable and disciplined lifestyles amid rising materialism and mental pressure. Eg. India's Mission LiFE
3. **Ahimsa (Non-violence)** - Non-injury in thought, word, and action.
   a. Promotes peace amid **war, terrorism, and communal violence**. Eg. Russia-Ukraine conflict
   b. Inspired global non-violent movements and peace-building initiatives. Eg. Gandhian freedom struggle
4. **Karuna (Compassion)** - Empathy and concern for suffering humanity.
   a. Encourages humanitarian support during disasters, pandemics, and refugee crises. Eg. India's Vaccine Maitri initiative
   b. Strengthens inclusive welfare and social justice policies in democratic governance.
5. **Eightfold Path** - Ethical conduct, right livelihood, and disciplined behaviour.
   a. Promotes **ethical governance, integrity, and responsible citizenship**.
   b. Helps combat corruption, greed, and unethical professional practices.
6. **Equality and Anti-Caste Outlook** - Rejection of caste hierarchy and discrimination.
   a. Supports social equality and dignity for marginalised communities. Eg. Dalit empowerment movements
   b. Strengthens constitutional ideals of **justice, equality, and fraternity**.
7. **Rational Inquiry** - Encouraged questioning over blind faith and superstition.
   a. Promotes scientific temper and evidence-based thinking in modern societies.
   b. Helps combat **fake news, superstition, and misinformation** in digital age.
8. **Universal Brotherhood** - Respect and harmony among all human beings.
   a. Promotes tolerance and peaceful coexistence in multicultural societies.
   b. Supports ideals of **global peace and Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**.
9. **Anicca (Impermanence) - Understanding that all earthly conditions, joy, and sorrow are in a state of constant change.**
   a. Builds internal psychological resilience during rapid global transitions and economic disruptions.
   b. Discourages arrogance of power and material hoarding, fostering humility in public life.

In an age of rapid technological, economic, and climate change, his message of **ethical self-transformation and harmony with all life forms** offers a timeless path for building a peaceful and sustainable world.

Lord Mahavira

Lord Mahavira (24th Tirthankara of Jainism) propounded an ethical and spiritual path based on **right faith, right knowledge, and right conduct (Triratna)** for the liberation of the soul.

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Mahavira

1. **Ahimsa -** Non-injury in thought, word, and deed towards all living beings.
   a. Promotes peace in a world affected by **war, terrorism, and social unrest**. Eg. Russia-Ukraine War
   b. Most powerful alternative to the **"Might is Right" doctrine** - inspire non-violent civil rights movements and peace-building initiatives globally. Eg. LGBTQ movement
2. **Satya (Truthfulness) - Speaking the truth in a way that does not harm others.**
   a. Ensures **integrity** in public and private life.
   b. Helps in **combating misinformation and corruption**
   c. Promoting the verifiable truth in digital and political discourse - antidote to the "Deepfake" and "Fake News"
3. **Asteya (Non-stealing) - Not taking anything that is not willingly given.**
   a. Promotes **Ethical economy, responsible production and consumption. Eg. avoiding greenwashing**
   b. Reduces crimes and theft
4. **Aparigraha (Non-possession) - Renunciation of excessive accumulation and greed.**
   a. **Remedy for consumerism and climate crisis. Encourages sustainable lifestyles and minimalism.**
5. **Brahmacharya (Self-control) - Discipline of mind and body for spiritual progress.**
   a. Self discipline and simple living **enhances mental well-being.**
   b. Can help reduce **suicide and anxiety** issues among youth
6. **Anekantavada - Acceptance of multiple perspectives of truth.**
   a. Helps in **managing ideological conflicts** in multicultural societies. Eg. Manipur violence
   b. Promotes **tolerance, ideals of sarv dharma samabhav and vaisudhaiva kutumbkam**
7. **Equality of all life forms - Every living being possesses a soul and deserves respect.**
   a. Compassion for all life supports ecological balance. Eg. Vegetarianism and vegan movements.
   b. **Promotes active citizenship** - Encourages ethical decision-making in democracy and governance.

In an age of rapid technological and economic change, his message of **ethical self-transformation and harmony with all life forms** offers a timeless path for building a peaceful and sustainable world.

Guru Nanak

Guru Nanak propounded a spiritual and ethical path based on **devotion, equality, truthful living, and selfless service**.

Major Teachings of Guru Nanak and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Ek Onkar -** Belief in one universal God beyond religious divisions.
   a. Promotes **religious harmony and communal peace** in multicultural societies.
   b. Counters religious extremism and intolerance globally.
2. **Naam Japna -** Constant remembrance and devotion towards God.
   a. Encourages **inner peace and mental well-being** amidst stressful modern lifestyles.
   b. Promotes spiritual discipline and emotional stability among individuals.
3. **Kirat Karo -** Earn livelihood through honest and hard work.
   a. Strengthens **work ethics, integrity, and professional honesty**.
   b. Relevant against corruption, exploitation, and unethical business practices.
4. **Vand Chhako -** Share wealth and resources with the needy.
   a. Encourages **social justice and welfare-oriented society**.

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   b. Inspires community kitchens and humanitarian service. Eg. **Langar tradition**
5. **Equality of Humanity** - Rejected caste discrimination and social hierarchy.
   a. Supports constitutional ideals of **equality and human dignity**.
   b. Relevant against casteism, racism, and gender discrimination today.
6. **Seva (Selfless Service)** - Service to humanity without expectation of reward.
   a. Encourages volunteerism during disasters and humanitarian crises. Eg. Sikh community COVID relief work
   b. Strengthens compassion and community participation in democracy.
7. **Rejection of Ritualism** - Opposed blind faith and meaningless religious rituals.
   a. Promotes **rational thinking and ethical spirituality**.
   b. Helps combat superstition and religious exploitation.
8. **Gender Equality** - Advocated dignity and equal respect for women.
   a. Relevant for women empowerment and gender justice movements.
   b. Challenges patriarchal practices and social exclusion.
9. **Universal Brotherhood** - Emphasised unity and fraternity among all humans.
   a. Promotes peaceful coexistence in conflict-ridden societies.
   b. Supports ideals of **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** and global cooperation.
10. **Simple Living and Humility** - Advocated modest and disciplined lifestyle.
    a. Counters excessive consumerism and materialistic culture.
    b. Encourages sustainable living and ethical consumption patterns.

In an age of conflict, inequality, and materialism, Guru Nanak's teachings provide timeless guidance for ethical, peaceful, and inclusive societies.

Essence of Ramayana and Mahabharata

The Ramayana

The Ramayana, composed by Sage Valmiki, is an ancient Indian epic that outlines the concept of Maryada (righteous boundaries) and Dharma (duty). It serves as a moral guide for individual character building, familial harmony, and ideal governance (Ramrajya)

Major Teachings and Contemporary Relevance

1. **Maryada (Righteous Boundaries):** Emphasizes living within moral, legal, and social boundaries to prevent personal and institutional downfall. Eg. Public servants strictly adhering to the Central Civil Services (Conduct) Rules.
2. **Raj Dharma (Duty towards citizens):** Prioritizing collective welfare and filial responsibility over personal comfort and desires.
3. **Ramrajya (Ideal Governance):** Establishing a welfare state centered entirely on the happiness, voice, and well-being of the common citizen.
4. **Tyaga (Sacrifice for Collective Good):** Giving up personal ambition, wealth, or positions to maintain social stability and harmony.
5. **Sharanagata Vatsalata (Protection of Refugees):** Providing unconditional protection and shelter to vulnerable seekers, irrespective of their origin. Eg. India harboring Tibetan refugees or treating global displaced groups with dignity.

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The Mahabharata

It explores the intricate dynamics of Pravritti (action) and Nivritti (detachment), demonstrating that strategic action must always serve the preservation of structural justice (Dharma) over greed, ego, and nepotism.

Key Quotes

1. "Yato Dharmastato Jayah." (Where there is Dharma, there is victory.)
2. "Karmanye Vadhikaraste Ma Phaleshu Kadachana." (Your right is to action alone, never to its fruits.)

Major Teachings and Contemporary Relevance

1. **The Just War (Dharma Yudh):** Fighting structurally against institutional injustice, corruption, and systemic oppression as a last resort. Eg. India's Op. Sindoor
2. **Consequences of Nepotism (Dhritarashtra Syndrome):** Demonstrating how absolute emotional blindness toward one's family or group destroys governance systems.
3. **Stree Dharma (Protection of Dignity):** Warning that a society or institution faces absolute collapse if it tolerates the humiliation of women.
4. **Anashakti Karma (Detached Action):** Doing one's professional duty with complete focus on execution rather than worrying about career rewards.
5. **Strategic Diplomacy and Pragmatism:** Seeking all possible peaceful, diplomatic channels before invoking punitive measures or legal penalties.

Kautilya

Kautilya (also known as Chanakya or Vishnugupta, c. 350-275 BCE) was a master strategist, prime minister to Chandragupta Maurya, and professor at Taxila University.

In his pathbreaking political treatise, the Arthashastra, he pioneered structural statecraft, public administration, and political realism, shifting governance from abstract theological morality to pragmatic, goal-oriented state welfare.

Key Quotes

1. "In the happiness of his subjects lies his happiness; in their welfare his welfare."
2. "Just as it is impossible not to taste honey that finds itself on the tongue, so it is impossible for a government servant not to eat at least a bit of the king's revenue."

Major Teachings and Contemporary Relevance

1. **Yogakshema (State Welfare):** Mandates that the primary duty of governance is ensuring citizen welfare, physical protection, and human security.
2. **Saptanga Theory (Seven Organs of the State):** Highlights that state stability relies on the harmonious, organic health of its key institutional pillars.
3. **Chanakya Neeti on Corruption:** Pioneers strict proactive financial surveillance and audit mechanisms to capture institutional leakage of public funds.
4. **The Mandala Theory (Foreign Policy):** Dictates geopolitical calculus by asserting that a neighbor is a natural rival while a neighbor's neighbor is a natural ally. Eg. India building deeper strategic defense partnerships with Vietnam.
5. **Shadgunya (Six Foreign Policies):** Advises using highly flexible diplomatic stances, from treaties (Sandhi) to strategic dual-track policies (Dvaidhibhava), based on evolving power dynamics. Eg. Navigating strategic autonomy by balancing ties between Quad and Russia.
6. **Upayas (Four Strategic Tactics):** Instructs utilizing persuasion (Sama), material incentives (Dana), internal division (Bheda), or tactical force (Danda) to resolve public security crises. Eg. SAMADHAN Doctrine to tackle Naxalism

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7. **Rajrishi (The Enlightened Ruler):** Insists that administrators must undergo rigorous training to control base temptations like greed, bias, and anger. Eg. Mandatory ethical code training at LBSNAA
8. **Asakti (Strict Administrative Surveillance):** Employs multi-layered intelligence and proactive whistleblower systems to safeguard internal state structures from corporate or foreign capture.
9. **Emergency Fund Management (Kosha):** Stresses maintaining deep, untouchable public reserve funds to withstand unforeseen climate, economic, or public medical emergencies. Eg. Utilizing the National Disaster Response Fund (NDRF) during intense flash floods.

Thiruvalluvar

Thiruvalluvar was a Tamil poet-saint from the Sangam era, celebrated for his profound work, **Thirukural**, also known as the "fifth Veda" or the "Bible of Tamil Nadu."

Major Teachings and Contemporary Relevance

1. **Secular Moral Order (Aram):** Establishes that righteousness is an active, daily duty completely free from religious dogmas, rituals, or sectarian labels. Eg. Formulating universal, non-religious public health policies.
2. **King-Craft and Righteous Governance (Sengonmai):** Mandates that a state's legitimacy rests on accessible justice, compassionate rule, and protecting the weakest citizen.
3. **Purity of Action (Vinait-Tuitpam):** Asserts that even noble goals must never be achieved through corrupt, exploitative, or underhanded means.
4. **Economic Wealth via Fair Means (Porul):** Advocates for the active creation of wealth through honest labor, which must then directly fund social security and public welfare. Eg. Corporations strictly aligning operations with mandatory ESG compliance metrics.
5. **Universal Benevolence and Compassion (Arul):** Places empathy and active kindness toward all living beings as the foundational core of human civilization.
6. **Avoidance of Backbiting and Slander (Puraangaamai):** Warns against the systemic destruction of human trust through false speech, deceitful reporting, and character assassination.
7. **Gratitude (Seinri-Arital):** Commands never forgetting an act of kindness, treating mutual social support as a non-negotiable community bond.
8. **Dangers of Gambling and Addictions (Suau):** Highlights how loss of personal self-control and addictive vices lead to absolute family ruin and institutional corruption.

Swami Vivekananda

Swami Vivekananda (1863-1902), a renowned Hindu monk, philosopher, and religious teacher, gained international fame after his iconic 1893 address at the **Parliament of the World's Religions** in Chicago. He is celebrated for promoting **Vedanta** and **Yoga** globally and advancing **interfaith awareness**. His teachings emphasized **spirituality, unity, rationalism,** and **service to humanity**.

QUOTES BY SWAMI VIVEKANANDA:

- **"Each soul is potentially divine. The goal is to manifest this divinity within by controlling nature, external and internal."**
- **"Arise, awake, and stop not until the goal is achieved."**
- **"Take up one ideMake that one idea your life-think of it, dream of it, live on that idea."**

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- **"In a day, when you don't come across any problems-you can be sure that you are traveling in a wrong path."**
- **"The more we come out and do good to others, the more our hearts will be purified, and God will be in them."**

Key Teachings and Philosophy of Swami Vivekananda

1. **Unity of All Religions** - At the 1893 **Parliament of the World's Religions**, Vivekananda declared, "We believe not only in universal toleration but we accept all religions as true."
2. **Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)** - Vivekananda emphasized the Vedantic teaching that the self (Atman) is one with the universal reality (Brahman). The divine exists in every being, and realizing this truth leads to liberation (moksha). Inspires self-awareness, inclusivity, and respect for all forms of life.
3. **Practical Vedanta** - Vivekananda stressed that spirituality must be practical and service-oriented, not confined to rituals or asceticism. Integrates spirituality with social work and personal development.
4. **Self-Confidence and Empowerment** - Vivekananda emphasized self-reliance, courage, and faith in one's own potential. "Arise, awake, and stop not until the goal is reached."
5. **Service to Humanity as Worship** - He advocated serving humanity as a form of worship (Seva). He believed that God resides in every individual, particularly the poor and oppressed. "Daridra Narayana" - Seeing God in the poor. Inspired the establishment of the **Ramakrishna Mission**, focusing on education, healthcare, and disaster relief.
6. **Education as the Foundation of Progress**- Vivekananda believed that education should build character, instill self-confidence, and foster practical knowledge. Education must be holistic, addressing intellectual, moral, and spiritual growth. "Education is the manifestation of the perfection already in man."
7. **Universal Brotherhood** - Vivekananda envisioned a world united by the principles of love, harmony, and mutual respect. Addresses issues like racism, nationalism, and cultural conflicts by promoting universal values.
8. **Strength and Fearlessness** - Vivekananda extolled strength-physical, mental, and spiritual-as the foundation of human progress. "The brave alone can create history."
9. **Four Paths of Yoga**:
    a. **Jnana Yoga**: The path of **knowledge** for developing rationality.
    b. **Bhakti Yoga**: The path of **devotion** for those with a loving nature.
    c. **Raja Yoga**: The path of **psychic control** for those inclined toward self-discipline.
    d. **Karma Yoga**: The path of **selfless action**, promoting work without attachment.

Relevance of Swami Vivekananda's Ideas Today

1. **Revitalizing Ethical Awareness**: His Vedantic teachings on **self-discipline** and **oneness** can deepen ethical awareness and **social responsibility**.
2. **Moral Foundation for Youth**: His values provide a moral foundation for young people, encouraging them to contribute meaningfully to **national progress**.
3. **Practical Ethical Living**: His emphasis on finding **God through service** inspire **charity** and **philanthropy**. Eg. Contributions to initiatives like **PM CARES** or supporting **NGOs**.
4. **National Youth Policy**: Vivekananda's call to "**Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached**" aligns with the **National Youth Policy** of 2014, inspiring India's youth to work towards a **developed nation**.
5. **Global Peace and Unity**: His 1893 Chicago speech's emphasis on **tolerance, unity,** and **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** is essential for a world troubled by **conflict and extremism**.

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6. **Promotion of Indian Spirituality**: His teachings continue to inspire pride in India's spiritual heritage, encouraging **mutual respect** and **interfaith dialogue**.

Kabir

Sant Kabir Das, born in **Varanasi**, was a 15th-century **mystic poet, saint,** and **social reformer** who played a significant role in the **Bhakti Movement**.

Major Teachings and Contemporary Relevance

1. **Nirguna Bhakti (Formless Divine Reality):** Rejects artificial religious borders, communal labels, and institutionalized divisions by viewing the ultimate truth as universal.
2. **Rejection of Blind Ritualism (Idolatry & Orthodoxy):** Strongly criticizes empty, unscientific religious customs in favor of inner moral transformation and practical logic.
3. **Radical Social Equality:** Fiercely attacks caste hierarchies, racial stratification, and untouchability, asserting that all human beings share identical dignity.
4. **Sahaja Bhava (Spiritual Simplicity):** Teaches that ethical living and social realization do not require ascetic isolation but are found in normal, honest daily life.
5. **Dignity of Labor:** Advocated earning an honest living through trade and physical work (weaving) while rejecting exploitation and corruption.
6. **The Philosophy of Love and Compassion (Prem):** Positions radical, non-discriminatory empathy as the highest metric of intellectual wisdom and human development.
7. **Sabda (Mindful and Measured Speech):** Warns against using harsh, malicious, or divisive language that destroys social tissue and community trust.
8. **Intellectual Fearlessness and Truth-Seeking:** Urges individuals to fiercely question corrupt authority figures, fraudulent religious salesmen, and dogmatic social norms.
9. **Detachment from Materialistic Greed:** Highlights the toxic nature of endless wealth hoarding, advocating for simple living and sharing resources. Eg. Mission LiFE.
10. **Self-Introspection (Atma Nirikshan):** Commands individuals to scan and correct their own internal character flaws before judging or criticizing others.

Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Raja Ram Mohan Roy was a pioneering **social reformer** and **educationist** known for his efforts to modernize **Indian society** and challenge **orthodoxy**. He is often called the "Father of Modern India."

Key Contributions and Philosophies

1. **Vedantic Philosophy**: Sought to **liberate Hinduism** from **orthodoxy and superstition** by reviving **Vedantic philosophy**. He advocated for **knowledge, enlightenment,** and **spirituality** as essential doctrines.
2. **Humanism and Human Values**: A strong proponent of **peace, decency, compassion,** and **justice**. He championed the **rights of the poor, weak,** and **marginalized**, believing that everyone deserves a happy life.
3. **Education**: Advocated for the inclusion of **Western technical education** in traditional Indian curriculIn 1825, he founded the **Vedanta College** in Bengal and supported **David Hare** in establishing the **Hindu College**.
4. **Monotheism**: Promoted the **oneness of God** and viewed all religions as different **paths to the same truth** and salvation.

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5. **Cosmopolitanism**: Embraced a **global perspective**, viewing people of all nations as parts of one **interdependent family**. He supported **French nationalists** and broke tradition by traveling to **England**.
6. **Rationalism and Modernity**: Like **Rousseau**, Roy valued **reason** and **rationality** over tradition and superstition. Known as the **"Father of Modern India"**, he emphasized **modern education** as a tool for social change and upliftment.
7. **Reformist**: Saw **social reform** as essential for **national prosperity** and **progress**.
   a. Worked to mobilize **public support**, influence the **government**, establish **educational institutions,** and form **volunteer organizations**.
   b. Advocated for **women's rights** on issues like **widow remarriage, consent age,** and **Sati**.
   c. His efforts led to **legislative reforms** such as the **abolition of Sati** and **prohibition of polygamy**.

Through his advocacy for **education, social reform, human values,** and **modernity**, Roy laid the foundation for a **progressive Indian society** rooted in **rational thought** and **inclusive values**.

Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar was a renowned **social reformer, scholar, and educator** in 19th-century India, widely respected for his commitment to **education, humanism,** and **social change**.

Key Contributions and Philosophies

1. **Humanism and Potential**: Advocated for **ethical behavior** that respects **human dignity** and allows each person to achieve their **full potential**.
   a. Emphasized that every individual has **basic rights** and **needs** that must be met.
   b. Argued that humans should be seen as **agents of their own destiny**, not merely bound by tradition.
2. **Importance of Education**: Saw **education as essential** for personal and societal progress.
   a. Believed that **learning** broadens perspectives, instilling **dignity, independence,** and motivation for **freedom and development**.
   b. Established a **Sanskrit college** specifically for **lower castes** and the underprivileged to provide them with access to education.
3. **Reformist Mindset**: Considered **social reform** crucial for **national and societal growth**.
   a. Believed it was the duty of the **educated** to lead efforts for **progress** and uplift society.
4. **Gender Equality**: Championed **gender equality** and was a key figure in promoting **women's rights**.
   a. Advocated for **widow remarriage, girl education**, and the abolition of **polygamy** and **child marriage**.
5. **Scholar and Educator**: Known as **'Vidyasagar'** (Ocean of Learning) for his extensive knowledge.
   a. Authored significant works like **Borno Porichoy** and brought **educational reforms** as the principal of **Sanskrit College**.
   b. Played a role in establishing the **Bethune School** in 1849, the first school for girls in India, alongside **J.E.D. Bethune**.

Vidyasagar's dedication to **human dignity, education, social reform,** and **gender equality** has left a lasting legacy in India's journey toward a more **equitable** and **progressive society**.

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar (1891-1956) was a visionary **jurist, social reformer, politician,** and **economist** who is widely regarded as one of the primary architects of the **Indian Constitution**.

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Key Contributions and Philosophies

1. **Champion for the 'Last, Lost, and Least'**: Ambedkar emerged as a revolutionary leader advocating for justice for the **most oppressed sections** of society, often referred to as the "last, lost, and least."
   a. He saw himself as a **protector of Dalit rights** and aimed to ensure **social dignity** for all marginalized groups.
2. **Advocate for Social Justice and Anti-Caste Ideology**: In his seminal work, Who Were the Shudras?, Ambedkar dissected the **caste system** and highlighted how it perpetuates **social injustice**.
   a. Believed that **true democracy** in India was impossible without dismantling **caste structures**.
   b. Asserted that **upper castes** would not willingly end the caste system, as it maintained their privileged status.
3. **Economic Exploitation and Caste**: Ambedkar argued that the caste system had an **economic foundation** that facilitated exploitation, benefiting upper castes while economically suppressing lower castes.
   a. He campaigned for **labor rights, fair wages,** and **land reforms** to uplift marginalized communities.
4. **Constitutional Guarantees for the Marginalized**:
   a. Enshrined fundamental rights in the Constitution, including **Right to Equality (Articles 14-18)**, **Right to Life and Liberty (Article 21)**, and **Freedom of Speech (Article 19)**.
   b. Advocated for **adult franchise**, allowing every citizen, irrespective of caste, gender, or background, to participate in the **electoral process**.
5. **Education as a Tool of Empowerment**: Ambedkar strongly believed that **education** was a powerful tool for social transformation.
   a. Advocated for **universal access to education**, particularly for the oppressed, believing that it would bring self-respect and a means of empowerment.
   b. Founded the **Bahishkrit Hitakarini Sabha** in 1924 to promote education among the socially marginalized and established **People's Education Society** in 1945.
6. **Promotion of Women's Rights**: Ambedkar was a staunch supporter of **gender equality** and pushed for progressive reforms to improve the status of women in Indian society. Eg. Special Marriage Act
7. **Rationalism and Modernity**: Ambedkar emphasized **reason and rationality** over tradition and superstition, seeing them as tools to achieve an equitable society.
8. **Advocacy for Labor Rights**: As a labor minister in the **Viceroy's Executive Council**
   a. Advocated for **fixed working hours, fair wages, leave policies,** and **industrial safety standards**.
   b. Introduced the **Maternity Benefit Bill**, which provided critical support to working women.

Mahatma Gandhi

Mahatma Gandhi (1869-1948), revered as the "Father of the Nation" in India, was a profound moral and political leader who championed **nonviolence**, **truth**, and **social justice**.

Gandhi's Talisman

One of Gandhi's most enduring pieces of advice, known as his **Talisman**, reminds us to focus on actions that help the poorest and weakest members of society. He encouraged asking oneself whether a contemplated action would benefit those who suffer, helping dissolve the self-centered ego and leading to **selfless service**.

Major Teachings of Mahatma Gandhi and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Satyagraha (Truth-Force) - Deploying resolute moral resistance against systemic injustice.**
   a. Promotes **peaceful civil dissent** and democratic expression against exploitative laws. Eg. Farmers protesting on highways against corporate agricultural laws.
   b. Counters **authoritarian overreach** by appealing to the moral conscience of the oppressor. Eg. Mass peaceful public demonstrations against regressive environmental rollbacks.

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2. **Ahimsa (Nonviolence) - Rejecting physical, verbal, and mental harm in all aspects of life.**
   a. Encourages **peaceful conflict resolution** and bilateral de-escalation in geopolitical friction zones.
   b. Combats **communal riots and societal hatred** by defusing hostile tensions at the grassroots level.
3. **Sarvodaya (Welfare of All) - Designing developmental models centered on universal progress.**
   a. Inspires **inclusive governance frameworks** that focus directly on uplifting marginalized communities.
   b. Supports **equitable economic distribution** over elite-centric, unchecked corporate wealth accumulation. Eg. Mandatory 2% corporate CSR spending.
4. **Antyodaya (Uplifting the Last Person) - Evaluating policies by how they serve the poorest citizen.**
   a. Establishes a benchmark for **grassroots welfare schemes** and social safety nets. Eg. national food security Act
   b. Strengthens **livelihood security** for vulnerable populations facing structural poverty. Eg. MGNREGA
5. **Trusteeship Philosophy - Viewing private wealth as a trust held on behalf of the community.**
   a. Encourages **philanthropic resource diversion** from wealthy elites back into public infrastructure. Eg. Tech billionaires committing major equity to public healthcare foundations.
   b. Promotes **ethical corporate governance** and social responsibility over raw profit hunting. Eg. Tata Group trust profits directly funding public cancer research.
6. **Swadeshi (Self-Reliance) - Promoting localized production and decentralized supply chains.**
   a. Strengthens **indigenous manufacturing** and economic autonomy in competitive global markets. Eg. Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.
   b. Safeguards **local community livelihoods** from being wiped out by sudden foreign import shocks. Eg. Vishwakarma scheme
7. **Purity of Means and Ends - Asserting that noble objectives never justify corrupt methods.**
   a. Restores **judicial and institutional integrity** by mandating completely fair investigation processes.
   b. Guides administrators to **reject shortcut compromises** when navigating complex ethical dilemmas.
8. **Nai Talim (Experiential Education) - Integrating academic learning with physical labor and skills.**
   a. Shapes modern education policies to blend **technical training with vocational proficiency**. Eg. Implementing vocational internship training modules under the NEP.
   b. Eradicates **social stigmas against manual labor** from a very young age in schools.
9. **Environmental Stewardship - Advocating for a lifestyle based on minimized desires.**
   a. Counters **excessive consumerism** and rapid, destructive depletion of finite natural resources. Eg. Mission LiFE.
   b. Encourages **climate-conscious individual behavior** to reduce global ecological footprints. Eg. Utilizing public transit and individual carbon footprint tracking habits.
10. **Eradication of Untouchability - Fighting deep-seated caste discrimination and social exclusion.**
    a. Supports constitutional ideals of **human dignity and social equality** for historical minorities. Eg. Enforcement of Article 17 abolishing untouchability.
    b. Eliminates **inhumane traditional practices** by replacing them with structural rehabilitation schemes. Eg. manual scavenging.

Gandhi's Seven Sins

1. **Politics without Principles**
2. **Wealth without Work**
3. **Pleasure without Conscience**
4. **Knowledge without Character**
5. **Science without Humanity**
6. **Commerce without Morality**
7. **Religion without Sacrifice**

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Jyotirao Phule

Along with his wife, Savitribai Phule, he pioneered women's education and spear-headed the anti-caste movement in India, establishing the Satyashodhak Samaj to dismantle Brahminical hegemony and liberate marginalized Shudra and Ati-Shudra communities from systemic oppression.

Key Quotes

1. "Lack of education leads to lack of wisdom, which leads to lack of morals, which leads to lack of progress."
2. "Truth is the only religion that can bind humanity together."

Major Teachings of Jyotirao Phule and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Universal Education as Liberation - Education is the supreme tool to break shackles of generational exploitation.**
   a. Inspires **affirmative educational policies** aimed at bringing marginalized rural students into mainstream institutions. Eg. PM SHRI schools upgrade scheme.
   b. Promotes **digital and financial literacy drives** among vulnerable sections to prevent modern tech-driven exploitation. Eg. Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan.
2. **Women's Empowerment - True societal progress is impossible without educating and liberating women.**
   a. Directs states to build **safe infrastructure and financial support** for girls' higher academic pursuits. Eg. Beti Bachao Beti Padhao campaign.
   b. Challenges **entrenched corporate glass ceilings** by pushing for gender diversity across leadership boards. Eg. Mandatory women directors under Companies Act.
3. **Satyashodhak Samaj (Truth-Seekers' Society) - Dismantling priestly dominance and religious exploitation.**
   a. Promotes **rationality and scientific temper** over superstition, blind rituals, and expensive traditional ceremonies. Eg. Maharashtra's Anti-Superstition and Black Magic Act.
   b. Encourages **simplified civil marriages** conducted without patriarchal rituals or high financial debt burdens. Eg. Mass community weddings under state welfare schemes.
4. **Critique of Structural Casteism - Exposing and destroying the artificial hierarchies of the caste system.**
   a. Strengthens **punitive legal frameworks** that penalize physical atrocities and social exclusion of historical minorities. Eg. Strict enforcement of SC/ST Atrocities Act.
   b. Counters **subconscious workplace discrimination** by standardizing objective, non-partisan interview and appraisal protocols.
5. **Empowerment of Peasantry (Shetkaryacha Asud) - Protecting agrarian workers from crippling debt traps.**
   a. Guides governments to provide **direct financial buffers** and minimum income insulation against crop market crashes. Eg. Income support via PM-KISAN Yojana.
   b. Backs the creation of **affordable institutional credit lines** to rescue farmers from exploitative informal moneylenders. Eg. KCC interest subvention schemes.
6. **Radical Humanism - Human dignity and equality must supersede any written scriptural authority.**
   a. Validates modern **human rights jurisprudence** that overrides discriminatory, outdated local customary traditions. Eg. Sabrimala verdict
   b. Supports **dignity of life for sanitation workers**. Eg. Deploying Bandicoot scavenging robots under NAMASTE.

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7. **Social Reform over Political Independence - Structural social equity must precede mere transfer of political power.**
   a. Reminds policymakers that **economic growth metrics are useless** without fixing deeply unequal social indicators. Eg. Tracking state success via Multidimensional Poverty Index.
   b. Focuses democratic devolution on **empowering the lowest local governance units** over hyper-centralized governance. Eg. reservation for women in Panchayati Raj.

CIVILSDAILY IAS

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A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (1931-2015) was a world-renowned aerospace scientist, the pioneer of India's missile development program, and the 11th President of India, affectionately known as the "People's President."

He bridged the worlds of cutting-edge technology and deep spiritual values, dedicating his life to youth empowerment, national self-reliance, and ethical governance to transform India into a developed nation.

Key Quotes

1. "Dreams are not those which we see while sleeping, but dreams are those which do not let us sleep."
2. "If a country is to be corruption free and become a nation of beautiful minds, I strongly feel there are three key societal members who can make a difference: the father, the mother and the teacher."

Major Teachings of A.P.J. Abdul Kalam and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Visionary Leadership (Vision 2020) - Setting ambitious, long-term national transformation targets.**
   a. Drives **strategic roadmaps** to transform developing countries into high-tech, self-reliant global manufacturing powerhouses. Eg. National targeted implementation under Make in India 2.0.
   b. Shapes **future-oriented energy security plans** aimed at building infrastructure completely free from fossil fuels. Eg. India's National Green Hydrogen Mission.
2. **PURA (Providing Urban Amenities in Rural Areas) - Bridging the developmental divide between urban and rural areas.**
   a. Replaces rural distress by **bringing high-speed connectivity and modern infrastructure** to agricultural villages. Eg. Delivering robust internet via the BharatNet rural connectivity project.
   b. Prevents distressed city migration by **establishing local agro-industries and job clusters** directly inside village groups. Eg. Setting up rural livelihood hubs under Shyama Prasad Mukherji Rurban Mission.
3. **Indigenization and Self-Reliance - Building domestic defense and space capacities to ensure sovereignty.**
   a. Boosts **sovereign security parameters** by indigenously designing high-tech protective hardware and military components. Eg. Deploying the home-grown aircraft carrier INS Vikrant.
   b. Lowers external technological dependence by **inventing domestic supercomputing frameworks and satellite fleets**. Eg. Scaling up regional satellite coverage using ISRO's NavIC network.
4. **Youth and Student Empowerment - Igniting young minds to act as the primary engine for social progress.**
   a. Restructures educational environments to **reward disruptive innovation, entrepreneurship, and hands-on tinkering**. Eg. Establishing NITI Aayog's Atal Tinkering Labs in schools.
   b. Encourages **youth-led tech startups** to solve complex regional problems rather than chasing conventional job markets. Eg. Providing soft capital loans through the Startup India initiative.
5. **Technology with a Human Face - Deploying advanced defense research to solve everyday healthcare struggles.**
   a. Adapts aerospace materials to **manufacture highly affordable, ultralight medical prosthetics** for physically challenged children. Eg. Creating low-cost Kalam-Raju carbon-composite calipers.
   b. Lowers public healthcare expenditures by **inventing mass-market cardiac devices and affordable hospital equipment**. Eg. Mass deploying the low-cost Kalam-Raju coronary stent.
6. **Ethical and Corruption-Free Governance - Developing integrity at home to construct a righteous nation.**
   a. Instills **proactive moral values in young students** by introducing mandatory value-education classes. Eg. Delhi Government's Happiness and Deshbhakti curriculums.
   b. Eradicates **bribery from administrative delivery mechanisms** using paperless, face-less digital touchpoints. Eg. Processing benefits directly using Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile (JAM) trinity.

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7. **The Scientific Temper - Approaching societal failures and technical challenges with rational thinking.**
    a. Promotes **evidence-driven policy formulation** instead of relying on populist rhetoric or unscientific traditions. Eg. ICMR coordinating nationwide healthcare initiatives via data audits.
    b. Empowers researchers to **view engineering failures as valuable stepping stones** toward ultimate project success.
8. **Value of Great Teachers - Teachers are the foundational moral architects of a child's character.**
    a. Promotes **holistic teacher training programs** that emphasize emotional mentoring alongside conventional academic subjects. Eg. Capacity building under the NISHTHA training initiative.
    b. Enhances **national recognition for grassroots teachers** who innovate teaching styles in remote tribal belts. Eg. National Awards to Teachers annually.

Adi Shankaracharya

Adi Shankaracharya (c. 788-820 CE) was a revered **Indian philosopher, theologian, and spiritual reformer**, known for consolidating the **Advaita Vedanta** philosophy, which emphasizes non-dualism and the idea that individual soul (Atman) and universal soul (Brahman) are one and the same.

Major Teachings of Adi Shankaracharya and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Advaita Vedanta (Non-dualism) - The ultimate reality is one seamless, interconnected consciousness.**
    a. Promotes **global human solidarity and empathy** by viewing all living beings as expressions of the same inner divinity.
    b. Counters **narrow tribalism, racism, and social polarization** by dismantling artificial boundaries between "self" and "other."
2. **Jnana Yoga (Path of Knowledge) - Spiritual liberation and maturity are achieved through intellectual realization.**
    a. Inspires **rigorous analytical reasoning and a scientific temper** to challenge dogmatic assertions and fake narratives.
    b. Promotes **evidence-driven decision making** in public administration rather than relying on populist emotion.
3. **Rejection of Blind Ritualism - Elevating internal moral and mental purity over empty external ceremonies.**
    a. Urges modern societies to **abandon unscientific, exploitative traditional practices** in favor of ethical humanist actions. Eg. campaigning against superstitious faith-healing practices.
4. **Samanvaya (Harmonious Synthesis) - Reconciling conflicting viewpoints to find a unified core path.**
    a. Equips diplomats to **negotiate constructive global treaties** in highly fragmented, multipolar geopolitical environments.
    b. Facilitates **bipartisan legislative cooperation** to pass crucial public welfare laws.
5. **The Concept of Maya (Cosmic Illusion) - The material world is transient and prone to misinterpretation.**
    a. Counters **unbounded consumerism and materialistic greed** by reminding individuals of the fleeting nature of physical possessions. Eg. Mission LiFE.
    b. Warns tech users against **losing touch with objective reality** inside hyper-personalized digital bubbles.
6. **Vairagya (Detachment with Purpose) - Cultivating objective dispassion to serve a higher calling.**
    a. Inspires **unbiased public service and ethical governance**, preventing officials from falling into nepotism or personal greed.
    b. Empowers professionals to **maintain integrity under intense pressure** by prioritizing organizational ethics over immediate personal career gains.

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7. **The Authority of Experiential Realization (Anubhuti) - Direct personal experience trumps mere theoretical text.**
    a. Restructures educational frameworks to **prioritize experiential, hands-on learning** over rote book memorization.
    b. Drives the move toward **evidence-based clinical practices** in modern public healthcare delivery.

Mother Teresa

Mother Teresa is remembered as a **symbol of compassion and dedication** to the poor and marginalized. She joined the **Sisters of Loreto** in 1928 and, feeling called to serve the destitute, established the **Missionaries of Charity** in CalcuttOver her lifetime, she founded **517 missions** across the globe, providing shelter, food, and care to the destitute and dying.

Key Contributions and Achievements

1. **Missionaries of Charity**: Founded in 1950, the organization's mission was to serve "the hungry, the naked, the homeless, the crippled, the blind, the lepers, all those people who feel unwanted, unloved, uncared for." Under her leadership, it grew to encompass **hospices, orphanages, and homes for the destitute** in over **100 countries**.
2. **Humanitarian Efforts**: Mother Teresa's projects included caring for the terminally ill, responding to **natural disasters**, and providing relief during famines and epidemics. Notably, she helped mediate a **ceasefire in Beirut** in 1982 to rescue 37 children trapped in a hospital amid conflict.
3. **Global Recognition**: Her selfless work earned her numerous awards, including the **Nobel Peace Prize** in 1979. Despite the accolades, she remained humble, always attributing her work to God's love and dedicating her life to those in need.
4. **Legacy of Love and Peace**: Mother Teresa's work transcended religious, cultural, and national boundaries, bringing people together in the spirit of **peace, unity, and service**.

Key Lessons from Mother Teresa's Life and Their Modern Relevance

1. **Pursue Noble Causes**: Mother Teresa's six decades of service exemplify resilience and dedication to helping the marginalized, despite significant obstacles.
    a. **Relevance Today**: Civil servants and individuals can emulate her example by engaging in community initiatives aimed at **improving the lives of marginalized groups**. This could involve volunteering in local outreach programs, tackling social issues such as homelessness, and advocating for policies that promote **social justice and equality**.
2. **Start Locally**: Her impact began in her immediate surroundings, emphasizing that meaningful change starts at the community level.
    a. **Relevance Today**: Individuals and leaders can initiate **neighborhood clean-up drives**, create community gardens to combat **food insecurity**, and volunteer in local schools. Small actions at the local level can inspire broader societal change.
3. **Maintain a Strong Foundation**: Her unwavering faith and values were a source of strength, allowing her to persevere despite doubts.
    a. **Relevance Today**: Civil servants can draw from a strong foundation of **integrity, ethics, and public service commitment**. Upholding these values fosters resilience, even when the impact of their work is not immediately visible.
4. **Radiate Love and Positivity**: Known for her warm smile and limitless love, Mother Teresa inspired others to adopt compassion and empathy.
    a. **Relevance Today**: Fostering a supportive and inclusive work environment, showing kindness to colleagues, and approaching interactions with empathy can inspire a culture of **compassion, cooperation,** and **positivity**.

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Memorable Quotes from Mother Teresa

1. "We have to bring God's love to the people by our service."
2. "There is only one God and He is the God to all. Therefore, it is important that everyone is seen as equal before God."
3. "If you can't feed a hundred people, then feed just one."

Mother Teresa's legacy of **selfless love, compassion, and dedication to the poor** serves as an enduring example of **humanitarian service** and inspires people across the globe to make a positive impact in their communities and beyond.

Ramanujacharya

Ramanujacharya (1017-1137 CE) was a philosopher, theologian, and the chief exponent of Vishishtadvaita Vedanta (Qualified Non-dualism).

He revolutionized the Bhakti movement by democratizing spiritual liberation, arguing that personal devotion (Bhakti) and total surrender (Prapatti) are open to all human beings regardless of their caste, gender, or social status.

Key Quotes

1. "All human beings are equal expressions of the divine; no one is high or low by birth."
2. "If by uttering the sacred mantra I go to hell while thousands are saved, I will gladly choose hell."

Major Teachings of Ramanujacharya and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Vishishtadvaita (Qualified Non-dualism) - The universe and individual souls are organic parts of a single divine whole.**
   a. Promotes **ecological stewardship and environmental balance** by treating nature as an interconnected, sacred extension of life.
   b. Fosters **deep societal empathy and mutual respect** among diverse human populations.
2. **Bhakti and Prapatti (Universal Surrender) - Salvation is achieved through pure devotion and complete trust, open to all.**
   a. Offers **mental resilience and psychological grounding** to combat anxiety and isolation in hyper-competitive environments.
   b. Encourages **unconditional trust and psychological safety** within high-pressure organizational frameworks.
3. **Democratization of Knowledge - Breaking elite monopolies on spiritual and intellectual truths.**
   a. Directs modern states to build **accessible, high-quality open educational resources** to empower marginalized rural students. Eg. SWAYAM portal.
   b. Drives the **democratization of critical data and technology**. Eg. Developing open-source public AI models.
4. **Radical Social Inclusivity - Rejecting birth-based discrimination and social hierarchies.**
   a. Strengthens **affirmative action policies and structural protections** for historically marginalized communities.
   b. Eradicates **subconscious biases in organizational hiring** by standardizing objective evaluation procedures.
5. **Kainkarya (Selfless Service as Worship) - Serving humanity is the highest form of devotion to the divine.**
   a. Inspires **spontaneous citizen volunteerism and humanitarian aid** during sudden climate or economic crises. Eg. Langar service
   b. Reshapes the mindset of public administrators to **view state service as a sacred moral responsibility**.

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6. **Dignity of the Marginilzed (Thirukulattar) - Uplifting down-trodden sections by giving them structural recognition.**
    a. Drives **targeted public housing and infrastructure development** in historically under-funded rural pockets. Eg. Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana.

Basavanna

Basavanna (1131-1167 CE) was a 12th-century philosopher, statesman, Kannada poet, and social reformer who served as the Prime Minister of the Kalachuri kingdom in Karnatak

He founded the Lingayat movement, fiercely rejecting the rigid caste system, Brahminical hegemony, temple-centric rituals, and gender discrimination, while introducing radical socio-economic democracy through institutions like the Anubhav Mantapa.

Key Quotes

1. "Kayakave Kailasa." (Work is Worship / Labor is Heaven.)
2. "Do not steal, do not kill, do not utter lies... This is inward purity, this is outward purity."

Major Teachings of Basavanna and their Relevance in the Contemporary World

1. **Kayaka (Dignity of Labor) - All honest, productive work is equally sacred, with no job being superior or inferior.**
    a. Eradicates **social stigmas attached to manual labor and blue-collar occupations** in modern workspaces. Eg. Granting formal recognition and social security benefits to gig workers and domestic help.
    b. Promotes **ethical corporate accountability**, ensuring fair wages and healthy working conditions for all laborers.
2. **Dasoha (Distributive Philanthropy) - Giving back excess earnings to the community rather than hoarding wealth.**
    a. Counters **extreme wealth inequality and hyper-capitalistic hoarding** by driving community-focused resource redistribution. Eg. CSR laws.
    b. Drives **grassroots community welfare and food security initiatives** to support vulnerable sections. Eg. community kitchens
3. **Anubhav Mantapa (The Academy of Experience) - The world's first democratic parliament for open socio-religious discourse.**
    a. Strengthens **participatory democracy and inclusive public policy formulation** by giving a voice to marginalized groups.
    b. Promotes **institutional diversity and multi-stakeholder representation** across decision-making boards.
4. **Rejection of Caste Hierarchy - Spiritual and social liberation must be completely independent of birth-right.**
    a. Tightens **punitive legal frameworks against caste-based discrimination** and physical atrocities.
    b. Eliminates **unconscious bias in administrative hiring and evaluations**, fostering true equality of opportunity.
5. **Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment - Women possess equal intellectual, social, and spiritual rights.**
    a. Justifies **legislative affirmative action** to increase women's representation in political governance. Eg. Reserving 33% of seats for women in parliament
    b. Protects **women's safety and professional dignity** across public and private sector workplaces. Eg. POSH Act.

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6. **Inward Purity over External Ritualism - True morality lies in character, empathy, and conduct rather than empty rituals.**
   a. Encourages **substantive ethical behavior over superficial compliance checklists** in corporate governance. Eg. avoiding Greenwashing
   b. Promotes **rational thinking and a scientific temper** over superstition and unverified social dogmas.
7. **Vachana Literature (Democratization of Language) - Expressing complex philosophical truths in simple, regional vernacular dialects.**
   a. Bridges the **educational divide by promoting mother-tongue instruction** in foundational learning.
   b. Enhances **accessibility to judicial and legal frameworks** for the common, non-elite citizen.
8. **Compassion towards All Living Beings (Daya) - Empathy is the very root of any civilized society.**
   a. Shapes **humane criminal justice and prison reform models** focused on rehabilitation over raw retribution.
   b. Drives the creation of **stringent environmental and wildlife safety laws** to check ecocide.

CIVILSDAILY IAS

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Chapter 6

Aptitude and foundational values

PYQs

[2022] Apart from intellectual competency and moral qualities, empathy and compassion are some of the other vital attributes that facilitate the civil servants to be more competent in tackling the crucial issues or taking critical decisions. Explain with suitable illustrations. (10)

[2021] Identify five ethical traits on which one can plot the performance of a civil servant. Justify their inclusion in the matrix. (10)

[2021] Identify ten essential values that are needed to be an effective public servant. Describe the ways and means to prevent non-ethical behaviour in the public servants. (10)

[2021] Should being impartial and non-partisan be considered as indispensable qualities to make a successful civil servant? Discuss with illustrations. (10)

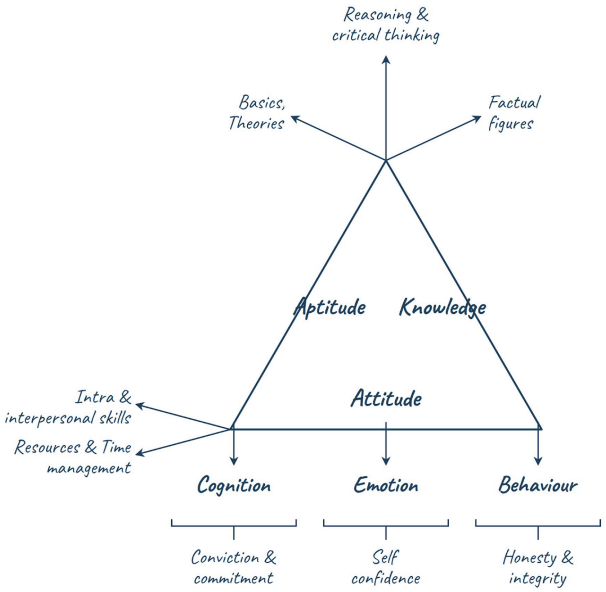
[2026] Efficiency is doing things right, while effectiveness is doing the right thing. How do you strike a balance between the two to enhance productivity? (10)

Aptitude

"Aptitude is the bridge between knowledge and accomplishment."- **John C. Maxwell**



Aptitude comes from the word '**Aptos,**' meaning **fitted for**. It is defined as a **natural or inherent capacity** to develop a certain **skill or ability** in the future.



Nature and Characteristics of Aptitude:

1. **Three components**: Includes intellectual, physical, and motivational aspects.
2. **Inborn or Acquired Potential**- Aptitude may be **inherent (genetic)** or **developed through learning and experience**.
3. **Task-Specific**- Aptitude is often **domain-specific**. Eg. numerical aptitude, verbal aptitude, mechanical aptitude, musical aptitude, etc.
4. **Predictive in Nature**- It indicates an individual's **future potential** to succeed in a particular area rather than current capability.
5. **Stable Yet Trainable**- they can be enhanced through **training, motivation, and exposure**.

Aptitude for a Civil Servant:

In the civil services context, aptitude refers to the **mental, ethical, and behavioral traits** that enable an officer to **deliver public services effectively, ethically, and empathetically**.

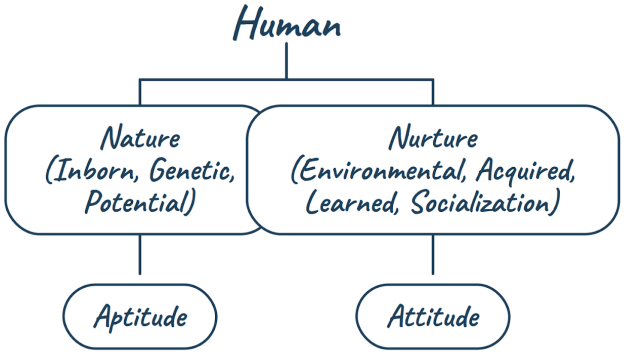
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Need For Aptitude

1. **Shift from Rule-Based to Outcome-Based Governance**
   a. Delivering measurable results under time-bound missions (Eg. Swachh Bharat, Digital India).
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Result orientation, project management skills, accountability aptitude**.
2. **Digital and Data-Driven Administration**
   a. Integrating technology in governance (e-governance, AI, big data) while maintaining data privacy and inclusivity.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Analytical aptitude, tech adaptability, ethical reasoning in digital decision-making**.
3. **Rising Citizen Expectations and Vigilance**
   a. Greater public awareness and demand for transparency, participation, and accountability.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Empathetic aptitude, communication skills, social responsiveness**.
4. **Complexity of Multilevel Governance**
   a. Coordination across central, state, and local bodies, especially in federal schemes and disaster management.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Interpersonal aptitude, leadership, conflict-resolution skills**.
5. **Polarized Socio-Political Environment**
   a. Navigating sensitive issues like caste, religion, and regionalism with neutrality.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Objectivity, constitutional aptitude, emotional balance**.
6. **Ethical Dilemmas and Pressure from Interest Groups**
   a. Balancing public good against political or corporate pressures.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Moral aptitude, integrity, courage of conviction**.
7. **Frequent Disasters and Public Health Crises**
   a. Crisis response during floods, pandemics, etc., with speed and sensitivity.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Quick decision-making, resilience, problem-solving aptitude**.
8. **Urbanization and Environmental Stress**
   a. Managing infrastructure, pollution, migration, and sustainability.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Planning aptitude, ecological sensitivity, innovation mindset**.
9. **Globalization and International Exposure**
   a. Dealing with international stakeholders, global standards, and cross-border regulations.
   b. **Aptitude Required**: **Cultural intelligence, diplomatic aptitude, global awareness**.

Key Aptitude Traits

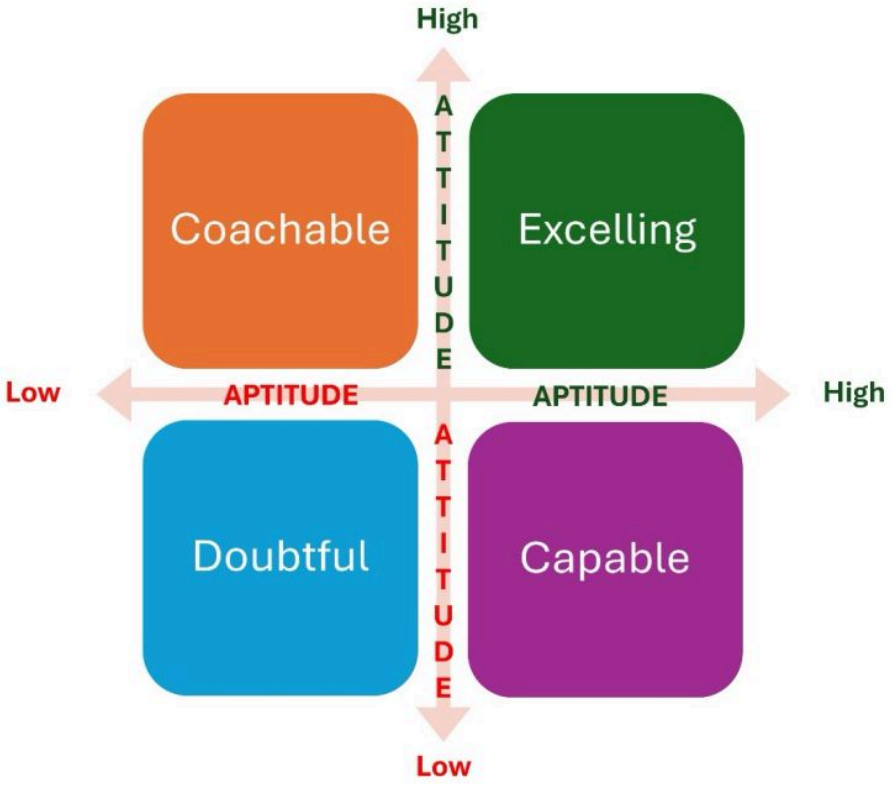
1. **Administrative Aptitude - Eg.** The successful completion of **Delhi Metro** and **Konkan Railway** projects by **Mr. E. Sreedharan**.
2. **Numerical and Analytical Aptitude -** Skills in **data interpretation, budget analysis**, and policy evaluation is important for evidence-based governance and rational decision-making.
3. **Problem-Solving Aptitude -** Capacity to handle complex, uncertain, and dynamic challenges calmly and creatively
4. **Social Aptitude / Interpersonal Skills -** Ability to **communicate, cooperate, and negotiate** with diverse stakeholders.
5. **Moral Aptitude -** Inclination to act with **honesty, fairness, and justice**, even under pressure.



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6. **Empathetic Aptitude** - Ability to **understand the pain and needs of marginalized sections** of society.
7. **Constitutional and Democratic Aptitude** - Understanding and internalization of **constitutional values** like equality, liberty, secularism, and fraternity.
8. **Leadership Aptitude** - Ability to **inspire, motivate, and guide subordinates** while ensuring accountability.

Attitude versus Aptitude



Difference Between Aptitude and Attitude

Aspect	Aptitude	Attitude
Meaning	It is the **natural or acquired ability** to perform or learn a specific task efficiently.	It is a **mental or emotional disposition** towards a person, object, or situation.
Nature	**Cognitive and ability-based**	**Emotional and evaluative**
Function	Indicates **potential for performance** in a particular area.	Reflects **mindset, approach, or outlook** towards tasks or people.
Measurement	Measured through **aptitude tests** (Eg. CSAT, IQ tests).	Measured through **psychometric or attitude surveys/questionnaires**.

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Aspect	Aptitude	Attitude
Stability	Relatively **stable**, changes slowly with training or exposure.	**More flexible** and subject to faster change based on environment and experience.
Relevance in Civil Services	Determines **suitability for specific roles** (Eg. administration, data analysis).	Influences **behavior, motivation, and ethical decision-making**.
Trainability	Can be **enhanced to a certain extent** through targeted training.	Can be **changed significantly** through awareness, reflection, and experience.
Example	Numerical aptitude, verbal aptitude, spatial aptitude.	Positive attitude towards public service, optimistic attitude in crisis.

Way forward to develop aptitude among civil servants

1. **Institutionalizing Competency-Based Training**
   a. Implementing tailored training tracks under Mission Karmayogi (National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building).
   b. Mandatory mid-career training modules on the iGOT Karmayogi digital platform.
2. **Fostering Technological Adaptability** - Using GIS mapping and predictive analytics for data-driven, evidence-based policies.
3. **Cultivating Practical Wisdom (Phronesis)** - Immersive rural attachment segments for officer trainees at LBSNAA.
4. **Strengthening Behavioral and Emotional Intelligence - Building empathy and cognitive flexibility.**
   a. Implementing dedicated **mindfulness and emotional health sessions** in academy induction courses.
   b. **Standardizing mandatory soft-skills and empathetic communication protocols**.
5. **Reforming Performance Appraisals and Merit-Based Postings**
   a. Utilizing the SPARROW (Smart Performance Appraisal Report Recording Online Window) system.
   b. Introduce specialized **lateral entry** to infuse domain-expert aptitude into complex sector portfolios.
6. **Promoting Creative Maladjustment & Encouraging systemic whistleblowing**
   a. Strengthening statutory protections under Central Civil Services Conduct Rules for formal dissent notes.
   b. Using integrated, secure whistleblowing portals linked directly to the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC).

Foundational Values of Civil Services

Foundational values are set of rules, principles, and belief that helps in discharging functions in a proper and efficient way.

Nolan Committee Values

1. **Selflessness**: Act solely in the public interest, avoiding personal gain.
2. **Integrity**: Avoid undue influence or obligations from external sources.
3. **Objectivity**: Make decisions based on merit.
4. **Accountability**: Be answerable for decisions and actions to the public.
5. **Openness**: Act and make decisions transparently.
6. **Honesty**: Be truthful in all dealings.

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7. **Leadership**: Exhibit and promote these values through personal behavior.

2nd ARC Values

1. **Integrity**: Maintain moral and ethical standards in governance.
2. **Objectivity**: Decision-making based on facts, fairness, and justice.
3. **Neutrality**: Treat all citizens and issues impartially.
4. **Accountability**: Be responsible for decisions and actions.
5. **Transparency**: Ensure openness in decision-making and execution.
6. **Empathy**: Understand and address citizens' grievances with compassion.
7. **Inclusiveness**: Promote social harmony and equal opportunity.
8. **Commitment**: Uphold public interest above personal interests.

Integrity

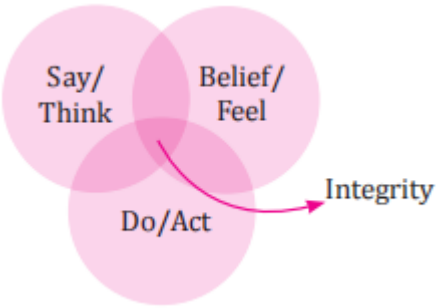
"Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching." - C.V. Raman

"Integrity is the soul of the character." - Mahatma Gandhi

"Integrity is making sure that the things you say and the things you do are in alignment"

The concept of 'integrity' is derived from the Latin word **integritas that means 'completeness,' and 'purity.'**

Integrity is the alignment of **Manasa (Thought), Vacha (Word), and Karmana (Action).** In the words of **C. S. Lewis,** "Integrity is doing the right thing even when no one is watching."



Types of Integrity:

1. **Personal Integrity - Eg.** Honoring commitments and being truthful in relationships.
2. **Professional Integrity - Eg.** A civil servant refusing to accept bribes.
3. **Moral Integrity - Eg.** Reporting corruption despite pressure to remain silent.
4. **Intellectual Integrity- Eg.** A researcher presenting data objectively without manipulation.
5. **Financial Integrity - Eg.** Proper use of public funds in government schemes.
6. **Social Integrity** - Commitment to societal values like fairness, justice, and equality.
7. **Institutional Integrity** - Maintaining the ethical and functional standards of an institution.

Examples:

1. **Mahatma Gandhi :** Led India's freedom struggle with truth, nonviolence, and moral integrity.
2. **S. R. Sankaran**: An ICS officer and **chief secretary of Tripura**, known for enforcing the **Abolition of Bonded Labour Act, 1976**.
3. **Abraham Lincoln**: He famously said, "I am not bound to win, but I am bound to be true. I am not bound to succeed, but I am bound to live by the light that I have."
4. **Satyendra Dubey (Professional Integrity):** Exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project, sacrificing his life for transparency.
5. **T.N. Seshan :** Reformed India's electoral process as CEC, ensuring free and fair elections.

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6. **E. Sreedharan (Professional and Financial Integrity):** Led Delhi Metro with transparency, accountability, and timely completion.
7. **Ashok Khemka (Professional Integrity):** Exposed corruption despite repeated transfers.
8. **Narayanan Krishnan:** A chef-turned-social worker, he dedicated his life to feeding and caring for the homeless and destitute in Madurai.

Importance of integrity

1. **Empowerment at the Personal Level**
   a. **Inner Peace**- Integrity eliminates the **"cognitive dissonance"** and provides the mental energy needed to focus on goals.
   b. Integrity ensures **predictability and reliability** in behavior - Key qualities of a **natural leader.** Eg. Mahatma Gandhi's adherence to Ahimsa in personal life
   c. **Integrity** acts as a foundation of genuine **self-esteem** and **confidence**. Eg. Sanchin Tendulkar refusing advertisement of Tobacco and Cigarettes brands.
2. **Empowerment at the Family Level**
   a. Parents with integrity empower children with a living blueprint of **"The Good Life"**.
   b. Integrity creates an environment of **emotional safety** and **trust** within the family.
   c. "The strength of a nation derives from the integrity of the home." - **Confucius**
3. **Empowerment at the Social Level**
   a. **Builds Social Capital-** Integrity is the **"currency"** of social trust.
   b. **Inspiration to Others** ("ripple effect" of goodness). Eg. **Babasaheb Ambedkar** inspiring generations of Dalit leaders
   c. **Catalyst for social change** - Eg. **Rosa Parks's** refusal to give up her bus seat led to the Civil Rights Movement.
4. **Empowerment at the Professional Level**
   a. **Moral Courage**- the **"inner transparency"** empowers a person to speak truth to power. Eg. Satyendra Dubey
   b. Integrity builds a **reputation** and **trust** that acts as a multiplier for one's influence and opportunities. Eg. Metro man **E. Sreedharan**
   c. Gives **moral authority** to lead. Eg. **Captain Vikram Batra** leading from the front in Kargil War.
   d. Integrity helps in **objective decision making.** Eg. T. N. Session as CEC
   e. **Knowledge without integrity is dangerous and dreadful**. Eg. developing of Nuclear bomb

The Erosion of Integrity in Public Service

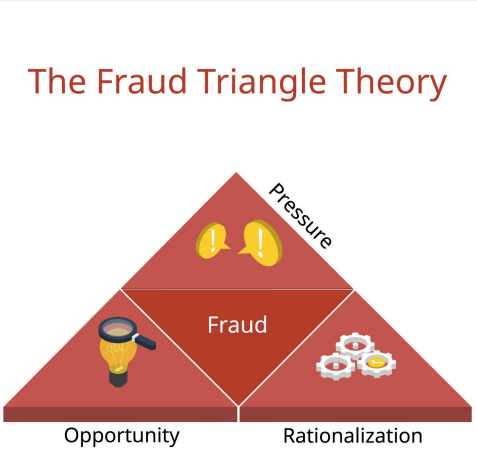
1. **Historical Factors**: Corruption in India has roots in **colonial rule**, where **low salaries** for Indian officials led to the normalization of corrupt practices. Eg. **"Baksheesh"** system.
2. **Shifting Values and Aspirations**: Rapid **urbanization** and **industrialization** have made **material wealth** a key determinant of **social status**.
3. **Article 311** of the Indian Constitution - **overprotection** of officials, allowing inefficiency or corruption to persist.
4. **Conflict of Interests**: Corruption is often facilitated by **collusion** between **business magnates** and **officials** for mutual gain. (Vohra committee)
5. **Political Interference:** Public servants often face undue pressure from political leaders to prioritize personal or political interests over public welfare.
6. **Societal Tolerance of Corruption (sanskritization of corruption):** Public acceptance of minor unethical practices normalizes integrity breaches.
7. **Lack of Ethical Training:** Absence of regular ethics training for public servants weakens their moral decision-making.

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8. **Pressure to Meet Targets:** Unrealistic goals may push civil servants to cut corners or compromise ethics. Eg. Manipulating data to show higher performance.
9. **Peer Influence and Organizational Culture:** Eg. Honest officials like Ashok Khemka being marginalized in a corrupt workplace.
10. **Inadequate Compensation:** Low salaries can tempt public servants to seek additional income through unethical means.
11. **Complex and Ambiguous Rules:** Overly complex regulations create loopholes that are exploited for personal gain.
12. **Fear of Retaliation:** Whistleblowers often face threats, transfers, or isolation, discouraging others from acting with integrity.
13. **Lack of Exemplary Leadership:** Absence of ethical leaders at the top discourages integrity at all levels.
14. **Inadequate Legal Enforcement:** Weak legal systems and prolonged trials fail to deter unethical practices. Eg. Corruption cases dragging on for years without resolution.

Knowledge without Integrity

- **Sophisticated Fraud-** A smart individual can bypass internal controls and audit trails. Eg. **Bernie Madoff** running ponzi scheme.



- High energy without integrity leads to **"winning at any cost,"** resulting in a toxic **"cut-throat"** culture that destroys team morale.
- **Reputational damage-** Eg. manipulation of financial data to show **"paper profits,"** in **Enron case**
- **Erosion of Stakeholder Trust - Eg. The NSE Co-location Case (Chitra Ramkrishna).**
- **Systemic Exploitation** by finding loopholes in laws or company policies. Eg. Nirav Modi - PNB Fraud
- **Corrosive Leadership-** "If ethics are poor at the top, that behavior is copied down through the organization." - **Robert Noyce** (Intel Co-founder)
- **Legal risks-** Eg. **Subrata Roy's (Sahara India)** massive "shadow banking" empire
- **The "Smart Criminal" Effect-** intelligent and high energy do the wrong things faster and higher in scale. Eg. Harshad Metha

Way Forward

OECD Public Integrity Recommendations

1. **Mandatory Pre-Employment Integrity Vetting -** Incorporate objective psychometric and behavioral integrity screenings directly into the civil services recruitment phase.
2. **Transition to Risk-Based Internal Auditing -** Shift internal public sector audits from passive rule-checking to data-driven risk-mapping of corrupt practices.
3. **Automated Asset and Interest Disclosures -** Build digital systems to continuously submit, track, and algorithmically cross-verify asset statements of public servants.
4. **AI-Powered Fraud Prevention in Procurement -** Deploy Machine Learning algorithms to analyze public bidding data and instantly flag artificial price-inflation or collusion.

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5. **Interactive Ethical Dilemma Simulation Training for addressing real-world administrative gray areas.**
6. **Systematic De-politicization of Internal Investigations** - Insulate internal disciplinary bodies from executive control to guarantee fair, timely corruption inquiries and trials.

2nd ARC Recommendations (Ethics in Governance)

1. **Implementation of a Statutory Code of Ethics** - Supplant negative, traditional "Conduct Rules" with a statutory, values-driven Code of Ethics emphasizing public service values.
2. **Institutionalizing the "Cooling-Off" Period for retired officials taking private corporate jobs.**
3. **Citizen Charters** - statutory status to Citizen's Charters with automatic financial compensation if public service deadlines are missed.
4. **Independent Protection for Whistleblowers from systemic workplace harassment or physical threats.**
5. **Independent Civil Services Boards to manage bureaucratic transfers**
6. **Enact laws holding public officials personally and financially liable for intentional damage or neglect of state property.**

Integrity Pact

- **Integrity Pact** is a **vigilance tool** that involves an **agreement** between prospective **vendors/bidders** and the **buyer**. Both parties commit to **not engaging in corrupt practices** or exerting **undue influence** in any part of the contract process.
- The **implementation** of the Integrity Pact is overseen by **Independent External Monitors (IEMs)**, ensuring that the agreement is upheld and transparency is maintained.

Difference between Honesty and Integrity

Aspect	Honesty	Integrity
Definition	Being truthful, sincere, and free from deceit.	Adherence to strong moral and ethical principles consistently.
Moral Depth	Surface-level **truthfulness**.	Deep-rooted **moral character and consistency**.
Scope	More about **telling the truth** and not lying or cheating.	Broader concept involving **doing the right thing**, even under pressure.
Dependency	Can exist in isolation (Eg. being honest in one instance).	Encompasses honesty but also includes **courage, accountability, and ethics**.
Example	Admitting a mistake truthfully when asked.	Taking responsibility for the mistake **even if no one noticed**.
Public Service Relevance	Needed in **reporting facts and data** accurately.	Needed for **ethical governance, decision-making, and resisting corruption**.

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Neutrality

Neutrality in civil services means that a civil servant remains politically impartial and non-partisan throughout their career.

Conduct Rules for Ensuring Neutrality:

1. **Avoid Political Involvement**
2. Officers should **not contribute** funds or provide assistance to any **political party**.
3. Civil servants may **vote**, but they should **not reveal their political preference** to others.
4. They must **not display election symbols** on their **person, vehicle, or home**, and should **avoid participating** in rallies, protests, or demonstrations without **government approval**.

Importance of neutrality of civil servants

1. **Guarantees Administrative Continuity during transitions of power.**
2. **Preserves Public Trust** by ensuring non-discriminatory, non-partisan delivery of welfare schemes.
3. **Enables Objective Policy Advice** - Empowers bureaucrats to give frank, unbiased, and data-driven recommendations to ministers without fear of political backlash.
4. **Prevents Spoil-System Nepotism** - Shields the civil service from degrading into political patronage, protecting merit-based recruitment and tenure security.
5. **Drives Uniform Policy Enforcement** - Guarantees that rules, regulations, and taxations are implemented uniformly without giving arbitrary political favors.
6. **Insulates Rule of Law** - Prevents the weaponization of administrative machinery and state police forces against political dissidents.
7. **Optimizes Public Resource Allocation** - Ensures national funds are distributed based on developmental merit and socio-economic indicators rather than political mileage.

Criticism of Bureaucratic Neutrality:

1. **Clashes with Constitutional Commitment** - They must be actively committed to Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity.
2. **Leads to Status-Quoism and Rule-Paralysis** - Absolute detachment breeds passive "red-tapism," where bureaucrats hide behind rulebooks to avoid taking the definitive, creative decisions needed for complex governance.
3. **Diverges from India's Welfare State Mandate** - India is a developing welfare democracy requiring highly proactive intervention for historical socio-economic inequities, rather than cold, clinical detachment.
4. **Alienation from Marginalized Masses** - An overly detached bureaucracy builds an ivory-tower disconnect, stripping public servants of the compassion and empathy
5. **Inhibits Creative and Dynamic Problem Solving** - Rigid neutrality restricts flexibility, out-of-the-box thinking, and risk-taking capacity
6. **Dilutes Personal and Professional Conscience** - Total detachment reduces a human administrator to a mere administrative robot, vulnerable to blindly executing highly unethical or flawed political commands
7. **Degrades the Ideal of Social Justice - To achieve true equity (Sarvodaya), a civil servant must lean positively toward the weak.**

Impartiality & Non-partisanship

Impartiality is the quality of making decisions based on objective criteria, merit, and facts.

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Non-partisanship is a state of being politically neutral and serving the government with equal dedication, regardless of personal political leanings.

Importance of Impartiality

1. Impartiality ensures that **all citizens are treated equally** regardless of status, identity or political affiliation. Eg. Kiran Bedi towing vehicle of PM
2. Maintaining **Public Trust and belief in fairness** of administration - strengthens legitimacy. Eg. UPSC selection process
3. **Promotes inclusivity and Social Justice-** Eg. **S. Shankaran** in implementing the **Bonded Labour Abolition Act**
4. **Prevents misuse of power**. Eg. **Ashok Khemka (IAS)** cancelled illegal land deals irrespective of political interests.
5. **Enables fair grievance redressal**. Eg. **U Sagayam (IAS)** conducted impartial inquiries into granite mining.
6. Ensures **efficiency in resource utilization**. Eg. **E. Sreedharan** ensuring objectivity in the awarding of contracts for the Delhi Metro.
7. Promotes **professional ethics** by ensuring adherence to principles of neutrality, selflessness and accountability.

Importance of Non-partisanship

1. **Continuity of Government-** Eg. The smooth transition of power in India since independence
2. **Fearless Advice** on the legality of a political directive.
3. **Efficient Crisis Management-** In communal or ethnic tensions, an impartial officer is the only trusted mediator.
4. It prevents the **"cooking of books"** (like GDP or employment figures) to suit a political party's re-election campaign.
5. **Prevents politicisation of bureaucracy.** Eg. **Durga Shakti Nagpal** resisting political interference.
6. **Maintains professional autonomy.** Eg. RBI independence in monetary policy.
7. Prevents **authoritarian tendencies and 'spoils system.'**
8. Safeguards **rule of law** by resisting politically motivated actions. Eg. EC's fair application of MCC

Examples of Impartiality:

1. The **central government**'s role in resolving **interstate water disputes** like the **Karnataka-Tamil Nadu** water issues.
2. **Neelam Sanjiva Reddy**, as Speaker of the **Lok Sabha**, resigned from his party and conducted proceedings impartially, ensuring a smooth and fair parliamentary process.
3. **Election Commission of India:** Ensured free and fair elections by taking strict actions against political parties violating the Model Code of Conduct.

Measures to Ensure Impartiality:

1. **Enact a comprehensive Civil Services Bill** that legally enshrines "Impartiality" and "Non-partisanship" as mandatory foundational values, elevating them above basic compliance rules.
2. **Independent Civil Services Boards (CSB)** to oversee postings, transfers, and promotions- prevents politicization and **spoil system.**
3. **Mandate a guaranteed minimum tenure** for operational postings to immunize honest bureaucrats against arbitrary, politically motivated removals.
4. **Objective, Data-Driven Performance AppraisalOverhaul the - SPARROW** system to heavily weight objective field results over subjective, political executive remarks.

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5. **Address "caged parrot syndrome" - insulate anti-corruption agencies like the CVC, CBI, and Lokpal** from executive control to prevent the targeted hounding of neutral officers.
6. **Use e-governance architectures** to automate resource allocation, public procurement, and licensing, minimizing personal discretionary bias. Eg. e-Tendering
7. **Fully operationalize and enforce the Whistleblowers Protection Act** to provide swift physical, financial, and career safeguards for officers reporting political exploitation.
8. **Mandate third-party civic evaluations and citizen-led social audits** of welfare distribution to instantly expose administrative favoritism or bias.

Objectivity

"Objectivity is the intellectual rigour that helps us separate facts from opinions." - Fareed Zakaria

Objectivity is the **ability to make decisions** based on **observable facts**, **rigorous analysis**, and the **merits of a situation**, without being influenced by **emotions, biases, or personal prejudices**.

Importance of Objectivity

1. **Ensures Merit-Based Decision Making -** Anchors administrative choices strictly on empirical evidence, factual data, and hard proof rather than personal whims. Eg. PM Gati Shakti Masterplan
2. **Eliminates Nepotism and Favoritism** in public recruitment, government procurement, and the allocation of state contracts. Eg. Gov e-Marketplace
3. **Minimizes Personal and Ideological Biases in policy making and implementation**
4. **Maximizes Public Resource Efficiency - Eg. E. Sreedharan ensuring** objectivity in the awarding of contracts for the Delhi Metro.
5. **Upholds Article 14** of the Constitution by treating all citizens equally before administrative processes.
6. **Fosters Institutional Credibility -** Rebuilds citizen trust in administrative machinery by projecting a reliable image of institutional fairness.
7. **Avoids emotional bias**: Prevents **emotions** from affecting decisions, such as **influence from family or friends** in contracts.

Major Challenges in Ensuring Objectivity

1. **Excessive Legislative Discretion -** Vaguely drafted laws give bureaucrats wide, unchecked personal powers, paving the way for subjective bias.
2. **Deep-Rooted Socio-Cultural Prejudices -** Subconscious caste, class, gender, or regional biases can subtly color an administrator's field assessments.
3. **Deficit of Real-Time Data -** Inaccurate, obsolete, fragmented or manipulated field statistics hinders data driven decision making. Eg. inclusion-exclusion errors in PDS
4. **Coercive political pressures,** such as sudden transfer threats, force officials to abandon factual objectivity.
5. **Systemic Red-Tape and Inertia -** A historical, colonial organizational culture prioritizes rigid, mindless box-ticking over proactive, objective problem-solving.
6. **Cognitive Dissonance in Crises -** Extreme high-pressure situations, like communal riots, trigger emotional override, clouding objective risk-assessment.
7. **Weak Institutional Checks and Balances -** Diluted internal audit structures fail to flag or penalize routine subjective deviations by senior officers.

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Measures to Ensure Objectivity among Civil Servants in India

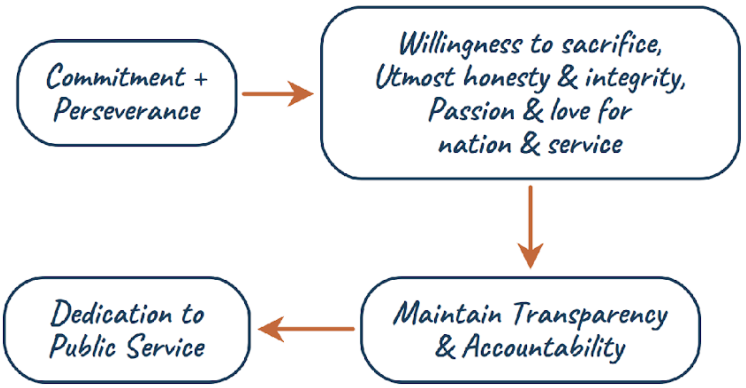
1. **Enact a comprehensive Civil Services Bill** to give statutory backing to "Objectivity" as an uncompromisable, legally enforceable core administrative value.
2. **Mandate clear, exhaustive, and written SOPs** for all public service deliveries to shrink room for personal interpretation or ad-hoc manipulation.
3. **Algorithmic and Data-Driven Governance - Expand robust e-governance architectures (like GeM for procurement and DBT** for welfare) to automate processes, remove human discretion, and let data drive resource distribution.
4. **Mandatory "Reasoned Decisions" (Ratio Decidendi)** - Introduce statutory guidelines forcing public servants to document explicit, written, and evidence-backed justifications for all high-value administrative decisions.
5. Embed continuous cognitive de-biasing, data analytics, and ethical reasoning courses into mid-career training programs under **Mission Karmayogi.**
6. **Open-Data Implementation (Section 4 of RTI)** - enables media, academia, and civil society to scrutinize the objectivity of administrative actions.

Dedication

> "Public service must be more than doing a job efficiently and honestly. It must be a complete dedication to the people and the nation" - **Margaret Smith**
>
> "The best to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others" - **Mahatma Gandhi**

Dedication is the quality of being **devoted or loyal** to a **duty or purpose**, persevering in actions even when **motivation wanes**, and **working towards organizational goals**.

1. The **Bhagavad Gita** highlights dedication by advising that we should **perform duties diligently** without expecting specific outcomes.



A genuinely dedicated public servant:

1. **Goes beyond the call of duty**. Eg. APJ Abdul Kalam
2. **Prioritises public welfare** over personal interests or even **safety**. Eg. Satyendra Dubey
3. **Seeks no rewards** or recognition for their efforts.
4. Shows **Resilience Against Political Pressure**. Eg. Ashok Khemka
5. **Courage and Bravery** even in the face of adversity.
6. **Mission-Driven Sacrifice**: Eg. Vikram batra
7. **Drives Effective Policy Implementation:** Eg. Ensuring last-mile delivery of welfare schemes like MNREGA or food subsidies in rural areas.
8. **Efficiency in Resource Use**: Eg. E- Sreedharan
9. **Reflection of Public-Spirited Values** like integrity, compassion, and non-partisanship

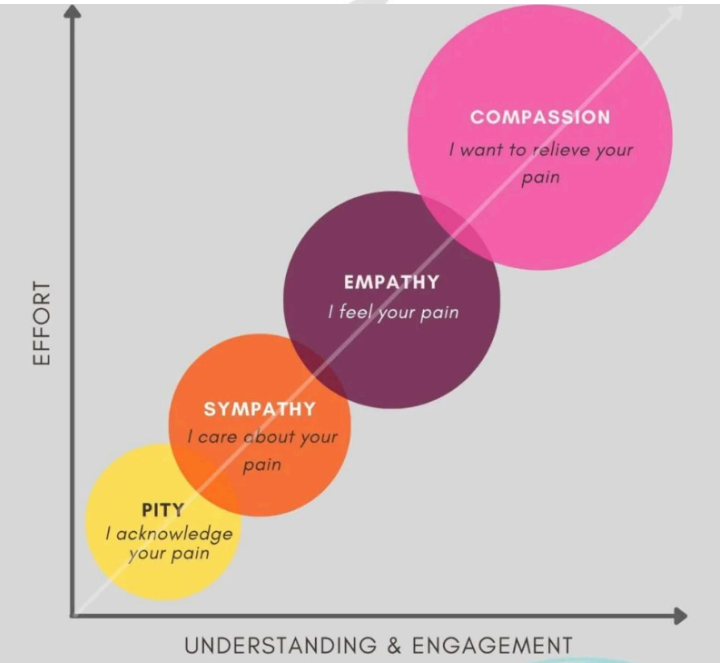
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10. **Role Model for Others**: Eg. T. N. Seshan

Compassion

Compassion is the combination of **empathy and action**. It involves **understanding the suffering of others** and having a **drive to protect and help**. Unlike empathy, compassion often leads to an **active desire to alleviate suffering**, making it a deeper form of **"co-suffering."**

Significance of Compassion for Weaker Sections



1. **Understanding the needs of marginalized populations**: Compassion enables policymakers to grasp the unique challenges of disadvantaged communities, promoting tailored solutions.
2. **Encourages responsiveness to citizens in distress**: Compassion-driven governance leads to swift and effective support for those facing hardships.
3. **Enables perspective-shifting**: Compassion helps leaders view issues from the perspective of the marginalized, fostering inclusive policies.
4. **Directive Principles of State Policy (Article 38)**: Compassion aligns with **DPSP's mandate** to establish a **welfare state** that minimizes inequalities, promoting **social and economic justice**.
5. **John Rawls' Theory of Justice**: Compassion mirrors Rawls' **veil of ignorance** concept, advocating for policies that uplift the **least advantaged** in society.
6. **Amartya Sen's Capability Approach**: Compassion encourages enhancing individuals' **capabilities** for a dignified life, focusing on **equality of opportunity** rather than mere economic metrics.
7. **Gandhiji's Talisman**: Compassion fulfills Gandhi's vision to consider the **needs of the poorest** in every decision, reinforcing moral responsibility toward the vulnerable.
8. **Addressing Rampant Poverty and Inequality**: Compassionate governance tackles **systemic poverty and inequality**, ensuring resources and opportunities reach all sections equitably.
9. **Navigating Weak and Complex Governance**: Compassionate leaders foster **transparency and accountability**, making governance accessible and empowering weaker sections in navigating complex administrative systems.

Examples:

1. **Nelson Mandela** said, "**A good head and a good heart are always a formidable combination**." He dedicated his life to **fighting apartheid** and **uplifting** the people of **South Africa**.
2. **S. R. Sankaran (1934-2010)**, known as the **"People's IAS officer,"** showed deep compassion for **socially disadvantaged** groups. He played a key role in enforcing the **Abolition of Bonded Labour Act, 1976** and mentored **Safai Karamcharis**, advocating for **pro-poor policies** throughout his career.
3. **IAS Jitendra Kumar Soni, upon seeing underprivileged kids attending school barefoot in winter, initiated the Charan Paduka Abhiyan, distributing shoes to them.**
4. **Baba Amte'S** work towards leprosy patients

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5. **Kailash Satyarthi's 'Save The Children'** campaign.
6. **Sindhutai sapkal** took care of more than **8000 orphans.**

Apathy, Sympathy, Empathy, Compassion

1. **Apathy - Indifference**: Apathy is the state of **indifference**, where no **emotion, concern, care, or motivation** is shown towards a situation. **Eg.** Ignoring a road accident and saying, **"Ye toh hota rehta hai"** (This happens all the time).
2. **Altruism** is the act of **selflessly doing good** for the **well-being of others**. **Eg.** If a person who has **recovered from cancer** feels **empathy** for other cancer patients, and then **builds a charitable cancer hospital** to support them, that is **altruism**.
3. **Sympathy - Kindness**: Sympathy is a **momentary instinctive reaction** of **kindness** towards someone's suffering. It is **spontaneous** and lacks a **deep understanding** of the issue. **Eg.** Noticing a road accident and saying, **"Bahut bura hua bhai"** (It's very unfortunate, brother).
4. **Empathy - Experience**: Empathy involves **putting oneself in another's place** to **truly understand** their **pain** and **sorrow**. It includes both **cognitive** and **emotional** aspects, providing a **deeper understanding** of the problem. **Empathy** is more **sustainable** than sympathy and **a stronger indicator of behavior**. **Eg.** Feeling deeply moved by a road accident, **crying** out of shared **pain** and urging others to **help** the victim.
5. **Compassion - Action**: Compassion combines **understanding** with a **desire to help**, focusing on **action** to **alleviate suffering**. It involves **putting others first**, **imagining their pain**, and then **acting to improve their situation**. **Compassion** is a **stronger predictor of behavior** than empathy. **Eg.** Compassion is what motivated **Mother Teresa** to leave her homeland and serve in **Kolkata**. In a road accident scenario, it means **calling an ambulance** and **ensuring the victim is admitted** to a hospital.

Tolerance

"I may disagree with what you say but I will defend to the death your right to say it" -Voltaire

"Let noble thoughts flow in from all directions" - Rigveda

"Think for yourself and let others enjoy the privilege of doing so too." - Voltaire

"Tolerance becomes a crime when applied to evil"- Thomas Mann

Tolerance means accepting and respecting the **differences, beliefs, and opinions** of others, even when they differ from our own.

Significance of Tolerance

1. **Peace**: Essential for maintaining **long-term peace** in societies. **Eg. vasudhaiva kutumbakam**
2. **Human Development**: Supports **human rights, pluralism, democracy,** and the **rule of law**, fostering **human development**.
3. **Equality**: Affirms the **moral worth** of every individual
4. **Inclusivity**: Embraces **all members of society**, including those with different **sexual orientations**, such as the **LGBTQ community**.
5. **Broadened Perspective**: Expands the views of civil servants, reinforcing values like **justice, impartiality,** and **objectivity**.
6. **Adaptability**: Aids civil servants in adapting to new environments, particularly when posted outside their own state.
7. Critical for upholding **secularism** as envisioned in the **Constitution**. **Intolerance** leads to **injustice** and **violence**

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8. **Better Decision-Making**: Helps **prevent impulsive decisions**, allows for **healthy debate and discussion**, and leads to **democratic outcomes**.
9. **Individuality and Diversity**: Creates a society where individuals feel **valued** and **respected**, allowing space for **different ideas, thoughts,** and **dreams**.
10. **Respect**: Tolerance fosters **mutual respect** and the **common good**, focusing on **understanding differences** rather than determining who is right or wrong.

Examples:

1. **Emperor Ashoka** promoted tolerance through **Major Rock Edict 7.**
2. **Akbar sulh-i-kul**
3. **Jainism Anekantavada.**

Examples of intolerance

- Killing of intellectuals like **Narendra Dabholkar, Comrade Pansare**
- Killing of leaders like **Abraham Lincoln, Gandhi, Martin Luther King Jr., Shinzo Abe**
- **Incidents of riots like Bhima koregaon riots, gujarat riots 2002**
- Targeted killings of **kashmiri pandits**
- **Issue Of Khalistan, Naga Separatism, Meitie Vs Kuki And Recent Manipur Violence**

How to Inculcate Tolerance:

1. **Sensitivity Training**: Educating judges, civil servants, and others on social issues like **homosexuality** and **poverty** through initiatives like **Bharat Darshan**.
2. **Role-Playing**: Engaging in **dramas** and **intra-organizational activities** to build empathy and understanding of diverse perspectives.
3. **Role of Media**: Media should avoid **sensationalizing news** for TRP and instead promote a culture of **tolerance**, influencing young minds positively.
4. **Indian Philosophical Teachings**:
   a. **"Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam"** (The world is one family) from the **Maha Upanishad**, engraved in the entrance of India's Parliament.
   b. **"Atithi Devo Bhava"** (Guests are equivalent to God).
5. **Role of Private Sector/Civil Society**:
   a. **Tackling fake news** on platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and WhatsApp with **content verifiers**.
   b. **Monitoring social media** for **hate speech** and **communal content**, with platforms following **self-imposed ethics**.
6. **Police Reforms**:
   a. **Accountability** for police officers who fail to act during **riots**, **inter-caste marriages**, and **khap verdicts**.
7. **Governance Reforms**:
   a. Promoting **pluralistic settlements** like **Samasthapuram** (Tamil Nadu) and **Mixed Racial Housing** (Singapore).
   b. **Increasing job opportunities** for **minorities**.
   c. Enacting laws like the **Prevention of Communal and Targeted Violence Bill, 2011** and **Anti-Mob Lynching Laws** in states like Rajasthan.
8. **Value Education**:
   a. Teaching children to **embrace diversity**, using resources like the **UNESCO Series "Tolerance: The Threshold for Peace"** as a model.
   b. **Decommunalizing** the teaching of **Indian history** to promote an inclusive mindset.

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Openness/Transparency

> **"Transparency breeds self-correction."**- Arthur Levitt
>
> **"Transparency means that my motives are easily perceived. No hidden agendas."**- Richard E. Simmons III
>
> **"In the age of information, lack of transparency leads to distrust and a deep sense of insecurity."**

Openness or transparency refers to the quality of being open, clear, and accessible about government policies, decisions, and processes to enable public scrutiny.

It is a proactive value requiring that institutions share relevant information openly and facilitate public understanding. It ensures accountability and fosters trust in governance.

Importance of Transparency

1. **Promotes accountability**: By making officials answerable for their actions. **Eg. RTI act mandates suo moto disclosure of information.**
2. **Enhances trust**: Builds confidence in public institutions by reducing secrecy. Eg. **U. SAGAYAM (IAS) was the first IAS officer in Tamil Nadu to publicise his financial information.**
3. **Prevents corruption**: Minimizes the opportunity for misconduct by increasing visibility. **Eg. social audit of schemes like MGNREGA**
4. **Improves governance**: Ensures that decisions are made based on objective and justifiable grounds.
5. **Empowers citizens**: Facilitates informed participation in decision-making processes. **Eg. EIA for infrastructure projects**
6. **Enhances Inter-Departmental Coordination:** Open communication between government departments **avoids duplication and inefficiency.**
7. **Reduces Misuse of Authority:** Transparency prevents public officials from exploiting their positions for personal gain. Eg. Asset declarations by civil servants deter corruption
8. **Prevents Rumors and Misinformation:** Open sharing of facts combats misinformation and builds credibility.

Value to Whom?

1. **Citizens**: Enables them to understand government actions, demand accountability, and participate effectively in democratic processes. **Eg.** RTI, SOCIAL AUDIT, CITIZEN CHARTER.
2. **Legislatures**: Ensures informed discussions and debates on policies.
3. **Judicial Institutions**: Aids in ensuring that justice is carried out visibly and fairly. **Eg. live streaming of judicial proceedings.**
4. **Media and Civil Society**: Provides tools for watchdog activities and advocacy.
5. **Internal Administration**: Helps in better interdepartmental coordination and checks.

Types of Transparency

1. **Procedural Transparency**: Clear rules and procedures for decision-making. **Eg. transparent coal block allocation process**
2. **Financial Transparency**: Disclosure of budgets, expenditures, and financial transactions.
3. **Policy Transparency**: Public sharing of policy objectives, implementation plans, and outcomes.
4. **Operational Transparency**: Clarity in daily operations and service delivery mechanisms. **Eg. citizen charter.**

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Tools to Ensure Transparency

1. **Right to Information (RTI) Act**: Empowers citizens to request information from public authorities.
2. **E-Governance Platforms**: Use technology to make government processes accessible. **Eg. gramswaraj portal has data on funds allocated to grampanchayats.**
3. **Citizen Charters**: Outline standards for service delivery and grievance redressal mechanisms.
4. **Audit and Vigilance Reports**: Provide oversight of public expenditures and decisions. **Eg. Vinod Rai -known for exposing scam as CAG**

Decline of Transparency

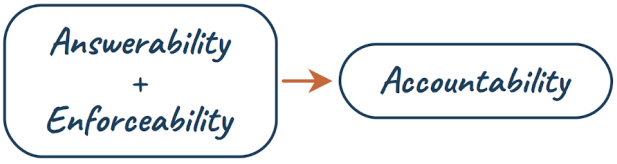
1. **Excessive Bureaucratic Secrecy**: Reluctance to share information, citing confidentiality.
2. **Misuse of Official Secrets Acts:** Overuse of confidentiality clauses to shield information from public scrutiny.
3. **Erosion of Media Freedom:** Restrictions on journalists limit investigative reporting and public awareness.
4. **Absence of Whistleblower Protection:** Fear of retaliation prevents individuals from exposing lack of transparency.
5. **Selective Disclosure:** Governments often disclose favorable information while withholding controversial details.
6. **Opaque Policy Formulation:** Lack of clarity and public consultation in policy drafting processes erodes transparency. Eg. laws via ordinances without parliamentary debate.
7. **Weak Implementation of RTI**: Delayed or incomplete responses to information requests.
8. **Technological Divide**: E-Governance initiatives not accessible to marginalized populations.
9. **Lack of Awareness**: Citizens not fully utilizing tools like RTI due to ignorance.

Accountability

> **"A body of men holding themselves accountable to nobody ought not to be trusted by anybody."** - Thomas Paine
>
> **"Accountability separates the wishers in life from the action-takers who care enough about their future to account for their daily actions."** - John Di Lemme

Accountability in public service means **holding public officials responsible** for their actions, ensuring they fulfill their **duties and obligations** effectively. This concept is essential to **ethical governance** and involves two main aspects:

1. **Answerability**: Public officials must be **answerable for their decisions and actions**, providing clear **explanations and justifications** to the public and oversight bodies.
2. **Enforcement**: Accountability requires **mechanisms to enforce consequences** for misconduct or rule violations.



Importance of Accountability

1. **Ensures rule of law**: Promotes compliance with laws, policies, and regulations.

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2. **Fosters Responsibility:** Accountability encourages public servants to take ownership of their duties and decisions.
3. **Checks and Prevents the Misuse of Public Funds - Eg. CAG audit** exposing the **2G spectrum** scam.
4. **Safeguards Citizen Rights and Entitlements - Eg. MGNREGA social audits** tracking rural wage payments.
5. **Drives Citizen-Centric Transparency - Eg. RTI applications** unmasking public distribution ration scams.
6. **Guarantees Public Infrastructure Safety and Standards:** Holding administrative project heads and private contractors legally answerable eliminates corner-cutting and sub-standard engineering projects.
7. **Prevents Arbitrary Administrative Delay - Eg.** State-level **Right to Public Services Acts**
8. **Installs Prompt Grievance Redressal - Eg. CPGRAMS portal** enforcing 30-day complaint resolution.
9. **Eliminates Corporate and Bureaucratic Nexus** through independent anti-corruption oversight. **Eg. CBI probe** into **NSE co-location case**.
10. **Enhances Grassroots Service Quality:** Localized democratic accountability forces municipal and panchayat leaders to demonstrate clear links between public tax collections and basic field utilities.
11. **Minimizes Institutional Blindspots via Judicial Scrutiny - Eg.** Supreme Court ordering the **Ganga cleanup** actions.

Value to Whom?

Accountability is crucial to multiple stakeholders:

1. **Citizens**: Ensures public service delivery and responsiveness to societal needs. **Eg. grievance redressal mechanism under citizen charter, sevottam model.**
2. **Political Leadership**: Aids in maintaining legitimacy and fulfilling electoral promises.
3. **Legislature**: Ensures that the executive branch is answerable to elected representatives. **Eg. instruments like question hour, budget, no confidence motion, etc used.**
4. **Judiciary**: Guarantees adherence to the rule of law and constitutional principles. **Eg. The supreme court in 2023 made itself a public authority to make it answerable to RTI.**
5. **Superiors and Peers**: Encourages collective responsibility and professional integrity.

Institutions and Mechanisms that Promote Accountability

Outside the State (Vertical Accountability)	Within the State (Horizontal Accountability)
• **Elections**: Citizens hold public officials accountable by voting and choosing representatives. • **Right to Information (RTI) Act**: Empowers citizens to access government-held information, enhancing **transparency**. • **Citizen Oversight Committees**: Engages citizens in **monitoring and evaluating government** actions. • **Civil Society/Watchdog Bodies**: NGOs and civil groups advocate for **transparency** and **good governance**. • **Media**: Acts as a **watchdog**, exposing government actions and wrongdoing. • **Service Delivery Surveys**: Collects citizen feedback on **public service quality**.	• **Superior Officers**: Ensure accountability within the executive through **reward and punishment**, performance management. • **CBI/Police/Vigilance**: Investigates **corruption** and **rule violations** within government. • **Internal Audit**: Assesses compliance in government financial and operational processes. • **Grievance Redressal Mechanisms**: Addresses complaints and cases of **maladministration**. • **E-Governance Mechanisms**: Platforms like **Pragati** and **National e-Governance Plan (NeGP)** use technology to enhance **transparency** and **efficiency**.

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Outside the State (Vertical Accountability)	Within the State (Horizontal Accountability)
• **Citizen's Charters**: Defines **rights and standards** for service delivery, promoting accountability.	

Decline of Accountability

1. **Political Influence**: Undermines independent functioning of public institutions.
2. **Weak Oversight Mechanisms:** Eg. Delay or non-disclosure of Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reports.
3. **Ineffectual Legal Frameworks:** Inadequate or poorly enforced laws fail to hold public officials accountable. Eg. Prolonged delays in corruption cases discourage accountability.
4. **Lack of Transparency:** Opaque governance processes hinder public scrutiny and accountability. Eg. RTI exemptions under DPDP rules
5. **Absence of Citizen Participation:** Limited public involvement in decision-making weakens demand for accountability. Eg. lack of public participation in EIA
6. **Poor Whistleblower Protection:** Fear of retaliation discourages individuals from reporting misconduct.
7. **Overburdened Judiciary:** Delayed justice in accountability cases undermines deterrence.
8. **Inadequate Training**: Absence of a strong ethical foundation among officials.

Way Forward to strengthen transparency and accountability in governance

1. Institutional and Legal Reforms

1. Ensuring the independence and resource-sufficiency of bodies like **Lokpal, Lokayukta** and **CVC**
2. Rigorous implementation of the **Whistleblowers Protection Act**.
3. Empowering the **CAG** to conduct social audits and performance audits
4. **Adoption of the "Hong Kong Model" (ICAC)** to tackle corruption - three-pronged strategy of Investigation, Prevention, and Community Education

2. Procedural and Technological Measures

1. **E-Governance** to reduce human discretion and the "gatekeeper" effect. Eg. **GeM**
2. **Citizens' Charters-** Mandating clear timelines for service delivery. Eg. SAKALA (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
3. Proactive disclosure under **Section 4 of the RTI Act** for transparency
4. Mandatory and periodic declaration of **assets and liabilities by civil servants**

3. Human Resource and Ethical Reforms

1. Moving beyond a "Rule-based" conduct code (what not to do) to a **"Value-based" code of ethics** (what to strive for) (**2nd ARC**).
2. **Competency-linked training** under **Mission Karmayogi** to ensure civil servants are not only skilled but also ethically grounded.

4. Social and Political Measures

1. **Legal backing to Social Audits. (Meghalaya Act)**
2. Ensuring **transparency in electoral funding** to prevent the "quid-pro-quo" culture at top.

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Leadership

> **"Leadership is taking responsibility while others are making excuses."**- John C. Maxwell
>
> **"A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way, and shows the way."**- John C. Maxwell
>
> **"Leadership is the capacity to translate vision into reality."**- Warren Bennis
>
> **"The greatest leader is not necessarily the one who does the greatest things. He is the one that gets people to do the greatest things."**- Ronald Reagan

Leadership in public administration is the ability to inspire, guide, and influence individuals and institutions to achieve organizational goals, uphold ethical standards, and serve the public interest.

Importance of Leadership

1. **Infuses Moral Vision into Static Regulations - Eg. S. R. Sankaran weaponizing laws for bonded labor abolition.**
2. **Shields the Subordinate Bureaucracy from Political Coercion - Eg. Julio Ribeiro insulating police ranks from partisan interference.**
3. **Fosters a Values-Driven Organizational Culture - Eg. E. Sreedharan embedding absolute financial probity in project cultures.**
4. **Bridges the Trust Deficit Between State and Citizens - Eg. P. K. Nair** institutionalizing transparent, direct public grievance durbars.
5. **Overcomes Systemic Bureaucracy-Induced Inertia:** Proactive leaders dismantle traditional red-tape and out-of-the-box bottlenecks by introducing decisive risk-taking and operational flexibility.
6. **Navigates Complex Moral and Ethical Dilemmas:** When rules are silent or ambiguous, leadership provides the internal conscience and clarity needed to make just, balanced decisions.
7. **Institutionalizes Long-Term Structural Reforms - Eg. T. N. Seshan** created permanent institutional teeth for electoral oversight.
8. **Champions Public Accountability and Self-Regulation: Eg. U. Sagayam** - 1st IAS officer to disclose assets

Decline of Leadership

1. **Bureaucratic Stagnation**: Resistance to innovation and change limits effective leadership.
2. **Corruption and Nepotism**: Erodes trust and weakens the ability to inspire.
3. **Lack of Vision**: Inadequate long-term planning undermines leadership effectiveness.
4. **Over-politicization**: Aligning with political interests over public welfare reduces credibility.
5. **Poor Training**: Insufficient capacity-building hinders leadership skills development.

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Chapter 7

Public Civil Service Values And Ethics In Public Administration

PYQs

PYQs

[2018] State the three basic values, universal in nature, in the context of civil services and bring out their importance. (10)

[2018] What is meant by public interest? What are the principles and procedures to be followed by the civil servants in public interest? (10)

[2018] Explain the process of resolving ethical dilemmas in Public Administration. (10)

[2019] What are the basic principles of public life? Illustrate any three of these with suitable exam. **(10)**

[2019] What do you understand by the term 'public servant'? Reflect on the expected role of a public servant. (10)

[2019] "Non-performance of duty by a public servant is a form of corruption". Do you agree with this view? Justify your answer. (10)

[2025] "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to a sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant. **(10)**

[2021] Besides domain knowledge, a public official needs innovativeness and creativity of a high order as well, while resolving ethical dilemmas. Discuss with suitable examples. (10)

[2022] Write short notes on the following in 30 words each : (10)

(i) Constitutional morality

(ii) Conflict of interest

(iii) Probity in public life

(iv) Challenges of digitalization

(v) Devotion to duty

[2024] Mission Karmayogi is aiming for maintaining a very high standard of conduct and behaviour to ensure efficiency for serving citizens and in turn developing oneself. How will this scheme empower the civil servants in enhancing productive efficiency and delivering the services at the grassroots level ? (10)

[2018] "In doing a good thing, everything is permitted which is not prohibited expressly or by clear implication". Examine the statement with suitable examples in the context of a public servant discharging his/her duties. **(10)**

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[2024] "Mindless addiction to Form, ignoring the Substance of the matter, results in rendering injustice. A perceptive civil servant is one who ignores such literalness and carries out true intent." Examine the above statement with suitable illustrations. (10)

[2022] Wisdom lies in knowing what to reckon with and what to overlook. An officer being engrossed with the periphery, ignoring the core issues before him, is not rare in the bureaucracy. Do you agree that such preoccupation of an administrator leads to travesty of justice to the cause of effective service delivery and good governance? Critically evaluate. **(10)**

[2025] "For any kind of social re-engineering by successfully implementing welfare schemes, a civil servant must use reason and critical thinking in an ethical framework." Justify this statement with suitable examples. (10)

[2025] To achieve holistic development goals, a civil servant acts as an enabler and active facilitator of growth rather than a regulator. What specific measures will you suggest to achieve this goal? (10)

[2019] What is meant by 'crisis of conscience'? How does it manifest itself in the public domain? **(10)**

[2023] Is conscience a more reliable guide when compared to laws, rules and regulations in the context of ethical decision making ? Discuss. **(10)**

[2021] Impact of digital technology as a reliable source of input for rational decision making is a debatable issue. Critically evaluate with suitable examples. **(10)**

[2022] What do you understand by the term 'good governance'? How far have recent initiatives in terms of e-Governance steps taken by the State have helped the beneficiaries? Discuss with suitable examples. (10)

[2022] Online methodology is being used for day-to-day meetings, institutional approvals in the administration and for teaching and learning in the education sector to the extent telemedicine in the health sector is getting popular with the approvals of the competent authority. No doubt it has advantages and disadvantages for both the beneficiaries and the system at large. Describe and discuss the ethical issues involved in the use of online methods particularly to vulnerable sections of society. (10)

[2024] The application of Artificial Intelligence as a dependable source of input for administrative rational decision-making is a debatable issue. Critically examine the statement from the ethical point of view. (10)

[2026] A business house is working on a project that could displace a forest community from their habitat. As the administrative officer of that district, what ethical challenges are you likely to face? (10)

[2026] In what ways can an Indian Administrative Officer apply Gandhi's notion of 'trusteeship' to ensure fairness in governance? (10)

[2026] Shakespeare in Henry IV says, "The arms are fair when the intent of bearing them is just". What ethical implications does this have in governance? (10)

[2026] Usually schools, working in remote areas, do not fully comply with government regulations. However, if the rules are enforced strictly, it would lead to most schools closing down. How should an administrator strike a balance between enforcement of rules and educational rights of children? (10)

[2026] On the request of his Personal Assistant (PA), the District Magistrate (DM) stops the transfer of a schoolteacher who takes private tuition for his daughter diagnosed with learning disability. In this context, discuss the aspects of empathy versus compliance with rules. (10)

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Concept of Public Service

Public service is a type of service provided by the government to residents within its jurisdiction, either directly (through public sector organizations) or indirectly (by funding service provision).

Conceptual Roots of Public Service

1. **Social Contract Theory - Philosophers like Hobbes, Locke, and Rousseau proposed that government is a contract between the state and its people. Public servants are duty-bound to act in the collective interest of society.**
2. **Constitutional Morality - Values like justice, equality, liberty, fraternity, and dignity of the individual form the ethical bedrock.**
3. **Democratic Accountability - Civil servants act as agents of the public will**, and governance must be transparent, participatory, and responsive.
4. **Rule of Law and Neutrality - The Weberian model emphasizes legal-rational authority, objectivity, and impersonal rules.**
5. **Ethics of Care and Empathy - Rooted in the principle of Antyodaya** - serving the last person first (inspired by Gandhi and Lohia).
6. **Utilitarianism and Welfare - Thinkers like Jeremy Bentham and J.S. Mill promoted the idea of public service as a way to maximize happiness for the greatest number.**
7. **Spiritual and Cultural Roots (Indian Context) - Ancient texts like the Bhagavad Gita emphasize selfless duty (Nishkama Karma). Kautilya's Arthashastra outlined Rajadharma.**

Characteristics of Public Service

Institutional & Structural Characteristics

1. **Welfare and Non-Profit Orientation:** Prioritizes social well-being, equity, and human development over commercial profitability. Eg. MGNREGA implementation
2. **Constitutional and Legal Subservience:** Mandates that every administrative action must trace its legitimacy to statutory law.
3. **Multifaceted Accountability and Oversight:** decisions answerable to the Legislature, Judiciary, CAG, CVC, and the RTI Act.
4. **Anonymity and Neutrality:** Empowers civil servants to provide frank, data-driven advice without fear of backlash.
5. **Monopolistic Sovereign Mandate:** Manages public goods and critical services that cannot be left to market forces. Eg. SEBI regulation of stock markets

Behavioral & Ethical Characteristics

1. **Integrity and Public Trust**
2. **Impartiality and Non-Partisanship**
3. **Objectivity and Evidence-Based Choice**
4. **Empathy and Compassion**
5. **Proactive Openness and Transparency**

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Changing Nature of Public Services (same for public administration)

Dimension	Traditional Public Service Values	Emerging Public Service Values	Example
Orientation	Rule-bound, process-focused	Outcome-based, citizen-centric	**Aspirational Districts Programme ranking**
Bureaucratic Style	Hierarchical, rigid, and command-and-control	Collaborative, flexible, and participatory	**Social Audits under MGNREGA**
Decision-Making	Based on procedures and precedence	Based on data, innovation, and responsiveness	**GATI Shakti Masterplan**
Accountability	Internal and upward (to superiors/government)	External and downward (to citizens and stakeholders)	**Citizen Charters**
Transparency	Limited disclosure, secrecy-driven	Open data, proactive disclosure, and RTI-based transparency	
Public Involvement	Passive beneficiaries of government schemes	Active engagement through feedback, consultation, co-production	**Jan Sunwais**
Service Delivery	Uniform and centralized	Targeted, customized, and decentralized	
Values Focus	Discipline, neutrality, obedience	Empathy, responsiveness, and social justice	**From Karmachari to Karmayogi**
Human Relations	Impersonal, formal interaction	Emotionally intelligent, ethical, and people-oriented	
Ethical Emphasis	Loyalty to the system, adherence to rules	Integrity, compassion, inclusion, and constitutional morality	
Training and Development	Static, initial entry-level training	Continuous learning	**Mission Karmayogi**

Public Services Bill, 2007

Public Services Bill, 2007 was introduced to enhance the **efficiency and efficacy of public services** in India. It aims to establish a framework that allows civil and police officers to operate **without interference or fear of persecution**, ensuring they can act impartially and ethically.

Objectives

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- To set up a **Public Service Code** for good governance, promoting **integrity and efficiency** in public services.
- To enforce public service ethics by subjecting breaches to legally defined penalties.

Provisions of the Bill

- **Central Public Service Authority:** Proposed as the **apex agency** to oversee coordination, control, and structural reforms within public services.
- The **Central Government** is required to consult the Central Authority on public service matters, especially on **ethics, public service codes**, and management strategies.
- **Public Service Values**
  - **Allegiance to the Constitution**
  - **Apolitical Functioning:** Serve impartially, objectively, and fairly.
  - **Integrity and High Standards**
  - **Accountability:** Be responsible for decisions.
  - **Merit-Based Employment**
  - **Duty without Discrimination**
  - **Impartial Advice:** Offer honest and unbiased guidance.
  - **Economical Use of Resources:** Avoid wastage in expenditure.
- **Performance Management Code:** Designed to address **developmental and management needs** while promoting **accountability and professionalism**.
- **Cadre Controlling Authority:** Proposed to review functions of bodies like **UPSC** and **CVC**, granting them more authority over service rules and grievance redress mechanisms.

Public Administration

Public Administration is the **systematic management** of public programs and policies, focusing on the execution of governmental functions for **societal welfare.**

1. It includes **planning, organising, coordinating,** and **controlling public resources** to achieve **societal goals** and serve the **community's interests**.
2. Public administration encompasses **policy development, budgeting, personnel management, public service delivery,** and **regulatory oversight**.

Sources and determinants of Ethics in Public Administration

1. **Historical Factors:** Legacies of unethical behavior like impersonalization, rigidity, mai baap culture etc increase **tolerance for immorality**.
2. **Constitutional and Legal Sources**
   a. **Constitution of India**: **justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity** (Preamble), Article 14 (Equality before law), Article 21 (Right to life), and DPSPs offer ethical direction.
   b. **Service Conduct Rules**: All India Services Conduct Rules, 1968
   c. **Statutory Acts**: Prevention of Corruption Act, RTI Act, Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, Whistleblower Protection Act ensure ethical compliance.
3. **Institutional and Administrative Sources**
   a. **Code of Ethics / Code of Conduct**: Recommended by the **2nd ARC** to standardize ethical norms in civil services.
   b. **Organizational Culture**: the values practiced by leadership define the operational norm.
   c. **Institutional Checks and Balances** - Robust functioning of watchdogs like the **CVC, CAG, Lokpal**, and an active Judiciary directly curtails systemic corruption.

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4. **Personal and Psychological Sources**
    a. **Conscience and Moral Compass**: One's inner voice, shaped by **family, education, and personal reflection**, guides moral action.
    b. **Role Models**: Ethical public servants like **T.N. Seshan, E. Sreedharan, Armstrong Pame** inspire imitation through their actions.
5. **Public Accountability - Eg. Social audits** under the **MGNREGA** scheme.
6. **Media and Civil Society - Eg.** Investigative journalism uncovering corruption cases like the **2G spectrum scam**.
7. **Technological Advancements - Eg. Direct Benefit Transfers (DBTs)** minimize leakages.
8. **Philosophical Sources of Ethical Guidance**

Indian

a. **Bhagavad Gita** - Nishkama Karma, Dharma (duty), and detachment from personal gains.
b. **Gandhian Ethics** - Truth, non-violence, swaraj, sarvodaya, and trusteeship.
c. **Buddhism & Jainism** - Emphasize compassion, non-violence, and self-restraint.
d. **Kautilya's Arthashastra** - Promotes Rajadharma, welfare state, and accountability of rulers.

Western

e. **Aristotle** - Virtue ethics: excellence through character and moral habit.
f. **Immanuel Kant** - Duty-based ethics: acting from a sense of moral obligation.
g. **J.S. Mill & Bentham** - Utilitarianism: maximizing welfare of the greatest number.
h. **John Rawls** - Justice as fairness, equality of opportunity, and equity.
i. **Paul Appleby's "Democratic Morality"** - implies that civil servants are **agents of the people**, accountable to constitutional and ethical mandates & not just technical efficiency.
j. **Max Weber's "Bureaucratic Morality** - **Merit-based recruitment, objectivity**, and **loyalty to the legal order** are central to Weberian ethics.

Basic Characteristics of Public Administration

1. **Public Service Orientation -** Aimed at delivering public goods and services. Eg. **PM Jan Dhan Yojana** promotes financial inclusion
2. **Governmental in Nature -** Operates as an integral part of the government structure. Encompasses both policy-making and policy implementation.
3. **Financial Management -** Eg. **Public Financial Management System (PFMS)** tracks government fund allocation and utilization.
4. **Interdisciplinary Nature -** Draws from various fields such as political science, economics, sociology, and law and encourages a holistic approach to governance.
5. **Rule-Bound -** Functions within a framework of laws, regulations, and guidelines.
6. **Hierarchy -** Follows a structured chain of command and authority. Eg. The **IAS structure**, with District Magistrates under Chief Secretaries
7. **Impersonal -** Operates on principles of neutrality and objectivity. Ensures decisions are based on merit rather than personal preferences.
8. **Accountability -** Responsible to the public, elected representatives, and higher administrative authorities. Eg. **CAG audits**
9. **Specialization and Expertise -** Relies on specialized skills and knowledge for efficient service delivery. Encourages division of labor and professional development.
10. **Political Neutrality -** Maintains impartiality in decision-making and implementation. Ensures stability and continuity regardless of political changes.

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Need For Ethics In Public Administration

1. **Control Administrative Discretion:** Internal moral boundaries prevent extensive official powers from devolving into arbitrary favoritism and corruption.
2. **Bridge Citizen-State Trust Deficit:** Ethical conduct humanizes the colonial-style bureaucracy, fostering widespread civic cooperation and compliance.
3. **Fulfill Welfare State Mandates:** Developing democracies require active empathy over clinical rule-following to uplift historical outcasts. Eg. **S. R. Sankaran** leading state enforcement for bonded labor abolition.
4. **Guide Officers Through Ethical Dilemmas:** Ethics provide a reliable internal compass when competing public values or choices collide.
5. **Anchor Policy Advice in Objectivity:** Moral integrity prevents data manipulation and biased policy briefs tailored to please political masters.
6. Deeply anchored values empower bureaucrats to withstand **illegal verbal commands or punitive transfer threats.** Eg. **T. N. Seshan** strictly enforcing the election MCC
7. **Financial integrity** prevents leakages, maximizing the reach of vital welfare funds to citizens. Eg. **E. Sreedharan** delivered the Delhi Metro project completely under budget.
8. **Eradicate Bureaucratic Apathy:** Value-driven governance prevents officials from passively hiding behind red tape while citizens suffer.
9. **Build Resilient Truth-Telling Environments:** An ethical institutional culture actively values internal dissent and shields honest whistleblowers from victimization.
10. **Uphold Constitutional Morality:** Ethics remind officials that their ultimate loyalty belongs to permanent constitutional values over transient regimes.
11. **Social Capital**: Builds **credibility** and **cooperation** with civil society and strengthens the bond between administration and citizens for effective **policy implementation**.

Challenges of Public Service and Public Administration

1. **Lack of Accountability:** Protections under **Article 311** reduce disciplinary enforcement and limited **whistleblower protection** leaves informants vulnerable to retaliation.
2. **Corruption and Lack of Integrity - rent-seeking behavior** in Indian bureaucracy contributes to governance inefficiencies and corruption. **Eg.** PDS leakages
3. **Politicization of Bureaucracy** - erodes **bureaucratic neutrality**, leads to short tenures and loyalty-based appointments. **Eg.** Frequent transfers of honest officers like **Ashok Khemka** and **Durga Shakti Nagpal**
4. **Inefficiency and Red Tape** - The **"chalta hai" attitude** results in **lack of accountability** and poor efficiency. **Eg.** delays in file clearances
5. **Limited Ethical Awareness**: administrators rely only on rule books without considering **cultural, social,** and **environmental factors** in decision-making.
6. **Poor Citizen-Centric Approach** - Insensitivity towards the poor and vulnerable leads to **alienation**. **Eg.** Denial of food rations due to **Aadhar linkage errors** in Jharkhand.
7. **Inadequate Training and Capacity Building** - Lack of regular ethics, digital, and soft-skills training leads to outdated functioning.
8. **Resistance to Change and Innovation** - Bureaucratic inertia stifles reforms and prevents adoption of technology. **Eg.** Delay in implementing **e-governance**
9. **Disregard for Rule of Law - Eg.** Use of **Section 144 or preventive detention** in non-violent protests
10. **Ethical Dilemmas** - Officers often face **conflict between following rules vs. doing good**.
11. **Misuse of Discretionary Powers**: leads to **favoritism** and conflict of interest.

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Recent cases of Problematic, Unethical, Or Corrupt Civil Servants:

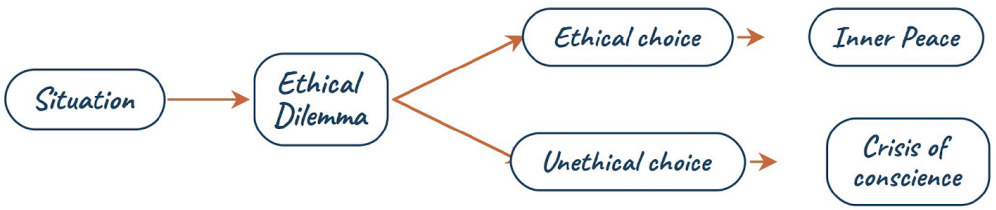
- **Puja Khedkar (IAS):** Discharged from service for forging medical and OBC disability credentials.
- **Subodh Agarwal (IAS):** Arrested by the Anti-Corruption Bureau for manipulating high-value tender processes within the multi-crore **Jal Jeevan Mission scam**.
- **Vinay Kumar Choubey (IAS):** Sent to judicial custody following an Anti-Corruption Bureau arrest over a multi-crore liquor syndicate excise scam.
- **Harcharan Singh Bhullar (IPS):** Arrested by the CBI in a direct trap for demanding cash bribes to settle pending police cases.
- **Pradeep Sharma (IAS):** Sentenced to five years in prison for misusing official positions to orchestrate illegal land allotments.
- **Vijay Dahiya (IAS):** Arrested by the state Anti-Corruption Bureau for demanding financial kickbacks to clear official department files.
- **Dharmender Singh (IAS):** illegally inflating a municipal corporation construction tender

OECD's Eight Key Components for Creating a Strong Ethical Administrative Framework

- **Effective Legal Framework:** A strong **legal structure** should address **unethical practices** like **breach of trust, abuse of power**, and **corruption**.
- **Political Commitment: Ethical political leadership** fosters an ethical environment, inspiring **civil servants** and reinforcing integrity through **role modeling**.
- **Active Civil Society:** A vibrant **civil society** with **freedom of speech** and **independent media** plays a vital role in exposing corruption and holding officials **accountable**.
- **Central Ethics Coordinating Body:** ensuring adherence and offering **guidance** to public officials.
- **Conducive Public Service Conditions:** Fair **salary, promotion**, and **transfer** conditions improve **morale** and attract talent.
- **Clear codes of conduct** with **core ethical values** guide acceptable behavior.
- **Efficient Accountability Mechanisms to** detect and punish unethical acts

Ethical Dilemmas in Civil Services

An **ethical dilemma** is a complex situation of severe moral conflict where an administrator must choose between two or more competing, valid moral imperatives



Conditions Leading to Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Presence of Conflicting Moral Principles:** Occurs when two distinct ethical values are equally legitimate. Eg. **strict rule adherence** Vs **empathy and compassion**
2. **No Clear Right or Wrong Answer:** Situations where multiple choices have equally valid ethical justifications, rendering standard codebooks obsolete.
3. **Mutually Exclusive Choices:** Eg. Directing limited state developmental funds to either **primary education** or **rural healthcare**.

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4. **Personal Responsibility for Decision:** The administrator cannot delegate or escape the accountability of the final chosen action and its moral fallout.
5. **Significant Consequences:** Eg. Executing massive tribal displacement for **mega-dam industrial projects**.
6. **Moral Reasoning Required:** Eg. Deciding whether to act as an internal **whistleblower against senior leadership**.

Major Ethical Dilemmas in Public Services

1. **Utilitarianism vs. Deontology/ right vs right dilemma** - sacrificing a unique, irreplaceable ecosystem for the "greater good" of national security.
2. **Efficiency vs. Accountability:** Meeting urgent administrative timelines versus fulfilling lengthy statutory transparency audits.
3. **Anonymity vs. Public Recognition:** Eg. Civil servants running **viral personal social media channels** to showcase official work.
4. **Personal Benefit vs Public Gain (Conflict of interest):** Eg. In the **Adarsh Housing Society Scam**
5. **Compassion vs. Rule of Law:** Eg. Deciding whether to **provide food rations** to an elderly citizen lacking biometric verification.
6. **Professional Loyalty vs. Whistleblowing:** Protecting institutional solidarity versus exposing massive internal financial irregularities to public watchdogs.
7. **Development vs. Environmental Conservation:** Fast-tracking industrial growth for job creation versus preserving pristine ecological balances.
8. **Political Neutrality vs. Executive Compliance:** Providing objective, apolitical advice versus succumbing to unwritten, highly partisan ministerial instructions.
9. **Public Interest vs. Commercial Profitability:** Eg. Setting public transit tariff rates within **PPP metro railway projects**.
10. **Right to Privacy vs. National Security:** Protecting citizen data secrecy versus deploying mass surveillance to deter active threats. Eg. use of Pegasus software
11. **Transparency vs. Administrative Confidentiality:** Proactively sharing data under the RTI Act versus safeguarding strategic secrets of state operations.
12. **Freedom of Speech vs. Public Order:** Upholding democratic protest rights versus executing preventive detentions to avoid riots.
13. **Organizational Discipline vs. Freedom of Conscience:** Obeying a lawful superior order that directly violates your personal convictions. Eg. **slum demolition drive** during harsh winters.
14. **Personal Family Safety vs. Strict Public Duty:** Eg. Leading major crackdowns against **powerful localized illegal mining mafias**.
15. **Limited Resources and Prioritization:** Dilemmas arise when **limited resources** require prioritizing **programs** or **services** for public welfare.
16. **Non-Discrimination vs Preferential Treatment**
17. **Centralized vs Decentralized Approach:** Balancing **central control** for consistency with **local autonomy** for flexibility.
18. **Speed vs Accuracy:** Eg. Media chasing **breaking news (speed)** often conflicts with delivering **verified facts (accuracy)**.

Impact of Ethical Dilemmas on Civil Servant Performance

1. **Decision-Making Paralysis:** Eg. **Delayed environmental clearances** for critical highway links.
2. **Psychological Stress and Burnout:** Constant friction between personal conscience and systemic pressures causes deep moral injury and cognitive fatigue.

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3. **Erosion of Administrative Innovation:** hyper-rigid, passive red-tapism to escape personal accountability.
4. **Subversion of Welfare Efficiency**
5. **Loss of Public Institutional Trust**
6. **Defensive Bureaucracy Syndrome:** Eg. Officers spending months on **superfluous inter-departmental file-passing**.
7. **Increased Susceptibility to External Coercion:** Unresolved moral conflicts weaken an officer's resilience, making them vulnerable to political or corporate blackmail.
8. **Erosion of Long-Term Career Commitment**

Process of Resolving Ethical Dilemmas

1. **Identification of the Ethical Issue** - clearly define the conflicting values and recognize the stakes for all parties involved is the primary step.
2. **Information Gathering** - collect all relevant data, consult subject matter experts, and understand the ground reality of the situation.
3. **Analyzing the Legal Framework - The decision must first pass the test of Legality.**
4. **Applying Ethical Frameworks for evaluating options**
   a. **Utilitarianism**- Which choice brings the "greatest good for the greatest number"?
   b. **Deontology**- What is my absolute "Duty" as a public servant?
   c. **Social Justice (Rawls)**- Does this decision benefit the "least advantaged" member of society?
   d. The "**middle path**" to balance the extremes.
5. **Assess the impact** of various options on different stakeholders.
6. **Final Decision and Review** - After choosing the most ethical path, the official should implement the decision and monitor its impact for course correction.

Approaches to Deal with Ethical Dilemmas

- **Legal-Rational Approach:** Prioritizes strict adherence to codified laws and constitutional provisions to ensure uniform rule of law.
- **Utilitarian Approach:** Selects the specific administrative path that maximizes the greatest good for the maximum number of citizens.
- **Deontological Approach:** Focuses entirely on the inherent rightness of the action, upholding official public duty regardless of consequences.
- **Virtue Ethics Approach:** Relies on the internal moral character and personal integrity of the administrator to navigate complex institutional gray areas.
- **Gandhian Talisman & Sarvodaya Approach:** Tests whether the proposed administrative action actively uplifts and empowers the poorest, most vulnerable individual.
- **Human Rights Approach:** Sets individual human dignity and fundamental constitutional liberties as non-negotiable boundaries that state policy cannot cross.
- **Social Justice Approach:** Designs resource distribution frameworks to maximize benefits specifically for the least advantaged segments of the community.

Ethical Dilemmas in Private Institutions

- **Profit Maximization vs. Environmental Sustainability/Social responsibility**
- **Executive Compensation vs. Worker Wage Equity:** Eg. High-profile tech firms **freezing entry-level salaries** while hiking CEO payouts.

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- **Whistleblower Protection vs. Corporate Reputation:** Eg. Systemic organizational retaliation against **Infosys whistleblower complaints**.
- **Data Monetization vs. Consumer Privacy Mandates:** Capitalizing on lucrative user data profiling models versus respecting fundamental data autonomy and consent frameworks.
- **Related Party Transactions vs. Minority Shareholder Rights:** Eg. **Adani-Hindenburg probe** regarding offshore shell entity transactions.
- **Aggressive Tax Avoidance vs. CSR:** Deploying complex offshore tax heavens to legally bypass tax liability while publicizing cosmetic charity projects.
- **Product Safety vs. Supply-Chain Cost Reductions:** using cheaper raw materials by cutting critical quality testing corners. Eg. bans on **Maggi noodles over lead contamination**.
- **Greenwashing vs. Honest ESG Disclosures**
- **Credit Default vs. Public Banking Health:** Eg. **Vijay Mallya and Nirav Modi** banking fraud escapes.
- **Employee Welfare vs. Cost Cutting** - Eg. Mass layoffs during economic downturns despite profitable quarters.
- **Marketing Ethics** - Promoting products ethically versus aggressive marketing for higher sales.

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Conflict of Interest (COI)

A **conflict of interest** occurs when a public servant's **personal interests** conflict with their **official duties**, potentially compromising **impartial decision-making**

"A civil servant must not only be clean but must also appear to be clean." - N. Vittal (Former CVC of India)

"The best way to resolve a conflict of interest is to avoid it altogether."

Types of Conflict of Interest

1. **Actual Conflict of Interest**: An **existing conflict** where a person's duties clash with personal interests.
2. **Perceived Conflict of Interest**: When a situation **appears to be a conflict** to others, even if it may not directly affect decisions.
3. **Potential Conflict of Interest**: A **possible future conflict** where personal interests could eventually affect decision-making.

Manifestations of Conflict of Interest:

1. **Financial Interests**: **Eg**: Awarding contracts to a company where the official or their family has a **financial interest**.
2. **Personal Relationships**: **Eg**: Favoring a **friend's business** in the allocation of resources.
3. **Post-Employment Concerns**: Known as the **"revolving door"** issue, where obligations or financial ties after leaving public service may affect actions **while in office**.
4. **Role Duality** - Simultaneously holding two roles that have competing interests, such as being a regulator in one capacity and a consultant in another.
5. **Moonlighting** - When an individual engages in outside work that conflicts with their primary professional duties, potentially leading to divided loyalties or reduced effectiveness.
6. **Use of Confidential Information for Personal Gain** - Eg. Using pre-budget policy details for stock trading.
7. **Dual Roles** - Eg. office of profit issue

6R Approach to Resolve COI

1) **Register** :- Full declaration, openness, disclosure
2) **Restrict** :- Limit one's participation
3) **Recruit** :- A third party, independent auditor
4) **Removal** :- Suspension / go for leave
5) **Relinquish** :- Personal interest, e.g. sale of property
6) **Resign** :- From organisation or political party, for impartiality

Addressing Conflicts of Interest:

1. **Mandatory Disclosure of Assets (2nd ARC)**
2. **Cooling-off Period**
3. **Code of Ethics and office of Ethics Commissioner**
4. **Institutionalized "Conflict of Interest" Registers**
5. **Integrity Pacts**
6. **Establishing Clear Legal Frameworks** to define, identify, and penalize CoI.
7. **Institutional Mechanisms for Recusal**

Global best Practices

- **United States - Office of Government Ethics (OGE)** - Mandatory financial disclosures, **prohibition on accepting gifts, favors, or employment offers** from related entities.
- **Canada - Conflict of Interest Act - Independent Ethics Commissioner** monitors compliance with CoI rules.
- **OECD Guidelines on Managing Conflict of Interest - disclosure registries, codes of conduct**, and **independent ethics oversight bodies**.

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Laws, Rules, and Regulations as Sources of Ethical Guidance

Laws, rules, and regulations establish a **framework for acceptable behavior**, defining **legal boundaries** and promoting **fairness**, **justice**, and the **protection of rights** for individuals and society.

Laws are formal, written rules and principles established by governing authorities to regulate behavior, maintain order, resolve disputes, and protect rights and freedoms within a society.

- "Where morality fails, law begins; where law is silent, ethics must prevail."
- In law a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so. - **Immanuel Kant**
- In matters of conscience, the law of the majority has no place. - **Mahatma Gandhi**
- Without law men are beasts. - **Maxwell Anderson**

Thomas Aquinas defined **law** as "a rule and measure of acts" guiding individuals to act or refrain from acting. He identified four types of law:

- **Eternal Law**: Eg. laws governing **planetary motion**, **energy flow**, and **matter**.
- **Divine Law**: revealed to humans through **sacred texts**, like the **Bible**, and **Bhagavad Gita**
- **Natural Law**: encompasses **universal moral principles**, such as "do good and avoid evil,"
- **Human Law**: formulated by **human reason** to suit specific **social, historical,** and **geographical contexts**.

Difference between Laws and Rules

Aspect	Laws	Rules	Regulations
Definition	Laws are formal **legal statutes enacted by the legislature** (Parliament or State Assembly).	Rules are **subordinate instruments** framed to provide details for implementation of laws.	Regulations are **standards or directives** issued by regulatory bodies to control specific activities.
Purpose	To **establish the legal framework** and grant powers	To **specify procedures, forms, conduct** under the law	To **ensure compliance**, monitor performance, and impose conditions
Scope	Broad in scope - defines **rights, duties, offences, and procedures**	Narrower - deals with **technical or procedural aspects**	Focused - applies to specific **industries or functions**
Authority	Made by **Legislature**	Made by **Executive or delegated authorities**	Made by **Regulatory agencies or statutory bodies** (Eg. RBI, SEBI)

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Aspect	Laws	Rules	Regulations
Amendment Process	Requires **legislative procedure** (debate, vote, assent)	Can be **amended by executive notification**	Can be modified by the regulatory authority itself under statutory mandate
Example	Right to Information Act, 2005	RTI Rules, 2012 (framed by DoPT under the Act)	SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015

Laws, Rules, and Regulations as a Source of Ethical Guidance

1. **Ensures Objectivity and Uniformity:** Codified rules remove personal, subjective moral biases, creating a predictable and standard baseline for all administrative actions.
2. **Aligns Administration with Constitutional Values:** Eg. **RTI Act** materializing the democratic ideal of transparency.
3. **Checks Arbitrary Use of Power:** Eg. **Prevention of Corruption Act** criminalizing public servant bribery.
4. **Establishes Clear Legal Accountability:** Written regulations pin down specific personal responsibilities, making it easy to identify and penalize deviations. Eg. **CAG financial audits**
5. **Protects Weak and Marginalized Segments:** Eg. **SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act** enforcing special protections.
6. **Provides Safety Against Political Coercion:** Eg. **Central Civil Services (Conduct) Rules** guarding administrative neutrality.
7. **Resolves Administrative Ambiguity During Crises:** Clear Standard Operating Procedures offer an immediate action pipeline in **Disaster Management**
8. **Institutionalizes Evolving Public Morality:** Eg. **Maternity Benefit Act amendments** protecting working women's rights.
9. **Builds Predictable Public Trust:** Eg. Transparent timelines under **State Right to Service Acts**.
10. **Minimizes Systemic Conflict of Interest:** Eg. **Representation of the People Act** mandating asset disclosures.

Why Not All Laws Can Serve as Ethical Guidance

1. **Relativity in Laws**: **Eg**: **Marijuana use** is legal in parts of the USA but considered unethical in India.
2. **Inconsistency in Laws**: **Eg**: **Attempted suicide** is treated differently across countries, leading to ethical confusion.
3. **Lack of Updation with Time**: Outdated laws may clash with **modern values** and democratic principles. **Eg**: **Section 124A (Sedition law)**.
4. **Not All Laws are Just**: Some laws lack **moral foundation** and violate human rights. **Eg**: **Taliban laws** restrict women's freedoms, Myanmar denies **Rohingya citizenship**.
5. **Minimalist Approach**: Coercive enforcement may not yield ethical change, as people exploit **legal loopholes**. **Eg**: Corporations use **tax laws** to legally avoid taxes.
6. **Community over Individual**: Some laws prioritize society over **individual rights**, compromising personal freedoms. **Eg**: **Marital rape** isn't criminalized in India.

Limitations of Laws, Rules, and Regulations as Sources of Ethical Guidance

1. **Breeds Cold Bureaucratic Red-Tapism:** Eg. **Denying emergency food rations** due to biometric mismatches.

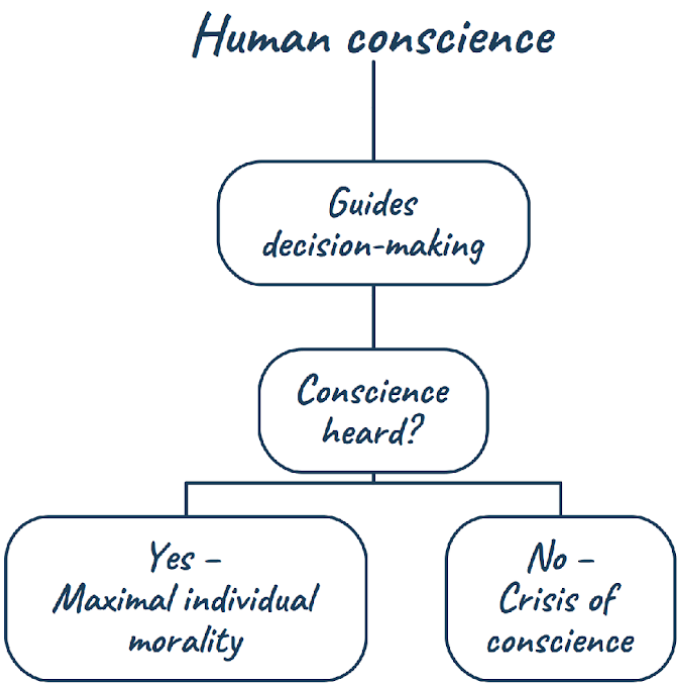
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2. **Incapable of Handling Novel Scenarios:** Eg. Lack of dynamic frameworks governing **Generative AI data privacy deepfakes**.
3. **Promotes a Minimalist "Box-Ticking" Culture:** Eg. Doing **token CSR spendings** solely for legal compliance.
4. **Rules Can Be Inherently Unjust:** Eg. **Marital rape** isn't criminalized in India.
5. **Fails to Govern the Inner Conscience:** Laws can modify outward human compliance through punitive fear, but they cannot cultivate genuine, internal moral integrity.
6. **Letter of Law Subverts the Spirit:** Eg. Designing **tailor-made eligibility criteria** for favored corporate tenders.
7. **Rigid legal framework** prevents empathetic exceptions. Eg. Evicting street vendors during **stringent urban beautification drives**.
8. **Encourages Passing of Personal Accountability:** Eg. Citing **complex multi-layered departmental approvals** for medical shortage deaths.

Conscience as Sources of Ethical Guidance

Conscience is the "inner voice" or the internal moral sense of what is right or wrong in one's conduct.

"There is a higher court than courts of justice and that is the court of conscience. It supersedes all other courts." - **Mahatma Gandhi**



Conscience as a Reliable Guide

1. Conscience addresses the **"spirit" of justice** where the "letter" of the law may be silent, outdated, or inhumane. Eg. Civil disobedience movement by **Gandhiji**
2. **Addressing the "Legal Vacuum"-** Laws cannot predict every future scenario. In these situations, conscience is the only navigator.
3. **Humanizing Bureaucracy-** While rules are rigid, conscience provides the empathy needed for substantive justice.
4. **Upholding Scientific Responsibility-** Eg. **Robert Oppenheimer** faced crisis of conscience after the atomic bomb's use, leading him to advocate for international nuclear control.
5. **Whistleblowing against Corporate Fraud (moral courage) -** Eg. **Sherron Watkins** exposed the Enron scandal.
6. **Guide for social and legal reforms-** Eg. **Martin Luther King's** fight for Civil Rights Act.
7. **Environmental Stewardship-** Laws often lag behind ecological destruction. Eg. **Sunderlal Bahuguna** led the Chipko Movement based on a conscience-driven duty to protect nature.
8. **Integrity in Sports** ("fair play") - Eg. Sachin Tendulkar walking off before the umpire gives a decision.
9. **Handling Political Pressure-** Eg. **Ashok Khemka** has prioritized his conscience over political convenience, resulting in over 50 transfers.

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10. In **conflict zones** where local laws are absent, conscience remains the sole guide. Eg. **Malala Yousafzai**'s campaign for girls' education despite Taliban ban.
11. **Prevents moral blindness**. Eg. Oskar Schindler saved Jews despite Nazi laws.

Challenges with conscience as a guide

1. **Subjectivity**. Eg. Extremists justify violence as a moral duty.
2. **Cultural bias**. Eg. Honour killings defended as conscience by communities.
3. **Moral relativism**. Eg. Different consciences produce conflicting actions.
4. **Conflict with rule of law**. Eg. Mob lynching violates "justice as fairness"
5. **Inconsistency**- Personal morals change across time and contexts.
6. **The "Slippery Slope"**- Once an official starts bypassing rules for "good" reasons, it becomes easier to bypass them for "convenient" or "bad" reasons later.

Manifestation of crisis of conscience

1. **Whistleblowing against Corruption-** conflict between "loyalty to the organization" and "duty to the public" triggers a crisis.
2. **Implementation of Unjust Policies-** Eg. implementing order for eviction of slum dwellers during a harsh winter without a rehabilitation plan.
3. **Conflict between Rule of Law and Compassion-** Eg. Denying a starving, elderly woman her rations because her biometrics failed to authenticate.
4. **Political Pressure on Neutrality-** Eg. An officer being asked to manipulate environmental impact data to favor an industrial project.
5. **Medical Ethics in Public Healthcare-** Eg. Medical triage decisions
6. **Journalists** reporting on sensitive issues like human rights violations face a clash between **"patriotism" and "truth."**
7. **Environmental Protection vs. Development-** Eg. **Aarey Forest case** in Mumbai
8. **Institutional loyalty vs public interest-** When statisticians are pressured to "under-report" inflation or unemployment figures to suit a government's narrative.
9. **Confidentiality vs. Public Safety-** When an official knows a "state secret" that involves a threat to public health but is ordered to remain silent.
10. **Efficiency vs justice** or Speedy action vs due process. Eg. Bulldozer demolitions.
11. **Security vs rights** - Eg. Internet shutdowns in J&K
12. **Career risk vs ethical stand** - Eg. **Sanjiv Chaturvedi (IFS)** facing transfers for exposing corruption in AIIMS and HRD Ministry.
13. **Majoritarian demand vs minority rights** - Public pressure conflicting with constitutional morality. Eg. Sabrimala case

Principles guiding resolving crisis of conscience

1. **Constitutional morality as the bridge** - Align personal conscience with constitutional values like justice, liberty and equality.
2. **Ethics training for public officials** under Mission **Karmayogi.**
3. Updation of laws with evolving ethical standards. Eg. DPDP Act
4. **Discretion** should be subject to transparency and review.
5. **Institutional ethical safeguards** - Ethics committees, ombudsmen and judicial oversight

Step-by-Step Process to Solve a Crisis of Conscience

1. **Isolate the Core Moral Conflict:** Clearly define the deep mismatch between your internal moral values, and the external institutional directive.

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2. **Check Legal Boundaries and Public Interest:** Eg. Verifying the **Forest Rights Act provisions** before executing any eviction orders.
3. **Apply the Gandhian Talisman:** Evaluate your available choices & choose the path that protects the weakest individual and preserves your inner character.
4. **Consult Trusted Mentors and Historical Precedents**
5. **Execute with Fortitude and Document Transparently:** Eg. Writing a formal, data-backed **dissent note on the official file** before refusing an illegal directive.

By aligning actions with the **"higher court of conscience,"** a public official can ensure **human-centric, just, and truly democratic** governance.

CIVILSDAILY IAS

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Chapter 8

Probity In Governance

PYQs

[2025] It is said that for an ethical work culture, there must be code of ethics in place in every organisation. To ensure value-based and compliance-based work culture, what suitable measures would you adopt in your work place? (10)

[2025] India is an emerging economic power of the world as it has recently secured the status of fourth largest economy of the world as per IMF projection. However, it has been observed that in some sectors, allocated funds remain either under-utilised or misutilised. What specific measures would you recommend for ensuring accountability in this regard to stop leakages and gaining the status of third largest economy of the world in near future? (10)

[2024] "In Indian culture and value system, an equal opportunity has been provided irrespective of gender identity. The number of women in public service has been steadily increasing over the years." Examine the gender-specific challenges faced by female public servants and suggest suitable measures to increase their efficiency in discharging their duties and maintaining high standards of probity. (10)

[2024] 'The 'Code of Conduct' and 'Code of Ethics' are the sources of guidance in public administration. There is a code of conduct already in operation, whereas a code of ethics is not yet put in place. Suggest a suitable model for code of ethics to maintain integrity, probity and transparency in governance. (10)

[2023] 'Probity is essential for an effective system of governance and socio-economic development.' Discuss. (10)

[2023] In the context of the work environment, differentiate between 'coercion' and 'undue influence' with suitable examples. (10)

[2023] Explain the term social capital. How does it enhance good governance? (10)

[2023] "Corruption is the manifestation of the failure of core values in the society." In your opinion, what measures can be adopted to uplift the core values in the society? (10)

[2022] Whistle blower, who reports corruption and illegal activities, wrongdoing and misconduct to the concerned authorities, runs the risk of being exposed to grave danger, physical harm and victimization by the vested interests, accused persons and his team. What policy measures would you suggest to strengthen the protection mechanism to safeguard the whistle blower? (10)

[2021] An independent and empowered social audit mechanism is an absolute must in every sphere of public service, including judiciary, to ensure performance, accountability and ethical conduct. Elaborate. (10)

[2019] What do you understand by probity in governance? Based on your understanding of the term, suggest measures for ensuring probity in government. (10)

[2019] Explain the basic principles of the citizens charter movement and bring out its importance. (10)

[2019] There is a view that the Official Secrets Act is an obstacle to the implementation of the Right to Information Act. Do you agree with this view? Discuss. (10)

[2019] Effective utilization of public funds is crucial to meet development goals. Critically examine the reasons for under-utilization and mis-utilization of public funds and their implications. (10)

[2018] What is meant by conflict of interest? Illustrate with examples, the difference between the actual and potential conflicts of interest. (10)

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[2018] "The Right to Information Act is not all about citizens' empowerment alone, it essentially redefines the concept of accountability. Discuss.

[2018] Distinguish between "Code of ethics" and "Code of conduct" with suitable examples.

Probity is a multifaceted concept representing the quality of having **strong moral principles**, absolute integrity, and uprightness in the discharge of public duties.

Philosophical foundations of Probity in Governance

1. **Deontological Ethics (Kantian Ethics)** - emphasis on **duty, honesty, and intention** over outcomes.
2. **Social Contract Theory (Locke, Rousseau)** - Public officials are **trustees of the people's will**, bound by a **contract of accountability**.
3. **Utilitarianism (Bentham, Mill) - efficient use of public resources** for **societal well-being**.
4. **Indian Ethical Traditions**
   a. **Dharma** - emphasizes righteous conduct and duty-bound governance.
   b. **Kautilya's Arthashastra** stressed **Rajadharma**, including impartiality, accountability, and ethical restraint.
   c. **Upanishadic values** of **truth, non-violence, and self-control**.
5. **Constitutional Morality**

Key Components of Probity

1. **Integrity**- Adherence to a strict moral and ethical code. E- Lal Bahadur Shastri
2. **Transparency**- Decisions and actions must be open to public scrutiny.
3. **Accountability**- Public servants must be answerable for their actions and omissions.
4. **Objectivity**- Decisions should be based on merit and evidence, free from bias or personal interest.
5. **Impartiality**- Acting without prejudice toward any particular group or individual.
6. **Avoiding conflict of interest** through disclosures and recusals
7. **Frugality**- Treating public money with more care than one's own

Importance of probity

For Governance Effectiveness

1. **Ensures optimal resource utilization**- Eg. **DBT** through JAM has saved over 3.5 lakh Cr.
2. Promotes **accountability and reduces corruption.** Eg. CAG audits of coal block allocation
3. **Rule of Law**- Probity ensures that laws are applied uniformly without selective enforcement. Eg. **T.N. Seshan** strictly enforced MCC
4. **Building Public Trust**- Integrity in public dealings enhances citizens' confidence in the state.
5. **Reducing Administrative "Red Tape"**- Probity eliminates the artificial delays created by officials to solicit "speed money." Eg. **MCA21 portal** for corporate filings
6. **Administrative Speed**- Ethical governance reduces internal friction and decision-paralysis. Eg. **E. Sreedharan** completed Delhi Metro ahead of schedule.
7. **Internal Motivation**- Probity fosters a "service-oriented" work culture rather than a "power-oriented" one.
8. **Prevention of "Elite Capture"** of policy through citizen participation and feedback. Eg. EIA

For Socio-Economic Development

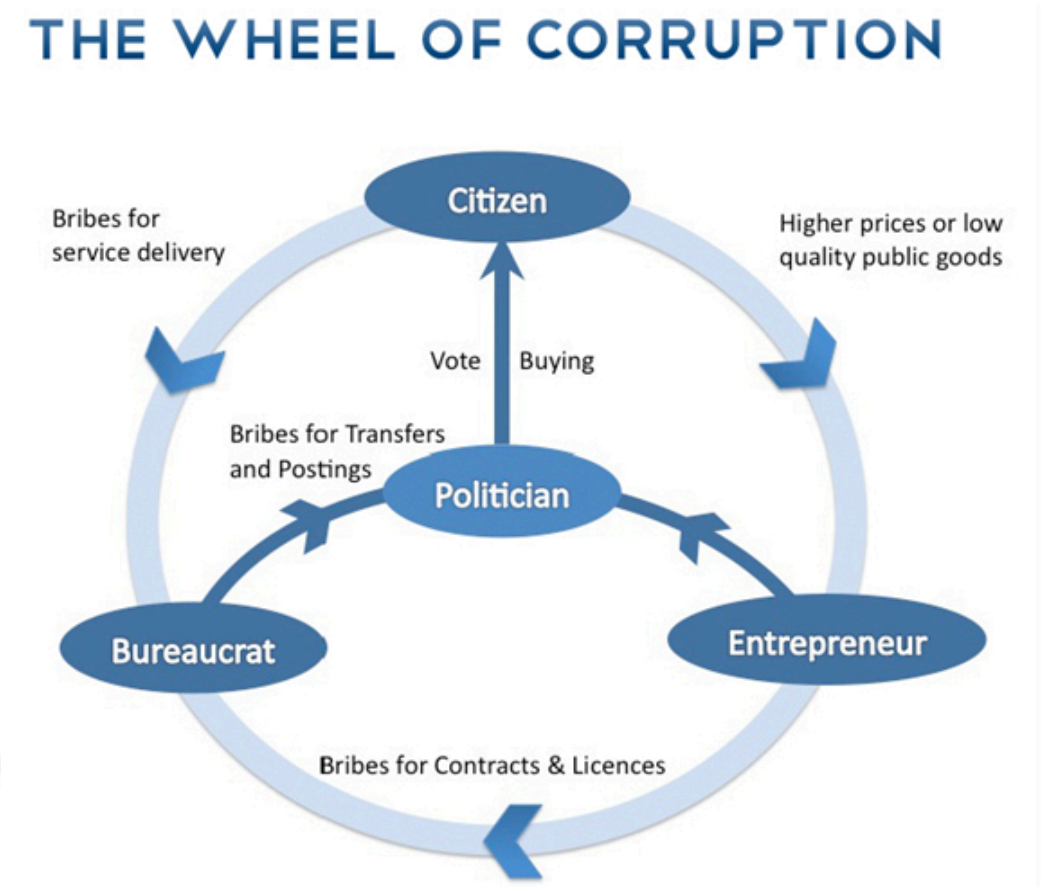
1. **Attract Investment** due to a predictable and stable environment free from "hidden costs." Eg. **Singapore** attracts global capital because of its reputation for zero tolerance for bribery.
2. **Inclusive Growth (Antyodaya)**- Probity ensures that welfare schemes reach the "last person" in the queue.

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3. **Human Capital Formation-** Merit-based recruitment improves the quality of the workforce. Eg. The **UPSC's** reputation for probity
4. **Sustainability-** Decisions made with probity consider long-term environmental impacts over short-term gains.
5. **Social Cohesion-** Fairness in governance prevents the grievances and conflicts that arise from perceived injustice.
6. Emphasis on **meritocracy and objectivity** is the engine of a modern, knowledge-based economy.
7. **Probity in judiciary** ensure accessibility, affordability and quality of justice - Promotes **Justice and Equality**
8. **Probity in corporate governance** promotes effective CSR under **trusteeship principle**. Eg. **Project Nanhi Kali of Mahindra Group** for women education

Challenges in Achieving Probity in Governance

1. **Colonial Legacy of Bureaucratic Secrecy:** Eg. Misusing the **Official Secrets Act** to block administrative accountability.
2. **Politicization of Bureaucracy** - Nexus between politicians, bureaucrats, and businesses and frequent **transfers of upright officers** (Eg. Ashok Khemka) erodes morale.
3. **Erosion of Ethical Norms and Social Acceptance of Corruption**
   a. **Minor corruption** is socially normalized. Eg. "chai-pani"
   b. **"Collective action problem"** where everyone decries corruption but participates because they doubt others will refrain.



4. **Absence of a Formalized Code of Ethics:** The persistent reliance on a purely punitive Code of Conduct fails to inspire higher values like deep empathy or psychological de-biasing.
5. **Ineffectiveness of Anti-Corruption Institutions**
   a. **Lokpal**: 90% complaints rejected
   b. **CBI** termed a "caged parrot" by the SC (2013); lacks operational independence.
   c. **CVC** lacks prosecutorial powers-mostly advisory, often ignored by departments.
6. **Whistleblower Protection Act (2014)** remains poorly operationalized. Eg. murders of **Satyendra Dubey**, **Shanmugam Manjunath**

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7. **Red Tape, and Procedural Opacity** - Excessive paperwork, unclear rules, and **discretionary powers** create rent-seeking opportunities.
8. **Slow and Ineffective Disciplinary Action** - This "justice delayed" environment emboldens the corrupt. (culture of impunity)
9. **"license-permit-inspector"** raj persists in various forms, especially at local levels where oversight is weaker. Eg. **2G Scam**
10. **Unregulated Corporate Lobbying** results in regulatory capture. Eg. Radia tapes (2010)

Measures for Ensuring Probity in Government (Use same for corruption)

1. Institutional and Legal Reforms

1. Ensuring the independence and resource-sufficiency of bodies like **Lokpal, Lokayukta** and **CVC**
2. Rigorous implementation of the **Whistleblowers Protection Act**.
3. Empowering the **CAG** to conduct social audits and performance audits
4. **Adoption of the "Hong Kong Model" (ICAC)** to tackle corruption - three-pronged strategy of Investigation, Prevention, and Community Education

2. Procedural and Technological Measures

1. **E-Governance** to reduce human discretion and the "gatekeeper" effect. Eg. **GeM**
2. **Citizens' Charters-** Mandating clear timelines for service delivery. Eg. SAKALA (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
3. Proactive disclosure under **Section 4 of the RTI Act** for transparency
4. Mandatory and periodic declaration of **assets and liabilities by civil servants**

3. Human Resource and Ethical Reforms

1. Moving beyond a "Rule-based" conduct code (what not to do) to a **"Value-based" code of ethics** (what to strive for) (**2nd ARC**).
2. **Competency-linked training** under **Mission Karmayogi** to ensure civil servants are not only skilled but also ethically grounded.

4. Social and Political Measures

1. **Legal backing to Social Audits. (Meghalaya Act)**
2. Ensuring **transparency in electoral funding** to prevent the "quid-pro-quo" culture at top.

Code of Conduct and Code of Ethics

Importance of a Code of Conduct & Ethics

1. **Uniformity and consistency in decision-making** based on values
2. **Building Public Trust-** Eg. Tata Group
3. **Ensures Legal and Regulatory Compliance** in spirit rather than letter
4. **Employee Pride and Retention-** Eg. Patagonia's employee turnover rate due to commitment to the environment.
5. **Prevention of Corruption-** Eg. PepsiCo's code provides specific dollar limits for business gifts
6. **Institutionalizing Accountability** based on principles like **trusteeship** and **fairness**
7. **Safeguarding Reputation-** Acts as a shield during crises
8. **Promoting Inclusivity-** Eg. **HanesBrands's** "Excellence through Diversity" principle.
9. **Stakeholder Protection through transparency.** Eg. H&M publishes 98.5% of its supplier addresses
10. **Conflict of Interest Control**. Eg. US Federal Ethics disclosure system.

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	Code of Conduct	Code of Ethics
Definition	A legally enforceable set of standards outlining expected behavior in public service.	General values, Guidelines for personal and professional decision-making based on ethics.
Nature	**Prescriptive, specific and disciplinary.** Eg. can't drink liquor in public.	Highly **descriptive and abstract**. Therefore different meanings for different individuals.
	Objective and hence easy to enforce	**Subjective** and hence **difficult to enforce**.
Function	Explains how public servants should act and behave.	Guides decision-making processes with ethical reasoning.
Content	Emphasizes rules and legal provisions.	Emphasizes values and morals.
Scope	Covers both personal and professional life comprehensively.	Generally applies to professional life with a narrower scope.
In India	Governed by Central Services (Conduct) Rules, 1964, and similar rules for All India Services.	No prescribed code for civil servants, though other countries may have similar codes.
Example	Rules regarding gifts and specific behavioral expectations.	Public servants are guided by community well-being and the common good in decision-making.

Work Culture

Work culture is the collective set of shared values, beliefs, psychological attitudes, and behavioral norms that dynamically govern how employees interact, communicate, and execute official responsibilities within an organization.

Importance of Positive Work Culture in an Organisation

1. **Boosts Institutional Productivity:** Eg. **ISRO's collaborative culture** ensuring cost-effective space missions.
2. **Accelerates Citizen Service Delivery:** Value-driven administrative environments actively eliminate red tape. Eg. **Passport Seva Kendra model** reducing verification turnaround times.
3. **Fosters Administrative Innovation:** Eg. **Armstrong Pame crowdfunding** a 100-km regional highway.
4. **Attracts and Retains Elite Talent:** Organizations that actively protect employee well-being and moral dignity see far lower rates of high-performing structural attrition.
5. **Reduces Systemic Corruption Risk:** Ethical, transparent working environments make under-the-table file manipulations easily visible, eliminating avenues for graft.

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6. **Enhances Psychological Well-being:** Eg. **Kerala Police introducing mandatory wellness** programs for personnel.
7. **Ensures Data-Driven Policy Advice:** A healthy culture enables civil servants to provide frank, unfiltered empirical truths to political executives without fear.
8. **Cultivates Inclusive Diversity:** eliminate identity-based prejudices & establishes a secure environment for all demographics. Eg. **Corporate gender diversity mandates** at Tata Group.
9. **Elevates Public Trust in Governance:** When citizens experience an empathetic, responsive administrative machinery, it directly bridges the historic citizen-state trust deficit.

Major Challenges in Ensuring Positive Work Culture in an Organisation

1. **Toxic Leadership** - Authoritarian managers create **fear and low morale**. Eg. Workplace criticism at **Uber** under former leadership.
2. **Workplace Discrimination** - Bias based on gender, caste, or race harms inclusivity. Eg. **Gender pay gap** concerns globally.
3. **Poor Work-Life Balance** - Excessive workload causes stress and burnout. Eg. Long working hours in startup culture.
4. **Lack of Transparency** - Opaque decision-making reduces employee trust. Eg. Sudden layoffs in tech companies.
5. **Office Politics** - Favouritism and lobbying weaken teamwork and fairness. Eg. Internal factionalism in bureaucratic systems.
6. **Resistance to Change** - Employees may oppose reforms and technological changes. Eg. Resistance during digitalisation initiatives.
7. **Harassment and Misconduct** - Unsafe workplaces reduce employee confidence. Eg. POSH complaints in corporate organisations.
8. **Communication Gaps** - Weak communication creates confusion and conflicts. Eg. departmental silos in ministries leading to duplication.
9. **Lack of Recognition** - Employees feel demotivated when efforts remain unacknowledged.
10. **Unethical Practices** - Corruption and manipulation damage institutional culture. Eg. Corporate fraud in **Satyam Computer Services scandal.**

Measures

Value-Based Measures

1. **Ethical Leadership-** Leaders must "walk the talk." Eg. **Narayana Murthy** following simple living to set a culture of austerity and integrity.
2. **Participative Value Formulation-** Involving employees in drafting the code **to create ownership.**
3. **Ethical Training-** Eg. **Kellogg Company** uses interactive quizzes and " grain farm" themed storytelling to teach ethics.
4. **Integration into Appraisals-** Rewarding "how" a goal was met, not just "what" was achieved. Eg. adding an "Empathy Score" to their performance reviews.
5. **Psychological Safety-** Eg. **Microsoft's "Growth Mindset" culture** encourages learning from failures rather than hiding them.

Compliance-Based Measures

1. **Robust Whistleblower Mechanism-** Secure and anonymous channels for reporting.
2. **Appointment of a Chief Ethics Officer** to oversee integrity initiatives.
3. **Regular Ethical Audits** for monitoring of financial and behavioral conduct. Eg. **"Social Audits"** by Big Four accounting firms.
4. **Clear Disciplinary Protocols-** Eg. The **"Zero Tolerance" policy** for sexual harassment in **Goldman Sachs.**

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5. **Leveraging RegTech-** Using technology to flag irregularities. Eg. AI-driven software to detect potential insider trading in real-time.
6. **Transparency in process. Eg.** GeM portal in public procurement.

Building ethical work culture requires a **Symphonic Approach** based on **moral clarity** through CoE, and **robust systems** for compliance.

Citizen Participation and Good Governance

"The building of a nation is not a government project; it is a **people's project.**" **PM Narendra Modi**

"Democracy is not merely a form of government; it is primarily a **mode of associated living.**" **B.R. Ambedkar**

"Never doubt that a **small group of thoughtful citizens** can change the world." **Margaret Mead**

"The government's role is to empower, but **citizens' role is to participate.**" **2nd ARC Report**

Importance of Citizen Participation in India

1. **Enhanced Accountability:** Citizens act as "vigilance eyes" preventing administrative corruption. **Eg. 2025 Social Audit of MNREGA in Meghalaya.**
2. **Resource Optimization:** Local inputs prevent top-down planning failures. **Eg. Village-level drought proofing under Jal Shakti Abhiyan.**
3. **Inclusive Development:** Ensures benefits reach the last person (**Antyodaya**). **Eg. Community-led beneficiary identification for PM-JANMAN mission (2026).**
4. **Policy Legitimacy:** Public feedback during drafting reduces street-level protests. **Eg. 23,000 suggestions received for Digital India Act 2025.**
5. **Transparency Boost: Eg. 4.3 million RTIs filed annually.**
6. **Social Cohesion:** Joint community projects reduce local ethnic/caste frictions. **Eg. "Aspirational Blocks" peace committees in 500 blocks.**
7. **Service Efficiency:** Real-time feedback loops fix broken utilities faster. **Eg. 24-hour repair cycles via MyGov feedback portal.**
8. **Democratic Deepening:** Shifts India from "Representative" to "Participatory" status. **Eg. Gram Sabha empowerment under PESA Act 1996.**
9. **Crisis Management:** Community volunteers act as first responders during disasters. **Eg. Local "Disaster Mitras" during 2026 urban floods.**

Major Challenges in Participation

1. **Digital Divide:** Half of rural India lacks the high-speed access needed for digital-governance
2. **Illiteracy Barriers:** Complex technical language in policy documents excludes the uneducated
3. **Elite Capture:** Local powerful groups often hijack participatory forums like Gram Sabhas
4. **Information Asymmetry: Eg. Low awareness of "Jan Sunwai" in Bihar.**
5. **Tokenistic Participation:** Inviting feedback only after decisions are already finalized. **Eg. Urban Masterplan "ceremonial" public hearings.**
6. **Gender Disparity:** Social norms often restrict women from speaking in public forums. Eg. **"Pradhan-Patis"**
7. **Fear of Reprisal:** Whistleblowers fear physical or social backlash for exposing local graft
8. **Resource Constraints:** Small NGOs and civil groups lack funds for sustained advocacy
9. **Bureaucratic Resistance:** A "secrecy mindset" persists among some officials despite the RTI
10. **High Inequality:** Extreme poverty forces citizens to prioritize daily wages over civic participation

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Andrea Cornwall's "Seven Sins of Citizen Participation"

- **Cosmetic Labeling** - Participation acts as a facade to gain "procedural legitimacy" without granting any actual influence over the project. **Eg. EIA**
- **Paternalism - Top down approach in policy making**
- **Politicization - Eg. Elite capture of Gram Sabhas**
- **Poor Representation - Eg. "Sarpanch-Pati" culture**
- **Instrumentalization** - Citizens are used as a means to an end, rather than as an active agent
- **Fragmentation** - Multiple agencies conduct uncoordinated, overlapping consultations, causing "participation fatigue" and administrative confusion. Eg. Parastatals
- **Overloading** - excessive administrative burdens on community workers or citizens without providing the necessary resources or compensation. **Eg. ASHA workers**

Central Initiatives

1. **Gram Sabhas** under PRIs as an instrument of direct democracy
2. **MyGov 2.0:** World's largest crowdsourcing platform; hit **45 million users** in early 2026.
3. **CPGRAMS 7.0:** AI-based portal that automates grievance sorting for faster disposal .

State Level Best Practices

1. **Meghalaya Social Audit Law:** First state to pass legislation mandating community audits for **21 departments**.
2. **Jan Sunwai (Rajasthan):** Institutionalized public hearings where officials explain spending to the village.
3. **Kerala people's plan campaign.**

Global Best Practices

1. The **UK Government's Open Data portal.**
2. **Participatory Budgeting - Porto Alegre in Brazil** .
3. The **UK's Citizen Charter introduced in 1991** set service standards for various public services.

Transparency and Accountability

Transparency: The principle that public officials and institutions have a duty to act visibly and provide clear, accessible information about their decisions and actions.

Accountability: The obligation of public authorities to explain, justify, and take responsibility for their actions.

OECD defines open government as

1. The **transparency** in government actions,
2. the **accessibility** of government services and information, and
3. the **responsiveness** of government to new ideas, demands and needs.

"Sunlight is said to be the **best of disinfectants**; electric light the most efficient policeman." **Justice Louis Brandeis**

"Accountability breeds **response-ability**." **Stephen Covey**

"Corruption thrives in **secret places** and avoids public places." **Woodrow Wilson**

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Importance of Transparency and Accountability

1. **Strengthening Democratic Legitimacy**
   a. **Building Public Trust: Eg. Proactive disclosures under Section 4 of RTI.**
   b. **Informed Citizenry: Eg. information on criminal cases against candidates**
   c. **Upholding Rule of Law: Eg. Removal motion against Justice Verma.**
2. **Enhancing Administrative Efficiency**
   a. **Reducing Leakages: Eg. ₹3.5 lakh crore saved via DBT-Aadhaar (2026).**
   b. **Time-bound Service: Eg. Right to Service Act of Maharashtra**
   c. **Optimizing Resource Use: Eg. CAG's 2025 performance audit of PMGSY.**
3. **Combating Systemic Corruption**
   a. **Deterrence of Graft: Eg. GeM portal.**
   b. **Protects Institutional Integrity: Eg. Mandatory social audits in Meghalaya.**
4. **Fostering Economic Stability**
   a. **Investor Confidence:** clear regulatory and transparent tax regimes
   b. **Fiscal Discipline: Eg. FRBM Act.**
   c. **Market Fair Play: Eg. Transparent 5G/6G spectrum auctions.**
5. **Promoting Social Equity**
   a. **Empowering Vulnerable Groups:** Information allows marginalized communities to demand their rightful share of resources. **Eg. PESA Act.**
   b. **Gender Justice:** Transparent reporting exposes wage gaps and representation issues in local bodies.

Major Challenges in India

1. **Political Challenges**
   a. **Criminalization of Politics:** Candidates with criminal records often resist accountability measures to protect their interests. **45% of current MLAs face criminal cases (ADR, 2025).**
   b. **Opaque Election Funding:** lead to nexus of **politician-bureaucrat-corporate (Vohra Committee)**
   c. **Political Resistance - Eg.** Reluctance to bring political parties under RTI
2. **Legal-Institutional Challenges**
   a. **Culture of Secrecy:** A colonial mindset among the lower bureaucracy views public questioning as "interference"
   b. **Judicial Pendency:** Massive backlogs make it impossible to hold offenders accountable in a reasonable time
   c. **Weak Whistleblower Protection:** Activists face physical threats despite laws, deterring citizens from exposing corruption
   d. **Institutional Vacancies:** Delays in appointing Information Commissioners lead to massive RTI appeal backlogs (over 23000 in CIC)

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3. **Technological Challenges**
    a. **Digital Divide:** Half of rural India lacks the internet access required for e-transparency portals
    b. **Accessibility issue** - lack of content in vernacular languages.
4. **Social Challenges**
    a. **Information Asymmetry: Eg. Low awareness of "Jan Sunwai" in Bihar.**
    b. **Elite Capture of** participatory forums like Gram Sabhas. **Eg. "Sarpanch-Pati" culture.**

Mechanisms for Transparency and Accountability

1. **Constitutional -**
    a. **Judicial review**. Eg. Supreme Court verdict on **Coal Mines Allocation case**.
    b. **Parliamentary Committees** - Eg. **PAC review of MGNREGA** scheme implementation.
    c. **Article 311** - Provides safeguards to **civil servants** against arbitrary dismissal, removal, or reduction in rank, ensuring fairness and neutrality in administration.
2. **Legal -**
    a. **RTI Act** - Promotes "informed citizenry"
    b. **Lokpal and Lokayuktas** - Investigate allegations of corruption against public officials
    c. **CAG** - ensures financial accountability. Eg. **CAG report on 2G Spectrum Allocation**.
3. **Institutional -**
    a. **CVC** - supervises vigilance administration and anti-corruption measures.
    b. **CIC** - Eg. **directive to RBI to disclose willful defaulters list (2015)**.
4. **Technological-**
    a. **CPGRAMS** - A centralized system for monitoring and resolving **public grievances**.
    b. **e-Governance** - Eg. DBT
5. **Societal -**
    a. **Media and Civil Society** - Eg. **ADR's 2025 "Know Your Candidate" campaign.**
    b. **Participatory Budgeting** - People plan campaign of Kerala
    c. **Social Audit** - Eg. **MGNREGA social audits in Andhra Pradesh**
    d. **Public Hearings** - Eg. **MKSS Jan Sunwais in Rajasthan**.

The **Second Administrative Reforms Commission (2nd ARC)** identifies transparency as the "antidote to corruption."

Citizen Charter

A **Citizen's Charter** is a public statement that outlines an organization's commitment to providing quality services within a specified timeframe, along with a mechanism for grievance redressal.

Key Components of a Citizen Charter

1. **Vision and Mission:** Statement of the organization's core purpose.
2. **Details of Business:** Clear description of services and goods provided.
3. **Service Standards:** Measurable and time-bound benchmarks (Eg. "Passport in 15 days").
4. **Grievance Redressal:** Information on appeal mechanism if standards aren't met
5. **Stakeholders:** Identification of specific client groups/users.
6. **Expectations from Citizens:** What the organization needs from the user. Eg. correct documentation

Key Principles of CC

1. **Quality:** Constant improvement of service quality.

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2. **Choice:** Providing alternatives for the user wherever possible.
3. **Standards:** Setting explicit targets for what to expect and timelines for delivery.
4. **Value:** Ensuring the best value for taxpayers' money.
5. **Accountability:** Making individuals and organizations answerable for service delivery.
6. **Transparency:** Openness in rules, procedures, schemes, and grievances

Status in India

- **Over 700 Citizen's Charters** have been adopted across Central Ministries/Departments, public sector undertakings, States/UTs, and local bodies.
- More than **20 States have enacted Right to Public Services / Service Guarantee Acts**
- **IS 15700:2005** of BIS provides certification for adopting the Sevottam framework.
- **CPGRAMS interlinks 91 Central Ministries/Departments and 36 States/UTs**, with more than 74,000 subordinate users. It is integrated with **5 lakh+ Common Service Centres (CSCs) and 2.5 lakh Village Level Entrepreneurs (VLEs)** for last-mile rural access.
- Indian Railways, India Post, Passport Seva, Income Tax (Taxpayers' Charter, 2020), Aadhaar (UIDAI), and Public Distribution System have active charters.

Importance of Citizen Charter in India

1. **Administrative Accountability**
   a. **Setting Benchmarks:** Provides measurable standards to evaluate performance.
   b. **Reducing Discretion:** Clear rules minimize the "human element," reducing chances for corruption. **Eg. Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) verification timelines.**
   c. **Consistency: Ensures uniform service across different regions**
   d. **Public Scrutiny:** Empowers citizens to question delays based on written commitments. **Eg. Jan Sunwai using CC benchmarks in Rajasthan.**
2. **Citizen Empowerment**
   a. **Information Access:** Citizens know exactly what they are entitled to. **Eg. Display of PDS entitlement charts at Ration Shops.**
   b. **Voice and Choice:** Encourages user consultation to improve service quality. **Eg. Feedback loops in the Swachh Bharat Mission (2025).**
3. **Organizational Reform**
   a. **Process Re-engineering:** Forcing departments to simplify internal workflows to meet promised deadlines. **Eg. Single Window System for industrial clearances.**
   b. **Performance Management:** Shifts the culture from "process-oriented" to "result-oriented"

Major Challenges in Implementation

1. **Design and Structural Hurdles**
   a. **Vague Standards:** use generic terms like "as soon as possible" instead of specific timelines
   b. **Poor Quality of Standards:** The IIPA Evaluation found that **service delivery standards were absent in 43%** of charters reviewed, and **service quality standards in 38%**.
   c. **Lack of Legal Teeth:** Most CCs are not legally enforceable, making them "pious declarations" without penalties
   d. **Limited Consultation** with end-users or NGOs, leading to gaps in service alignment.
2. **Social and Awareness Gaps**
   a. **Information Asymmetry: Only 15% of rural citizens are aware of local CCs (2025 Survey).**

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   b. **Linguistic Barriers:** Charters are often not available in local dialects, excluding non-Hindi/English speakers
3. **Administrative Resistance**
   a. **Lack of Training:** Ground-level staff (ASHA/Postmen) are often not trained on the charter's commitments
   b. **One-Size-Fits-All:** Charters are often drafted at HQs without local context.
   c. **Rare Updates**: Many charters are outdated, having not been revised since the 1990s.

Best Practices

1. **UK (Charter Mark):** An excellence award given to agencies that meet strict "Citizen First" criteria.
2. **Australia (Service Charters):** Includes a "Redress" clause where citizens can get a refund/credit if service standards are missed.
3. **Canada (Management Accountability Framework):** Links the senior management's promotions directly to their department's CC performance.
4. **Sakala Mission (Karnataka):** Statutory backing through the Karnataka Guarantee of Services to Citizens Act.

Way Forward:

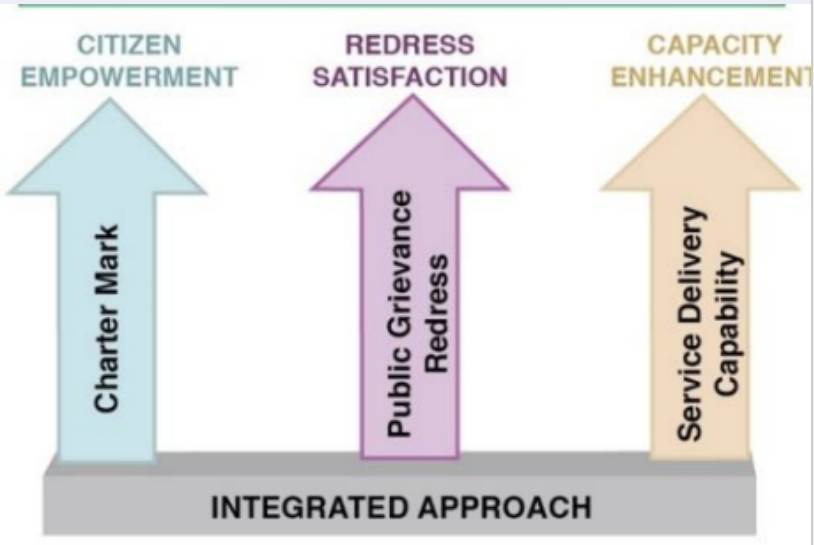
1. **2nd ARC:** Enact a **"Right to Service Act"** at the Centre to make CCs legally enforceable. (**Revive the Right of Citizens for Time Bound Delivery of Goods and Services Bill, 2011**)
2. **Sevottam Implementation (2nd ARC):** Move from mere "declaration" to a "service excellence model" involving capability building.
3. **Mandatory Compensation** if a service is delayed beyond the CC limit
4. **Local Language Mandate: Eg. Use of Bhashini AI for real-time translation.**
5. **External Audits :** Independent third-party NGOs should audit CC performance quarterly.
6. **Staff Incentives:** Link "Mission Karmayogi" performance credits to the successful delivery of CC targets.
7. **Participatory Drafting:** Involve RWAs and Gram Sabhas in the initial drafting phase to ensure realistic standards.
8. **Public Awareness Campaigns:** Use "Nukkad Nataks" and social media to inform citizens of their rights under the CC.

The **Sevottam Model** is an assessment-improvement framework developed by the **DARPG** in 2006 to elevate the quality of public service delivery in India.

The name combines the Hindi words Seva (Service) and Uttam (Excellent), symbolizing a shift from "administration and control" to "service and enablement."

Core Concept

- **Nature:** A **Quality Management System (QMS)** specifically for public service organizations.
- **Objective:** To provide a roadmap for organizations to assess their service delivery, identify gaps, and implement systemic improvements.



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- Compliant organizations are awarded the **IS 15700:2018** certification by the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS).

The Seven-Step Implementation Model

- **Define:** Identify all services provided and the specific clients (citizens) served.
- **Set Standards:** Establish measurable norms and timelines for each service.
- **Develop Capability:** Build the internal capacity to meet these set standards.
- **Perform:** Implement workflows to achieve the defined service standards.
- **Monitor:** Continuously track performance against the benchmarks.
- **Evaluate:** Assess the impact through independent mechanisms to ensure objectivity.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Use feedback and evaluation results to drive further excellence.

Social Audit

Social Audit is a **democratic process** that ensures public accountability by empowering stakeholders to systematically demand information and scrutinize the implementation of government programs.

Unlike financial audits, it measures **social impact, quality of work, and ethical adherence** alongside expenditure.

Recently, there is a demand for social audits of **Special Intensive Revision exercise** to ensure accuracy in electoral rolls

Process of Social Audits

1. **Planning:** An annual calendar is prepared by the **Social Audit Unit (SAU)**.
2. **Preparation:** Implementing agencies provide all records (muster rolls, bills, measurement books) to auditors **15 days in advance**.
3. **Verification:** Resource persons visit work sites and cross-verify records by interviewing beneficiaries in their homes.
4. **Gram Sabha Meeting:** Findings are read out in a public meeting. Officials must be present to answer on-record queries.
5. **Public Hearing (Jan Sunwai):** Issues not resolved at the village level are taken to a block or district-level public hearing with senior officials.
6. **Action Taken Report (ATR):** The government must submit an ATR on the findings within a stipulated timeframe (usually 30 days).

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Importance of Social Audits in India

1. **Accountability & Corruption Control**

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   a. **Eliminating Ghost Beneficiaries:** Identifies people who only exist on paper
   b. **Preventing Financial Leakage:** Eg. Nearly Rs 900 cr has been misappropriated under the MGNREGA scheme over the past five years as per social audit reports
   c. **Direct Questioning:** Officials are forced to justify expenses in front of the community. **Eg. Jan Sunwais in Rajasthan.**
2. **Quality & Service Delivery**
   a. **Work Quality Verification:** Citizens check the quality of material used (Eg. cement in roads)
   b. **Ensuring Entitlements:** Confirms that laborers receive full wages on time
   c. **Infrastructure Sustainability:** Local monitoring ensures that built assets are actually functional
3. **Empowerment & Participation**
   a. **Democratizing Information:** Provides illiterate laborers access to complex financial data
   b. **Boosting Civic Agency:** Citizens transform from passive recipients to active "vigilant" stakeholders. **Eg. Success of "Nigrani Committees" in UP.**
   c. **Inclusion of Marginalized:** Mandates participation of women and SC/ST groups
   d. **Conflict Resolution:** Addresses grievances locally before they escalate into legal battles

Major Challenges in Implementation

1. **Institutional & Political**
   a. **Bureaucratic Resistance:** Officials often delay records or skip public hearings to avoid scrutiny
   b. **Lack of Financial Independence:** SAUs depend on the very departments they audit for funds
   c. **Political Hijacking:** Powerful local elites intimidate or silence dissent during Gram Sabhas
2. **Operational & Structural**
   a. **Thin Capacity:** Social Audit Units are often understaffed and auditors under-trained
   b. **Information Asymmetry:** Complex technical reports are hard for rural citizens to understand. **Eg. Technical jargon in "Measurement Books."**
   c. **Inadequate Follow-up:** Findings are reported, but Action Taken Reports (ATRs) are rarely finalized
3. **Social & Legal**
   a. **Risk to Whistleblowers:** Lack of a robust protection mechanism for those who speak out
   b. **Language Barriers:** Reports often not available in the local dialect

Major Successful Case Studies

1. **Meghalaya Social Audit Act**
2. **Andhra Pradesh (Society for Social Audit):** recovered over **₹150 crore** in embezzled funds since inception.
3. **Sikkim (Village Monitoring):** 100% saturation of social audits in rural development projects with high community attendance.

- The **Ministry of Labour** has issued a framework for conducting social audits under the **Building and Other Construction Workers Act, 2013.**
- Department of Social Justice and Empowerment has established the **National Resource Cell for Social Audit**

Way Forward

1. Enact a **National Social Audit Act** to provide legal protection and permanent funding to SAUs.
2. **Financial Autonomy:** Create a separate corpus for audits, independent of the implementing ministry (recommended by **2nd ARC**).
3. Shift from "Post-facto" (after work) to "Concurrent" (during work) audits using drones and AI tracking.

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4. Link social audits with the **Whistleblower Protection Act** to ensure the safety of citizen participants.
5. **Incentivizing Performance:** Link a portion of state grants to the quality and frequency of social audits conducted.

Right to Information Act

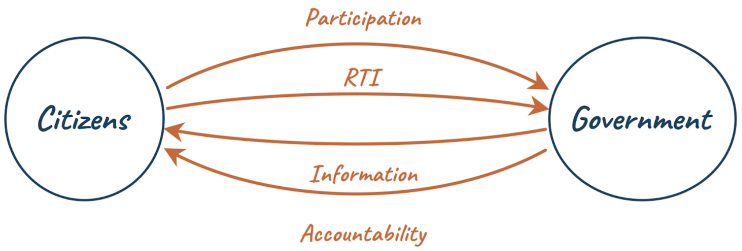
The Right to Information **(RTI) Act, 2005** is hailed as the **"Master Key to Good Governance."**

- "The Right to Know is a facet of the Right to Speech and Expression (Article 19)." - **Supreme Court (State of UP v. Raj Narain, 1975)**
- "Information is the currency of democracy." - **Thomas Jefferson**
- "A citizen has a right to know how the government, which he has elected, is functioning." - **Justice P.N. Bhagwati**

Beawar, in central Rajasthan, is called "RTI City" as the 1st demand and protest for RTI was made by MKSS and School for Democracy in 1996.

Key Provisions of RTI Act, 2005

1. **Section 4(1)(b):** Mandates **proactive disclosure** (Suo Motu) of information by public authorities to minimize the need for filing RTIs.
2. **Section 6:** Allows any citizen to request information in English, Hindi, or the official language of the area. No reason for seeking information is required.
3. **Section 7:** Information must be provided within **30 days** (or **48 hours** if it concerns the life or liberty of a person).



4. **Section 8:** Lists **exemptions** (Eg. national security, cabinet papers, fiduciary relationships). However, Section 8(2) allows disclosure if "public interest outweighs the harm."
5. **Section 20:** Empowers Information Commissions to impose penalties of **₹250 per day (up to ₹25,000) on erring officials.**

RTI Amendment Act, 2019

1. **Tenure:** Removed the fixed 5-year term; tenure is now **"as prescribed by the Central Government"** (currently set at 3 years).
2. **Salaries of Chief/State Information** Commissioners are no longer at par with Election Commissioners; they are now determined by the Centre.
3. The **Central Government** now prescribes the service conditions even for State Information Commissioners

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Significance of RTI Act

For Government:

1. **Transparency and Openness:** Mandates **proactive disclosure**, dismantles **bureaucratic secrecy**, and institutionalises **open decision-making.**
2. **Strengthening Institutional Checks: Eg. Electoral Bonds judgment (2024)** upheld **transparency and citizens' rights.**
3. **Institutional Mechanism for Transparency:** Establishment of **Central and State Information Commissions** provides a **quasi-judicial avenue for grievance redressal.**
4. Establishes **India as a leader in open governance. Eg. Bangladesh** modeled RTI laws on **India's Act.**

For Citizens:

1. **Informed Citizenry:** Promotes **deliberative democracy**, reduces **information asymmetry**, and builds **public consciousness** about rights. **Eg. Citizens accessing MGNREGA job card data.**
2. **Democratic Deepening:** Extends democracy beyond elections by institutionalising **citizen engagement** and **continuous public oversight.**
3. **Political Accountability:** Brings **judiciary (in part), and public-funded NGOs** under greater **public scrutiny.**

Administration:

1. **Exposure of Corruption and Maladministration: Eg. 2G Spectrum, Adarsh Housing, Commonwealth Games.**
2. **Improved Service Delivery:** Enables **monitoring of schemes** like **MGNREGA** and **PDS**, improving **transparency, efficiency, and benefit delivery.**

Media and Civil Society:

1. **Support for Investigative Journalism:** Journalists have used **RTI** to uncover **policy lapses, irregularities in public spending, and human rights violations.**
2. **Civil Society Empowerment:** Strengthens **NGOs and social activists** by enhancing their ability to demand **accountability, transparency, and evidence-based advocacy.**

Major Challenges in Implementation

1. **Political Challenges**
   a. Despite the **CIC Decision (3 June 2013)** declaring six national parties "public authorities" under Section 2(h), all refused compliance.
   b. **Lack of political will** - Eg. No earmarked central budget for RTI awareness or digitisation.
   c. **RTI Amendments 2019 & 2023** reduced autonomy of CIC
2. **Institutional & Legal Challenges**
   a. **Massive Pendency:** Over **4 lakh appeals** pending across 29 commissions as of
   b. **Vacancies: Eg. 9 Commissions were without a Chief in late 2025.**
   c. **Penalty Evasion:** Penalties are imposed in only **4% of cases** where they were warranted
   d. **Bureaucratic Resistance: Section 8(1)** exemptions (national security, fiduciary, etc.) are widely misused; **Section 8(2)**'s public-interest override invoked in < 1% cases.
3. **Social & Operational Challenges**
   a. **Threats to Activists:** Over **100 RTI activists killed** since 2005
   b. **Digital Exclusion:** Poor portal design in regional languages limits rural use
   c. Only **~25%** of rural respondents know how to file RTIs (Centre for Media Studies 2023). Awareness is lowest among **women, SC/ST, and rural poor**
   d. Since 2005, only **9%** of commissioners have been women.

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Section 44 (3) of Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023 amended **Section 8(1)(j)** of RTI to provide a **blanket ban** on the disclosure of "personal information," removing the "public interest" exception.

Justification for (DPDP) Act, 2023 (Government's Stand)

- **Alignment with Puttaswamy Judgment:** It harmonizes RTI with the 2017 SC verdict that declared privacy a fundamental right under **Article 21**
- **Removal of Ambiguity:** The previous "public activity/interest" test was subjective; the new phrasing provides a clear "bright-line" rule for PIOs
- **Preventing Harassment of Officials:** Protects public servants from "targeted info-fishing" that could lead to identity theft or harassment
- **Global Harmonization (GDPR):** Brings India in line with EU standards where personal data protection is paramount
- **Section 8(2) Override:** Government claims **Section 8(2)** (Public Interest override) still exists as a general safety valve for the entire Act
- **Codifying Jurisprudence:** Aligns with **Girish Ramchandra Deshpande case principles** that personal details like IT returns or service records are generally private
- **Informed Consent:** Ensures that data provided for a specific purpose (Eg. healthcare) isn't used for another (Eg. public scrutiny) without permission
- **Ease of Compliance:** Simplifies the job of Public Information Officers who previously struggled to balance competing fundamental rights

Criticism of the Amendment

- **Removal of "Public Interest" Override**
- **Justice BN Srikrishna Committee** recommended narrow exemptions rather than broader and vague ones.
- The **blanket exemption of and the vague definition of personal information** provides discretion to public authorities.
- **Shielding Corruption:** Details like **Asset Declarations** and educational qualifications of officials are now strictly "personal"
- **Impact on Accountability: Eg. Challenges in accessing PM CARES fund donor details.**
- **Executive Overreach:** The definition of "Personal Information" is now so broad it can cover almost any file noting
- **Chilling Effect on Journalism:** Investigative reporters collecting "personal data" during probes may be treated as "data fiduciaries"

SC Judgments

1. **State of U.P. vs Raj Narain (1975):** RTI recognised as implicit in Article 19(1)(a).
2. **S.P. Gupta vs President of India (1982):** Citizens have the right to know about public transactions.
3. **People's Union for Civil Liberties vs Union of India (2004):** RTI elevated to the status of a human right linked to Article 21 (Right to Life and Liberty).
4. **Subhash Chandra Agarwal vs. Office of the CJI (2019)** - Brought **Office of the Chief Justice of India (CJI)** under RTI.
5. **Electoral Bonds Case** - struck down the **Electoral Bonds Scheme**, holding that **secrecy in political funding violates Article 19(1)(a)**.

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Global Best Practices

1. **Mexico (INAI):** Its Information Commission has the power to **overrule** the government's "national security" classification if human rights violations are suspected.
2. **Estonia:** Operates on a "Once-Only" principle with **X-Road technology**, where all non-sensitive government data is open by default.
3. **South Africa:** Its PAIA law allows citizens to access information even from **private bodies** if it is required to protect a fundamental right.

Way Forward

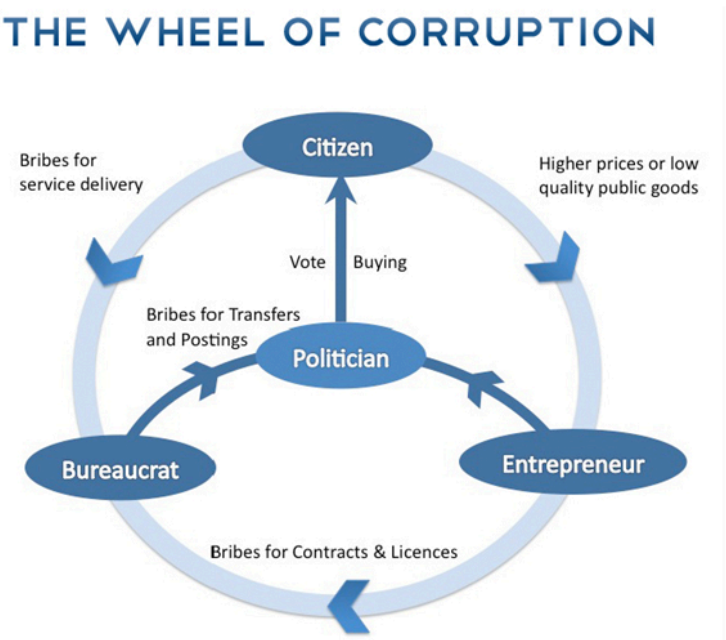
1. **Fill Vacancies:** Mandate 50% non-bureaucratic appointments (academics, journalists) to diversify commissions.
2. **Statutory Timeframes for Appeals:** Fix a **90-day disposal limit** for Information Commissions (2nd ARC Recommendation).
3. **Harmonize DPDP & RTI:** Amend the 2025 rules to ensure "Public Interest" remains the overriding factor in data disclosure.
4. **Digitize Record-keeping:** Standardize all state portals and integrate them with **Bhashini AI** for multilingual access.
5. **Outcome Budgeting:** Link state grants to the performance of their Information Commissions
6. **2nd ARC Recommendations:**
   a. Establish a National Coordination Committee (NCC) for RTI monitoring.
   b. Conduct awareness campaigns through NGOs and educational institutions.
   c. Strengthen record management and digitisation.
   d. Bring NGOs receiving ≥ ₹1 crore in government funds under RTI purview.

Utilisation of Public Funds

Resource stewardship is the hallmark of **good governance** and is essential for translating fiscal resources into social welfare. Its poor utilisation violates the **"trusteeship" principle (Locke)**

Importance of Effective Utilization of Public Funds

1. **Achieving Social Justice-** Tribal sub plan funds reducing historical inequality.
2. **Ensure timely completion of infrastructure projects to** drive long-term GDP growth.
3. **Human Capital Formation** through improved public service delivery
4. **Poverty Alleviation-** Eg. DBT provides a safety net for those below the poverty line.
5. **Fiscal Discipline-** Prevents unnecessary borrowing and reduces the fiscal deficit
6. **Builds Public Trust** in government - ensures better tax-compliance
7. **Attracting Investment-** "Crowding-in" effect.



Major Challenges in utilization of public funds

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Under-Utilization

1. **Administrative Red Tapism-** Lengthy approval processes for tenders and contracts.
2. **Late fund release** lead to **"March Rush"**
3. **Capacity Constraints-** Local bodies lack technical staff to draft Detailed Project Reports (DPRs).
4. **One-size-fits-all guidelines** limit flexibility. Eg. CSS
5. **Land acquisition delays** stalls major infrastructure projects.
6. **Low accountability-** lack of real-time tracking of funds
7. **Fear of the "3 Cs"(CBI, CVC, CAG)** causes bureaucratic paralysis

Mis-Utilization

1. **Corruption** through **ghost beneficiaries.** Eg. over 10 lakh fake accounts in Ayushman Bharat (CAG)
2. **Political populism** - Diverting long-term developmental funds into short-term electoral "gifts".
3. **Poor accountability mechanisms.** Eg. lack of social audits
4. **Absence of Outcome Budgeting-** Focus on "outlays" rather than "impact" (lives changed).
5. **Institutionalized Rent-Seeking-** The presence of middlemen in every stage of fund dispersal.
6. **Politician-bureaucrat-corporate nexus (Vohra committee)** - leads to **culture of impunity**

Implications

1. Violates **utilitarian maxim** of greatest happiness of greatest number
2. Leads to **inequality** - 1% holding >40% national wealth (**Oxfam**)
3. **Poor quality of service** is delivered to citizens. Eg. rotten foodgrains in PDS
4. **Cost Overruns-** Delays lead to inflation-adjusted increases in project costs.
5. **Delayed Benefits-** The public is deprived of essential services
6. **Opportunity Cost-** Capital that could have been used elsewhere remains locked and unproductive.
7. **Economic Distortion-** Unproductive spending leads to inflation without asset creation.
8. **Erosion of Ethics-** Normalizes a culture of dishonesty within the civil service.
9. Leads to **"Taxpayer Cynicism"** - encourage tax evasion.

Measures needed

1. **Performance-Linked Promotions-** Incorporate "Fund Utilization Efficiency" as a key metric in the Annual Confidential Reports (ACR) of IAS and IPS officers.
2. Implement a **financial incentive and protection program** for whistleblowers. **(US Model)**
3. Ensuring the independence and resource-sufficiency of bodies like **Lokpal, Lokayukta** and **CVC**
4. **Adoption of the "Hong Kong Model" (ICAC)** to tackle corruption - three-pronged strategy of Investigation, Prevention, and Community Education
5. **E-Governance** to reduce human discretion and the "gatekeeper" effect. Eg. **GeM**
6. **Citizens' Charters-** Mandating clear timelines for service delivery. Eg. SAKALA (Karnataka Guarantee of Services Act)
7. Moving beyond a "Rule-based" conduct code (what not to do) to a **"Value-based" code of ethics** (what to strive for) (**2nd ARC**).
8. **Competency-linked training** under **Mission Karmayogi** to ensure civil servants are not only skilled but also ethically grounded.
9. **Legal backing to Social Audits. (Meghalaya Act)**
10. **Real-time Public Dashboards-** Eg. "Jan Soochna" portals to track spending and report misuse.
11. Ensuring **transparency in electoral funding** to prevent the "quid-pro-quo" culture at top.

Efficiency in spending is as important as expansion of spending for **Viksit Bharat @2047.**

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Whistleblowing

Whistleblowing is the courageous act by an employee or an insider who exposes deep-seated corruption, financial fraud, or systemic mismanagement happening within a public or private organization to external watchdogs or the public.

Key Features of Whistleblower Protection Act (2014)

1. **Broad Definition:** Allows any public servant, non-governmental organization, or common citizen to make a protected disclosure regarding systemic corruption.
2. Establishes the **Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)** and State Vigilance Commissions as the dedicated, independent bodies to receive complaints.
3. Strictly obligates the competent authority to keep the name and personal details of the whistleblower **completely anonymous.**
4. **Safeguards Against Victimization:** Empowers authorities to give binding directives to protect employees from administrative demotions, harassment, or punitive transfers.
5. **Exclusion of Identity under RTI:** Specifically exempts the personal identity details of the whistleblower from being disclosed under the Right to Information Act.
6. **Penalties for False Disclosures:** Prescribes strict prison terms and financial fines for individuals who deliberately file malicious or completely fabricated complaints.

Significance of Whistleblowing in an Organisation

1. **Deters Institutional Financial Fraud:** Eg. **Satyendra Dubey exposing NHAI** sub-contracting scams.
2. **Upholds Public Health and Safety:** Eg. **Dinesh Thakur exposing Ranbaxy** data falsification.
3. **Improves Corporate Governance Integrity:** Eg. **Whistleblower letters exposing governance failures** at Infosys.
4. **Protects Pristine Ecological Environments:** Eg. Disclosures exposing **illegal stone mining syndicates** in Assam.
5. **Enforces Constitutional Accountability:** Eg. Exposing the multi-crore **Jal Jeevan Mission tender manipulations**.
6. **Optimizes Public Welfare Allocations** by eliminating leaks. Eg. Whistleblowers exposing **PDS ration grain diversions** to open markets.
7. **Saves Severe Exchequer Cost Overruns:** Catching procurement corruption early prevents long-term project delays and budget inflations.
8. **Cultivates an Ethical Workplace Culture:** Normalizing truth-telling eliminates toxic cultures of complicit silence and fear among employees.
9. **Exposes Illegal Political-Bureaucratic Collusions**
10. **Bridges the Citizen-State Trust Deficit**

Major Issues with Whistleblowing in India

1. **Lack of Physical Protection:** Eg. **Murder of Shanmughan Manjunath** for exposing oil adulteration.
2. **Chronic Operational Sluggishness of CVC:** Multi-year delays in investigating protected complaints allow corrupt entities to easily destroy evidence.
3. **Vindictive Career Retaliation:** Eg. **Frequent punitive transfers of Ashok Khemka** after exposing land scams.
4. **No Provision for Anonymous Complaints:** The legal requirement to submit personal identity proofs deters many honest employees from reporting fraud.

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5. **Weak Judicial Enforcement of Protections:** Lower courts frequently fail to issue immediate, binding stay orders against the harassment of whistleblowers.
6. **Absence of Monetary Reward Incentives:** Unlike Western corporate setups, India lacks financial frameworks to support whistleblowers who lose their livelihoods.
7. **Misuse of Official Secrets Act** to criminally prosecute employees who expose fraud.
8. **Socio-Cultural Normalization of Complicity:** Entrenched institutional mindsets label whistleblowers as "disloyal snitches" rather than ethical guardians.

Way Forward

1. **Enforce 2nd ARC Recommendations:** expand the definition of whistleblowing and create a dedicated, independent protection cell.
2. **Institutionalize Global Best Practices (US SEC Model):** Introduce a financial **bounty system** that rewards whistleblowers with a percentage of the recovered stolen public funds.
3. **Enact a Comprehensive Witness Protection Scheme:** Adopt the **UK model** of establishing specialized police units explicitly tasked with providing physical security and identity shifts for threatened insiders.
4. **Hota Committee Directives:** Legally insulate civil servants from arbitrary, vindictive transfers by ensuring all postings are managed by an autonomous **Civil Services Board.**
5. **Narrow down National Security Exemptions**
6. **Set Up Dedicated Fast-Track Whistleblower Courts** to resolve all whistleblower harassment cases within a 90-day window.
7. **Mandate Independent POSH-Style Corporate Committees** to handle internal ethical violations.
8. **Ethical Literacy under Mission Karmayogi** to shift the bureaucratic mindsets from protective departmental loyalty to absolute constitutional morality.

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Chapter 9

Corporate Governance

PYQs

[2023] What do you understand by 'moral integrity' and 'professional efficiency' in the context of corporate governance in India ? Illustrate with suitable examples. (10)

[2022] In the contemporary world, the corporate sector's contribution in generating wealth and employment is increasing. In doing so, they are bringing in unprecedented onslaught on the climate, environmental sustainability and living conditions of human beings. In this background, do you find that Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) is efficient and sufficient enough to fulfill the social roles and responsibilities needed in the corporate work mandated? Critically examine. (10)

1. According to the **Cadbury Committee**, corporate governance is the **system by which companies are directed and controlled** to serve the best interests of all **stakeholders** and society at large.
2. Corporate governance consists of **systems, processes,** and **principles** that ensure **fairness, transparency,** and **accountability** in corporate management.
3. **Scope**: It includes **structures, mechanisms,** and **practices** that regulate the **conduct** of corporate entities and support **ethical business practices**.

Quotes on Corporate Governance

- "Good corporate governance is about **'intellectual honesty'** and not just sticking to rules and regulations." - Mervyn King
- "If management is about running the business, **governance is about seeing that it is run properly**." - R Tricker
- "Corporate governance is not a matter of law, it is a matter of ethics and conscience."

Theories & Ethical Philosophies Related to Corporate Governance

- **Gandhian Trusteeship Model** - Wealth is a **trust** held by the rich on behalf of society. Business leaders should act as **custodians of societal welfare**, not just profit-makers. Eg. Tata Group's philanthropic model aligns with trusteeship ideals.
- **Narayana Murthy's "Compassionate Capitalism"** - Capitalism must include **compassion, fairness, and stakeholder respect**. Promotes **employee welfare, ethical leadership, and long-term stakeholder value**.
- **Chanakya's Arthashastra Ethics** - A king (or CEO) must act with **dharma (duty), artha (wealth), and nyaya (justice)**. Advocates for **merit-based appointments**, **vigilance**, and **anti-corruption** mechanisms.
- **Carroll's Pyramid of Corporate Social Responsibility**
- **Four-tier Model:**
  - **Economic Responsibility** (Be profitable)
  - **Legal Responsibility** (Obey the law)
  - **Ethical Responsibility** (Do what is right)

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- **Philanthropic Responsibility** (Be a good corporate citizen)
- **OECD Principles of Corporate Governance**
  - Ensuring effective corporate governance framework
  - Shareholder rights and responsibilities
  - Equitable treatment of shareholders
  - Role of stakeholders in governance
  - Disclosure and transparency
  - Responsibilities of the board
- **Triple Bottom Line - Companies should measure success not just by Profit, but also People and Planet.**
- **Business Ethics Theory (Deontological & Utilitarian)**
- **Deontology (Kant):** Act based on **duty**, not outcomes. Ethical corporate conduct regardless of profitability.
- **Utilitarianism (Bentham/Mill):** Maximize **overall good**. Eg. CSR that benefits the most stakeholders.
- **"Commerce without Morality" as One of Gandhi's Seven Social Sins**

Importance of Corporate Governance

1. **Attracting Global Capital:** Robust governance frameworks build international investor confidence, encouraging sustained Foreign Direct Investment (FDI).
2. **Preventing Corporate Scandals:** Active, ethical board oversight acts as a shield against financial fraud, insider trading, and severe accounting manipulations.
3. **Protecting Minority Shareholders:** Ensuring that promoter families or majority stakeholders do not unethically suppress the financial rights of small retail investors.

1. **Mitigates Corporate Frauds and Scandals by**
   a. Enforcing **audits**, **risk oversight**, and **independent boards**.
   b. Promoting **whistleblower protections** and **ethics hotlines**.
   c. **Institutionalizing Right Livelihood (Samma Ajiva):** Aligning business operations with broader social ethics, preventing data theft, employee exploitation, and consumer deception
   d. **Driving Long-Term Value Creation:** Moving businesses away from short-term profit maximization toward sustainable growth, protecting long-term equity value.
   e. **Ensuring Regulatory Compliance:** Helping companies systematically navigate India's dense, evolving legal landscape, preventing costly litigation and severe penal fines.
   f. **Enhancing Corporate Accountability:** Defining clean boundaries of power between Board of Directors, the CEO, and executive management to prevent dictatorial operational choices.
   g. **Promoting Environmental and Social Justice:** Eg. **BRSR (Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting)** frameworks to track ESG metrics.
   h. **Securing Workplace Democracy:** Eg. The mandatory institutionalization of **Internal Complaints Committees (ICC)** under the POSH Act to safeguard female employees.
   i. **Compensation for Weak Laws**: Strong governance can offset **deficiencies in corporate laws** or enforcement, promoting integrity despite external regulatory limitations.

Corporate Governance Issues in India

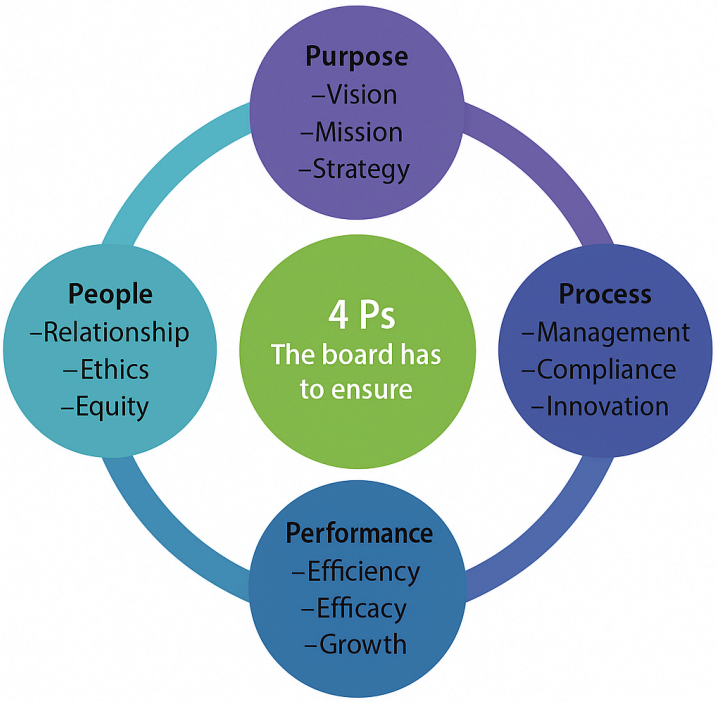
1. The majority of Indian corporations are **family-owned or promoter-controlled**. This leads to boards acting as rubber stamps, undermining the concept of an objective board.
2. **Lack of Ethical Leadership - Eg.** Satyam scandal (2009) - Falsification of accounts under promoter control.

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3. **Conflict of Interest** - Independent directors and audit committees are compromised due to personal or professional affiliations. Breach of **impartiality** & **professional integrity**.
4. **Lack of Transparency** - **Eg.** IL&FS crisis - Concealment of financial stress from investors and regulators.
5. **Weak Whistleblower Mechanisms** - Fear of retaliation, lack of anonymity, and inaction on complaints. Discourages **moral courage**, **truth-telling**, and **organizational justice**.
6. **Insider Trading and Market Manipulation** - Use of non-public information for personal gain. Breach of **fairness**, **honesty**, and **fiduciary responsibility**.
7. **Crony Capitalism and Regulatory Capture** - Close links between business and political elites lead to biased policymaking. Erodes **institutional integrity**, **justice**, and **rule of law**.
8. **Tokenism in CSR Compliance** - CSR becomes a statutory burden, not a moral responsibility. Dilutes the spirit of **corporate conscience** and **inclusive development**.
9. **Regulatory Arbitrage** - Companies exploit gaps between SEBI, MCA, and RBI rules. **Eg.** Sahara bypassed SEBI rules to raise funds unethically.
10. **Poor Succession Planning** - Overreliance on founders leads to instability during transitions. **Eg.** Infosys saw multiple CEO exits due to unclear succession policies.
11. **Inadequate Risk Management Systems** - Firms fail to foresee or mitigate financial and operational risks. **Eg.** Yes Bank had no checks on concentration of risky loans.

Way Forward

1. **Strengthen Board Independence and Accountability** - Impose **cooling-off periods** for independent directors who had past relationships with the firm.
2. Establish and enforce a clear **code of ethics** defining expected conduct and ethical standards for all employees and stakeholders.
3. Align **executive compensation** with company performance to incentivize leadership for sustainable growth.
4. **Improve Transparency and Disclosure Norms**
   a. Strengthen **mandatory real-time disclosures** for related party transactions and beneficial ownership.
   b. Mandate **Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG)** reporting for all large-cap firms.
5. **Rotate auditors** periodically and bar conflict-prone consulting roles. Strengthen oversight by **NFRA** (National Financial Reporting Authority).



6. **Harmonize provisions** across SEBI, MCA, RBI for unified compliance.
7. Reduce regulatory arbitrage through **single-window grievance redressal systems**.
8. **Foster Ethical Leadership** - Integrate **ethics training** into board orientation programs.
9. Move from **shareholder primacy** to **stakeholder-inclusive models**. Empower minority shareholders through **e-voting rights, class action suits**, and education.
10. **Global Benchmarks and Best Practices** - Adopt successful elements from:
    a. **UK Cadbury Report** (board accountability)

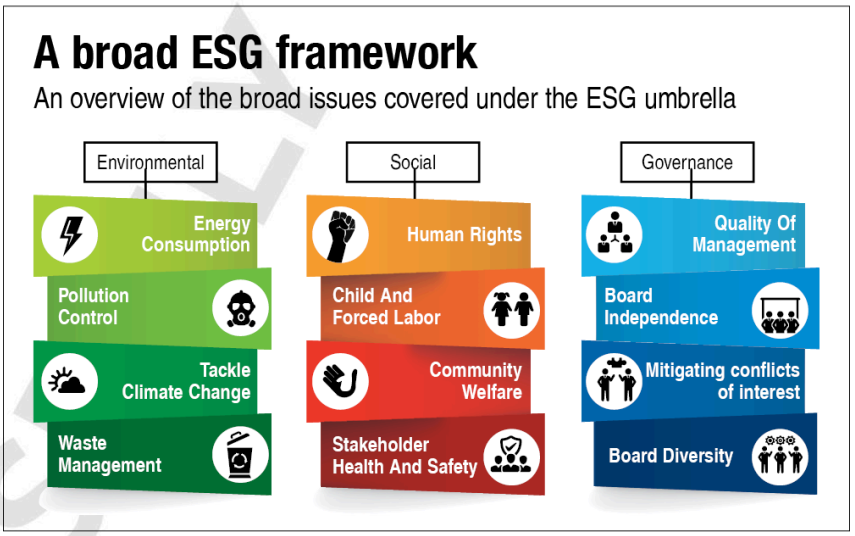
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b. **South Africa's King IV Report** (integrated thinking),
c. **Philippines' Seal of Good Local Governance** (incentive-based governance rating).

11. **Kumar Mangalam Birla Committee Report (2000)**
    a. Recommended establishing an **audit committee** with at least three independent directors.
    b. Required **four board meetings per year** to ensure consistent oversight.
    c. **Comprehensive information disclosure** to shareholders about their investments.
12. **Uday Kotak Committee (2017)** - Recommended **separating the roles** of chairperson and CEO/MD to balance power and improve accountability.

ESG Norms in Corporate Governance

ESG framework evaluates a company's performance **beyond financial metrics**, focusing on its environmental impact, social responsibility, and governance standards.



Significance in Corporate Governance

1. **Long-term Value Creation** - ESG-integrated governance leads to **resilient, future-ready businesses**.
2. **Ethical and Transparent Practices** - Encourages **accountability, compliance**, and **responsible leadership**.
3. **Risk Mitigation** - Identifies **non-financial risks** like climate liability, social unrest, and reputational damage.
4. **Investor Confidence** - Globally, ESG-aligned firms attract **ethical and impact investors**.
5. **Aligns with Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** - Supports India's commitment to **Agenda 2030** and **Net Zero** targets.

Challenges in Implementation

Challenge	Explanation
Lack of Standardized Frameworks	Different ESG rating agencies use inconsistent metrics.
Greenwashing	Companies falsely market themselves as sustainable without substantive action.
Data Gaps and Poor Disclosure	Limited availability of verifiable ESG data, especially among mid-sized firms.
Short-Termism	Corporate focus on quarterly results sidelines long-term ESG goals.
Low Awareness	Many boardrooms and investors are unfamiliar with ESG principles.

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Way Forward

1. **Regulatory Strengthening** - Expand BRSR applicability to more firms and mandate **third-party ESG audits**.
2. **Capacity Building** - Train board members, compliance officers, and auditors in ESG risk assessment.
3. **Global Alignment** - Harmonize India's ESG framework with **IFRS Sustainability Standards** and **EU Taxonomy**.
4. **Encourage Ethical Investing** - Promote **ESG mutual funds** and incentives for impact investors.
5. **Enforce Anti-Greenwashing Mechanisms** - Penalize false sustainability claims and set up a **regulatory watchdog**.
6. **Integrate ESG into Corporate Culture** - Make ESG a **core governance value**, not just a compliance requirement.

Indian Best Practices

- **Tata Group:** Integrated sustainability into business strategy; publishes detailed ESG reports.
- **Infosys:** Achieved carbon neutrality ahead of schedule; strong ESG transparency.
- **Mahindra Group:** Internal carbon pricing and green manufacturing initiatives.

Global Best Practices

- **EU Green Taxonomy:** Standardized classification system for sustainable economic activities.
- **BlackRock:** World's largest asset manager uses ESG scoring to guide investments.
- **Japan's GPIF:** Public pension fund integrates ESG into long-term investment mandates.

ESG norms are no longer optional-they are **ethical imperatives** in modern corporate governance. As

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

CSR refers to a company's ethical obligation to contribute to **social, environmental, and economic development** while improving the quality of life for employees, communities, and society at large.

Under **Companies Act, 2013,** eligible companies must spend at least **2% of their average net profit** over the previous **three years** on CSR activities, contributing to **social development** and **welfare**.

Significance of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

Stakeholder	Significance	Examples
Company	Enhances **brand credibility** and **stakeholder trust** Builds an **ethical corporate culture** grounded in **Integrity**, **Accountability**, and **Gandhian Trusteeship**. Fosters **long-term sustainability** and **ethical capitalism**, beyond profit maximization.	Infosys: Carbon neutrality & ESG disclosures Tata Group: Ethical legacy in business
Community	Empowers local populations and ensures **inclusive development**, in line with **Utilitarianism** - maximizing welfare for the greatest number. Embodies **Gandhian ideals of Sarvodaya** - upliftment of all.	ITC's e-Choupal: Rural digital empowerment HUL: Hygiene & nutrition programs

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Stakeholder	Significance	Examples
Government	Complements state efforts in delivering **public goods** and achieving **SDG targets** Reduces **fiscal burden** by leveraging private sector resources for **welfare delivery**. Operationalizes the **Subsidiarity Principle** by decentralizing development efforts.	NTPC: Skill centers aligned with Skill India ONGC: CSR support for Swachh Bharat
Environment	Encourages **environmental stewardship** and **climate responsibility**, aligned with **Intergenerational Ethics**. Promotes **green innovation**, **ESG compliance**, and **resource conservation**, helping businesses transition toward **net-zero emissions**	Wipro: Green campuses and zero-waste initiatives

Issues with Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)

1. **Compliance over Conscience** - CSR is v**iewed as an additional corporate tax**, not as a moral responsibility. Violates the spirit of **Gandhian Trusteeship** and **moral voluntarism**.
2. **Tokenism and Superficial Implementation** - CSR activities often involve symbolic acts like donations or publicity events without sustainable outcomes.
3. **Lack of Impact Assessment** - Most CSR projects are not independently evaluated for actual community impact or long-term benefit.
4. **Diversion and Misuse of Funds** - Funds are often routed through proxy NGOs, family-run trusts, or opaque entities with poor monitoring.
5. CSR spending is **concentrated in urban areas and popular sectors like education and health,** ignoring rural and tribal needs.
6. **Limited Stakeholder Engagement** - Imposing top-down corporate agendas that completely ignore the actual felt-needs of grassroots communities.
7. **Lack of Sector-Specific Expertise in Corporates** - Companies often lack in-house knowledge to plan or execute development programs meaningfully. Leads to **inefficiency**, and **wastage**
8. **Greenwashing and Misreporting** - Companies exaggerate their CSR efforts in public disclosures to gain goodwill. Breaches **honesty**, **truthfulness**, and **reputation ethics**.
9. **Superficial Public Relations Window-Dressing:** Eg. Conducting single-day medical health camps instead of investing in durable village primary healthcare centers.
10. **Absence of Collaborative Synergy:** Fragmentation of funds across isolated corporate projects prevents solving systemic national crises.

Recommendations of the Injeti Srinivas Committee on CSR

1. **Tax Deductibility**: Make **CSR expenditure** tax deductible to encourage greater corporate participation.
2. **Carry Forward of Unspent Funds**: Allow companies to **carry forward unspent CSR funds** for **three to five years** for better project planning and sustained impact.
3. **Alignment with SDGs**: Align **Schedule 7** of Companies Act, with the **SDGs** to enhance CSR contributions toward global sustainability priorities.
4. Balance **local area CSR preferences** with broader **national priorities** for a more effective impact.
5. Mandate **impact assessments** for CSR projects with obligations of **INR 5 crore** or more to ensure accountability and measure outcomes.

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6. **Registration of Implementation Agencies**: Require **implementation agencies** to register on the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) Portal** to increase transparency.
7. Develop a **CSR exchange portal** to connect **contributors, beneficiaries,** and **agencies** for coordinated project implementation.
8. Permit **CSR spending** in **social benefit bonds** to attract investment for socially beneficial projects.
9. Encourage the establishment of **social impact companies** focused on social welfare to strengthen CSR ecosystems

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Chapter 10

Case Study Answer Writing Framework

THE SEVEN-MOVE STRUCTURE — AT A GLANCE

Move	Section	What it must do
1	Introduction	Hook (quote / data / context), then a two-line summary naming the central ethical conflict.
2	Guiding values	State the constitutional and ethical compass that should govern the response.
3	Stakeholders	Map every party touched and, crucially, their competing interests.
4	Ethical issues	Surface the issues — chronologically or stakeholder-wise; list, never narrate.
5	Ethical dilemma	Name the value-conflict precisely; resolve it with a stated framework.
6	Options evaluation	Lay out three to four realistic options with merits, demerits and a short ethical read on each.
7	Course of action	Commit to the chosen path, implement with safeguards, flag the hurdles, add measures.

MOVE 1 — INTRODUCTION

Three ways to open

Quote-based

Best when the case turns on a single clean value such as integrity, compassion or courage. Eg. a line on conscience to open a whistle-blower case.

Data / fact-based

Open with a hard statistic or institutional fact that frames the stakes, then connect it to the case. Best where the public-interest dimension is measurable. Eg. for corruption - you can start with India's rank in the corruption perception Index.

Contextual

If the case study mirrors any recent news then you can start with the same reference and then link with the case study.

The summary line (do this right after the hook)

In two lines, state **(a)** who must decide, **(b)** what they must decide between, and **(c)** why it is hard. This signals to the examiner that you have grasped the crux before you begin to analyse.

> **Reusable opening template**

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> "[Hook — quote / data / context]. The case places [protagonist / role] at the intersection of [value A] and [value B], where [the binding constraint] makes a clean choice difficult. At its core this is a conflict between [X] and [Y]."

A quote bank for openings and conclusions

Quotes
Power: *"Power tends to corrupt; absolute power corrupts absolutely."* — Lord Acton
Public trust: *"A public office is a public trust."* — Maxim of administrative law
Welfare: *"In the happiness of his subjects lies the king's happiness."* — Kautilya, Arthashastra
Courage: *"To see what is right and not to do it is want of courage."* — Confucius
Right vs lawful: *"Knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do."* — Potter Stewart
Service: *"They alone live who live for others."* — Swami Vivekananda
Justice: *"Justice delayed is justice denied."* — W. E. Gladstone
Conviction: *"Knowing what is right does not mean much unless you do what is right."* — Theodore Roosevelt

MOVE 2 — GUIDING PRINCIPLES OR VISION OR ETHICAL VALUES

GUIDING PRINCIPLE - Before dissecting issues, state the compass. One or two lines naming the values that should govern the protagonist's conduct shows ethical clarity and sets up the judgement you make later. Draw from three wells: constitutional values, civil-service values, and ethical theory.

VISION - It will involve your objective. Mention stakeholders. Eg- ensuring justice and upholding rule of law.

ETHICAL VALUES - Give the list of values using diagram

Constitutional and civil-service values

Source	Core values to invoke
Constitution (Preamble, Part IV-A)	Justice, liberty, equality, fraternity, dignity of the individual.
Civil-service ethos (2nd ARC, 2007)	Integrity, impartiality, non-partisanship, objectivity, dedication to public service, empathy.
Seven Principles of Public Life (Nolan Committee, 1995)	Selflessness, integrity, objectivity, accountability, openness, honesty, leadership.

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Western ethical frameworks you can invoke

Theory	Core idea	Best invoked when
Utilitarianism (Consequentialism)	The greatest good for the greatest number.	The action affects a large public and outcomes are measurable.
Deontology (Kant)	Act only on a rule you would will to be universal.	A duty or rule is at stake regardless of the outcome.
Virtue ethics (Aristotle)	Cultivate character — honesty, courage, prudence.	You are judging the person's character, not only the act.
Care ethics	Decide through empathy and the web of relationships.	Vulnerable individuals and the human element dominate.
Justice as fairness (Rawls)	Protect the least advantaged; reason behind a veil of ignorance.	Distribution of benefits and burdens is contested.
Rights-based ethics	Protect inviolable individual rights.	Life, liberty or dignity of an individual is threatened.
Social contract	Honour the implicit citizen–state compact.	Public trust in institutions is at stake.

Indian ethical thought — ideas and shlokas

Nishkama Karma — कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन (Karmanye vadhikaraste ma phaleshu kadachana): you have a right to action alone, never to its fruits — act for duty, not reward.

Dharma — धर्मो रक्षति रक्षितः (Dharmo rakshati rakshitah): righteousness protects those who uphold it.

Truth — सत्यं वद धर्मं चर (Satyam vada dharmam chara): speak the truth, walk the path of righteousness.

Public welfare — प्रजासुखे सुखं राज्ञः (Praja-sukhe sukham rajnah): in the welfare of the people lies the ruler's welfare. — Kautilya

Universal family — वसुधैव कुटुम्बकम् (Vasudhaiva kutumbakam): the world is one family.

Compassion — सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः (Sarve bhavantu sukhinah): may all beings be happy.

Humility — विद्या ददाति विनयम् (Vidya dadati vinayam): true knowledge bestows humility.

Gandhi's seven social sins

Invoke these when the case shows a means–ends problem or the erosion of values for expedient gain.

1. Wealth without work.
2. Pleasure without conscience.
3. Knowledge without character.
4. Commerce without morality.
5. Science without humanity.
6. Worship without sacrifice.
7. Politics without principle.

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MOVE 3 — STAKEHOLDERS & THEIR INTERESTS

List every party touched by the decision and, crucially, what each one wants. Showing competing interests is exactly what converts a description into ethical analysis. A two-column table (or a stakeholder diagram) works well; always include the protagonist, the vulnerable, the institution, and society at large.

Stakeholder map — a working template

Stakeholder	Interest / stake at play
You (the officer / protagonist)	Integrity, conscience, career security, legal safety.
Immediate victim / beneficiary	Justice, relief, dignity, sometimes survival.
Family / personal relations	Loyalty, well-being, emotional and financial ties.
Superior / political executive	Compliance, authority, reputation, control.
Colleagues / subordinates	Fairness, morale, and the precedent the decision sets.
Organisation / department	Credibility, rule of law, institutional integrity.
Society / general public	Public interest, equity, and trust in governance.
The wider system / future cases	Precedent, deterrence, long-run systemic integrity.

Spotting the dilemma early. Where two stakeholders' interests collide head-on — a superior's order against a victim's right to justice, say — flag it here. That collision is usually the very dilemma you resolve in Move 5.

MOVE 4 — IDENTIFYING THE ETHICAL ISSUES

Approach A — the chronological method

Walk the case in time order; at each event, name the value at stake. Best when the case unfolds as a sequence of decisions or events.

1. **At the first event** — an issue of [value], because [reason] or impact.
2. **At the next event** — an issue of [value], because [reason] or impact.
3. **Up to the present decision point** — the live issue the protagonist now faces.

Strength: mirrors the narrative, so nothing is missed. **Risk:** it can drift into mere retelling — keep each point analytical by naming the value, not just describing the event.

Approach B — the stakeholder-based method

Group the issues under each stakeholder: what ethical concern does each party's position raise? Best when many parties are involved and the situation is static rather than sequential.

Strength: guarantees no party is ignored and reads as analysis, not narration.

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Which method to use

Rule of thumb. Use the chronological method for event-driven cases (a sequence of choices over time). Use the stakeholder method for actor-driven cases (many parties, a single static situation). You may blend the two — a chronological spine, with a stakeholder lens trained on the pivotal event.

Bank — common ethical issues to flag

Integrity and probity

Issue	What it is
Corruption / bribery	Demand, offer or acceptance of illegal gratification for an official favour.
Misuse / embezzlement of funds	Diversion, leakage or wasteful use of money meant for the public.
Conflict of interest	Private interest — financial, family, personal — colliding with official duty.
Falsification of records	Doctored reports, fake muster rolls, manipulated figures or evaluations.
Kickbacks in procurement	Tilting tenders, contracts or postings for personal or partisan benefit.

Abuse of power and position

Issue	What it is
Abuse / misuse of authority	Using the office for personal, partisan or vindictive ends.
Nepotism / favouritism	Favouring kin, friends, caste or community over merit.
Political pressure / interference	A superior or politician pushing an illegal or unethical action.
Coercion / intimidation	Pressuring subordinates, citizens or witnesses through threats.
Capture by vested interests	Bending policy or enforcement to benefit a contractor, lobby or industrialist.

Justice, fairness and rights

Issue	What it is
Discrimination / bias	Unequal treatment on caste, religion, gender, class or region.
Violation of dignity / rights	Custodial excess, denial of due process, humiliating the powerless.
Insensitivity to the vulnerable	Ignoring the poor, women, children, the disabled, tribals or migrants.
Exploitation	Wage theft, forced work, or denial of entitlements to labour or beneficiaries.
Gender insensitivity / harassment	Workplace harassment or gender bias in service delivery.

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Transparency and accountability

Issue	What it is
Suppression of information	Hiding facts, doctoring an inquiry, or stonewalling RTI.
Lack of accountability	Passing the buck; no ownership of decisions or failures.
Breach of confidentiality	Leaking or misusing privileged official information.
Privacy violation / surveillance	Unauthorised monitoring or misuse of personal data.
Misinformation / manipulation	Spreading false or selective information to mislead.

Duty and professional conduct

Issue	What it is
Negligence / dereliction of duty	Callousness or apathy; failure to act when action is owed.
Red-tapism / procedural rigidity	Mechanical rule-following that defeats the rule's purpose and harms citizens.
Professional misconduct	Breach of code of conduct, service rules or professional ethics.
Compromising merit / process	Exam leaks, recruitment fraud, or rigged evaluations.
Environmental / ecological neglect	Ignoring environmental norms for development or convenience.

Character and courage

Issue	What it is
Moral cowardice	Knowing what is right but lacking the courage to do it.
Dishonesty / deception	Lying, misrepresentation, or breaking trust.
Misplaced loyalty / blind obedience	Following an unethical order out of loyalty or fear.
Victimisation of whistle-blowers	Punishing honest officers who expose wrongdoing.
Erosion of public trust	Conduct that damages the credibility of the institution itself.

Conflict of interest (forms)

Issue	What it is
Revolving door	Moving between a regulatory post and the private firm one once regulated.

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Issue	What it is
Quid pro quo / future favour	A decision quietly shaped by an expected personal benefit later.
Insider use of official information	Using privileged information for private or family gain.
Family / business interest	Deciding matters that benefit one's kin or one's own enterprise.
Gifts and hospitality	Accepting favours or perks that subtly bias official judgement.

Ends versus means

Issue	What it is
Noble-cause corruption	Breaking rules in the belief it serves a higher good.
Cutting corners for results	Bypassing due process to hit a target or a deadline.
Falsifying data to show success	Doctoring outcomes to project achievement that did not happen.
Coercion to meet targets	Pressuring staff or citizens to deliver the numbers.
Extra-legal / vigilante action	Taking the law into one's own hands for a 'just' cause.

Environment versus development

Issue	What it is
Bypassing environmental clearances	Pushing a project past mandatory approvals or norms.
Suppressing impact data	Hiding or diluting environmental or health assessments.
Displacement without rehabilitation	Uprooting communities with no fair resettlement or relief.
Forest / tribal rights override	Diverting forest or tribal land for industry or mining.
Intergenerational neglect	Sacrificing long-term ecology for short-term growth.

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Work-life balance

Issue	What it is
Overwork / burnout culture	Normalising unreasonable hours and 'always available' demands.
Neglect of family and health	Sacrificing personal well-being and relationships for career.
Blurring personal and official time	Public duty intruding on private life, and the reverse.
Toxic workplace pressure	Unreasonable demands that erode staff dignity and morale.
Ambition over ethics	Compromising values or relationships to climb faster.

Corporate and business frauds

Issue	What it is
Accounting fraud	Cooking the books or falsifying financial statements.
Insider trading	Trading on unpublished, price-sensitive information.
Misleading investors / mis-selling	False disclosures, Ponzi schemes or deceptive products.
Bank fraud / wilful default	Diverting loans, or defaulting by design.
Regulatory and audit capture	Colluding with auditors or regulators to hide wrongdoing.

From issue to dilemma. Several issues are the seed of a Move 5 dilemma — 'political pressure' becomes loyalty to superior vs public interest; 'conflict of interest' becomes personal relationship vs duty; 'red-tapism' becomes rules vs compassion.

MOVE 5 — RESOLVING THE ETHICAL DILEMMA

A dilemma is not a wrong to be condemned — it is a genuine clash between two defensible goods where every option costs something. Your task is to name the conflict precisely, then resolve it with a stated method rather than gut feeling.

Issue versus dilemma — do not confuse them

Issue: a value is violated and the right answer is obvious — stop the wrong.

Dilemma: two values both pull legitimately (Eg. transparency against confidentiality), so you must choose and justify the trade-off.

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Frameworks to resolve a dilemma

Stakeholder-based resolution (recommended default)

1. List the stakeholders and the value each one represents.
2. Identify the two or three values in direct conflict.
3. Rank them by constitutional priority — public interest and the vulnerable usually outweigh personal or political interest.
4. Choose the option that honours the higher-ranked value while minimising harm to the other.
5. Justify with a theory — utilitarian for scale, deontology for duty, care ethics for the vulnerable.

The Potter Box (alternative)

1. Define the facts of the situation.
2. Identify the values in play.
3. Apply ethical principles — utilitarian, Kantian, Rawlsian.
4. Choose loyalties — to whom is the primary duty owed? — then act.

Useful when conflicting loyalties (to self, to a superior, to the public) are the heart of the case.

Kidder's checklist (alternative)

Recognise the dilemma, then classify it by paradigm — **truth vs loyalty, individual vs community, short term vs long term, or justice vs mercy.** Gather the facts

Bank — common ethical dilemmas (value conflicts)

Dilemma	The competing pull	Typical case trigger
Personal vs professional ethics	Private conscience vs official duty	An order conflicts with personal morality.
Legal vs ethical	What the law allows vs what is right	A lawful action produces an unjust outcome.
Loyalty to superior vs public interest	Obedience vs duty to citizens	An illegal or unethical instruction from a boss.
Rules vs compassion (justice vs mercy)	Letter of the rule vs human need	A rule, applied strictly, harms the deserving.
Efficiency vs equity	Speed and cost vs fairness	Allocating a scarce resource.
Transparency vs confidentiality	Right to know vs duty of secrecy	Disclosure could harm, or could expose a wrong.
Individual good vs common good	One person vs the many	A public project displaces a few.
Means vs ends	Morality of method vs worth of goal	A worthy end tempts an improper shortcut.
Short term vs long term	Immediate relief vs lasting good	A populist quick-fix against durable reform.

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Dilemma	The competing pull	Typical case trigger
Autonomy vs paternalism	Letting people choose vs protecting them	Welfare imposed 'for their own good'.
Personal relationship vs duty	Loyalty to kin or friend vs impartiality	A conflict of interest involving family.
Truth vs organisational reputation	Honest disclosure vs protecting the institution	Reporting an internal failure.
Whistle-blowing vs organisational loyalty	Exposing wrong vs team solidarity	Witnessing corruption among colleagues.
Discretion vs accountability	Personal judgement vs following process	A rule fits the case badly; bending it tempts.

MOVE 6 — OPTIONS EVALUATION

How many options, and how much detail

If the question asks...	Then provide
'Critically evaluate the options', or merits and demerits explicitly asked	Three options (four at most), each with three merits and three demerits.
Simply 'options available' or 'what would you do'	Either three to four options with merits and demerits, or five to six options each briefly elaborated — both are acceptable.

A framework for generating options

Anchor the set on the two extremes, then build the realistic middle. Most cases yield a clean three or four.

1. **The two extremes** — full compliance (completely agree) and outright refusal (completely disagree).
2. **One or two middle paths** — a balanced or creative option that secures the core value while limiting harm — usually where the marks lie.
3. **Inaction / status quo** — wait for the superior's written orders and hold the position; worth weighing, rarely the best.
4. **The escapist route, transfer or resignation** — reserve strictly for extreme pressure, a threat to your life, or a safety risk to your family. Do not reach for it in ordinary circumstances.

Use the escapist route with care.

Seeking a transfer or resigning is a legitimate option only when the pressure is extreme, your life is threatened, or your family's safety is at risk. In any lesser situation it reads as evasion — the examiner wants you to engage the problem, not flee it.

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Writing the merits and demerits

For each merit and demerit, name the stakeholder interest it serves or harms, and substantiate with an ethical principle, a value, or a real-life example. A merit or demerit that names no interest and cites nothing is just an assertion.

Per-option structure

- State the option in one line.
- Merits — each point names the interest it serves, plus a value or example.
- Demerits — each point names the interest it harms, plus a value or example.
- A short ethical evaluation of the option, set off in a box (see below).

Worked example of one option

Option A — comply with the order and clear the file.

Merits. (i) Protects your career and avoids immediate confrontation (self-interest). (ii) Keeps the working relationship with the superior intact (organisational harmony). (iii) Disposes of the file quickly (efficiency).

Demerits. (i) Betrays public interest and the rule of law (probity). (ii) Sets a precedent of pliability (institutional integrity). (iii) Violates your conscience and your oath of office.

Ethical read. Fails the tests of public interest and constitutional morality — short-term safety bought at the cost of probity and long-term public trust. Defensible only if no lawful alternative existed, which here it does.

Real-life examples to substantiate

A precise, accurate example is worth a paragraph of theory. Keep a few ready.

Satyendra Dubey — NHAI engineer who exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral and was murdered in 2003; the case drove India's whistle-blower protection debate.

S. Manjunath — IOC officer killed in 2005 for sealing a fuel outlet selling adulterated petrol; a symbol of integrity and duty.

Ashok Khemka — IAS officer transferred dozens of times for upholding rules against pressure; the personal cost of integrity.

T. N. Seshan — Chief Election Commissioner who asserted the Commission's independence and enforced the model code; institutional courage.

Armstrong Pame — IAS officer who built a 100-km road through public contribution where funds were absent; initiative and public service.

MOVE 7 — COURSE OF ACTION

The eight-step decision framework

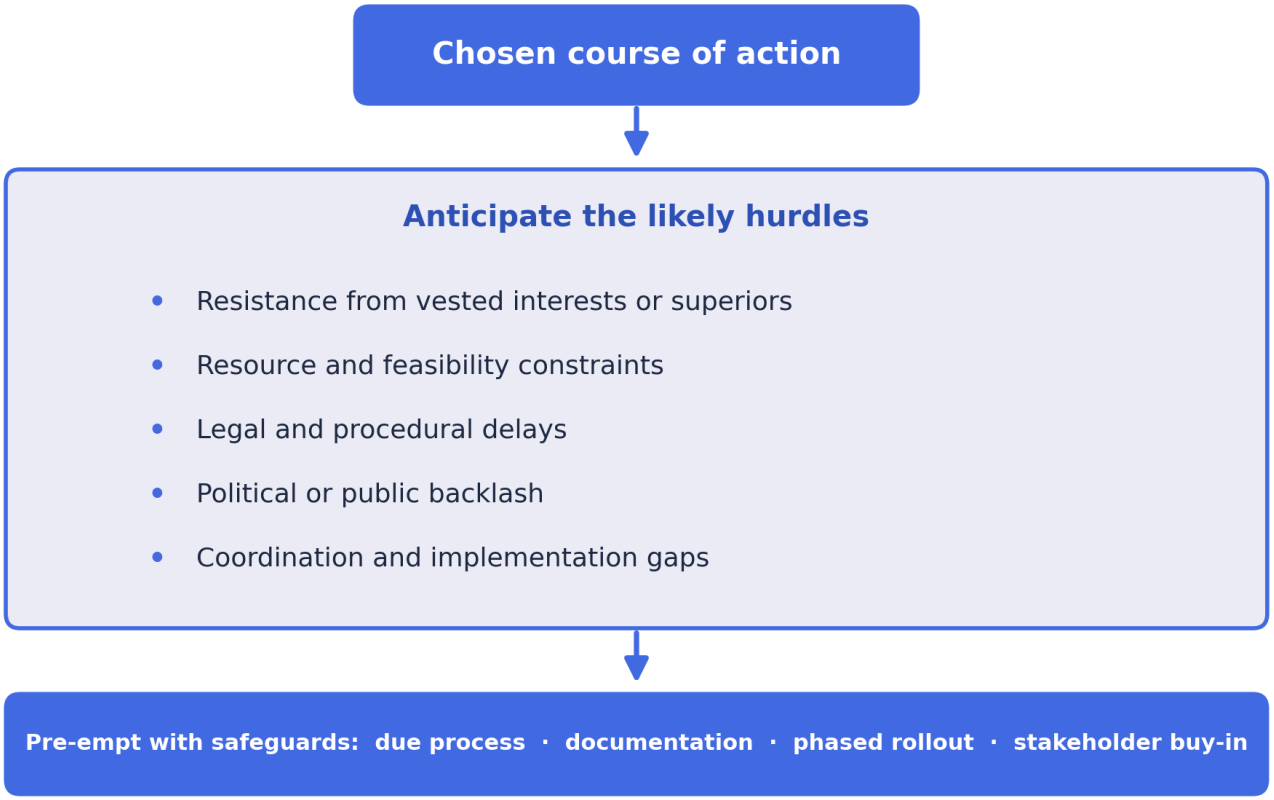
1. **Identify the ethical dilemma** — state the precise conflict.
2. **Analyse the context** — facts, constraints, urgency, the law.
3. **Refer to principles and values** — the compass from Move 2.
4. **Generate options** — usually three: two obvious extremes and a balanced third.
5. **Evaluate each option** — its consequences for every stakeholder.

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6. **Choose the best course** — the one maximising right and minimising harm.
7. **Implement with safeguards** — sequence, due process, documentation.
8. **Mitigate risks and reflect** — anticipate the fallout; note the lesson learned.

Anticipate the hurdles

Once you state the chosen course, add a quick flow of the obstacles it is likely to meet and the safeguards that pre-empt them — just pointers, not prose. It signals foresight and earns credit.



Measures — short-term and long-term (PESTLE)

After the immediate decision, add systemic measures so the same dilemma does not recur, and classify them. The PESTLE lens — Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Legal, Environmental — helps you generate a diverse set of long-term measures.

Short-term measures (immediate)	Long-term measures (systemic)
Address the immediate harm and protect the victim.	Reform the rule or process that created the dilemma.
Follow due process; document the decision.	Build institutional safeguards — audit, oversight, checks.
Escalate or report through the proper channel.	Training, value-orientation and ethical leadership.
Provide interim relief where warranted.	Transparency mechanisms and grievance redress.

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MOVE 7 — CONCLUSION

Close in three to four lines. Restate the resolution, lift it to a principle, and end forward-looking. A short, apt quote lands well — but only if it genuinely fits the case.

A reliable closing structure

1. One line affirming the chosen course and the value it upholds.
2. One line on the broader principle — that public office is a public trust, for instance.
3. One line that looks forward — how this builds institutional integrity and public trust.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Tie back to the core conflict you named in the introduction.	Introducing new arguments or stakeholders.
Keep it value-anchored and constructive.	Vague moralising or sermonising.
End decisive and forward-looking.	Sitting on the fence or refusing to choose.
Use a quote only where it fits.	Forcing in an unrelated quote.

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